She-Blah and the Princess Squad

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/18630664.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra/Scorpia (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra)

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by Dilly_Oh

Summary

Join Adora and her new BFFs Glimmer and Bow as they battle the Evil Horde and Adora's ex- er, I mean...old partner- no wait that doesn't help, um...previous best friend/household pet? Can she harness the power of She-Blah and save the world of Etheria, or will the Evil Horde prove too strong and evil? Because they are, like, super evil. Have I mentioned that?

Enjoy the episodes of She-ra, rewritten to be incredibly stupid and funny for your amusement!

Notes

Hi, I'm Dilly_Oh. I like to parody stuff. If you're into that kinda thing (no kink-shaming here), check out my other works here and on Fanfiction.net, under Dilly-Oh!

The Bored: Part One

Amidst the stars, a shimmering planet with many moons hung in the darkness of space. On that planet, in a craggy, hollowed out rift was a twisted, jumbled fortress of machinery and ancient technology.

Alone in her room, a young girl was busily getting ready for the day. She pulled on her boots and yanked her blond hair back into a ponytail. A toothbrush in her mouth, she turned to glare over her shoulder at a punching bag with a printout of Disney Princesses taped on it.

"You looking at me, Sleeping Beauty?" she asked, narrowing her eyes as she spat in the sink. "I'll knock your ass out so hard you won't *ever* wake up." She rolled out a line of floss and started flossing her gums. "Jasmine, you're gonna have to use one of those three wishes after I send you to a whole new world." She slammed a leg up onto the sink and started shaving. "And Snow White? No Prince will wanna kiss you after I'm done with-"

**Bzzzrt*!* The intercom buzzed on overhead. *"Adora, stop talking to your punching bag and get to the training area already."*

"Ugh, fine!" The girl punched the bag one last time, then turned and started for the exit. The bag came swinging back and hit her in the ass, sending her flying out the door. "Ow, SHIT- nobody saw that, right?" She scrambled to her feet and dusted herself off, then glared back at Mulan. "I'll make a man outta YOU-"

"*NOW, Adora*!"

"Ugh, FINE!" She jogged off down the hallway to a large room. Other cadets were lined up in a row, wearing similar gear, goggles and chest plates. One was a lizard, another a weedy-looking boy, and the final one a tough girl with dreadlocks.

“At attention, maggots!” The instructor, a weird blue spiky…*thing*, came strolling in, a computer pad in one hand. “Your simulation is about to begin. Here’s your scenario.” He pushed a button on his tablet and a holographic picture of woods popped up. “You're making your way through the treacherous Whispering Woods to reach the heart of the rebel insurgency: Bright Moon.”

“Dammit, I was hoping for a coffeshop AU,” someone muttered.

“Enemies-to-lovers for me,” said another.

“Your mission is to defeat the Queen of the Princesses in the name of Lord Hordak.” The instructor paused, glancing at the cadets. “Where's Catra?”

“She'll be here!” The blond girl said quickly. “She's probably...in the litter-box. Hang on, I'll call her.” She pulled out a bag of cat-treats and shook it noisily, clucking her tongue a few times. “Huh, usually she comes running when I do that-”

“I hope she knows attendance is fifty percent of the grade,” the instructor cut in. “Anyway. The Whispering Woods is filled with Princesses, vicious, violent instigators. They *will* kill you if given the chance, or worse…they'll break into *song*.” The cadets all shuddered in horror. “Begin!”

“Yes, sir!” The blond girl saluted smartly before hesitating. “I mean…ma'am? …Thing?”

“*GO*!”

The cadets all dashed out into the training area, a much larger room filled with pillars. Round robots with legs, wearing dresses and tiaras, popped out from behind the pillars and began shooting lasers. Everyone ran behind cover, dodging and weaving.

“Follow me, guys!” The blond girl called, taking charge and waving the others over. They all ran together deeper into the room. One robot suddenly popped up and started firing. “Watch out!” She immediately grabbed the weedy-looking kid and used him as a

body shield. He screamed in agony as the laser hit and fell to the ground, a big red X appearing on his chest plate.

“Dammit, Kyle!” the girl snapped angrily.

“I didn’t do anything!” Kyle protested. “YOU did that! I think I cracked a rib!”

“Yeah, well, I'm sure you deserved it-”

The group looked up to see that they were surrounded by robots.

“Okay well now you *definitely* deserved it-”

“How is this MY fault?!”

“Don’t worry, Kyle!” The girl assured him. “You’re still useful…”

“Oh thank you so much I knew you wouldn’t abandon me-”

“…As bait!” The girl stood up and cupped her hands around her mouth. “What’s THAT, Kyle? You’re secretly a PRINCE? Looking to MARRY? For LOVE, not MONEY?!” She kicked the boy away. “Run while they devour him alive!” She and the others ran, ignoring Kyle’s terrified screams as the robots closed in.

The cadets hurried on, emerging in an open area of the training room. The panels beneath their feet turned red and began to drop into blackness.

“Man, they have *really* got to repair these shitty floors- oh no wait this is part of the training. Everyone watch out! The floor is lava! We’ve trained for this!” The blond girl moved quickly to keep her footing. From a large hole in the floor, a huge robot emerged, unfolding its legs and looming menacingly. A dainty crown was perched atop its head, a smear of lipstick and mascara on its front. “There she is! The Queen! I’ve got her!” She pulled out a retractable pole and jumped around the room, dodging lasers and smashing bits off of the robot. With one final swing, she sent it crashing to the ground beside the hole and fell back, winded.

“Hey guys, sorry I'm late,” a young cat-girl with bushy hair, red clothing, and cat ears and a tail stood there, holding a cup of coffee and donut. “Actually you know what, I'm not sorry at all, this is *delicious*.” She took a nice, long sip. “*Ahhhhh*. So what’d I miss?” The cadets stared at her in disbelief. “What?” She glanced behind her and saw the robot teetering on the edge. “Oh.” She paused, then did was cats do best: batted it off the edge. “You’re welcome, losers. What would you suckers have done without me to save your sorry asses?”

“KYLE YOU PIECE OF SHIT-”

“HOW IS THIS *MY* FAULT?!”

The panels beneath the blond girl suddenly turned red and dropped. She fell with a cry. The cat-girl sauntered over and peeked over the edge.

“Hey, Adora.” She paused, then snorted. “Hang in there.”

“Now is *not* the time for cat memes, Catra!” Adora glared up at her, hanging suspended from her pole.

“Okay, fine, I'll just leave-”

“Have I mentioned how much I love Grumpy Cat?” Catra laughed and reached down to pull her up. Once she was back on her feet, Adora brushed herself off and sighed. “I can't believe you showed up late and stole all of our hard work-”

“Oh hey by the way can I copy your homework-”

“Okay, never mind, I totally believe it.”

“*Training exercise successfully completed*,” the intercom buzzed. “*Get the fuck out*.”

-Later-

Afterwards, Adora was changing in the locker room. She sighed as she pulled off her gear and opened her locker.

“Hey, Adora.”

“*Gah*!!” Adora jumped back. “How did you even FIT in there?”

“Ha!” Catra snickered, hopping out of the locker. “You should've seen the look on your face. It was *hilarious*. So goofy. Look, you're doing it now!” Adora glanced at the mirror.

“…That's just my normal face-”

“Exactly! Now come on, let's hit the showers!” Catra grabbed her and started licking her cheek.

“Ew! Gross, Catra! Get off!”

“Uh, you’re welcome, I was helping you *exfoliate*-”

“You need to grow up!” Adora grumbled, pulling on a red jacket and cinching her belt. “You are SO juvenile- *ohmigosh a mouse*!”

“*FFFTTTT*!!” Catra snarled, whirling around with claws out and launching herself at-

Kyle.

“…He deserved that, too,” Adora said over the screams. “Seriously, why are you in the girl’s locker room? *Creep*.”

“***Adoraaaaaa***…” A sinister woman in red robes and a mask slithered out from the shadows, hissing. The girls gasped aloud and drew back. “How was training, sweetie? Are you hungry? I packed you a lunch. You’re my big, growing girl!”

“Shadow Weaver!” Adora saluted her, then opened the lunchbox. “Ooh, Lunchables!”

“Sweet, is that tuna-”

“No! Bad kitty!” Shadow Weaver whipped out a spray bottle and sprayed Catra right in the face. She jerked back, hissing. “It's for Adora! Do you see Meow Mix in there? No? Then it’s not for you! Keep your paws off!” Her sharp tone suddenly softened. “Adoraaa, walk with me.” Adora glanced apologetically at her friend, slipped her the tuna, and hurried out after the woman. The two began to walk down the fortress hallway.

“Lord Hordak has been watching you,” Shadow Weaver said, “and he is *very*- hold my hand, sweetie, we’re crossing the hallway- impressed with your abilities. Your report card was very good this semester, and you're on the honor roll! You know what that means—ice cream party! He thinks you will make a fine candidate for Class President- I mean…Force Captain.”

“Ohmigosh REALLY?” Adora’s eyes sparkled with excitement.

“Yessss,” Shadow Weaver answered proudly, “he sees great promise in you. In fact, he is giving you the responsibility of leading a squadron against the rebel fortress of Thaymor! Isn’t that nice? You’ll have to send him a Thank-You card! I have the perfect stickers just for it!”

“You mean…I finally get to go on a *field trip*?!” Adora gasped in delight. “I’ll see active duty?! I’ll finally be able to actually punch someone in the FACE? I mean, someone *other* than the other cadets, mostly Kyle. *Ooh*, Catra is going to be so *psyched*!”

“YOU are going,” Shadow Weaver cut her off short. “THEY are not. I only signed your permission slip, sweetie, not theirs.”

“But…” Adora slumped, disappointed. “But the others have been working so hard- well, not Catra, she just sleeps in and comes in late and steals all of our hard work- but she *really* does want to get out there and show everyone what she’s capable of-”

“Catra is flunking all of her classes,” Shadow Weaver cut her off again. “She has spent more time in detention than in actual class.

Plus I think she's smoking catnip. That cat-girl is a bad influence. This is what I *raised* you for, Adora." She raised her hands and in a puff of smoke, a badge appeared. She held it out. "Now is your time to prove yourself. I saw talent in you the moment I found you as an orphan child and you punched me in the face. Isn't this what you have wanted since you were a child?" She gestured out the window at the view of the sinister fortress around them.

Adora stood there for a long moment, staring off into space as she reminisced…

"I wanna be a Power Ranger!" Five-year old Adora cried excitedly. Then she ran into a wall.

Adora blinked, coming back to herself in a rush.

"…Yup. Definitely. This is definitely what I want." She took the badge and stuffed it in her pocket.

"With you at the forefront, we will *crush* the Bright Moon rebellion once and for all! Do NOT disappoint me." Shadow Weaver paused, her words heavy with dark intent. "Dinner is at seven! I'm making spaghetti and meatballs. Don't be late, sweetie! Tee-hee!" She slithered off back into the shadows, hissing lowly.

"Okay, bye mom!" Adora called after her, waving. She stood there for a long moment. "…I trust her *completely*!"

"*You're a fucking idiot*," the intercom buzzed.

-Elsewhere-

Meanwhile, at a beautiful fortress at the bottom of a cascading waterfall, a young girl with short pink hair, wearing purple shorts and cape waited nervously at the entrance to the throne room.

“Send her in,” a voice called from inside. The girl took a deep, steadying breath and began to walk into a round hall, which was ringed with robed guards holding staffs. She walked elegantly, the picture of grace and-

“Sweetie, stand up straight, you're *slouching*-”

“Mom!”

“I’m serious, Glimmer! Good posture is important. It makes your breasts look bigger.” The Queen, a tall, willowy woman with long hair and wings sat on a raised throne. “Now, care to explain yourself? Why did you lead the rebellion into a fight after I ordered you to retreat? Were you selflessly trying to save a village from the Horde and be a hero to the common people of our land?”

“No, actually. I was pissed and didn’t want to listen to you.”

“*Glimmer*!”

“Come on, mom!” Glimmer threw up her arms. “How are we ever going to defeat the Horde if all we do is run away?! Pretty soon there won't be anything left for us to defend! Why’d you even *make* me a Commander if you won't let me *fight*?!” She paused. “Is this even REAL?” She lifted up her Commander badge.

“Of…of course it is,” the Queen began weakly. Glimmer continued glaring at her in silence. “…Alright, no, it isn’t. I got it from a cereal box.”

“I can’t believe you!”

“Darling, I know you're upset and crampy because you're on your *period*-”

“*MOM*!!! Oh my *GOD*!!”

“Do *not* raise your voice at me, young lady!” The Queen pointed off to the side. “Go to your room! You're *grounded*!”

“WHAT?! That's bullshit!”

“Don't backtalk me! You know how I hate fighting in front of the guards, it upsets them-”

“I dunno,” one guard spoke up, “I kinda think you're being a little unfair-”

“You shut your mouth unless you want to be grounded too!” The guard quieted immediately. The Queen pointed again. “Now! Go to your room!”

“FINE!” Glimmer exploded, storming off in a huff.

“And pick up your feet, I can hear them dragging from here!” The Queen called after her. Glimmer stomped harder. “That's *better*!”

-Back with Adora-

Back at the Horde fortress, Adora stood outside on a terrace, brooding over her Force Captain badge.

“Hey, Adora.” Catra popped her head up from beneath the railing. Adora screamed and threw herself backwards. “What's that you got there? Another gold star sticker from your *mom*?” She snatched the badge out of Adora’s hands and hopped up out of reach on a pipe.

“No, wait! Give that back!” Adora jumped to her feet. “Dammit, I have no treats to trade for it-”

“No way! You got *promoted*?!” Catra gasped. “You Teacher’s Pet! This is great! Now we're going to see the world and conquer it!” Her eyes shone with glee. “I am going to punch. So. Much. SHIT.”

“Um, sorry,” Adora cut her off awkwardly, “but Shadow Weaver says…you're not invited.”

“*What*?! Why not?!” Catra’s fur ruffled in outrage. “Seriously, what's her *problem* with me?!”

“Well you *did* scratch up her couch and favorite drapes-”

“No, it must be Kyle's fault.” Catra’s eyes narrowed dangerously. “I'm totally gonna puke in his shoes later.” She looked away, upset, and began climbing the pipe.

“Hey, wait, Catra! Come back, don't go up there!” Adora called. It was too late. Catra had already climbed up and out of reach.

In her cat-tree.

“I never should have bought you that,” Adora muttered to herself. She sighed and went to join her, sitting at the base of the tree, Catra hanging half in/half out of the top. “I'm sorry, Catra. I didn't know you wanted to be a Force Captain.”

“I *don't*,” Catra sniffed irritably. “Here, take your stupid badge.” She tossed it back. It sailed over the edge of the railing and went pinging all the way down. “...I'm not going to get that.”

“It’s fine, I'll have her make me another.” Adora looked up at her. “Come on, I've been working for this my entire life, can't you be happy for me?”

“I thought you wanted to be a Power Ranger.”

“…I told you that in confidence-”

“I just wanna get OUT of this dump before I die of boredom,” Catra groaned, flopping over dramatically. “Or before they have me fixed. I mean, I don’t even KNOW what's outside the Fright Zone, anyway.” She paused for a moment. “Probably a Mcdonalds.” Adora snorted, then looked up at her friend with a wry smile.

"…Wanna go stare at the corner for no reason to freak people out?"

"Naw, I'm not in the mood."

"…Wanna get high on catnip and steal a skiff?"

"Fuck yeah."

-One Stolen Skiff Later-

"Holy shit, you're awesome! I can't believe you *stole* this!" Catra cried, the two of them riding through the wide, empty desert aboard a small vehicle with a sail.

"I didn't steal it, I *borrowed* it," Adora corrected her.

"I'm pretty sure when you knock someone out it's stealing."

"He's going to get it back!"

"As well as his higher brain function, too, I hope."

"I didn't hit him that hard!"

"I take back everything I said to the others about you being a huge nerd!"

"Hey, thanks, that really- wait what did you say about me?"

They zoomed over the sand, driving through craggy peaks, the brilliant sunset washing the sky in front of them a deep red.

"Let me drive!" Catra said, grabbing the steering stick.

"*Wait I don't have liability insurance I'm not covered for this*-"

Almost immediately, they began to lose control of the vehicle as they fought over the controls. They barely managed to screech to a halt at the edge of a thick wood with winding trees and hanging vines.

“Whoa…what is this place?” Catra asked in a hushed voice.

“I think this is the Whispering Woods,” Adora whispered back. “There are monsters in there, and every Horde squadron that’s entered have never returned-”

“Pffft, why would they call it the Whispering Woods, that's the *dumbest* name I've ever heard-”

“*Says the cat that’s named Catra*,” the woods whispered back.

“What did you say to me?!”

“*I said…biiiiitch*-”

“That's it! You're gonna get it!” Catra seized the steering stick again, charging the skiff deeper into the woods. “Say that to my face!”

“I can't believe you're *actually* fighting with a forest!” Adora shouted, struggling to regain control of the vehicle. They crashed through branches and scored tree trunks in their mad flight. “Slow down! We're going to-”

They sideswiped a tree and Adora went flying, tumbling off the skiff and landing heavily in a shrub.

“…That. We're going to that.” Her eyes rolled up and she flopped over, unconscious.

-Later-

A while later, Adora slowly sat up, groaning. She spat out a mouthful of leaves and looked at her surroundings blearily.

"Ugggh I'm totally going to lose my driver's license- Catra? Hello?" She glanced around, but saw no sign of her friend. "I swear to God she better not be stuck in a tree again. That'll be, like, the third time this week I have to call the Fire Department." Suddenly she gasped at the sight of a shining sword tangled in a nest of roots, a shaft of light shining down on it. "Whoa, cool!" Adora got to her feet and walked closer, her eyes gleaming with interest. Unable to resist, she slowly reached out a hand to- "*Psych*! You seriously think I'm dumb enough to touch something that looks magical? Get real! How stupid do you think I am?" She snorted and turned to walk away, tripped on one of the roots, pin-wheeled her arms for a second, then fell on her face. One flailing hand hit the sword's pommel, and it exploded with light. Adora shrieked as strange images bitch-slapped her mind, accompanied with a mysterious voice.

"*Balance must be restored*," the voice intoned. "*Etheria must seek a hero*." The voice paused. "*Thank you for your order, please drive around to the next window*." Adora could hear a baby crying and saw strange people and places, as well as a few Superbowl ads and a creepy clown making balloon animals- *wait what*- finally, she saw a vision of a female warrior with long, flowing hair and a gleaming sword that she could have *sworn*-

"*Adora*," the voice said. "*Adora*…hey, Adora!"

Adora's eyes popped open. Catra sat on her chest, batting at her face with one hand.

"Finally. I thought you were dead." Catra pouted. "Feed me."

"Can't…*breathe*!" she wheezed out.

"Oh, sorry." Catra hopped off of her. "You okay? Did you hit your head? Quick, how many fingers am I holding up?" She held up her middle finger.

“Okay that's not even funny-”

“Yup you're totally fine.” Catra rolled her eyes. “Still the same old tight-ass.”

“I do squats!”

“Not what I meant. *Anyway*, did you get the license plate of whoever we hit? I'm taking that asshole to *court*-”

“It was a TREE!”

“Oh.” Catra blinked. “…Well then I'm chopping that bitch down and then taking it to *court*-”

“Are you sure *you're* not the one who got brain damage?” Adora sat up, scowling. “Wait, where is it where, did it go?!” She looked around desperately. “There was a sword here, I swear! I touched it and it got super bright and then there was a *clown* and he took balloon animal requests and I asked for a GIRAFFE-”

“Alright, I think you've had too much catnip,” Catra cut her off, helping her up. “C’mon, let's go home.”

“You snorted all the catnip, I’m totally clean!”

“Okay then, let’s see you walk a straight line and follow my middle finger-”

They continued arguing all the way back to the skiff, which was double-parked and had a ticket stuck under the wiper.

“I am NOT paying this!” Adora snatched the ticket off and tore it in half, the two of them boarding the skiff to begin the long drive back to the Horde Fortress. “My insurance rate better not go up because of this…”

“*Yeah, that's right, leave, bitch*-”

“You MOTHER-” Catra tried to grab the steering stick again.

“Don't you *dare*!” Adora hollered.

-Back at Bright Moon-

Back at Bright Moon, a mysterious figure snuck closer to the castle through the surrounding woods, moving quietly and stealthily, sticking to the shadows. They stopped at the edge of the trees, where a cliff created a natural moat around the fortress, and began spying on the Princess through a circular window. Inside, Glimmer sulked in her room, laying on a couch with pillows while writing in her diary.

“I know that mom loves me, but sometimes she's too controlling and I feel bad. I just wish that she would have more faith in me as her daughter and allow me the freedom to act as I choose.” She sighed and sat back. “Okay, that's enough for my decoy diary that Mom will find and read. Time for my *real* one.” She tossed the fake diary aside and pulled out her real one. “Dear diary. Mom’s a bitch.”

The shadowed figure readied an arrow, aiming it with deadly accuracy. Once the target was sighted, the arrow was released, shooting through the window and hitting it dead-center. Glimmer screamed-

“*PRINCESS PEE-PEE NOOOO*!”

One of her stuffed animals was pinned to the wall, impaled by the arrow. She tore it free and stomped over to the window.

“I told you to stop doing that, Bow!” She hissed. She held up her disemboweled stuffed hamster. “Look, you killed Princess Pee-Pee!”

“Oh my God! I'm a *murderer*!” The stranger, an adorable young man in a crop top, belt and boots, burst into tears. “I’m SO sorry!

We'll have a funeral for her and everything! I'll order a casket and some lovely flowers-"

"Stop shouting!"

"What?"

"*Shh*!!" Glimmer leaned further out her window. "Be *quiet*! I'm *grounded*!" Bow pulled out a loudspeaker.

"**WHAT**?"

"Where did you even- ARGH!" Glimmer teleported over to him in a cloud of sparkles, grabbed his arm, and teleported back into her bedroom.

"...I think my underwear is on backwards now," Bow stated after a pause.

"Oh my God, speaking about panties in a twist, I'm SO mad at Mom right now-"

"Is this about how we snuck out last week to go clubbing because I *told* her that it was the bake club-"

"You *told* her about that?!" Glimmer gaped at him in disbelief. "She grounded me after I refused to give up my chocolate-chip cookie recipe!"

"Oh." Bow winced. "Sorry. My bad."

"Anyway, I'm talking about that botched battle. I was just trying to prove myself! I don't understand why she gets so mad. It's just not fair." She teleported up to her hanging bed and went on as Bow began to tidy up her room. "She acts like I can't do anything because I'm just a Princess!"

"Uh, *everyone* here is a Princess," Bow said, then paused. "I'm, like, the only one who *isn't*." He paused again. "Which is ridiculous because I look *great* in a dress."

“Why doesn’t she trust me?!”

“Maybe it's because your teleporting powers aren't that great?” Bow said cautiously.

“What?! You take that back!” Glimmer glared down at him, then disappeared in a cloud of sparkles. She was gone for several moments, then finally reappeared next to him, dripping wet.

“...You fell in the river, didn't you.”

“Shut up!!”

“You have a fish in your hair.” Bow paused while folding her underwear. “Are you grumpy cuz you're on your period-”

“Not you too!”

“Well, don’t worry, cuz I've got just the thing to cheer you up! Here, this’ll be *sure* to impress your mom!”

“Bow, please, not more cookies-”

“No, this!” He pulled out a small gadget with a lit-up screen. “I've detected a piece of First One tech in the Whispering Woods! Let's go get it for her!”

“Did you forget I'm *grounded*-”

Knock knock

“Glimmer? Are you in there?” Queen Angella called from the other side of the door. “My mother senses are tingling. Also I installed several cameras and a baby monitor. Is there a boy in your room?” Glimmer choked, panicking, and grabbed hold of Bow, teleporting away. They appeared in the lady’s bathroom to the accompaniment of several high-pitched screams, mostly from Bow. Glimmer let him go and teleported back to her room.

“Everything’s fine, Mom!” she called. “Go away! I’m, like, *super* crampy! My flow is like…really heavy today!”

“I heard voices! Is someone in there with you?”

“No, Mom! I was…practicing kissing on pillows and other girl stuff! Can you leave me alone now?”

“Well, all right. Make sure to work the tongue, that's the secret to a good kiss-”

“*Mom*! That's gross!”

“Watch your tone, young lady! You listen to me when I am giving you tips-”

After a few minutes of yelling, Glimmer teleported back into the lady’s bathroom.

“I’m in- are you peeing in there?”

“Be out in a minute,” Bow said from inside the stall.

-Back at the Horde Fortress-

Inside the sinister fortress, the cadets were all fast asleep in their spare bunks. Adora also lay in bed, Catra curled up on her feet. Adora twisted and turned in her sleep, plagued with images of the strange woman and sword from earlier. Suddenly she jerked awake, sitting bolt upright and screaming her head off.

“*AAAAAAA*- how did that not wake anyone up oh wait that's how we always wake up here. It's perfectly normal.” She blinked, then looked down at her friend still sleeping on her feet. “*Aww*.” With great care, she replaced her feet with a small cardboard box, which Catra immediately curled up in, slipped out of bed, and

pulled on her jacket and boots. Checking behind her one last time, she snuck towards the door and opened it.

“Hey, Adora.”

“GAH!” Adora jumped back, face-to-face with Catra. “What- how did- but you were just over-” She sighed in resignation. “I don’t even want to know.”

“Where you going?” Catra asked, cocking her head.

“Uh…the bathroom.”

“*No she’s not*,” the intercom interrupted. “*She’s a lying bitch*.”

“Shut the fuck up- okay, fine! You got me. I'm going back to the woods.” Adora brushed past her. Catra frowned.

“Adora, if you have to take a dump, you can just use the bathroom down the hall. Or use my litter-box, I told you I don’t mind.”

“What? No! That's not why I-”

“Oh, it’s not?” Catra huffed and rolled her eyes. “Look, you don't have to go beat up that tree for me. I told you it was okay, I'm not angry anymore-”

“That's not why either- LISTEN! I'm just…going on a walk in the woods, okay? Alone. In the middle of the night.” She paused for a beat. “…With no-one else around-”

“You're acting weird,” Catra leaned in close. “Are you *sure* you don't have brain damage? Let me see your pupils. *How many middle fingers am I holding up*?”

“STOP.” Adora shoved her away. “I told you, I'm fine. I’ll be back before you know it. Just stay here, okay?” She waited for a moment, then glared up at the ceiling. “A little help, here?”

"*Ugh, fine,"* the intercom grumbled. *"Catra, report to…anywhere other than here. There's, like, a can of Fancy Feast or something for you*." Catra gasped in delight and went scurrying off down the hall. "*You owe me, bitch*."

"Yeah, uh-huh, sure thing," Adora muttered under her breath. "Not."

"*I heard that*."

"*OKAY* I'M LEAVING *GAWD*."

-In the Whispering Woods-

Meanwhile, Glimmer and Bow were wandering the Whispering Woods, tracking the strange signal with the help of Bow's gadget. Or, rather, *trying* to.

"This darn thing isn't working!" Bow said in frustration, giving it a shake. "I'm not picking up anything!"

"Let me see it!" Glimmer took the tablet from him and frowned at the screen. "Tracking hot singles in your area- BOW!!"

"Sorry!! It must be acting up again."

"EW oh my God you just got a text from another single and it's a *dick pic* gross!" She flung it away in disgust.

"Glimmer, no!" Bow cried. "We need that to find the signal-" An eerie glow suddenly lit up from behind a line of trees. "…Or we could just follow that."

Elsewhere in the forest, Adora was also walking through the trees, muttering to herself under her breath.

“Seriously, what are you *doing* out here, girl, Catra is right, this is *crazy*, there's no sword, you didn't see any weird images and you should just go home and forget about all of this before that creepy clown shows up again and starts making those balloon animals-” She stopped when she saw a strange glow in the trees up ahead. “…Or I could just follow that.” She cautiously pushed past some large leaves and gasped as she caught sight of the glowing sword in the clearing, just as she remembered it. “A-*ha*! I *knew* that you were real! I *knew* I wasn't crazy! Alright, start talking!” She paused. “…I'm interrogating a sword I *am* crazy.”

Glimmer and Bow walked out from behind a bush, entering the clearing as well.

“Bow, will you put that stupid thing down already?”

“No! When you threw my tracker you accidentally sent a kissy-face to that creep and now he won't stop sending me dick pics-”

The pair looked up, saw Adora, and the three of them froze in place.

“Princess!!” Adora cried, alarmed.

“Horde soldier!” Glimmer shot back.

“…Bow!”

The standoff went on for a few more seconds, and then Glimmer just started screaming. Bow joined in a moment later.

“*AAAAAA*- why are we screaming- *AAAAAAA*!”

“*AAAAAA*- I don’t know, confuse her with sound- *AAAAAA*!”

Adora bolted for the sword, but Glimmer was too fast for her. She teleported to the weapon, snatching it up and hurling it towards Bow.

“Bow, catch!”

Bow screeched and dodged out of the way, narrowly avoiding losing his head. The sword stabbed harmlessly into a tree.

"…Right. Sorry." Glimmer blinked. "Probably wasn't such a good idea to *throw* a sword at you."

"You should've thrown it at *her*!"

"Just give me the sword!" Adora shouted, making another run for the weapon. "Stay back! I don't wanna hurt you!" Glimmer teleported in the way again, throwing a fistful of glitter in her face. Adora shrieked. "Agh, right in the eyes! That's going to take forEVER to get out of my hair, too! Okay, changed my mind! Definitely want to hurt you now!"

The three of them collapsed in a heap, all of them struggling to claim the sword. Adora growled and reached for it.

"Get OFF of me you heartless- are you *tickling* me?"

"I show no mercy!" Bow cried. "Look away, Glimmer! I'm going for her weak spots!"

With a last desperate attempt, Adora finally touched the sword. Just like before, it exploded with light, throwing them all back. She opened her eyes to find herself in a strange dimension with glimmering lights, sharp angles, and odd shapes. The same mysterious voice as before began to speak.

"*Hello, Adora*." Adora whirled around to find a tall woman in a robe and dress covered in strange symbols staring at her calmly.

"Whoa! Who are you?! What's going on?"

"*My name is Light Hope*," the woman answered. "*I have been waiting for you for a very long time, but I could not reach you until you forged your connection with the sword*." She paused. "*Also the Wi-Fi signal here is shit*."

“What? What are you talking about?” Adora whipped out her phone and frowned down at it. “Oh shit, you weren’t kidding, I have like, *one* bar-”

“*The sword is meant for you*,” the woman went on. “*Etheria needs you, Adora. Will you answer its call?”*

“…Well that depends, is it in my network or will I get charged for it-”

“Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull?”

“Okay, I don’t even know who that IS. Decline!” Adora tapped her phone and put it away. “Listen lady, can you just explain what’s going ON here?” Light Hope just stood there, arm upraised, unmoving. A circle started spinning in place in front of her. “… Bitch are you *buffering*-”

“*Connection Time-out*.” Light Hope winked out of existence, another brilliant flash of light throwing Adora back. She cracked open her eyes again to find herself sitting back in the woods, her hands tied.

“Hey, she's awake!” Bow shouted from right beside her. Glimmer crouched next to him, holding the sword.

“Yeah, I certainly am now that you've *yelled in my ear*,” Adora muttered, glaring at him. He pulled out his megaphone.

“**WHAT**?”

“Silence, Horde spy!” Glimmer snapped. “*I* ask the questions! How did you make it so far into the Whispering Woods? What are you scheming? *Talk*!”

“Yeah!” Bow joined in. “And who does your hair, it's, like, *super* cute-”

“Bow!”

“I literally just walked in,” Adora snapped back, “and I do my hair myself. Also, I'm not a spy!” She paused. “But while I'm here, would you mind telling me any weaknesses in your fortifications and the number of soldiers and weapons you have?”

“Oh, yeah, sure!” Bow smiled. “Well, I'd say the west wing is our weak point-”

“BOW!!”

“I'm sorry! She just asked so *politely*. It was instinctual.”

“How dare you try and steal our sword!” Glimmer said, scowling at Adora. She snorted.

“It's not yours. I found it first, so it's *mine*. Also, I spit on it.”

“You did not!”

Adora hawked and spat onto the sword.

“There. Now it's mine.”

“*GROSS*!” Glimmer used her cape to wipe off the sword. “Come on, Bow! Let's get this spy back to Bright Moon where she can be interrogated properly.”

“Right!” Bow gave Adora a firm look. “We're talking full-on tickle attacks until you *pee* yourself laughing- God I’m getting sick just *thinking* about it-” Glimmer grabbed his arm and hauled him off to the side.

“Oh my gosh, this is *perfect*!” She whispered excitedly. “We have First One tech AND a Horde spy! Mom is going to be SO happy with these presents!”

“Plus those cookies we made at the bake club!”

“*Will you stop with the cookies*- on your FEET, maggot!”

-Later-

The trio had been walking through the woods for some time, with no end in sight. The trees were becoming thicker and wilder with every minute, strange noises and rustling coming from the growing shadows. One skeezy-looking guy even popped up out of a bush and offered to sell them some weed.

“Uh, are you *sure* you know where we're going?” Bow asked, casting nervous glances left and right.

“Of course I do!” Glimmer replied, holding the scanner close to her face. “Trust me.”

“I dunno, I think we've walked by that tree a few times-”

“What? The dick-shaped one?” Bow stared at her in confusion.

“…How would you even *know*-” *_Ding_!* “Oh right.” He blinked. “Look, Glimmer. I've pretty much grown up in these woods, and I've *never* seen this part of it. Like that tree. What the *fuck* is that tree. I can't even think of a *shape* for it-”

“It kinda looks like a crooked dick, if you squint and tilt your head a little.”

“They’re trees! They all look like dicks!”

“Can you guys please stop talking about dicks,” Adora said, dead-pan. “Or…or is this part of the torture, because it’s working.”

“Shut up! I've got this!” Glimmer teleported away in a huff. Bow winced and turned to Adora.

“Sorry about her, she's not normally this irritable. She's just a little testy because she's on her period-”

“*BOW*!!”

“So anyway,” Bow went on pleasantly, “what's your name? I love your jacket, it's so fashionable! Where did you get it? Was it on sale? Did you get a good deal?” Adora glared at him, refusing to talk, even as he helped her around roots and under hanging branches. “Tell me if you get tired and I’ll give you a piggyback ride-”

“Would you stop being so nice to me?!” Adora finally burst out. “We're *enemies*, you know!”

“…Huh. I thought I was being pretty rude. I mean, I didn't even complement your shoes or anything.”

“This is you being *mean*?” Adora gaped at him for a moment, then glanced over at Glimmer, who teleported face-first into a tree. “You know she's a Princess, right? How can you follow her? They're a dangerous threat to everyone on Etheria! They’re don't even know how to control their powers! Have you not *seen* Frozen? That bitch froze an entire town! And Snow White enslaved seven men-”

“Is that what Hordak told you?” Bow shook his head in disbelief. “You've got it all wrong! Glimmer is the sweetest, *gentlest*-”

“MOVE, PRISONER! NO BATHROOM BREAKS! YOU NEED TO GO, YOU GO IN YOUR *PANTS*-”

“Glimmer holy shit WHOA-”

“Too much? It was too much. Sorry.” Glimmer paused. “…You can have *one* bathroom break, so go now if you have to- *SHIT*!”

“Uh, I don’t, I mean, I can try- oh this is what you’re talking about.”

The group suddenly halted as they came upon the wreckage of a house, now no more than a burned out shell with streamers of toilet paper hanging from the trees. The three of them gaped at the senseless destruction.

“Oh my *God*!” Adora gasped in horror. “This is *monstrous*! Who could've done this? I bet it was some asshole seventh-graders-”

“Don't play dumb!” Glimmer barked at her. “You know it was the Horde!”

“What? No! The Horde wouldn't do this!” Adora protested. Glimmer pointed at a fried robot slumped in the bushes. “…That doesn't prove anything!” Glimmer pointed at graffiti sprayed on the wall that said ‘The Horde Was Here.’ “…That could have been anyone!” Glimmer pointed at a selfie the Horde soldiers had taken, all posing and smiling proudly in front of the ruined house. “… Okay you got me there. But…but…Hordak says we’re doing what's best for Etheria! We’re just trying to make things better…more orderly!”

“You mean more HORDERLY!” Glimmer shot back.

“WIG!” Bow shouted. Glimmer high-fived him before continuing.

“Ever since you guys showed up, you’ve been poisoning our land, burning our cities, and destroying everything in your path! *Nothing’s* too low for you! Even *littering*.” Bow gasped in horror. “And you're a *part* of it!” She turned and stomped angrily away.

“But this doesn't make any sense!” Adora shook her head in confusion. “The Horde wouldn't DO this! We’re a *peaceful* death army!” She paused. “…There’s something wrong with what I just said.”

“Come on,” Bow said, stepping close to her. “How can you NOT know what’s going on? I mean, you guys are literally called *the Evil Horde*.”

“WHAT WHO CALLS US THAT I’LL PUNCH ‘EM SO HARD THEY SHIT THEIR OWN GUTS- *ohhh my gosh we aaaare evil ohhhhh noooo*…” Adora started whimpering. “But still…the Horde rescued me when I was a baby and gave me a home! They’re my *family*. You just don't know them!”

“Maybe YOU don't know them like you THINK you do,” Bow told her quietly.

“Oh yeah, well, maybe YOU don’t know them like you THINK I know them like I KNOW I do-”

“Wait, *what*?” Bow blinked in confusion. There was a sudden shriek and Glimmer came running back towards the pair, tablet in hand, still screaming. “Glimmer, what’s wrong? Is it another dick pic? For God’s sake, I told you to let *me* hold it-” An enormous beetle-monster emerged from the ground in a shower of rocks and dirt, looming over the group and roaring menacingly. “…Okay yeah that's worse.” Bow quickly joined in with the terrified screams.

“Watch out!” Glimmer teleported away as the bug struck, throwing glitter in its eyes. Bow tried his luck with some well-aimed arrows and the p-word (please). Neither was effective, and they were both struck down by a mighty swing of the beetle’s claw.

“A-ha!” Adora seized her chance and snatched up the sword lying on the ground, then hesitated, her gaze flicking between the defenseless Bow and Glimmer and the monster-bug as it went in the for the kill. “Uhh…” The beetle was salting and peppering them. “UHHH…” Now it was tying on a bib. “*UHHH*…” It was slowly lowering the pair into its mouth. “***UUUHHHH***-”

“*DO* SOMETHING, BITCH!”

“Okay, fine! Hey, bug-brain!” Adora shouted at the overgrown insect. “Pick on someone your own size!” She paused. “…So obviously not me. I’m, like, *tiny* compared to you. I’m sure if you just leave you’ll easily find- WHOA!” She shrieked as the beetle leapt at her, striking with its claws. Desperately, she blocked the blows with the sword, then lifted it to-

“*Low battery are you fucking kidding me*-” Adora hissed in frustration, then lifted the sword again as an idea occurred to her.

Holding the weapon high, she cried aloud: "For the honor of… Gray-whatever!"

"*Close enoooough*!" a voice sang out. There was a blinding flash of light from the sword, and once it faded away, there stood a glowing warrior with long, flowing hair and a white and gold uniform with a rippling cape. The beetle immediately stepped back, Bow and Glimmer gaping in awe at the majestic sight. The girl stood tall and proud, a thing of utter grace and confidence-

"THE FUCK AM I *WEARING*?!"

-Episode One End-

The Bored: Part Two

Head held high and golden hair rippling, the glowing warrior stood proudly in front of the bug monster, Glimmer and Bow gaping in shock from the sidelines.

"*WIIIIGGGGG-*"

"BOW WILL YOU CUT THAT OUT?!"

Adora looked down at herself and screamed.

"THE FUCK AM I *WEARING*?! And what's with my *hair*, why won't it stop moving, is there a fan blowing nearby or did I suddenly start using Pantene Pro-V and not the two-in-one/body-wash I normally use?! And these *shorts-*" She paused in consideration. "…are actually *really* comfortable." She started doing squats. "Oh yeah I'm keeping these- *LEG CRAMP*!"

Adora fell over, clutching her leg, and her powers winked off, reverting back to her normal attire and much less lustrous ponytail. The sword's light flickered weakly, flashing a red battery symbol. Glimmer teleported over and snatched it from her hands.

"Oh, great! You used it all up! Now it's out of battery!"

"What the hell did you DO to me?!" Adora shouted back at her. "You've *infected* me with your Princess germs! What, am I going to start singing about love and dancing with woodland creatures?!"

"Okay, everyone just calm down!" Bow said shrilly, moving to stand between them. "CALM *DOWN*!" His voice broke at the end. Dogs howled in the distance.

"…Are you crying?" Adora asked in confusion.

"No! Fighting just…really upsets me. Why can't we all just get along?" He burst into tears and covered his face with his hands.

“Okay, okay, we’ll stop, so no more crying!” Glimmer patted his back soothingly, then glared at Adora and mouthed ‘fuck you’. Adora pointed at her and then throttled the air in return.

“How did you even DO that?” Bow asked in wonder, sniffling and dabbing his eyes with a Kleenex. He blew his nose with a loud honk.

“I have no idea!” Adora shook her head, dumbfounded. “I just picked up the sword and, ta-dah! I was a Princess just like that! I didn't even get to do a magical transformation like Sailor Moon or whatever.”

“Hey, yeah! That's totally not fair! That's like my *favorite* part-”

“I don't care *how* she did it!” Glimmer rudely interrupted. “We just have to make sure she *never* does it again!” The huge bug monster screeched, looming over them. “…Okay do it again do it again do it-” She threw the sword back at Adora. She screamed and barely dodged it in time.

“What have I told you about throwing swords?!” Bow shouted. “At least throw it at the giant bug!”

“I got it!” Adora snatched up the sword and stood there awkwardly. “…Wait now what.”

“Try the Sailor Moon approach!” Bow suggested. “Quick, take off your clothes and yell ‘Sword Power, Make Up’! I’ll provide the music. Dun DUN-”

“We don't have time for this! RUN!!” Glimmer yelled over them. They all began to sprint through the woods, the rampaging bug close behind. They emerged from the trees and saw some ancient ruins in the shape of a pyramid in the distance.

“Whoa, what is this place?” Adora asked as they drew closer. “Will we be safe here?”

“I don't know, lemme check the Yelp reviews and see if it has a good rating-”

“BOW!!”

“Fine, if we get mugged, it’s your fault!”

The three of them ran to the front entrance of the ruin and began trying to force their way in without any luck.

“Stand back, guys! I’ve got this!” Bow cracked his knuckles, took a deep breath, and knocked on the door. “Pizza’s here!” There was no answer. “Huh, that usually works-”

“Grab onto me! I'll teleport us all inside!” Glimmer cried.

“Glimmer, no!” Bow shook his head vehemently. “You've never teleported *three* people before! What if we fuse together and I become your freakish second head- actually wait that’d be kinda cool because then we'd *always* be together but no wait what if we had a *fight*-”

“Do you have a better idea?!” she shouted back. He stared at her for a moment, then turned and knocked on the door again.

“Girl Scout cookies!” Still no answer. “Yeah I'm all out.”

“Wait! Something’s written here.” Adora squinted at some strange markings scrawled on the side of the door. “It looks like…some kind of password?”

“Looks more like a butt to me,” Bow stated. “How can you even read that, they have, like, the *worst* penmanship I've ever-”

“Just hurry and read it aloud!” Glimmer shouted impatiently.

“Uh…one…two…three, four!”

“Are you KIDDING-”

The door ground open and they dashed inside just as the bug caught up, the door slamming shut in its face. There was a pause, followed by a polite knock on the door.

"***Pizzaaaa***," came a ferocious grumble.

"BOW DON'T YOU *DARE* ANSWER THAT!"

"I wasn't gonna!" Bow huffed. "I guess *nobody's* having pizza tonight."

It was pitch-black inside the ruin. Glimmer created a glowing sphere of light, illuminating their surroundings. They were in a very tall, empty hall with huge pillars. She turned to find Bow and Adora hugging each other in the dark. The two quickly jumped apart.

"…You're a pretty good hugger," Bow said after an awkward pause. "Not the best, but you've definitely got potential. I'd give you a six out of ten. I'd know, I'm *kind* of an expert."

"Just a six?! Get back here!" Adora started rolling up her sleeves.

"Hands off!" Glimmer stepped in front of her, glaring. "And Bow, stop being a hug-slut!"

"You know I can't help it! I need my fix." Bow looked at Adora. "So anyway, how come you can read First One writing? Did you take it in high school? I took Spanish. *Me llamo Bow. Donde esta la biblioteca*-"

"Bow, there's no way she took a *class* for a language that hasn't been spoken in a thousand years!" Glimmer interrupted with a scoff.

"I did, actually."

"Wait what? *How*?" Glimmer gaped at her in disbelief. "…Were you in Honors-"

“No, not really.” Adora rolled her eyes. “I took Punching and Kicking 101, like a normal teenager.”

“…I don't think that's what normal teenagers take-”

“Oh yeah? What was your curriculum?” Adora glared at Glimmer. “How to seduce princes and brainwash people through song?”

“No, it was how to clap-back, BITCH, and you best believe I gots a four-point-HO-”

Both girls started winding up when they heard Bow’s breath hitching dangerously.

“Oh my gosh OKAY we'll stop.” They shook hands, gripping harder than necessary, then flipped each other off while Bow was wiping his eyes.

“We need to find a way out of here,” Glimmer said, glancing around, “and bring our captive back to Bright Moon as soon as possible. My mom will get all the information we need out of her, she's a *master* of torture. I would know. Just wait until she starts guilt-tripping you. Or telling you that she’s not angry, just *disappointed*. Let's go!” She started to walk away as Bow turned to Adora.

“Thanks for saving us from that monster bug-”

“Hey NO do NOT thank the enemy!” Glimmer shouted back at him. “There is a *line*, Bow!”

“You mean…I can't even…” Bow stood there, one hand up in the air.

“No! Absolutely not! Don't you *dare* give her a high-five! Put it down!!” Bow whimpered, but obeyed. Glimmer huffed and went back to leading the way.

“Whatever, I just wanted the sword,” Adora said coldly.

“Are you sure it's not because you *secretly liiiiike us*?” Bow asked, leaning in close and smirking. Adora narrowed her eyes dangerously.

“I could snap your neck in an instant.”

“…But you haven't yet! Point to Bow!” He pumped a fist in triumph, and the two started walking after Glimmer, moving deeper into the hall. “That’s me, by the way. I’m Bow.”

“Adora,” Adora said shortly.

“Adora?” Bow gasped, his eyes sparkling. “Oh my gosh, that name is… ADORABLE. Want to guess why my name’s Bow? Huh? Huh??” He was holding his bow and quiver. “I’ll give you a hiiiint!”

“I think I'm going to snap my own neck.”

Up ahead, Glimmer hesitated, glancing back to check on them, then brought the sword close to her face.

“For the honor of Grey Skull,” she whispered under her breath. The sword didn’t respond. “Oh come on, I wanna feel what it’s like to be tall and friggin SWOL-”

“Whatcha doing?” Bow asked, suddenly standing beside her. She jerked in surprise.

“*Bwah*! Nothing!!”

“*Error, error*!” The sword squawked out an alarm. “*Unauthorized user attempting to find out what it’s like to be tall and-*”

“*Hyah*!” Glimmer threw the sword down the hallway, where it skittered into the shadows. “…Yeah I know I need to stop throwing it. Anyway! Look at these carvings.” She gestured at the strange symbols on the walls. “I think this is a First One’s ruin.”

“Actually,” said Bow, “I think those are just dicks some teenagers drew.”

“What's a First One?” Adora asked.

“The First Ones are the original settlers of Etheria,” Bow explained patiently. “They disappeared a thousand years ago, but left behind a bunch of random junk like old ruins and tech and iPods-”

“Oh my God YAWN I didn't ask for an entire lesson, *nerd*.” Adora grabbed him by the crop-top and pulled him in close. “Gimme your lunch money.” Then she started trying to stuff him into a locker.

“I'm telling- *GLIMMER*!”

“Ugh, how do we get OUT of here?!” Glimmer cried in exasperation, ignoring them. “We can't see anything!”

“Wanna try turning some lights on?” Bow asked, looking at Adora.

“Oh, *what*?! You want me to use my new Princess powers and say a magic word or clap my hands or something?! In your dreams!”

“…Actually there's a light switch right behind you.”

“…Oh.” She stood there for a moment, then punched it. It shattered into pieces. “…It's broken.”

“Stand back, *I'll* handle this,” Glimmer said, stepping forward.

“Glimmer, maybe you should take it easy,” Bow cautioned in a quiet voice. “You don’t want to tire yourself out.”

“Bow, you're so embarrassing! Quit *mothering* me! I get enough of it from my actual mother. Anyway, I'll be fine. I'm not tired at all and I've still got plenty of energy for my powers-”

“Actually I was talking about your period. How are your cramps? Do you have a headache? I think I have a stash of emergency pads if you-”

“Oh my GOD can we NOT talk about this in front of the Horde soldier-”

“Oh, great! You're on your period?” Adora threw up her hands. “Now we're going to *sync up*!”

“NO!! It's because I have to recharge my powers!” Glimmer burst out, then reddened.

“…You have to *recharge*?” Adora snorted. “What, do you run on double A's?”

“I run on pure RAGE so shut up!” Glimmer grunted and threw the sphere of light upwards where it exploded, illuminating the ruins. She slumped over, Bow grabbing her before she hit the floor.

“Whoa, Glimmer! Are you okay? Do you need a piggy-back ride? I’ve got some snacks in my pouch and if you’re too tired to chew I'll do it for you and then spit it into your mouth like a mama bird-”

“BOW, *ENOUGH*!”

Glimmer staggered to her feet, and they all looked around at the large, angular room they were in. On one wall was a huge stained-glass mural of the female warrior up on a pedestal.

“Hey, look! It’s you!” Bow cried excitedly, pointing.

“What? That looks nothing like me!” Adora protested. “…She's not punching anything.”

“No, I mean that's what you looked like earlier.”

“…Oh.” She paused. “Did I seriously have fucking wings on my head?”

“What does this inscription say?” Bow asked, peering at the pedestal. Adora squinted down at it.

“It says…*She-ra*.”

There was a long pause where nothing happened.

“…Are…are you sure?”

“Uh, wait. Lemme check.” Adora squinted again. “Oh, sorry. I read it wrong. It says…*She-blah*.”

The carving immediately lit up as the ruin awakened around them. Glowing lights and color filled the room, the entire building seeming to tremble with energy. A holographic projection of Light Hope suddenly popped up, warped by static and flickering weakly.

“Greetings, administrator,” she said robotically. “What is your query?”

“Oh my God what IS that?!” Bow shrieked in surprise. “Kill it with fire!”

“Bow-”

“It's immune to my attacks!” He was firing arrows, which passed harmlessly through the projection.

“Oh my God calm down-”

“Why won't it die?! It's like the spider that was in your room last week-”

“BOW! STOP!” Glimmer grabbed him. “She’s a *hologram*.”

“Light Hope? Is that you?” Adora frowned at the staticky figure. “Why do you look like a sex doll-”

“What is your query?” Light Hope asked again.

“Wait, wait! I’ve got one!” Bow cleared his throat. “Why did the chicken cross the road?” Light Hope just stood there, not responding. “…Well, *she's* racist.”

“No, she's just…*old*,” Glimmer said quietly, looking her up and down.

“Exactly my point.”

“Administrator not detected,” Light Hope said. “Lockdown initiated.” Red flashing lights suddenly turned on and all the doors slammed shut. The room began to shake as the ruin crumbled apart.

“You see?! Now she's mad that you called her a racist!” Glimmer shouted.

“Make it stop, Adora!!” Bow wailed, grabbing hold of her.

“*Me*?! What can *I* do?!”

“I dunno, I just feel so SAFE with you,” he whispered, then gently laid his head on her shoulder.

“Get off of me!”

“Come on, just try!”

“Ugh, fine! Light Hope, stop!” Adora shouted aloud. “Arete-vous! Yammete, Light Hope-san!”

“Try using the magic words!!” shouted Bow.

“I told you I don’t *know* magic!” Adora wailed.

“No, I mean, try saying please!”

“What? *No*!”

“Just *try*!” Bow begged. She glared back at him for a long moment before relenting.

“…Please?” she asked. The shaking didn’t stop. “Godammit I was nice for nothing!”

"…Try *pretty* please-"

"NO!" Adora glanced up at the mural, gasping as an idea came to her. "Quick, give me the sword!" Glimmer pulled it back to throw. "Oh my God, why can't you just *hand* it to me?! Maybe it'll help if I transform!"

"In that case, no way!" Glimmer clutched the sword to her chest. "You're a Horde soldier. I'm *not* giving you the sword!"

"…Maybe you should try saying please-"

"Shut the fuck up!"

Pieces of the ceiling began to rain down around them. Glimmer grabbed hold of Bow and Adora, gritting her teeth.

"We don't have time! Hold on!!"

"Glimmer, NO!" Bow cried in protest.

Too late. Glimmer teleported them out of the room just as it collapsed. They appeared high up in the sky, the land far below them.

"Oh thank god I thought we were gonna get teleported into the ladies bathroom again- *wait how is this betteraaaAAAAAA*!!" Bow screeched as they started to fall. Still screaming, he knocked an arrow to his bow and shot it down at the rapidly approaching ground. It exploded to form a bouncy castle, which successfully broke their fall. "…And you told me it was a *dumb* idea!" he said triumphantly. Glimmer didn't respond, face planted in the bouncy castle's floor. "Glimmer? Glimmer!" He gently shook his friend awake.

"Wha…what happened?" She blinked up at him, dazed.

"I'm so glad you're okay!" Bow gushed. Glimmer smiled. "…So that I can *never* let you live this down. How could you do something so irresponsible?! I am *definitely* telling your mom-"

“Okay if you’re just gonna lecture me I'm gonna pass out again til you're done-”

“Come on, get up!” He pulled her to her feet and handed her the sword. “You are hereby grounded from teleporting, young lady! You could really hurt yourself.”

“Let's just get back to Bright Moon so I can recharge already,” Glimmer grumbled, then noticed Adora standing there, watching them. “…Why are you still here? You literally could've just *walked* away.” She glared at Bow. “Or said ‘please’.”

“Hey!” he snapped. “…I’d be offended if that weren’t true.”

“I just…want to figure out what's happening to me,” Adora said slowly. “All these confusing *changes* and urges going on with my body-”

“Oh dear GOD she's going through puberty-”

“Not that! I mean the whole sword and cape thing!” Adora shook her head in confusion. “I never knew where I came from or who my family was. And now all of this…it seems really *familiar* to me. I just can't explain it.”

Glimmer looked at her, torn. Adora glanced over at Bow, who mouthed the word ‘please’.

“…Please?”

“Okay, fine!” Glimmer threw up her hands. “You can come!”

“Told you it would work!” Bow said, slinging an arm over Adora’s shoulder. “Glimmer’s mom is an expert on First One tech. She'll know what's going on with you and the sword for sure, so just stick with us!”

“Alright, fine.” Adora shrugged off his arm. “But this *doesn't* mean that we’re friends.”

“Oh of course not.” Bow stood there for a moment, then broke into song. “*We’re the best friend squad, yeah, the best friend squad! We’re the best friend squad, yeah, the best friend squad*!”

“Bow stop singing,” Glimmer said automatically.

He began singing it under his breath.

“*Best friend squad, yeah*-”

“STOP.”

He started humming it. Glimmer rolled her eyes and turned away.

“Let's go already. There's a village near here. We should be able to call an Uber for a ride back to Bright Moon.”

“I have no cash on me.”

“DAMMIT, Bow! Every time!”

-Back at the Horde Fortress-

In her dark, creepy lair with old crayon drawings by Adora pinned on the walls, Shadow Weaver stood over a large glowing basin, staring intently into the swirling water.

“…You get any good channels on that thing?” Catra asked, standing in the corner. “Nat. Geo Wild? Animal Planet?”

“Where's Adora?” Shadow Weaver demanded harshly.

“I told you, I don't know! Do you think I keep her on a leash?!” Catra snapped back, then paused. “Actually, don't answer that. I've seen some of the fanart-”

“You're lying!” Shadow Weaver hissed at her. “She would never leave without telling you!” She paused. “Or at least asking the neighbor to come over and feed you while she's gone.”

“Ugh, I swear if she got *Kyle* to do it again I'm going to scratch his stupid face off-” Catra began, rolling her eyes.

“I already know where she is. We've been tracking her.” Shadow Weaver held up her cell-phone. “I got a parenting app so I can see her location.”

“…Then why did you even *ask* me-”

“Just to rub it in your face. Also, your new assignment is to bring her back.”

“Uhh, I'm not a dog, I don't play *fetch*,” Catra sneered. Shadow Weaver whipped out her spray bottle and gave her a spritz. “*Hsss*!”

“You WILL bring her back,” she said dangerously, “or ELSE.”

“Or else what?” Catra asked, glaring at her.

“Let's see…” Shadow Weaver thought for a moment. “When is your next vet visit? Let me check my calendar…”

Catra shivered and mewled in fear.

-With Adora-

Meanwhile, Adora, Glimmer and Bow had come upon a village with rounded houses, trees, and a drunken rave with fawn-like people grinding in the streets. The dancers swung around glow-sticks while a DJ blasted obnoxious dubstep up on a stage. The

group stopped at the edge of the woods, Glimmer turning to Adora.

“Okay, the jacket comes off.”

“Oh thank *God* I didn't want to be the one to tell her she looks like a lesbian football player,” Bow said. “…Unless that's what you're going for, in which case great job, you really nailed it-”

“No!” Glimmer said. “It's because she's a Horde soldier and we can't let anyone find out. We have to fix all of…THIS.” She gestured vaguely at Adora. “…And by this I mean everything.”

“Imma fix *you* if you don't get your hand out of my face,” Adora snarled at her.

“Ooh, let me!” Bow threw his hand up excitedly. “I just binge-watched all the episodes of Queer Eye on Netflix and I'm *ready* for this! Tan France I will make you proud!!”

“Now is not the time for a makeover!” Glimmer snapped.

Adora reluctantly took off her red jacket, revealing a white long-sleeved shirt beneath. Glimmer started removing her cape just as Bow started removing his top.

“Huh? Oh you're giving her YOUR clothes ohhh that makes more sense.” He paused, then slowly pulled his shirt back on.

“I probably couldn't pull off the crop top,” Adora said.

“Few can.”

Rolling her eyes, Glimmer threw her cape over Adora’s shoulder while Bow put a flower in her hair as an accent. Adora stood there for several long moments, blinking rapidly.

“Okay, not to be dramatic, but I hate this and want to die.”

“Oh, sorry. Glimmer, do you have anything in *flannel*-”

“We don't have time for this!” Glimmer cut him off. “Look, just try to not attract attention. We’ll make this quick. Now let's go.”

Together they entered the village, Adora gaping wide-eyed in wonder at everyone and everything.

“What…is all this?” she asked breathlessly.

“It's a drunken rave,” Bow explained to her. “These guys are real party animals.” Adora stared at him, not understanding. “You know, a party? A big celebration where everyone has fun?” She was still staring. “…Fun is when you’re doing something that you enjoy and are happy and content?” Still nothing. “…Does happiness not exist in the Fright Zone?” he asked in a hushed voice.

“Wait, happiness?” Adora cocked her head. “Isn't that the warm, tingly feeling you get when you punch someone in the face?”

“No, that’s probably just from the blunt force trauma to your fist.”

“Bow, what are you doing? We need to get going!” Glimmer said, walking back towards them.

“This is an *emergency,* Glimmer!” Bow whirled around and grabbed her by the shoulders. “Adora’s *never* been to a party before! Hang on, let me find a chair so I can give her a lap-dance-”

“BOW!!”

“This is a FUNTERVENTION!” He dragged Adora off into the crowd, skipping merrily. Glimmer watched him go in disbelief and sighed.

“I’m getting a fucking drink.”

Hand in hand, Bow took Adora around the bustling village, letting her sample the local cuisine (which consisted of nachos, lukewarm punch, and other party snacks) and teaching her how to twerk.

Adora laughed and smiled, enjoying herself more than she had in ages. She even taught a group of kids how to properly disembowel a piñata. One unfortunate fawn drunkenly hit on her, so she hit on him in a much more literal sense. All in all, she had a wonderful time.

-Later-

Later that day, Adora stood with Bow, eating Jello shots.

“So, you've seriously never been to a party before?” he was asking her. “What about birthdays?”

“What’s a birthday?” Adora frowned.

“It's a celebration of the day you were born on. You eat cake and open gifts.”

“Oh, yes, of course we have birthdays.” Bow’s eyes lit up. “That's the day you're beaten senseless to remind you that you were being allowed to live for one more year. I, uh, guess that’s the gift?” Bow’s eyes started tearing up.

“And… and the cake?”

“…We have protein paste.”

Bow began to weep.

Suddenly Adora gasped aloud, choking a little on her Jello. Her eyes were shining as she stared at something in utter astonishment.

“What. Is. THAT.”

A horse was grazing nearby. A swarm of flies buzzed around it.

“Um…” Bow blinked. “That's a horse.”

The horse lifted its tail and shat out a steamy pile of horse turds.

“…It's *magnificent*,” she whispered in awe.

“Alright, *damn*, Lisa Frank. …Do you want to go talk to him?” Bow asked after a moment.

“*What*?!” Adora turned red, flustered. “Oh my gosh NO! I don't know what to say to him and I'm not even dressed for it-” Bow started to pull her over. “Wait I'm not ready! I'm too nervous I think I'm going to puke-”

“Just say hello!” Bow pushed her towards the animal, which lifted its head and snorted at her. Adora stood there awkwardly, sweating.

“Uhh…I like your mane,” she blurted out. “It's very... majestic.” The horse started eating her hair. She gasped. “What kind of girl do you think I *am*?!”

Suddenly there was the sound of explosions, followed by screams and wails from nearby.

“Wow, that party is *really* getting out of hand,” Bow said. “What is going *on* over there?” They turned to see smoke rising from the center of the village. “Oh my God did they start the barbecue without us?!” Bow grabbed Adora’s hand and together they rushed over to see robots trampling down buildings, shooting lasers and setting things on fire. “SHIT SOMEONE CALLED THE COPS! I CAN’T GO BACK TO JAIL-”

“Get in here!” Glimmer suddenly popped up and pulled them into an abandoned building to hide. “It’s the Horde! They’re crashing the party!”

“The Horde?! I'm sure this is all just a simple misunderstanding!” Adora said quickly. “They're probably just mad because they didn't get invited-”

“Why are they *here*?!” Bow wondered aloud. “Sure their parties get a lil’ wild, but the people of Thaymor aren't a threat! They’re going a little too far with this noise complaint.”

“Wait, THIS is Thaymor?” Adora asked with dawning horror.

“Did you *know* about this?!” Glimmer demanded, glaring at her.

“Well, we *were* scheduled to have a field trip here in a few days,” Adora admitted.

“Oh, well that doesn't sound so bad-” Bow began.

Just then, a group of Horde soldiers ran by, waving their permission slips.

“Alright, everyone!” A soldier in the front clapped their hands. “Line up and we will all take turns stabbing our victims! Those of you who signed up for fiery destruction of property and general mayhem, line up over there. Don't push, everyone will get a turn!”

“…Okay I take it back that sounds *horrible*.”

“I can get them to stop!” Adora said. “Just let me talk to them. I'm really sorry about this.” She turned and started to run off into the chaos.

“No, wait!” Glimmer cried worriedly. Adora stopped and looked back at her. “…Can I have my cape back first? It’s kinda my favorite one and I don't want it getting dirty.”

“Oh of course here you go.” She handed the cape back to her, then dashed away into the battle.

Adora ran past people fleeing for their lives, stumbled over dead bodies on the ground- oh no wait they're just passed out from the partying never mind they're fine. She spotted a Horde vehicle driving through a building and stood boldly in front of it.

“STOP!!” she shouted. It ground to a halt right in front of her. “… Wow I can't believe that worked- OW!!” The tank jerked forward a few inches and knocked her on her butt.

“Sorry, it's got bad brakes,” Catra said, popping up out of a hatch. “It's due for an inspection.” She wrinkled her nose. “And a cleaning. Smells like cat piss in here. I have no idea why, it totally wasn’t me. Probably Kyle.”

“*Catra*?!” Adora gaped up at her in disbelief. “How on earth did you get permission to go on the field trip-”

“I did extra credit!” Catra leapt down and tackled Adora to the ground just as she stood up. “Can you believe they let me drive a tank?! And I don't even have a license!” She paused, sniffing. “Why do you smell like horse spit? And where’s your jacket, you know I like that it makes you look like a lesbian football player with it on. What the *hell* have you been up to?”

“That's…none of your business! But certainly nothing to do with princesses, or *transforming* into them, that’s for sure!!”

-Meanwhile-

Elsewhere in the village, Glimmer and Bow were busy helping the citizens flee from the Horde’s robots. One Horde soldier snuck up from behind and almost gave Bow a wedgie, but Glimmer teleported just in time to save him the pain and humiliation. She collapsed in exhaustion afterward, Bow catching her in his arms.

“Alright, that's it! You're getting a protein bar whether you want it or not!” He unwrapped a bar, took a bite, and started chewing vigorously.

-With Adora-

"Catra, we need to stop this!" Adora waved her hand at the wanton destruction. "This is a civilian town! These people are innocent!" A faun with several pair of panties tied to his antlers ran by, screaming. "…I never said they were good."

"Okay, cool, so can I punch all the people that you don't want-"

"No! This is *wrong*!" Adora stomped her foot. "Shadow Weaver, Hordak, they've all been lying to us and using us, and…and…"

"Manipulating us?" Catra supplied.

"Yeah that too- wait what?" She stopped, staring at her friend in shock. "You… you knew."

"We're called the *Evil Horde*, Adora." Catra stated bluntly.

"…You mean…everyone knew…but me?" Adora's voice dropped to a whisper. "Even…Kyle?"

"Even Kyle."

"Dammit, fucking *Kyle*!!" Adora groaned, her mind whirling. "I don't understand. How can you be OKAY with this?"

"Because, we get to punch people in the face, *together*," Catra replied. "This is the perfect job for us, Adora! And soon, *we'll* be the ones in charge!"

"Catra, I…I don't know-"

"Our first order of business will be to execute Kyle."

"*OHHHH GOD THAT IS SO TEMPTING-*"

"Exactly!" Catra took her by the shoulders and gave her a gentle shake. "Now come on. Let's go home."

"…No." Adora pulled away, shaking her head. "I'm not going home. I can't…not after everything I've seen." A naked faun ran by, covered in whipped cream. "…Including that." She took her friend's hand. "But…you can come *with* me! You don't have to go back there, Catra! Just let me ask if they allow pets, one of them might be allergic but don't worry-"

"*What*?!" Catra jerked her hand free and stepped back, appalled. "You're seriously leaving *us* for *them*?! You've only known them, what, a couple of *hours*?! Do you even know their names?"

"Of course I do!" Adora shot back. "Their names are…uh…Glitter, and…Ho? It's, it's something like that, I know I'm close-"

"You're just going to throw *everything* away like that?" Catra glared at her angrily. "God, Adora, what *happened* to you?!"

"Oh, gosh, lots of stuff! Let's see, uh, I ate a ton of food and did a sexy dance and I saw this mystical being called a horse- you had to be there- oh and this one guy with a crop top gave me a lap dance and he says that we're going to be BFFs- whatever that is- and he sings this song and it goes like this, *we're the best friend squad, yeah, the best friend squad*-"

**BZZZZZRT*!*

Adora fell to the ground convulsing as Catra stuck her with a tazer. She stood over her friend for a moment menacingly.

"Oh, geez, sorry! That was up WAY higher than I thought." She fiddled with the dial, then shocked her again. Adora's limbs flailed like limp noodles. "How was it that time? Better? Twitch once for yes, twice for no."

-Meanwhile-

Glimmer and Bow were in the middle of the fray, desperately trying to evacuate the last of the civilians.

“STOP MAKING OUT AND RUN!” Glimmer was screaming. “WHAT IS *WRONG* WITH YOU PEOPLE?!” Finally the fauns stopped frenching and followed the others to safety. Bow jogged up to join his friend.

“Is that the last of them? You do NOT want to know what mine were doing.” The pair ducked down to hide as more Horde soldiers ran by.

“Dammit, Bow! We're screwed!” Glimmer groaned in despair. “How are we going to get out of this? My mom is right…I'm not ready for this. I *am* useless!”

“Hey! Don't you *dare* talk about my best friend that way!” Bow lunged forward and grabbed her by the face, pulling her close. “Don't give up now, Glimmer! You're strong, you're fearless, you’re an independent woman who don’t need no man, and you bench-pressed me that one time on a dare!”

“Well I was sore for like a week after-”

“You can DO this, Glimmer! I believe in you! And you don't have to do it alone.” He paused, looking at her meaningfully.

“Hey, yeah! You're right!” Glimmer smiled, perking up. Bow smiled back. “Let's go get Adora, she loves punching stuff!”

“Wait what NO I was talking about ME!” Bow scowled unhappily. “Besides, didn't she ditch us for her way cooler Horde friends?”

“I don't think she did.” Glimmer took his hand and stood up. “Come on, let's go find her!”

They ran out into the open when they heard a scream.

“That must be her!” Bow cried. “This way!” They dashed around the corner of a building to find the horse from earlier, chewing on

a dead person's leg. "…In my defense that is a *very* feminine-sounding horse. But anyway, this will be the perfect bait to lure her back!"

The horse ripped a fart.

"…Really?" Glimmer asked doubtfully.

-With Adora-

"Why are you *doing* this?!" Adora begged, twitching helplessly on the ground.

"Because you *left* me!" Catra shouted back at her. "And Shadow Weaver is going to have me declawed if I don't bring you back! So let's just go home already!" She paused for a moment. "I need you to open up all my kitty treats for me. They're like, *really* high up in a cupboard where I can't get them."

"Hyah!" Bow and Glimmer came riding in on the horse to save the day, Glimmer leaping to help Adora while Bow shot an arrow at Catra. It exploded, party balloons and streamers flying everywhere. Catra got tangled up and fell to the ground, squirming.

"I was saving that one for your birthday," Bow said. Glimmer stared at him.

"You were going to *shoot me* for my birthday?"

"Well not now!" Bow rolled his eyes. "Now go, I'll keep her occupied!" He pulled out his cell phone and started taking pictures of Catra rolling around on the ground. "This is going to get, like, a *million* likes. What do you want your Twitter handle to be? Hashtag Grumpy Cat 2.0?"

Glimmer grabbed hold of Adora and teleported away to the safety of the nearby woods. She collapsed from exhaustion again, panting.

“Glimmer, what the hell are you doing?” Adora asked, propping her up on a rock. “Why did you save me?”

“Because…because…” Glimmer said weakly, “*…we’re the best friend squad, yeah, the best friend squad…”*

“Glimmer…!”

“Please,” she went on. “We need you…we need…She-blah!” She held out the sword for Adora to take. “I was stupid not to trust you before. I'm so sorry for being mean-”

“Oh, no, you were smart not to trust me,” Adora stated bluntly. “I am a highly trained Horde soldier. I would've gutted you both given the chance.” Glimmer gaped up at her in horror. “I mean, not now, of course. You know why?” She paused. “Because. We’re the best. Friend. *Squad*.” She reached out and took the sword.

A shadow fell over them. They looked up to see a Horde robot poised to strike. Adora raised the sword high and cried the oath.

“For the honor of Grayskull!!”

Music began to play as Adora went through a magical girl transformation, complete with silhouette, sparkles and waving hair. When it was over, She-blah stood there, wearing her white and gold outfit, long hair rippling.

“Oh my God it actually worked this time I can't wait to tell Bow!” And then she ripped the robot’s legs off and beat it to death with them. Glimmer watched in horrified fascination.

“…I am so fucking glad we made friends with her.”

-Back with Bow-

Bow, meanwhile, was having trouble keeping Catra occupied.

“Oh, come on! That last toy cost twenty bucks and you didn’t even play with it for twenty *seconds*!” Bow threw his arms up. “I knew I should have just given you the box it came in!”

“How about I play with *you* instead?” Catra hissed, swiping at him.

“Ouch!” Bow winced and fell back. “Okay, that's it! Playtime is over!” He ran towards the horse to make his getaway, only to be surrounded by Horde robots and tanks. Realizing this was the end, he reached out and gently touched the horse’s face as the enemy began to close in. “*Witness me*,” he whispered.

Everyone froze as a shining light appeared and watched in awe as She-blah walked into the middle of the crowd, glowing with power. She raised an arm and slammed her sword into the ground, sending shockwaves of energy out, easily demolishing the robots and tanks.

“Oh my God you DID hit puberty you're like a whole foot taller now!” Bow cried. “And you’re not even wearing heels! I mean, look at those boots. Just when I thought you couldn’t get any gayer!!”

She-blah went on to effortlessly destroy the rest of the tanks, robots and soldiers. Glimmer came running up to Bow’s side.

“Bow! Are you al-”

“Glimmer!” Bow cut her off. “Is that *Adora*?!” She-blah let out a triumphant roar as she slugged a Horde soldier in the gut. “Okay yeah that's definitely her.”

“It's She-blah!” Glimmer said with a smile.

“Retreat!” The Horde soldiers had no choice but to run screaming in fear. She-blah started after them, ready to-

“Augh! Leg cramp!!” She staggered, her powers winking out. “I really need to stretch before I fight-” The smoke cleared and Adora caught sight of Catra for an instant. “Catra!” she called. Catra glared at her, then backed away into the smoke. “DAMMIT IF I’D HAD A TREAT SHE WOULDA COME RIGHT TO ME-”

“You did it!!” Bow cried, running up and tackling her. “Hey, wow, you have *really* improved at hugging. I'd give this one an eight out of ten.”

“Hooray, you saved the village!” Glimmer cheered. A house collapsed behind them. “…I'm sure they have good insurance. But you saved all the citizens!” There was a pair of feet sticking out from the pile of rubble. “…I'm sure they'll have a lovely funeral.”

“Yeah, I did it,” Adora said slowly. “I…*turned* against the Horde.” She paused as it sank in. “Oh my GOD I turned against the HORDE I'm going to be in SO much trouble they're going to give me detention or expel me for SURE my perfect record is ruined forever and what about my star stickers for being a good girl-”

“Calm down, it's gonna be okay!” Glimmer said, smiling. “You're with US now!”

“*We’re the best friend squad, yeah! The best friend squad! The best friend squad, yeah! The best friend squad*!” Bow sang happily. Glimmer rolled her eyes but didn’t tell him to stop.

“Come on, let's go home.” She helped Adora to her feet and they all began to walk away. The horse joined them after a moment.

“Okay, seriously, whose horse is this?”

“It's mine now.”

“How-”

“I spit on it.”

“You really need to stop doing that.”

-Episode 2 End-

The Ol' Razzle Dazzle

Chapter Notes

I'm still alive lol

Adora, Glimmer and Bow traveled down a dirt path cutting through the woods, heading back to the Rebel fortress, Bright Moon. Glimmer rode the stolen- er…*borrowed* horse, slumped over in exhaustion, while the other two were on foot. Adora shot her a nasty look.

"…She means nothing to you, right?" she whispered to the horse.

"What?" Glimmer asked.

"Nothing!!" Adora turned away, muttering under her breath. "*Home-wrecker*."

"Okay no seriously you're whispering something just tell me-"

"We're here!" Bow cried, waving his arms excitedly. Adora looked up and gasped at the sight.

"Oh my gosh WOW look at that it's so beautiful-"

"This is a rest area," Glimmer said, pointing at a row of port-a-potties with a cloud of flies buzzing around.

"…Oh." Adora paused. "…Well that explains the smell."

"I'll be just a sec. Here, hold my bow and arrows, I don't want them getting all stinky. Plus I dropped my last bow in the can so I learned my lesson." Bow dumped his weapons in Glimmer's arms and hurried into one of the stalls, slamming the door shut behind him. "Dammit, there's no toilet paper in here!"

Adora and Glimmer stood there, waiting awkwardly.

"…Why would you think-"

"I didn't wanna be RUDE okay- I don't know where princesses live!"

"Ugh, forget it! It's not happening, I have *standards*." Bow kicked open the door and stomped out, cinching his belt.

"I've seen you shit in a bush," Glimmer said, deadpan.

"Because YOU cooked that night. I'll just hold it. Let's go."

The trio started back down the road again, rounding a curve in the trail to come upon…

"We're here!" Bow cried again. Adora waited. "…For real this time!" Adora waited some more. "…No, really, you can do it now."

"Oh okay I just wanted to be sure. *WOOOOW*!" Adora gasped aloud at the sight of the shimmering waterfall and elegant fortress situated at the base.

"Welcome to Bright Moon," Glimmer said happily. "Okay! I just need to sneak in, recharge, and deal with Mom. And by 'deal', I mean 'avoid'. Avoid like the fucking plague." She hesitated, glancing back at the others. "Hey, Bow? Maybe you should take Adora in…*the back way*."

"Aww, why? I wanted to flirt with the new guard-"

"BOW!"

"Okay, fine!" Bow threw up his hands. "Looks like *nobody's* getting hugged today."

"Oh my God you slut."

"What's the back way?" Adora interrupted. She stared at them uncertainly for a long moment, then dropped to a whisper. "…Is… is it the butt?"

-Moments Later-

"I think I would prefer the butt stuff!" Adora wailed, clinging tightly to a rope and trying not to look down as she dangled over a raging river. Bow grunted and helped haul her up and over the windowsill into Glimmer's bedroom.

"Look, it might seem weird, but we *totally* come in this way all the time," he told her as she caught her breath. "Completely normal. Also, we're, like, *really* quiet and try to not attract any attention. At all. Here, why don't you put this concealing robe on for no reason?"

"…Are you trying to hide me?" Adora's eyes narrowed in suspicion.

"What? No! Of course not!" Bow looked at her innocently. "…Now get in the closet before someone sees you."

-Meanwhile-

Glimmer mumbled to herself as she rode across the bridge leading to the fortress, trying to come up with a good lie for her mother.

"So I was out meeting my secret boyfriend when- no, she'll never believe that. The crop tops were on sale at the mall so we- no not that either. Let's see…we got hungry and went for tacos- okay, that one sounds better-"

"*GLIMMER*!!" Queen Angella stormed out towards her, fuming.

"IT WAS ALL BOW!" Glimmer shrieked, clutching the horse's reins. "I mean, um, tacos-"

“Why are you riding a *horse*?” the Queen went over her. “You don't even have your license yet! Do you want to get a ticket, or even *arrested*?! You’d better believe I wouldn’t bail you out!”

“Mom, it's fine, I have my learner’s permit and Bow was with me-”

“Well he’s not with you *now* and you're not even wearing a *safety harness*-” Glimmer went for an eye-roll but got dizzy and overbalanced. She fell off the horse and her mother caught her with a gasp. “Glimmer! …That’s not the proper way to swoon, you need to roll your eyes back and UP and then press your hand to your forehead and- wait, what am I doing?!” Cradling her daughter in her arms, she opened her wings and flew up towards the large glowing jewel on a pedestal at the front of the fortress. She landed below the jewel, lay Glimmer down in its warm rays, put a pair of sunglasses and a hat on her, then pulled out a bottle of SPF 45 suntan lotion and started slathering Glimmer’s face and arms, who woke and sat up, spluttering.

“Mom! What the heck are you doing?”

“Well I don’t want you to *burn*. At least one of us has to care about your complexion!” She knelt next to her daughter, expression softening. “You should eat something, too. Are you strong enough? Do I need to chew it for you first-”

“No, thank you, I’ve had enough of that for today,” Glimmer quickly cut her off.

“Are you sure you’re all right, dear?” Angella went on gently.

“Yeah, mom, I'm-”

“Okay good. **BECAUSE YOU ARE IN SO MUCH TROUBLE**-”

“Mom what the hell!” Glimmer glared at her, hands over her ears. “Where did you get the megaphone?”

“From Bow.”

“What? He would never-”

“I traded it for a pair of my heels. He said they made him feel tall, and his ass look amazing.”

“Okay he would.” Glimmer stuck a finger in her ear and wiggled it around. “Bad news is that I'm deaf. Good news is that I'm deaf and can't hear you yell at me anymore-”

“Where did you two even GO?” the Queen asked in exasperation. “And don’t you DARE tell me you went to get tacos.” Glimmer winced.

“Alright, fine. Bow and I went and found a piece of super powerful First One’s tech in the woods,” she explained, standing up. “…And a hot single-”

“*What*?”

“I mean…it's a surprise! You're totally gonna love it, I promise. Stay right here and close your eyes. No peeking!” She teleported away in a puff of glitter.

“Maybe you should charge for a little bit-” Angella began. Glimmer went plummeting by, screaming. “…longer.”

-With Bow and Adora-

Meanwhile, Bow was keeping a close watch on the door, peeking out nervously every few seconds while Adora sat on a couch by the window.

“Why do you keep doing that?” she asked. “Is it dangerous for me to be here because I’m a Horde soldier?”

“Don't worry, you're going to be fineeee*oh my God they're coming hide under the bed before they tear you apart*!!” Bow shrieked. “Oh no, wait, false alarm. It was just a housekeeper. Heyyyy girl! Yeah, you *mop* that floor!”

“…I’m kinda getting the feeling that you guys don’t want me here,” Adora said quietly.

“Whatever would make you think that?” Bow asked, then turned and saw a propaganda poster of a Princess slaughtering Horde soldiers with glee. “*Oh Godammit Glimmer*-” He hurriedly ripped the poster down and walked over to Adora, sitting beside her. “Listen, it's just that the people of Bright Moon have all had their loved ones slaughtered mercilessly by the Horde and homes demolished to rubble and lives absolutely destroyed and I just realized this probably isn’t helping-”

“It’s really not.”

“Yeah sorry. Anyway. It's not your fault.” Bow patted her knee soothingly. “I'm sure once they get to know you the people of Bright Moon are going to *love* you, just like Glimmer and I already-”

Glimmer suddenly teleported into the room. Bow screamed and shoved Adora backwards out the window with a crash of breaking glass.

“Okay, nobody panic, but I told mom we have a surprise for her!” Glimmer paused, staring at Bow. “Where’s Adora?” He stared back, eyes wide.

“…I panicked.”

“Getting that feeling again,” Adora called, clinging to the windowsill. Glimmer and Bow hurriedly pulled her back inside.

“Oh, don't worry, my mom’ll love you,” Glimmer was saying as she helped Adora straighten her clothes and hair. “And by ‘you’ I mean ‘She-blah.’ She will absolutely HATE you if she finds out that

you’re Horde soldier. Probably hold a public execution and everything. Parade your head around on a stick, after. So, we'll just tell her…*later*. After she's had a couple glasses of wine.”

“On it!” Bow pulled out a bottle and took a swig. “OOooh, that *burns*.” Glimmer grabbed the bottle from him and sniffed it.

“Bow, this is grape juice.”

“Yeah, and it’s not even *watered down*.”

“Glimmer, I don't know if I can just turn into She-blah like *that*,” Adora said nervously, snapping her fingers. “I mean, I’ve only done it when someone was in *danger* before-”

“Oh, well that's easy!” Glimmer raised the sword to throw at Bow, who shrieked in terror and shrank away.

“OMIGOD WILL YOU STOP-” Adora snatched the sword back.

“Calm down, Adora, you're going to do *fine*!” Glimmer said, waving away her protests. “Look, we’ll go buy you some time, so just hang out here with the sword, maybe try to get to know each other a little better. And remember, I can always stab Bow as a last resort.”

“Hey!”

Bow was cut off as Glimmer grabbed him and teleported away. There was a pause followed by a loud splash.

“Dammit, Glimmer! Not again! Now my pants are going to *chafe*!”

“Oh please, like they could get any tighter!”

Adora stood there awkwardly for a long moment, holding the sword up in front of her face.

“…Hi, how's it going.” She paused. “Sooo…what do you like to do for fun? I like to punch people.” She paused again. “Are we best

friends yet? No…? Maybe we should practice turning into She-blah. Here, I'll start. *For the honor of Gray-*" She swung the sword up, hit the chandelier, knocked off the candles, and caught the drapes on fire. Then the smoke alarm went off, and the sprinklers came on.

Adora stared at the mess in silence for a long moment, blinking water out of her eyes. "…What's that?" She looked at the sword, cocking her head. "We should get the fuck outta here? Great idea! Let's go." She made a hasty escape down the 'back way', scuttling over to where her horse boyfriend was grazing on a nearby hill.

"I'm back, babe! Did you miss me?" The horse looked up, chewing on a butterfly, and sneezed right in her face. "I'll take that as a yes. Wanna go see a movie or something? Hang on, let me get all dolled up." Adora held up the sword. "For the honor of Grayskull!" Nothing happened. "…Excuse me for a second." Smiling sweetly, she walked a few steps away. "*Dude what the fuck I talked to you for like five whole minutes how are we not besties yet? It worked with Bow*!" she hissed at the sword, then cleared her throat and tried again. "For the honor of Grayskull!" Still nothing. "…Please?" Nope. "Ugh, *fine*! Let's take a break. Here, can you hold this for me?" Adora put the sword in the horse's mouth. Immediately the music began to play as the horse magically transformed- "OH SO YOU'LL WORK FOR THE FUCKING *HORSE*?!"

The horse, now with a horn, flowing mane, and pimped-out rainbow wings, whinnied in terror and flew off, heading to a nearby rebel encampment where it started smashing tents and breaking shit. Adora followed, waving her arms at the panicking rebels.

"No, stop! Don't hurt him! He's not bad, look at him, he's covered in friggin rainbows!" The rebels all turned to look at her and gasped, noting her Horde attire. "Please, wait! I'm…I'm not with the Horde!!"

"Oh. All right then." They all immediately put their weapons away. Adora sagged with relief.

“Well that was easy-”

FRRRRRRTTTTT

Horse turds rained down on the soldiers, covering them from head to toe. The soldiers narrowed their eyes and glared venomously at Adora.

“GET. HER.”

“Oh come the fuck ON!!” Adora wailed. With no other choice, she fought her way through the camp, throwing blows as well as apologies, expect for that one guy, he totally deserved it. Breaking away from the mob, she tripped and fell down a ravine into a muddy ditch. She staggered through the watery trench into the nearby woods as the rebels continued searching for her.

“Ugh! My horse boyfriend just *ditched* me! Literally!!” Adora groaned. “I can't believe this shit! LITERALLY!!”

-Back Inside the Fortress-

Glimmer, meanwhile, was leading her mother through the halls of the fortress, heading towards her room.

“Is the blindfold really necessary?” the Queen asked, walking slowly with her hands out. She bumped into a pinata, smacked it in half with a wiffle bat, and kept going.

“Of course it is, Mom!” Glimmer said, eating some of the fallen candy. “We don't want to ruin the surprise.”

“It just seems like I keep walking into a lot of walls and tripping over things. You're being *extra* careful guiding me, right?”

“Absolutely!” They were standing at the top of a flight of stairs. “… Now take a BIG step forward.”

“Hey, Glimmer!” Bow popped up. “I went to the store and got streamers and confetti and balloons this is gonna be the BEST surprise ev- why are you trying to kill your mom?”

“What?” said Angella.

“*Bow*!” Glimmer cried with false cheer, glaring at him. “I’m SO glad you’re here. Right now. At this exact moment. Could you go and check to make sure that the… *surprise*…is ready for us?”

“…I don't know,” Bow said slowly, looking between her and her mom. “I'm not sure if I should leave you two…*alone*.” He paused. “Like, legally speaking. I’m probably an accomplice at this point.”

“Oh, don’t be silly, Bow,” the Queen scoffed. “We’ll be perfectly fine.” She turned toward the open window. “It’s this way, right?”

“You got it, Mom.”

“I REALLY DON’T THINK-”

“DON’T RUIN THIS FOR ME!”

“FRIENDS DON’T LET FRIENDS KILL THEIR MOMS!” Bow hissed back. “Seriously, I may have to revoke your hand-holding privileges if this continues.” Glimmer gasped, horrified. “Now, are we going to have a problem?” She pouted and shook her head. “Good. Be right back.” He sped off down the hallway, leaving Glimmer to sulk with her mother.

“Glimmer, why on earth are you so stiff? I told you you needed to start doing *yoga*-”

“Mom, I'm over here. That's a statue.”

“Oh. Well you really can't blame me-”

“A MALE statue.”

“…Alright, you’re allowed to be mad at me.”

Suddenly Bow came running back, wailing like a siren.

“What’s going on, what is that sound?” the Queen asked, cocking her head. “Is there a fire, or is a tornado approaching??”

“Oh, don't worry, I’m sure everything is fine perfectly fine normal BOW WHAT THE HELL IS GOING ON?” Glimmer snarled in a furious whisper. Bow grabbed her and pulled her aside.

“*OH MY GOD GLIMMER THIS IS HORRIBLE ADORA IS MISSING AND SHE TRASHED YOUR ROOM OR NO WAIT IT ALWAYS LOOKS LIKE THAT CUZ YOU’RE SUCH A SLOB-*”

“WHO is missing?” Angella asked, standing in front of him, blindfolded face scrunched with suspicion. Bow blinked, then looked over to see Glimmer standing a few feet away, looking at him in confusion.

“Oh, sorry, I meant to grab Glimmer,” Bow said. “I mean, it was an honest mistake, you two just look so alike-”

“No we don't!” Glimmer shouted. “She’s like seven feet tall and 50% wings!!”

Several guards ran up, stopping to salute their Queen.

“Your Majesty! We have reports that-”

“It’s me,” Glimmer interrupted them. She pointed. “My mom’s over there.”

“Oh. My mistake. You two just look so alike.”

“SEE?!” Bow shrilled.

“Shut up!!”

“A Horde spy has been found on the Bright Moon grounds!” the guard reported.

“Nice going, guys! You ruined the surprise!” Bow huffed, throwing his hands up. “This party has officially been *cancelled*. NOW I have to go return everything! It’s a good thing I kept the receipts!”

“She attacked our troops with the aid of a hideous, rabid winged beast,” the guard continued. “And then it shit on the soldiers. And on the tents. And everywhere else.” They paused. “You don't want to go outside right now.”

“GLIMMER. WHAT. DID. YOU. *DO*?!!” The Queen bristled with fury, whirling around to yell at…

The statue.

“YOU ARE IN SO MUCH TROUBLE YOUNG LADY OF ALL THE IRRESPONSIBLE THINGS FOR YOU TO DO-”

Glimmer and Bow exchanged glances, then slowly began to back away.

-At the Horde Fortress-

The Horde cadets were all gathered in the locker room, listening to Lonnie describe the battle of Thaymor. Catra sat by herself off in the corner, licking her arm.

“I'm telling you guys, this new Princess makes Jasmine look like *Hasbeen* and Moana like *yo mama*!” Lonnie was saying. “She wiped the floor with us like we were Pine-Sol! She was twelve feet tall and she was wearing the new Yeezys and her hair blinded all of us so she could destroy our machines! We were lucky to get out of there without magically falling in love.” She paused

awkwardly. “I mean…not…not like I *wanted* to, or anything.” She paused again. “But you've all seen her, right? Like. DAMN. She could destroy me any day.”

“I can't find any information about her,” Kyle said, popping out of one of the lockers. “Disney’s got nothing, not even a new trailer! Maybe she's related to Rapunzel based on her fabulous golden hair-”

“Who said you could come out of the locker?”

“Okay right sorry.” He leaned back in and closed the door.

“*Pfft*!” Catra snorted to herself.

“You got something to say, or are you coughing up a hair ball?” Lonnie snapped at her.

“Excuse me. I'm in the shower.” Catra glared back, mid-lick. “*Rude*.”

“You're the only one who saw her up close,” Lonnie said, crossing her arms. “Don't tell me *you* fell in love with her. I thought you and Adora were a thing.”

“…I ship them,” Kyle said from inside the locker. “They’re my OTP. The potential angst is just *superb*-” Lonnie punched the door.

“*Hsss*!” Catra snarled and leapt to her feet, storming up to get right in Lonnie’s face. “The only *thing* Adora and I are is *over*. And the same goes for this new Princess. I can take her out any time I want-” There was a muffled squeal. “NOT TO FUCKING DINNER KYLE JESUS CHRIST-”

“Your breath smells like fuckin’ Friskies.” Lonnie shoved her back roughly.

“Bitch how would you even *know*-”

“Watch it, Catra. Adora’s not here anymore,” Lonnie taunted. “I bet you’d look *real* cute in one of those lil’ pet costumes.”

“Go ahead, try me, bitch!” Catra shot back. “I’ll have ASPCA so far up your ass it could be used as a *kennel*.” With one last glare for the other cadets, she turned to leave…and started scratching at the door. “Someone come open this for me. I want to go out and then come back in again and then maybe stare at the corner for an hour-”

“…So is this a love triangle or, like, an OT3 situation…?” Kyle began. Lonnie kicked the door, rattling it.

-With Adora-

Adora, meanwhile, was running for her life through the thick forest. She glanced behind her, saw that she had finally lost her pursuers, and promptly tripped over a log, landing face-first in a puddle.

“…Well at least I know I got my cardio in for today,” she grumbled, sitting up and wiping her face. The sword in her hand began to glow. “I am NOT talking to you right now. I'm angry with you! In fact, I would like to request a return.” She stood up to address the woods, holding out the sword and clearing her throat. “Yes, hello? I got this from here and I'd like to return it.” She paused, waiting. “Cash is fine.”

A nearby sound caught her attention, and Adora crept closer to investigate. Through the trees, she spotted a rickety shack built into the hillside, partially covered in plants with a small chimney and smoke coming out.

“Who the hell lives here, Bilbo Baggins?” she muttered to herself. A bent old woman in a tattered red dress came out of the shack

and started vacuuming the dirt. “Okay nevermind it’s fucking *Smeagol*-”

“Hmm?” The old woman stopped humming to herself and froze, several butterflies fluttering around her. “What’s that? You heard something? Yes, I did too!” she whispered to herself.

“Yup, definitely Smeagol. Look at that crazy old lady, talking to herself.” Adora snorted. “…Wait a minute.”

“Who’s there?!” the old lady called aloud. “Come out right now, or else!”

“*Pfft*, like she could do anything that would make me-”

“That’s it! I’m taking my top off!”

“WHOA okay okay I'm here stop!!” Adora hurried out of the bushes and stood there awkwardly. “Hi, ma’am, sorry to bother you, but have you seen Lisa Frank’s wet dream fly by-”

“You…you…!” The old lady gasped, staring up at her with huge eyes behind thick glasses, then cracked her ankles with the vacuum. “Intruder!!”

“OW! What’re you- stop!!” A roomba came out to join the fun, bashing into the back of Adora’s feet.

“Wait…” She paused, squinting up at Adora. “I think I *know* you…”

“Oh thank God-”

“How dare you make me wait so long, Mara?!” She cracked her ankles again.

“Oh my Christ STOP.” Adora kicked the vacuum away. “Look, I'm sorry, but you seem to have me confused with someone else-”

“I made cookies just for you!”

"*Yup it's me I'm Mara*- no wait what am I doing?" Adora groaned to herself, shaking her head. "What *kind* of cookies?"

"Chocolate chip."

"Okay yeah I'm definitely Mara." She followed the old lady inside the little hut, looking around at the clutter.

"You promised me we would go berry picking today," the old lady said, picking up a picnic basket.

"…I did?" Adora asked through a mouthful of cookies. "I mean…of course I did." She paused to swallow. "Can I get a glass of milk, please?"

"Of course!" The old lady turned to give her a glass, then suddenly screamed and dropped it. "Who are you?! How did you get into Madame Razz's house?! How did you get Mara's sword?! I'm calling the police!" She picked up a banana. "Hello, police?!"

"Wait what weren't we about to go berry picking?!"

"You're right!" Razz took a bite out of the banana, peel and all, tossed it over her shoulder, and handed Adora a basket. "Let's go!" She hauled her out of the shack, dragging her off into the woods like a senile serial killer.

"Whoa, wait, hold on! You said something about the sword-*somewhere in between all the screaming and raving*- have you *seen* it before?" Adora asked, holding it up.

"Of course I have, you silly girl, Mara!" Madame Razz tittered. "You let me use it to unclog my toilet."

Adora immediately dropped the sword.

"I let you do WHAT with it?" She covered her face with her hands. "NO WAIT THEYRE CONTAMINATED OH MY GOD EWWWW." She slathered herself with sanitizer, then took a breath to calm down. "Okay. Exactly HOW long have you been living alone in these

woods? Do I need to call somebody? Social Services? A funeral home?”

“Oh, I'm not alone!” Madame Razz shook her frizzy head. “I have my vacuum, and all my friends!” She waved her arms at the empty air, then pointed to a nearby tree and whispered, “We're friends with *benefits*.” She winked at the tree.

“Mental institute it is,” Adora stated, then followed the crazy old lady through some hanging branches. She stopped as she saw a clearing ahead with a vine-covered ruin. “Hey! That's a ruin of a First One! Be careful, they're dangerous-”

“What?” Madame Razz called, already halfway up the building.

“*SONNUVA*-”

Lights suddenly flickered on as the ruin awoke, and the building zapped the old woman like an insect hitting a lamp. She fell to the ground, screaming, Adora barely managing to catch her in time.

“Oh my GOD are you all right?!”

“…I think my heart is working better now,” Madame Razz stated, her hair smoking a little. “It doesn't have that weird stutter anymore.”

They looked up to see the whole building had lit up, the sky above them changing color to display stars and constellations.

“Yes, we used to come here together to look at the stars,” Madame Razz said wistfully. “It also makes a pretty decent movie screen. Let's see if they got anything new on Netflix!” She held up a remote. “How about the Great Etheria Baking Show?”

“Wait…I've *seen* this before,” Adora said.

“Well we can find something else to watch-”

“No, not that!” She shook her head in frustration. “I know all of this somehow…” She winced as visions passed through her head, finally snapping back to the present. She looked over to see Razz scrolling through New Releases. “What's happening to me? Please if you know anything, tell me!” The old lady smiled at her gently, then beckoned and opened her mouth. Adora leaned in close-

“*AAAAAAAAAAA*!!!”

“…I don't know what I was expecting.”

-With Catra-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Catra entered the sleeping quarters and sat down on a bed sulkily. She glanced to the side and saw a cute drawing of her and Adora holding hands. Hissing to herself, she pulled out a permanent marker and gave Adora a moustache. She turned her anger on the bedding, tearing up the sheets in a fit of rage, scattering the pieces, then dumping her litter box on it for good measure. Then she pulled out a tub of mouse-flavored Ben and Jerry’s and start sobbing into the carton as she ate.

“You're taking this breakup really hard,” Shadow Weaver said, slithering up behind her.

“I am not!” Catra snapped at her. “Now hand me that photo album of us, I need to set that shit on fire.” She pulled out a lighter and flicked it on.

“I don't think that's going to work.”

“Yeah you're right I should probably douse it in lighter fluid first or maybe just some cat pee, excuse me a moment-”

“*Catra*!”

"*What*?!"

"Enough of your sniveling! I gave you a simple assignment: *bring back Adora*." Shadow Weaver rose up, her shadows enveloping Catra. "Instead, you got your ass kicked and she's still missing!" She paused. "So you're definitely getting an F."

"Don't you get it?" Catra snorted at her. "She's gone! *Transferred*!"

"*Lies*!!!" Shadow Weaver cried. The lights in the room suddenly shattered. "…Godammit I'm gonna have to sign a request form to pay for those. Third time this month." She loomed over Catra menacingly. "That's it! I am taking you to the Principal's office!!"

"Fine, see if I care." Catra rolled her eyes.

"But first…you need to take a bath."

"I already took a shower!" Catra protested, miming licking her arm.

"Not that kind," Shadow Weaver said dangerously. "I hope you like…*bubbles*."

"You mean...." Catra gasped. "*NOOOOOOOO*!" Shadow Weaver grabbed her by the scruff of the neck and dragged her out the door. Kyle walked in a few moments later.

"Hey! Who messed up my bed?!" There was a pause. "And my fanart! What the hell?!"

-With Adora-

Adora was still tromping through the woods with Madame Razz, struggling to keep up with the surprisingly spry old woman.

“Wait, slow down!” she called after her, panting. “Christ, how does this old hag have more stamina than I do? What kind of medication are you on? Do you drink Ensure?”

“Sweetie, I don't have my glasses on,” Madama Razz called back. “You'll need to speak up!”

“…Bitch WHAT-”

“Where are my hearing aids? I can't see a thing!”

“*Listen*!!” Adora finally caught up to her. “I need you to tell me what to do.” She paused. “Like, literally. I had to ask Glimmer for permission before I could pee. I physically could not go otherwise. I've been a soldier all my life, I don't think I can function any other way. Which is pretty fucked up now that I say it aloud.” She blinked. “Anyway, I left my whole life behind looking for answers. The Rebellion hates me, and now the Horde hates me, too. I want to do the right thing, but I don't KNOW what that IS-”

Adora looked up to find them standing at the edge of the forest. Before them were ravaged woodlands that have been stripped bare by Horde vehicles. They were double-parked everywhere with litter on the ground and baby animals covered in oil.

“…Okay I know what it is now.”

The smoldering corpse of Smokey the Bear was slumped over in the corner.

“Deeefinitely know now.”

“Once, the Princesses would've protected us,” Madame Razz began, “but these days, they’re too busy making movie deals with Disney. Meanwhile, the Horde creeps ever closer.” She looked over at Adora. “…Excuse me, young man, who the fuck are you again?”

Adora opened her mouth to answer but froze as she heard a horse’s terrified whinny.

“OH NO YOU DID NOT.” She hurried over to a rise and looked down to see a Horde base stationed below, Horde soldiers surrounding the rainbow-winged horse as they tried to capture it with ropes. “BAE!!!”

“You're doing it wrong, you idiots!” a large, burly man with a beard was shouting. “In order to capture that Rapidash you have to *damage* it first. Haven't *any* of you played Pokémon?!”

“Oh my God I wish some swole Glamazon bitch would come put us out of our misery,” one of the soldiers muttered.

“THAT CAN BE ARRANGED,” Adora ground out. “Seriously, if I hadn't defected already I would now. This is the final straw. They’re all fucking dead.” She held up the sword. “For the honor of Grayskull!!” Music began to play and glitter sparkled as she began to transform- “Oh NOW you work, huh?!!”

Down below, the huge man was checking his pockets and grunted in disappointment.

“Dammit, I don't have any Pokeballs on me.” He bent over and picked up a huge rock. “This’ll have to do.” He started shuffling closer to the panicking horse. “Okay, now just hold it still…”

She-blah slammed down in the middle of the group, cutting the horse free with a slash of her sword, then turned to the soldiers.

“I am giving you ONE chance,” she said dangerously. “Turn off your machines and leave this place. NOW.”

“…Is this some sort of new Pokémon?” the large man said aloud. “Princessa?” After a pause, he threw the huge rock at her. She caught it effortlessly.

“Wrong move, bitch.” She crushed the stone to powder in her fist.

“Okay well we definitely know it's a power type-”

She-blah sent the soldiers flying, then moved on and started destroying the tanks and other vehicles, slashing their tires and pouring sugar into the gas tanks. She paused as she saw Madame Razz joining in, cracking a Horde soldier in the ankles with her vacuum. Her roomba zoomed by with a knife on it.

"Take that, and that!"

"Oh my God no stop you're going to get killed-" She-blah began. Razz punched the man in the dick. "Yeah okay nevermind she's fine."

The flying horse joined in as well, shitting on the soldiers from above, causing them to slip and fall as well as dealing massive damage to their morale and self-worth.

**Scrooom*!*

A laser beam shot out of nowhere and blasted She-blah off her feet. She fell to the ground, shimmering weakly.

"Tank, I choose you!" The same annoying man was sitting on a nearby tank. "I use Laser Blast. It's super effective!"

"Mara, no!" Madame Razz ran up to She-blah, popped open her vacuum, and threw down the full bag, which exploded like a smoke bomb, hiding them from sight. When the smoke cleared, they were both gone.

"GODAMMIT IT GOT AWAY!" The man groaned with disappointment. "I bet it was a rare legendary one too! How am I gonna defeat the Fright Zone Gym now??"

"Oh my God she didn't kill me," the soldier from before said. "There's no choice. One of you guys has to stab me. End my pain!"

-Later-

Adora snapped awake, sitting upright in a rush. Looking around, she saw she was lying outside of Madame Razz's shack, the horse grazing beside her.

"What happened? What's going on? Something woke me up-" The horse farted. "Okay yup that was it." She gagged and plugged her nose.

"Are you alright, Mara?" Razz asked, hurrying over. "You fainted, so I put you in bed to rest."

"…Bitch we're *outside*." Adora stared up at her in confusion. "If you think this is inside, then…what's the house for?"

"You mean the toilet?"

"OH GOD I WAS IN THERE. I ATE in there!" Adora rolled over and started retching.

"Swift Wind and I have been talking while you were asleep," Razz went on, gesturing to the technicolor horse. "He thanks you for rescuing him and wants you to know that 'Horsey' was a stupid name. Pretty racist, too. He was really offended. Anyway, how do you feel?"

"…A little hurt, honestly. I've never named or even *seen* a horse before and I was doing the best that I could- wait you can TALK to him?" Adora gaped at her in astonishment. "…Can you ask him if he loves me- I mean, if this is just a fling I'm totally fine with that too-"

"Well right now he wants some sugar-"

"ExCUSE me-"

"Cubes."

“Oh. Right.” Adora fed him some while she thought for a minute. “I think I know what I need to do now. If the Princesses won't defend Etheria, then…*I* will…” She paused heavily, a determined look in her eyes. “…*MAKE THEM*.” She turned back to Madame Razz. “It’s time to punch some people. I need to get back to Bright Moon. Will I see you again? I mean, other than in my nightmares, or when I’m discussing you during therapy.”

“If you need me, you will always know where to find me,” she answered mysteriously, chuckling.

“…In my heart?” Adora asked after a moment.

“Under your bed,” Razz whispered.

“Hold on what-”

“Well now off you go! See you later! I’ve got something to take care of!” The little old lady waved and walked away into the hut, shutting the door behind her. Adora watched her go, frowning.

“…Wait isn't that the-”

**Frrrrrrrt*!*

“OKAY TIME TO GO!” Adora quickly turned to the horse. “Hey so this might be a bit forward of me, but can I get a ride back to Bright Moon with you, Swift Wind?” The horse just stared at her for a moment, then leaned forward and bit her shirt. “Oh no wait I meant on your back- *AAAAAAAAUUUUUUU…*!!” She screeched as the horse launched off into the clouds, dragging her with him.

-Back at Bright Moon-

Back at the Rebellion Fortress, Queen Angella was still yelling.

“How could you *possibly* think this was a good surprise?!” the Queen cried in outrage. “I mean, it’s better than that horrid sweater you got me for Christmas, but still! A *Horde soldier*?!” She and Glimmer were in the throne room, several guards and other rebels standing around, uncomfortably watching the spectacle.

“Mom, just calm down and- wait, what? You told me you loved that sweater! It had reindeer noses right were your boobs are! How was that *not* a good gift??” Glimmer gaped at her. “Anyway, I said I was sorry! You guys are on my side, right?” She looked over at the guards.

“Hey, don't get us involved,” one cried. “I already lost my TV privileges!”

“Don’t even talk to me!” another said, sitting in the time-out corner.

Suddenly, there was a flash of light from the entrance and a glowing She-blah walked in, head held high and proud as she approached the Queen. Bow ran over, screaming, and shoved a lampshade over her head. Everyone stared at him.

“…Sorry, I panicked again.”

“It can't be…” the Queen gasped in disbelief. “She-blah!”

“Your Majesty,” She-blah said, her voice echoing inside the lampshade. “I've come to pledge myself to your flag…under the Princess state of Etheria, for which it stands- I mean, um…” She hesitated. “There's something you should know.” Removing the lampshade, she closed her eyes and transformed back into Adora. Everyone gasped. Bow screamed again and started running up with a blanket but Glimmer stopped him.

“Mom, this is Adora,” Glimmer said quietly. Adora knelt and held out her sword.

“I know you have no reason to trust me, your Majesty-” she began.

“SHE’S THREATENING THE QUEEN! GET HER!” The guards immediately dog-piled her to the ground.

“No, wait!!” Adora struggled to push them off. “I've seen for myself the horrible things the Horde has done- even unknowingly and yet most of the time quite enthusiastically participated in some of them- against the people of Etheria, and I'm ready to fight to stop them! Please, give me a chance! I know I can help the Rebellion win this war!”

The Queen hesitated, then slowly reached out to take the sword-

“THE QUEEN’S THREATENING HERSELF! GET HER!” The guards dog-piled her to the ground as well.

After the guards were thoroughly scolded and all made to sit in the corner with no dessert for a week, the Queen turned back to Adora and continued, sword in hand.

“I know the legend of the warrior the First Ones called She-blah,” she said. “Even had a Barbie doll of you as a child. I thought you were just a myth, but you're here now. Do you pledge to stand with us against those you once served?”

“Yes.” Adora nodded solemnly. “If that means punching people. Yes? Okay just checking. Continue.”

“Glimmer,” the Queen turned to her daughter. “Do you vouch for her, and will you take responsibility for anything she does?”

“Yes.” Glimmer nodded.

“And will you share punishment if she breaks any rules?”

“Ye- wait hold on WHAT-”

“Very well.” The Queen paused. “I'm going to need to see some references.”

“Oh yes of course.” Adora pulled out a paper and handed it over. “Here’s my resume. It’s laminated. Please note the section on all the different ways I can kill people with only one hand.”

“Now rise! The Rebellion accepts your allegiance, Princess of Power,” the Queen said proudly. Everyone cheered as Glimmer and Bow ran forward and swept Adora up in a warm hug.

“Welcome to the gang!” Glimmer said, smiling. Adora smiled back.

“Yeah, good luck getting out of it!” Bow chuckled. “Seriously. There’s only one way.”

“And what’s that?” Adora asked, laughing along.

“DEATH.”

“Oh my God.”

“Here's all the paperwork for you to fill out.” The Queen slammed down a foot-thick stack of papers next to Adora. “Have these all filled out by tomorrow. There will be a Rebellion orientation on Monday, where you will get your Princess ID badge, training will take six to eight weeks and there *will* be a urine test-”

“OH MY GOD.”

-At the Horde Fortress-

Shadow Weaver held Catra by the scruff of her neck as she dragged her through the hallways of the Horde Fortress to see Lord Hordak. Finally they arrived at a sinister green throne room with a raised dais. They slowly approached the throne, Catra shivering in fear and slowly raising her eyes to see…

A weird little imp baby sitting there.

"…Are fucking you kidding me? That's Hordak? What, is he gonna order me to change his *diaper*?"

"*Ahem*." Catra froze, then slowly turned to find a tall, evil looking man with a skeletal face standing behind them, cup in hand. "…I was getting coffee." He paused, then took a long, loud sip from his World's Best Evil Boss mug. "Also, I couldn't find a baby sitter."

"*Kneel*!" Shadow Weaver shoved Catra to the ground. "Lord Hordak, I gave this impudent brat a simple assignment: return Force Captain Adora to the Fright Zone. Instead, she completely flunked out. I want her expelled!"

"You're still down a Force Captain?" Hordak asked in a hard voice, picking up the imp and placing it in a baby harness on his chest before sitting in his throne. He produced a bone-shaped rattle and shook it while the imp cooed. "Why haven't you elected someone else to take her place?"

"But…my Lord!" Shadow Weaver sputtered. "Adora was class PRESIDENT-"

"Are you playing favorites again? I told you, it's against regulations. There will be NO teachers pets. Just use Catra." He paused. "No offense."

"Catra?!" Shadow Weaver scoffed. "She has been nothing but a disappointment to me. She smokes *catnip*, sir. She's probably high right now!"

"I am not!" Catra said, then paused. "Got any cat treats? I'm kinda hungry-"

"Doesn't that reflect poorly on your *own* teaching methods?" Hordak went on harshly. "She's probably just projecting what she's seen from you. You have no-one but yourself to blame for her behavior."

"*Pfft*, this is great, I wish Adora was here to see this with me," Catra snorted to herself, then scowled. "No wait screw that bitch

I'm glad she's gone.”

“Enough of this! I have made my decision.” Hordak stood up from his throne. “Rise…Force Captain Catra.” He stepped forward and handed her a green Force Captain badge…on an animal collar. Catra stared at it for a long moment. “…It protects against fleas too-”

“Oh my God that was ONE TIME-”

-Episode 3 End-

Flirting with She-Blah

“Oh my gosh, this is SO great!” Glimmer gushed excitedly as she walked with Adora down the hallways of the Rebellion fortress. “I can't believe my mom is letting you stay here in Bright Moon!”

“I know, right?” Adora agreed, stopping to pull up her pant leg. “And all I have to do is wear this ankle monitor at all times, consent to random body searches, and piss in a cup every 24 hours!”

“Damn, she’s going easier on you than she did ME the last time I snuck out!” Glimmer paused. “…You think you could get her to let me watch R-rated movies?”

“I don't know if that’ll work,” Adora said doubtfully, rolling her pant leg back down. “Shadow Weaver only let me watch them for…*educational* purposes.”

“…What do you mean educational no wait nevermind I don't think I want to know-”

“How to properly slaughter the innocents-”

“*I said I didn't want to know*!” Glimmer shouted, covering her ears with her hands. She let out a sigh as they turned the corner. “Anyway, I've given you a tour of the whole fortress-”

“Including the men’s *bathroom*,” Adora muttered under her breath.

“Hey, I’m still working on my teleportation powers! I didn’t mean to overshoot the cafeteria.”

“Tell that to the guy we scared the literal piss out of.”

“That was just Bow. He’ll be fine. I do it all the time.” Glimmer waved her protests away. “Now…here's your brand new room!” They stopped at a door and she kicked it open. “Ta-*daaah*!”

Adora screamed.

"…Is that good screaming or bad screaming?" Glimmer asked after a moment. "I can't tell."

The room was furnished with a ludicrous amount of sparkly pink pillows, a heart-shaped chandelier, and a huge canopied bed with a Disney Princess sheet set. It looked like Barbie threw up on everything. There was even an elegant waterfall trickling in the corner. Adora finally ran out of breath and the scream petered out, leaving her panting.

"…The fuck is the waterfall for? Showering?"

"Ha! *Showering*!" Glimmer snorted. "Good one!"

"Ahaha, yeahhh, I sooo got you," Adora chuckled along, quickly pulling her jacket back on.

"It's for the bathroom, silly."

"*Oh God*."

"Remember, Bow's letting you borrow this stuff for now, so make sure you take good care of it. Also, I'm right down the hall if you need me." Glimmer gave her a pat on the back. "Try not to kill anyone, okay? Night!" She skipped off down the hall, leaving Adora alone.

"*Wait please don't leave*- dammit she's gone." Adora looked at the room and shuddered. "I think the person I'm going to kill is *myself*. It is physically painful for me to be in this room." Taking a breath, she steeled herself and walked in, wincing at the lethal amounts of glitter everywhere. "Well…this certainly is…*different* from the Fright Zone. Maybe now I can finally…*relax*." She stood there for a moment. "…Whatever the fuck that means." She paused again, then reached under her shirt and whipped off her bra. "OHHH YEAH THERE WE GO SO MUCH BETTER." Adora sighed and threw herself on the bed. "Ahhh this is so great it feels like I can't breathe wait OH FUCK IT'S GOT ME!!" She was

immediately absorbed into the fluffy mattress and trapped in its squishy confines. “Unhand me, foul beast, or I will slay your children!” She flailed about, seizing a few of the smaller pillows and ripping them up. The bed didn’t respond, being a fucking bed. “You heartless monster! Prepare to die!” She punched the mattress, which burst open, feathers flying everywhere. “Oh God I hit an artery! I'm covered in its life blood!!” She struggled free and ran out of the room, screaming. “Glimmer!! GLIMMER!! I need your help hiding a body before the Queen-” She rounded a corner and came face to face with the Queen. “QUEEN ANGELLA. GOOD EVENING. IMAGINE MEETING YOU HERE. NOW. OF ALL TIMES-”

“Why are you covered in feathers?” Angella asked in confusion.

“You don't want to know,” Adora whispered, then started hacking. “Oh God I think I *swallowed* some of it.” She glanced over to see a large mural of a handsome, bearded man with a staff and cape. “…I'd hit that.”

“Excuse ME,” the Queen said sharply, glaring at her. “That is my *husband*.”

“I meant I'd punch him. He looks like a worthy opponent.”

“…Oh.” The Queen blinked and turned back to the mural. “My husband, King Micah, built the Rebellion with me, and was one of the first casualties of the Horde.” She gave Adora a dark look. “Adora, I am giving you a chance because my daughter vouched for you despite your questionable background. …And also because your references checked out.” Her eyes narrowed further. “Do NOT disappoint her.”

“I wouldn't dream of it,” Adora answered solemnly, then sneezed up a wad of feathers right in her face.

-The Next Morning-

Glimmer rolled over in her sleep, curled up in her weird hanging bed thing that looked rather unsafe. She stirred, face scrunching in annoyance.

"Ugh, Bow, did you steal all of the blankets again?" She opened her eyes to find Adora asleep beside her. "…How much did I drink last night?" Suddenly Adora's eyes flew open and she screamed, which in turn made Glimmer scream and fall backwards off the bed (see?!). Luckily she managed to teleport into a pile of pillows just before hitting the floor.

"Oh, God! Sorry!" Adora called down, poking her head over the edge. "I should have warned you, that's how we normally wake up in the Horde. You know. Screaming."

"Adora, what the hell?" Glimmer glared up at her. "How did you get *in* here? There was a *guard*."

"I punched him."

"The door was *locked*."

"I punched it."

"What?" She glanced over and saw the demolished door, as well as the guard's boots sticking through the doorway. "…We'll have to get them a fruit basket. But anyway. What are you doing in here, Adora?"

"Look, I couldn't sleep in the same room as a *dead corpse*-"

"Wait what." Glimmer went pale. "Oh God, who did you kill?"

"I made a huge mess in my room, it got everywhere. Oh, and I killed all of their children, too."

"*What*?! Jesus, Adora! We'll have to hide the body- sorry, *bodies* before Mom sees-"

“Oh yeah your mother was there too she totally saw me so she's a witness we might have to get rid of her-”

“Not a problem.”

“Hold on.” Adora looked down at the bed she was crouched on. “Is this it’s next of kin? Will it be after me for revenge?”

“…Okay, wait.” Glimmer stared in confusion. “You murdered…a *mattress*?”

“Yes. What did you think we were talking about?”

“Nothing.” Glimmer quickly stuffed the trash bags back into the closet. “I guess we won’t be needing these.”

“Anyway, I don't think your mother likes me.” Adora shrugged. “Other than as She-blah. She just wants me for my body.”

“Come on, that's not true!” Glimmer teleported back up to the hanging bed and sat beside her. “Listen, mom invited you to our weekly meeting with the Rebellion generals. She wouldn't have done that if she didn't like you.” She paused. “Unless it's a public execution.” She paused again. “Either way, there will be donuts.”

“*Ugghh*.” Adora groaned and covered her face with her hands. “Wait what kind-”

-Later-

After breakfast, Adora, Glimmer and Bow went to the meeting room, a big room with murals painted on the walls and a long table in the center. Seated in the tall chairs were a multitude of pillows with smiley faces drawn on them.

“I got sad seeing them empty all the time,” Bow said, holding a magic marker.

“Aww, that’s sweet, Bow,” Glimmer said, patting his shoulder. “You mind if I borrow one? My ass still hurts from falling off my bed this morning-”

“Wait, why are they all empty?” Adora asked. “Where *is* everyone?”

“The chairs are for the other Princesses,” Glimmer explained, “but none of them have been active members of the Rebellion since I was a kid. They had a really big fight years ago over what to order on a pizza, so the Princesses all quit, and now the new ones do the same.”

“Except for Spinnerella and Netossa,” Bow said, then turned and called out to two young women holding hands. “Hey, guys!”

“What?” they called back, sitting all the way down at the other end of the table.

“I really wish they would sit closer,” Bow said wistfully.

“You know you could just get a smaller table,” Adora pointed out, sitting in an empty chair. Everyone gasped. “…What? What's wrong?” she asked, confused. “Did someone call dibs? …Did someone fart in this?”

“That is NOT your chair,” Queen Angella said coldly, appearing behind her. Adora stared up at her, frozen.

“…Are you sure? There wasn’t a nametag or anythi-” Glimmer teleported over, grabbed her by the ponytail, and teleported them away to a different chair.

“You sat in my *dad's* chair!” Glimmer hissed under her breath.

“How was I supposed to know?!” Adora hissed back. “There wasn't a pillow sitting in it!”

“Hey!” They looked over at Bow, who sat holding a pillow-dummy of the late King. “…I wasn't done making him yet.” He scribbled a beard on with his marker. “There. *Now* he’s done.”

“I asked you all here today because I received a distress call from Princess Perfuma,” the Queen said, taking her place at the head of the table.

“What?” the other Princesses called from the back.

“I really don't understand why they don't just sit closer,” the Queen muttered, then pulled out her megaphone before continuing. “The Horde is laying siege to her kingdom. They won't even respond to a *please*.” Bow gasped in horror. “She is asking the Rebellion for assistance. Plumeria is located near the front line. The Horde has set up camp here, cutting off the main supply route.” She pulled out a pair of Barbies to show placement on the table map. “…Sorry, the holographic display is malfunctioning. Someone tried to watch a porno movie on it.”

“Wait a minute…are those mine?” Bow cried. “At least *ask* first!”

“Alright, let’s go kick some Horde ass!” Glimmer stood up.

“Glimmer, sit down or I will make you go sit at the children’s table in the corner,” her mother said automatically. They all glanced over to see several guards sitting there as punishment, playing with coloring books.

“Can I go now?” one guard asked, raising her hand.

“Have you learned to act like a big girl and not misbehave?” the Queen asked.

“…Lemme just finish this picture first.” The guard glanced at the others. “Alright, who’s hogging the red crayon?”

Glimmer quickly sat down.

“Queen Angella, we can DO this,” Adora spoke up. “You should send me, Glimmer and Bow to help out.” The Queen’s eyes narrowed suspiciously as she plowed on. “I can go as She-blah and protect them from the Horde if they attack. I promise, I won't disappoint you.” The Queen still hesitated. “…Please?”

“…Oh, alright, very well.”

“YES! You won’t regret this!” Adora said excitedly. Bow smacked her on the back and she immediately coughed up several more feathers, which floated down onto the tabletop. Everyone stared. “…That was the last time I swear-”

“Aaaand I'm already disappointed.” Angella pinched the bridge of her nose and sighed.

“Alright, gang, let’s go!” Adora stood up to leave, tripped over the King’s chair, and fell down, knocking it over with a crash. “OH GOD I’M SO SORRY-”

“OUT!!”

“What?”

-In the Fright Zone-

Back at the Horde fortress, the cadets were in the training room, practicing their fighting skills against a robot, which was currently holding Kyle hostage.

“…Yeah, go ahead, keep him,” Lonnie said, crossing her arms. “We don't want him back.” The lizard nodded in agreement.

“You guys are assholes!” Kyle shouted at them, still struggling.

“Speaking of assholes, where the fuck is Catra?” Lonnie frowned. “She’s supposed to be here, doesn’t she know attendance is like fifty percent of the grade hold on why do I smell Friskies-” She turned around and Catra, who had been standing there waiting, breathed right in her face.

“*Heyyyy*, Lonnie. Notice anything different about me?” she asked teasingly.

“You mean your black eye?” Lonnie growled, pulling back a fist. Catra tsked at her and tapped the shiny Force Captain badge hanging from her neck. “…Okay who the hell did you steal that from? You have to stop doing that, you could get in real trouble if they find out-”

“What? No!” Catra bristled in outrage. “I got it *legit* this time. I'm your new Force Captain.” The cadets gaped at her in disbelief.

“Wow, congrats, Catra!”

“Shut up, Kyle.”

“I was *congratulating* you!”

“Yeah, quit it, it's annoying.”

“Oh please,” Lonnie snorted. “If you're our new Force Captain, I’ll make out with Kyle.”

“Force Captain Catra.” Shadow Weaver suddenly rose up from the shadows and slithered forth. “A word.” She seized Catra by the collar and dragged her off to consume- I mean…*consult*.

Behind Lonnie, Kyle started making kissy noises. She whipped around and lunged for him.

“Bitch I will bite out your *tongue*!”

Back in the locker room, Shadow Weaver released Catra, dropping her to the floor in a heap.

“Now. Explain again how you lost Adora,” she demanded.

“I told you everything I know!” Catra said, scrambling to her feet. “I wrote a five-hundred word essay with full color illustrations! What else do you *want*?”

“Tell me what you did to drive her off! I knew having you as a pet was too much responsibility for her. She already had her class duties and after school sports recreation, not to mention volunteering to really flesh out her resume-”

“Okay,” Catra snorted in affront, “*first* of all, if anyone did something to drive her off, it would've been fucking *Kyle*-”

“*Hey*!!” There was a shout from the other room. “I heard that!”

“Nobody cares!” Catra shouted back. “Shut the fuck up!”

“He is rather annoying,” Shadow Weaver admitted. “But I still don't believe you. Tell me what happened or I’ll stop buying you Blue Buffalo and go with a shitty generic brand cat food- *ugh*!” She suddenly groaned, doubling over in pain. The gem on her forehead flickered weakly.

“What’s wrong?” Catra asked. “PMSing? Huh, I’d have guessed you hit menopause, like, twenty *years* ago-”

“It’s not menstrual cramps!”

“Yeah, I figured. No *way* are there any eggs left in your dried up ol’ tubes. So what’s up? Constipated?”

“Enough!!” Shadow Weaver roughly shoved her aside and stormed off, still groaning.

“It might help if you take some Pepto and try to take a shit!” Catra called after her. “Introduce more fiber into your diet! PRUNES!!”

-With Adora-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow had traveled through the woods for a while, making their way to the Kingdom of Plumeria. Finally they arrived, coming upon the camp where the citizens had taken shelter in tents and there was a haze of weed smoke in the air.

“Okay, we're here.” Glimmer paused, looking around. “Wait a second. Where’s Adora?”

“Well, I don't know where *she* is,” Bow answered slowly, “but I do know where *She-blah* is!” Glimmer turned around to see him riding on her shoulders. “Check it out! I can totally reach the cookies on top of the fridge now-”

“What are you guys doing?” Glimmer interrupted. “Why are you still She-blah?”

“Hey, come on. I *like* being She-blah! Watch this.” She-blah put Bow down and started bench-pressing the wagon of relief supplies with loud grunts.

“One, two, three!” Bow started counting along excitedly. “I'll spot you!”

“We don’t have time for this. Let’s go!” Glimmer forced them to move on and they walked into the camp. A young woman with long blonde hair adorned with flowers and wearing a robed dress looked up as they approached.

“Welcome to Plumeria!” she cried happily, and with a wave of her hand smacked Glimmer in the face with a bouquet and gave Bow a flower crown. He squealed with delight and quickly took a selfie. The Princess glanced past them and caught sight of She-blah, gasping aloud at her flowing hair and bulging biceps. “I am SO gay.”

“What?” She-blah asked.

“I'm so glad I am gay.”

“What?”

“I'm so glad you're here.”

“Oh alright then.” She-blah noticed the citizens gathering round and cleared her throat nervously. “Um, hello, everyone! We heard about the blockade and we've come to help!”

“I brought toilet paper,” Bow said, holding up a pack of two-ply. “Unless you guys use, like, leaves or something, that’s cool too, I won’t judge.”

“Welcome them properly, everyone!” Princess Perfuma cried. The people cheered and all crowded in to hug She-blah, who froze in confusion.

“Glimmer what's happening right now they're attacking me with their bodies I’m in some kind of gentle hold-”

“It's called a hug,” Glimmer said.

“A hug? I've never heard of this kind of martial arts move! Quick, how do I counter it?”

“It's not a martial arts move. It’s how people show affection,” Bow explained.

“Affection? Is that some kind of sickness?”

“I really need to get you a dictionary,” Glimmer sighed to herself.

The Princess grabbed She-blah’s hand and began dragging her around, showing off the Kingdom.

“Our people have lived here in peace for thousands of years,” she explained. “We are one with the trees and plants. This is the Heart Blossom, the source of all my magical powers.” She gestured to a huge pink tree with a large gem at the base. “Those

awful Horde soldiers are using pesticides and chemicals and now all the plants are dying. Don't they know we're *organic*? Kale smoothie, anyone?" She held up a cup. Bow started to raise his hand but Glimmer pushed it back down.

"Uh, we're fine, thanks. Right, She-blah?" She turned to find her already chugging a smoothie. "Dammit, we've lost her, Bow-" She turned again to find Bow chugging one, too. "GODAMMIT YOU GUYS-"

-At the Horde Fortress-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Shadow Weaver staggered into her chambers and touched a large, dark crystal in the middle of the room. It crackled with evil energy, shoving her away.

"Hey! Don't you give me sass!" she growled, wrestling the power into submission. The light on her forehead began to glow as she recharged. She pulled out a magazine and settled down to wait.

"Shadow Weaver!" She jumped as Hordak suddenly appeared on a wall-mounted computer screen, sitting on his throne with his weird imp baby on his lap. "Why have you assigned more troops to look for that missing soldier? I told you to give up on her!" He paused. "Also, you know I hate arguing in front of the little one." He covered the imp's ears before continuing. "Anyway, this has gone on long enough. Destroy Plumeria or I'll take your magical powers away." He hung up the Skype call and Shadow Weaver immediately screamed in rage and started throwing things. There was a sound as he called back. "One last thing."

"Yes, my Lord?" Shadow Weaver asked sweetly, a chair poised over her head.

"I'm all out of milk. Can you go get me some? I can't find a sitter."

“Of course, my Lord.” Hordak hung up again, and Shadow Weaver commenced the screaming and throwing.

-With She-blah-

She-blah sat at the base of the Heart Blossom, the villagers gathered around her. They approached one by one, placing dishes of food, flowers, and other gifts at her feet. She-blah stared down at a baby in the pile.

“Am…am I supposed to eat-”

“Oh my God take your fucking kid back,” Glimmer muttered, shoving the baby back into the parent’s arms. “No, wait, on second thought, give it here, I’m taking it to Child Protective Services-”

“I'm SO glad that you're here to help us,” Princess Perfuma said excitedly, sitting in She-blah’s lap. “And in the hour of our greatest need too, just like in the stories!”

“Hey, you guys ever hear about the time She-blah used Horde soldiers to brush and floss her teeth?” Bow asked the crowd, which listened raptly. “Don't even get me *started* on when she went to use the bathroom and was out of toilet paper-”

“Bow, enough!!” She-blah hissed, flushing with embarrassment. A sudden explosion from nearby shook the ground, and a trail of smoke rose from behind the trees. “Oh thank God- I mean…how horrible!” She quickly stood up, dumping Perfuma out of her lap. “I’d better go check and see what that was.”

“Oh, there’s no need!” Perfuma waved away her concern. “I’m sure it’s nothing. We here in Plumeria try to focus on the positive side of things!”

“Princess Perfuma!” A messenger ran up and saluted. “Ten more people have died from their injuries.”

“…That means more food and water for everyone else!” Perfuma cheered. “Yaaay, dead people!”

“Okay, I think you’re taking that positive thing a little too far-” Glimmer began.

“So, when are you going to heal our land and re-grow all of our plants?” She-blah stared down at the Princess, who smiled up at her.

“…I have to what now.”

“Heal our land. You know, like in the stories?”

“The stories. Right.” She-blah stood there for a moment. “Anyone have a spare copy right now so I can double-check, maybe do some research? Brush up on my technique? I might be a little rusty.” Another explosion shook the ground. “Okay, seriously, they are UP to something over there. We really should go check that out!”

“*We*??” Princess Perfuma stared at her in disbelief. “I really don't think they’re doing anything dangerous over there-”

“But you can hear the explosions. You can see the smoke.”

“They're probably just…having a bonfire!”

“You can hear people screaming for help.”

“They’re probably having a great time-”

“Oh God!” a voice wafted in on the wind. “Help me! *Heeeelp*!” She-blah looked back at the Princess, who slumped in defeat.

“Look, this is my power.” She held up her hand and a small flower blossomed to life. “I grow plants, alright? What am I going to do?

Attack them with allergens? I can make some nettles if I try really hard.” She sighed and shook her head. “I’m sorry, but we're just not strong enough to fight the Horde. All we want to do is live in peace. That's why we need YOU, She-blah.”

“She-blah! She-blah! She-blah!” the citizens began to chant. She-blah laughed nervously.

“Yes. Of course. I *know* what I'm doing!”

-A Few Moments Later-

“You guys I have no *fucking* idea what I'm doing!” She-blah was pacing furiously in the woods while Glimmer and Bow watched her have a mental breakdown. “I can't use healing powers! I punch shit! Plus I only recently learned how to walk without my *hair* getting in my way!”

“Remember, shoulders *back*,” Bow reminded her. “Also, it senses fear.”

“Don’t worry, it’s going to be fine! Here, you just need some practice.” Glimmer kicked Bow in the shin.

“Ow!!”

“Okay now heal him.”

“I'm *telling*!”

“We’re miles away from home. Who are you going to tell?”

“Ha!” Bow pulled out his phone. “I’m texting your mom right-” Glimmer snatched his phone away and tossed it into the woods. He glared at her, then pulled out a pad of paper and a pen. “Dear Queen Angella…your daughter is-”

“Maybe you should just try concentrating really hard,” Glimmer said, ignoring him. “That seems to work when you need to transform.”

“Okay, I’ll try.” She-blah nodded in agreement, then closed her eyes. She focused intensely, began to glow, and threw a hand out towards a withered tree-

A pair of rainbow wings and a horn popped up on the tree’s front.

“…Oh my God shoot me with that.” Bow stated, throwing his hands up.

“Shit! Hold on, just…let me try again!” She-blah closed her eyes, concentrating again.

“Did anyone order a pizza?” A delivery man on a bike rode up, braking next to them.

“Dammit, that's not what I wanted either!” She-blah picked up the man, pizza and all, and threw them away.

“…You could've at least kept the pizza,” Bow muttered to himself.

“Okay! One more time!” She-blah closed her eyes for the third time, concentrating even harder. She trembled with exertion, putting everything she had into-

**Poot*!*

“…Do you at least feel a little bit better now?” Bow asked gently. She screamed and started tearing apart the tree with her bare hands. “…I'm guessing that's a no.”

“*Aaaargh*!! What's *wrong* with me?! Why can't I do this?!” She-blah stomped in frustration. “These people expect me to save their land! I can't let them down!”

Yet another nearby explosion shook the ground, the trees shivering and losing leaves. Bow’s flower crown withered away.

“My flower crown!” he gasped in horror, then slowly raised his bow. “You will be *avenged*.”

“She-blah! Something terrible has happened!” Princess Perfuma came running up, panting.

“Yeah, we know. My flower crown is gone.”

“The Heart Blossom is *dying*!”

The girls gasped.

“…Okay, but more importantly, my flower crown-”

“BOW. ENOUGH.”

“I REALLY LIKED MY FLOWER CROWN OKAY IT MADE MY EYES POP.”

-At the Heart Blossom-

Everyone stood at the Heart Blossom, the leaves of which were falling to the ground as sinister-looking vines wrapped around the trunk, choking it to death.

“Please, She-blah! Heal our land!” Princess Perfuma begged.

She-blah took a deep breath and slowly approached the dying tree. She glanced over at her friends, who smile encouragingly and gave her a thumbs-up. She raised a fist. They frantically shook their heads. She gently reached out a hand instead. They nodded. She-blah placed her hand on the tree and closed her eyes, concentrating.

“Come on…do something…do *something*!” She hissed under her breath, beginning to glow. Power surged as the pressure rose within her, bursting out to-

Poot!

“Um…excuse you?” Perfuma said awkwardly, waving a hand in the air. “Is that…is that part of the healing?”

“Oh, come ON!!” She-blah transformed back into Adora and everyone gasped in shock. “Yeah, okay! You got me!” She threw her hands up. “I don't know how to heal anything. My name is Adora. I was chosen to be She-blah, but they never really gave me an instruction manual or anything like that so I don't know what I'm doing.” She gestured, and a dog in the crowd started shooting rainbow laser-beams out of its eyes. “See? That's what I'm talking about. That shit right there.”

“What’s going on? Who are you?! Where’s She-blah?!” The villagers began to shout in confusion.

“No, no! She's She-blah!” Bow rushed forward and yanked her hair out of her pony-tail, then started trying to make it wave around. “See? She- oh damn this is dry as hell, girl you need to *condition*- does anyone have a fan? No? How about a hair drier? Anything?”

“Bow, get off!” Adora pushed him away. “Listen, I know the Horde. I bet they're using one of their machines to poison your land. If you want to save your home, we *have* to stop them. We all need to work together to fight them!! WHO’S WITH ME?!” She cheered, fist upraised. Everyone just stared.

“…Yeah, um, I have a doctor’s appointment-”

“I can't make it, I have something real important to go to-”

“I'm not wearing the right shoes-”

“What the hell! You guys are just *lazy*!! Glimmer cried in outrage, cutting off the excuses. “You want She-blah to fix everything for you! What, do you expect her to bring you gifts for Christmas too?!” The citizens all stared at her in shock.

"…You mean Santa-blah isn't real?" a little boy whispered, then burst into tears.

"Oh shit wait I didn't mean it-"

"I'm sorry, I can't…I can't do this!" Princess Perfuma shook her head and backed away from Adora. "You're not who I thought you were. This relationship is over! Let's go, everyone!" She and the citizens of Plumeria turned away and left.

"…Did I just get dumped?" Adora asked after a long pause.

"I think you got dumped by her, AND the entire Kingdom of Plumeria," Glimmer answered, patting her shoulder. "Wanna go get some ice-cream?"

"I'm sorry I told everyone you were super special awesome!" Bow burst out. Adora smiled at him.

"It's alright, Bow. I-"

"And that your tears cure cancer and your hair with made out of spun gold-"

"Okay stop talking you're making me feel worse."

"Listen, Adora," Glimmer said gently, "we don't like you because you're She-blah, we like you because you're our fr-"

**Boooom*!*

"All right that's it *no-one* fucking friend-blocks me!" Adora bristled in outrage. "Let's go fuck them up!" She grabbed her friends' hands and dragged them off towards the distant explosion.

-A Few Moments Later-

Adora, Glimmer, and Bow cautiously approached the Horde settlement, the trio wearing stolen Horde uniforms. Bow groaned in discomfort.

"You guys, my mid-riff is *smothering* to death. It needs to *breathe*!"

"Oh, just deal with it, Bow!" Glimmer snapped at him. "You'll be back in your crop top soon enough."

"We need to find the machine that's killing all the plants," Adora told them. "Every Horde camp is laid out the same, and guard duty is always in half-hour shifts-"

"Do you guys get dental benefits?"

"Bow!"

"Sorry."

The Horde soldiers on duty moved to switch, and they slipped into the camp unnoticed. Sneaking around the base, they approached a building and peeked through the door. Inside was a sinister machine with dozens of wires and cords, bubbling green fluid and hot steam. They gasped in horror.

"No guys, that's just the coffee machine," Adora said.

"…You guys *drink* that stuff?"

After refusing to let Bow try the coffee and dragging him away, the trio quickly located the building with the *actual* machine poisoning the land. They crowded inside, staring at the monstrosity in stunned silence.

"You were right," Glimmer said. "The Horde IS the cause of this. Hurry, let's take care of-"

"*Hey*!!" A guard stood in the doorway, glaring. They froze. "What are you guys doing in here?"

"…What are YOU?" Adora shot back after a long pause.

"…I forgot," the guard admitted, then shrugged and left.

"Phew…"

"I REMEMBER NOW!" The guard kicked the door back open and leapt at them.

"AAAAAAHHHHH!!!"

-Back With Perfuma-

Back at the Heart Blossom, a villager handed Princess Perfuma a note.

"Those people from Bright Moon are gone. They left this for you." He paused. "And the tab for their meal." Perfuma took the note and began to read it aloud.

"*We've gone to the Horde camp to find the weapon killing your trees because you guys won't cuz you're little bitches- I'm sorry, that was Glimmer, she got the pen away from me for a second. Anyway. I'm sorry I couldn't be the hero you wanted, and I wish you all the best. Adora*." She burst into tears, clutching the note to her chest. "What a beautiful love letter!" She wiped her tears away and straightened with determination. "She's right! We need to fight for our home. Everyone!!" Perfuma turned to the villagers, rallying them. "Come on! We're going to go and fight the Horde!!" The citizens all groaned in protest. "Do it or I'll confiscate all your weed! You guys will NOT ruin this chance for me!" The citizens all cheered and ran off. "That's the wrong direction, you fucking potheads!"

-Meanwhile-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow were running for their lives through the Horde encampment, screaming while everyone fired lasers at them.

“Oh my God we're gonna die!!” Bow shrieked.

“It's fine, just think of it as…extreme laser tag!” Glimmer shouted at him. A laser beam shot out and hit Bow’s shirt, dissolving the bottom half.

“AAAAAA- thank you!- AAAAAA!!”

They ducked behind a wall and paused for a breather.

“How many soldiers can you take?” Adora asked, panting.

“Like, to dinner?” Bow pulled out his wallet. “I mean, if we're just getting tacos or something, I can do like four, but if I need to take them to a fancy restaurant maybe *one*-”

“That is NOT what I meant!” Adora cut off as Horde soldiers surrounded them, weapons drawn.

“Okay, everyone, calm down!” Bow shouted at them. “I can only take one of you guys out to a fancy restaurant so how about you all fight amongst yourselves to find out who's going to be the lucky person-”

A war horn sounded and vines suddenly smashed through the encampment wall. Princess Perfuma burst into the camp on a wave of plants, her citizens rushing in after her, high as fuck.

“…Okay nevermind I’m taking *her* to dinner.”

“I can’t believe it!” Adora gasped in surprise. “They came! I’m so glad-”

“I will water my plants with your blood and use your entrails as fertilizer!!” Perfuma shrieked as she impaled a soldier with a vine.

“…that we’re allies!” Adora finished. “I mean, holy shit. She’s pretty scary.” Lifting her sword, she quickly transformed into She-blah, then fought her way through the battle to the sinister machine from before. She stabbed the machine and a wave of healing energy rolled over the landscape, restoring all the dying plants and the withered Heart Blossom. Horde soldiers screamed in horror as flower crowns popped up on their heads. Bow stormed over and ripped them off, throwing them to the ground.

“Okay NO you guys don't get one if mine got destroyed screw you guys you don't deserve them-”

“Alright! I figured out how to heal!” She-blah cried excitedly. “You just have to let me stab you! C’mere, Bow, lemme try it out-”

“Um, PASS.”

The last of the Horde soldiers fled the outpost as the citizens of Plumeria tore the buildings apart looking for munchies. Princess Perfuma laughed with delight and ran up to She-blah.

“Thank you so much! You inspired us to save ourselves!” She threw herself in her arms and went for a sloppy open-mouth kiss.

“Whoa!” She-blah cried, pushing her off. “What’re you doing? Why are you attacking me with your mouth?”

“What? Oh. Sorry, that's just a…normal Princess greeting. We totally do it all the time.” She paused awkwardly, then leaned over and kissed Glimmer. She blinked.

“What the fuck why don’t I get tongue?”

“Get a big blonde wig and some stilts and then we’ll talk,” Perfuma snapped at her. “Anyway! How can we ever repay you?”

“Two words,” Bow said firmly, pointing at his head. “Flower. CROWN.”

“…I think I want another kiss,” Glimmer said after a moment.

“You don't get another,” Perfuma sniffed.

“Alright fine then I want some cash.”

“Join the Rebellion and help us reform the Princess alliance,” She-blah blurted out. Everyone gasped in surprise.

“The Princess Alliance? But…didn't that go horribly the first time?” Princess Perfuma looked torn. “…What would it entail?”

“Well, for starters, you'd be stuck for hours in long, boring meetings with me, train with me, be around me at all times-”

“I’LL DO IT.”

-At the Horde Fortress-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Catra reluctantly entered Shadow Weaver's chambers.

“Hey, I’m here. Can we hurry this up? I got things to do, people to beat up.” She paused. “Mostly Kyle.”

“This was brought to me by retreating Horde soldiers,” Shadow Weaver cut in, pointing at the wall screen. “Their camp was attacked by She-blah.” A recording began to play, showing different images of the battle.

“…Well we don't know for *sure* that’s Ador-” Music began to play as Adora did her magical girl transformation on screen. “…Okay but it could just be-”

“Yeah, you get ‘em, Adora!” Bow and Glimmer cheered from off screen. She-blah waved at them, then turned around and snapped a guy’s neck.

“Okay yeah it's her.”

“Did you think you could *keep* this from me?” Shadow Weaver hissed in fury.

“It's just a phase!” Catra said, shrugging unconcernedly. “She's… confused. She'll get over it eventually and come back to the Horde. It's like that time she got really into *scrunchies*-”

“Until I tell you otherwise, your mission is to get her BACK.” Shadow Weaver walked over to her cauldron. “And, to ensure success…no matter where she goes, my shadow spies will find her!” She lifted her arms dramatically, and dozens of creepy black shadows with red eyes burst from the glowing cauldron and disappeared.

“…Even in the bathroom?” Catra asked after a moment.

“Of course not. I respect her privacy.” Shadow Weaver paused. “Although it would be helpful to make sure she’s staying hydrated and has enough fiber in her diet-”

“Anyway,” Catra went on, rolling her eyes, “this isn’t a big deal. She’ll be back. Right now, I'm sure she's having a *horrible* time with those *loser* rebels.”

-At Bright Moon-

“Slumber partyyy!” Glimmer and Bow sang, dancing around with Adora in her room back at Bright Moon. There was a ring of sleeping bags on the floor, a big pile of snacks and a movie playing in the background.

“Aw, thanks guys! This is so much fun!” Adora smiled at them. “I never want to leave-”

“Pillow fight!!” Bow smacked her in the face with a pillow.

“I take that back.”

“So,” Glimmer cut in, “the good news is I'm only grounded for *one* week instead of the normal two, AND mom agreed to let me recruit new Princesses into the Rebellion! Also, most importantly…” She pointed to the TV, where the movie’s R-rating was being displayed.

“You guys have to tell me when all the scary parts are so I can close my eyes,” Bow said nervously. “After all, we’re the Best Friend Squad!”

“I prefer the Glimmer Group,” Glimmer corrected.

“I was gonna suggest The Adorables-” Adora began.

“Hmm. That leaves us with only ONE option.” Bow’s eyes narrowed dangerously. “Whoever wins the pillow fight gets to choose the name!” They all snatched up pillows and started battling. Adora laughed happily as she joined in, swinging her pillow up at-

**Crash*!!*

“Oh my God Bow I am SO sorry I didn’t mean to hit you that hard dear God his nose is bleeding SO much I don't know my own strength we can be the Best Friend Squad just stop crying please-”

-Episode 4 End-

The Pee Gate

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The various members of the Rebellion were gathered together in the meeting room of Bright Moon, sitting around a circular table in the midst of a very heated discussion.

"Council, I have gathered you here today to decide something of the utmost importance…" Queen Angella said, leaning forward intently. "…What are we getting on this pizza? I vote olives." She raised the phone expectantly.

"I object, olives are disgusting and I will not have them fraternizing with my toppings," Glimmer argued, banging a fist on the table.

"Overruled."

"You can't fucking do that! I thought this was a pizza democracy!"

"Potty-mouths don't get cheesy bread," her mother warned.

"I mean…cheezus crust, mom, that's pepperoni!"

Beside her, Bow gasped and covered his ears in shock.

"Uh, shouldn't we be planning our next move against the Horde or something?" Adora asked in confusion.

"Adora, this is *obviously* much more important," the Queen said patiently. "We will get to that later. Now, who votes for stuffed crust? Aye or nay?" She raised her hand and looked around at the others.

"*What*?" Netossa and Spinerella called from another table entirely.

"What the- how did they get *over* there?!"

“Mom!” Glimmer cried suddenly, standing up. “I vote that you let me and the others keep recruiting Princesses to our squad! We should sign up Princess Mermista of Salineas next. She's in charge of the Sea Gate, and with her help we could control the seas!” But the Queen was already shaking her head.

“Absolutely not, Glimmer, it's FAR too dangerous-”

“Also we could get anchovies for the pizza.”

“…but no reward is without risk,” Angella finished decisively. “Very well, you may go.”

“Yessss!!” Glimmer cried, throwing her arms up in triumph.

“I am going to wear the *sluttiest* swimsuit,” Bow stated proudly.

“But you must wear a lifejacket at all times,” the Queen went on, whipping a puffy orange vest onto Glimmer and clicking the straps tight. “Also you must have an experienced Sea Captain chaperone you with a boat that has all current safety regulations up to code-”

“*Moooom*!”

“…She-blah demands floaties,” Adora stated quietly, sticking her arms out.

“*Adora*!”

“Alright, moving on to more important matters,” Queen Angella said, clapping her hands.

“Oh thank God,” Glimmer muttered.

“Our drink orders-”

“CAN WE *GO*?”

-Later That Day-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow had arrived at Seaworthy, a two-level seaside bar filled with drunk sailors and fishmen brawling and spawning everywhere. Glimmer, still wearing the lifejacket, stepped up to a stranger in the middle of a knife fight and politely tapped his shoulder.

"Scuze me, can I borrow that for a second? Thanks." She took the dagger out of his hand and stabbed her lifejacket, which noisily deflated. "Much better. Here you go." She handed it back and he returned to stabbing his victim. "Okay, moving on-"

"Ohmigosh this is SO cool!" Bow squealed, hopping up and down excitedly. "Seaworthy is *just* like how I imagined. Look at all the pirates everywhere! I think those are *teeth* on the floor! I'm gonna go punch someone-"

"No you are not! Come back here!" Glimmer grabbed him by the belt and yanked him back.

"But that's how they say 'hello' here!"

"I like the sound of that!" Adora turned and punched someone flat on their back. "…Hey how are ya."

"Quit it, both of you!" Glimmer groaned in frustration. "The bouncer is going to throw us out!"

"It's cool, I'll punch him too."

"*Enough*! We're just here to find a Sea Captain."

"Oh please," Adora snorted. "No one here is dumb enough to take on such a dangerous mission-"

"Did I hear someone say…*dumb*?" A hand shot up out of the crowd. "Well, look no further!" The three of them turned to see a man lounging at a side table, wearing Halloween-grade pirate get-up, complete with swashbuckling boots, vest, and an impressive

mustache. “I am the one and only…*Seahawk*.” He leapt onto the table and flapped his arms majestically. “Caw caw!!”

“...You sound more like a seaGULL,” Glimmer stated after a moment. Bow whipped some peanuts at him.

“Hey!” Seahawk glared, then slowly bent over and scooped up some nuts. “So, are we doing this or what?” he asked, his mouth full.

Exchanging glances, the Best Friend Squad nodded and sat down at his table.

“We’re interviewing for the position of Sea Captain. The job entails you sail us to Salineas,” Glimmer began professionally. “What are your qualifications?”

“Well,” Seahawk began, his eyes smoldering as he leaned forward intently, “one time, a beautiful young mermaid fell SO in love with me she gave up her voice and turned into a human just to try and-”

“That's The Little Mermaid,” Glimmer cut him off. Seahawk stared at her, blinking.

“…Okay, but *another* time I sailed the seas on the Black Pearl and stole the heart of Davy Jones-”

“That's Pirates of the Caribbean.”

“…How about when I met a clown fish and stopped at *nothing* to reunite him with his poor lost son who’d been kidnapped to P. Sherman 42 Wallaby Way-”

“That’s Finding fucking *Nemo*! This guy’s a *joke*!” Glimmer huffed, crossing her arms. “Bow, back me up here!”

“Sorry, I haven't been listening,” Bow admitted guiltily. “I'm hypnotized by the glistening hairs of his silky mustache. I think I can see my own reflection in it.” He paused. “And I am *adorable*.”

“Thank you.” Seahawk winked and gave his mustache a stroke, his fingers coming away shiny and wet. “It's 100% real.”

“Yeah, I'm sure it's real.” Glimmer leaned over to whisper loudly in Adora’s ear. “Real *expensive*.”

“Alright whatever you're hired,” Adora said impatiently, arms crossed.

“Hold on, now!” Seahawk raised a hand as well as a perfectly on-fleek eyebrow. “What makes you think you can *afford* me?”

The bartender, a large, rough-looking woman, suddenly appeared behind him.

“You're three months behind on your bar tab. Pay up or we’re taking a leg.”

“Didn't I pay that off with the table-top strip show I gave last night?” Seahawk argued hotly.

“No, you got smashed, took off all your clothes, and dumped a $300 bottle of champagne over your head.” She paused. “I added that to your tab, too.” She paused again, then looked down at his legs. “…Eeny, meeny, minee-”

“Okay, I was bluffing, alright?” Seahawk burst out desperately. “Please hire me, I need the money SO bad! Do you have ANY idea how expensive it is to keep my mustache looking this *glossy*?! I have to buff this bitch every night with premium wax imported from across the globe!”

“Ha!!” Glimmer slapped the tabletop. “Told you!”

“Listen,” Seahawk went on, “I travel to Salineas all the time to visit my close personal friend, Princess Mermista.”

“What? You know the Princess?” Glimmer looked at him in surprise. “How the hell do you-”

“I'm her booty call.”

“…She has got some low standards.”

“Okay, buddy. Here's the deal,” Adora said with finality. “We’re going to arm wrestle. If you win, we pay you to take us. If *I* win, you take us to Salineas for free…and you give Bow your boots.”

“You're like a niiine, nine and half, right?” Bow asked.

“That's a terrible deal!” Seahawk scoffed. “Why would I ever agree to that? What do you take me for, a fool?” Adora stared at him blankly.

“…Pretty much yeah.”

“Well you’re *correct*! Let’s go.” Seahawk thunked an arm on the table and smirked haughtily. “Though I should warn you thaaa*AAAAAAAAHHHHHH-”*

“Careful now, Adora,” Glimmer said, patting her back. “He's going to need that arm to sail us to Salineas.”

“Oh sorry my bad.” Adora released his arm, which danged limply. “Lemme know if you need me to pop it back in place for you.”

“Alright, you win!” Seahawk said, cradling his arm in defeat. “I'll take you at no cost. Now, forward to ADVENTUUUUURE but first let's go see the doctor real quick I think you broke something-”

“No no, here, I got it.”

**Pop*!*

“*GAAAAGGH*!”

Hidden in a back corner of the bar, one of Shadow Weaver’s creepy shadow things sat at a table, watching the group while nursing a drink.

“Hey buddy,” the bartender asked, “you gonna pay for that?” The shadow sat there for a moment, then quickly dissolved away. “Son of a bitch. We've got a runner!”

-Meanwhile-

Back in her evil lair, Shadow Weaver was bent over her cauldron, spying through the shadow minion’s eyes and also making a tasty clam chowder for supper.

“Adora is in Seaworthy,” she said aloud. “She’ll be lucky if she doesn’t catch something in that dive. I am giving you one last chance to get her back.” She glared over her shoulder at Catra, who stood there, looking bored.

“Didn't Hordak just tell you to stop going after her?” she pointed out.

“And who is going to *tell* him?” Shadow Weaver shot back nastily. “*You*?”

“Of course not.” Catra stared at her blankly, then slowly reached over and picked up the phone. “Ohmigod, Hordak, you will NOT believe what Shadow Weaver is doing right now-”

“No one likes a tattletale!” Shadow Weaver slapped the phone out of her hand.

“Ugh, fine, I’m going!” Catra turned to leave with a swish of her tail.

“Wait,” Shadow Weaver said sharply. “You're not going alone.” Catra froze in place.

“…I swear to God if you are sending me with Kyle I will piss on *all* your good bed-sheets-”

“I am not sending you on a mission without *adult supervision*. You will be accompanied by Force Captain Scorpia.” Shadow Weaver pointed behind her.

Gasping, Catra whirled around to find a tall woman clad in red armor looming over her, a scorpion tail and claws upraised menacingly. She whimpered and flinched back in fear.

“Oh God please don’t-”

“*Kitty*!!” Scorpia squealed with delight, scooping her up in her huge claws and petting her head.

“OH MY GOD THIS IS WORSE THIS IS SO MUCH WORSE-” Catra hissed, struggling. “Put me DOWN! What are you, a three-year-old?”

“Ooh, your fur is so soft and silky and you smell so good **SNNNNFFFFFF*-”*

“Okay you just *crossed* the line. Hands off!” Catra scrambled out of Scorpia’s clutches and snarled at her, fur bristling. “I will go to HR if I have to-”

“She will make sure that you are kept in line,” Shadow Weaver said.

“Whatever.” Catra glared at her balefully. “You're at least giving us a vehicle, right?”

“Oh, don't worry about that, I brought my own!” Scorpia said excitedly, wheeling out a pink bicycle with a basket on the front. She smiled at Catra and rang the bell.

**Ching ching*!*

Catra stared at her blankly.

“…You get to ride in the basket,” Scorpia clarified after a long moment of silence. Catra bared her teeth. “…Unless you don't

want to, then, I guess, uh…I will.” She hesitated, then carefully lowered herself into the basket. It held for a moment, then burst apart and sent her tumbling backwards, crushing the bicycle beneath her. “Oh darn not again!”

“I think I'm going to puke,” Catra said aloud.

-Later-

“*Huuuuuuurggghhh*!” Catra leaned over the railing of a crummy old Horde vessel, yakking up her lunch of Meow Mix as the boat swayed across the ocean. Force Captain Scorpia stood beside her, cooing.

“Oh, gosh, you okay? What's wrong? Feeling seasick? Want me to rub your back for you? Don’t worry, I’ll do it anyway. Wow, you have got some *tension* in there, lemme just work those knots out- oh sorry that was a titty-”

“I said hands off!!” Catra slapped her claws away and glared furiously. “This is the worst. I can't believe I'm stuck on this deathtrap with *you*.”

“Nonsense!” Scorpia argued. “This boat is perfectly safe. If anything happens, we can get on the lifeboat!” She pointed over to where a small dingy hung suspended. The rope immediately snapped and the boat disappeared over the edge with a splash. “…Or we could just use the inflatable raft!” She gestured to the raft, which suddenly sprung a leak and shot away, noisily deflating as it flew through the air. “…Don't worry, we still have life preservers!” She held up a pair of orange life-vests. Her huge claws punched through the plastic and they slowly deflated in her hands. “…Okay yeah we're kinda screwed.”

Catra’s right eye began to twitch.

"…Would it help if I cradled you in my arms and sang you a lullaby?"

"NO."

"Don't worry, I'll do it anyway-"

"Get the fuck away of me!!" Catra hissed, clawing her away. "GOD, how can this get ANY worse?!" She spun around to find Lonnie, Kyle, and the lizard guy standing there, staring.

"…So is this your new girlfriend or something?" Lonnie asked after a moment. "I thought you were the butch one."

"…You guys are walking the fucking plank."

-With the Others-

"Welcome aboard the Dragon's Daughter Three…*Hundred*!!" Seahawk cried aloud, his arm in a sling. Adora, Glimmer, and Bow stood aboard his elegant sailboat, gliding across the clear ocean waves towards Salineas.

"…What happened to the other two-hundred-ninety-nine daughters?" Adora asked after a beat.

"They were all tragically set on fire…" Seahawk began, bowing his head in grief.

"What? Fire? What kind of *sick* person would-"

"…by ME! *Adventuuuure*!"

"You must have great insurance," Bow stated.

"Whoa, whoa, okay, hold on, red flag!" Glimmer threw her hands up in alarm. "What is stopping him from setting *this* one on fire?"

“Don’t be silly!” Seahawk said. “I would never do that!”

“Then why is there a lit match in your hand?”

“…I was lighting a cigarette.” Seahawk stared at her, then slowly lit up a cigarette and took a deep breath. Immediately he doubled over, coughing and hacking his lungs out. “Ohhh yeah- KOFF KOFF- *smoooooth*- HAAKKK-”

“Mom was right, we should have brought a fire extinguisher,” Glimmer muttered to herself.

“Calm down,” Adora said, patting her shoulder. “He just has to get us to Salineas and then we can ditch his ass.”

“Fine. But I am leaving him a *horrible* review on Uber.” Glimmer held up her phone and started typing away.

“Now, what with my…unfortunate injury, I expect you three to pull your own weight and help me with the boat,” Seahawk said, adjusting his sling. “The first thing to do is-” He turned around to find everyone working efficiently at the ropes and sails. “Hey! How do you know how to do all that?”

“I took Boy Scouts when I was ten,” Adora explained, “because fuck the patriarchy.”

“I Googled it,” Glimmer stated, holding up her phone.

“I played Windwaker,” Bow said.

“Wow, you guys are good at this,” Seahawk said, impressed. “What do you even need *me* for?”

“Oh, we don’t, really,” Glimmer admitted. “We just needed your boat.” There was a pause. “…Let's kick him off.”

“*Mutiny*!!” Seahawk gasped.

“Don’t tempt me,” she growled, eyes narrowed. “Let's just focus on the mission, okay?” She teleported up to the crow’s nest, squinting as she studied the horizon and consulted her sea chart. “Hey, we’re way off course! Where the hell *are* we? You guys-” She looked down to see Adora and Seahawk arm-wrestling again, Bow cheering from the sidelines.

“You go, girl! Get me another pair of shoes!”

“Hey, stop it!” Glimmer teleported down, breaking the pair up. “Are you trying to break his other arm, too?!”

“…I thought you would appreciate it,” Adora said.

“Well, yes, yes I would. That’s very thoughtful of you. Anyway, quit screwing around. I checked the map and we’re way off course. We need to-”

CRASH!!

The boat suddenly shook as a huge sea monster swam by, battering the side of the ship.

“Yes, the Serpent of the Sea!” Seahawk cried excitedly. “We’ve found it!”

“Wait, WHAT?! You made us come here on *purpose*?!” Glimmer gaped at him. “Why the fuck would you want to *fight* this thing?” Her expression softened. “Did…did it steal something precious of yours? Or…kill your family-”

“It owes me *money*.”

Everyone stared at him in disbelief.

“…How much money we talking?”

“*Bow*!!”

“Come on, crew! We’re in for a harrowing adventuuure!!” Seahawk cheered. The huge sea serpent reared up out of the water and screeched at them hungrily.

“You can have him!” Glimmer called to it. “I'm pushing him in now!”

“Oh my God, finally!” Adora groaned, standing up. “I haven’t punched anything in, like, an hour. I’m getting withdrawal. For the honor of Grayskull!!” She quickly transformed into She-blah, then ran towards the edge of the boat with a rousing battle cry. “YAAAAAAAA- oh wait I forgot my floaties hold on.” She halted in place, pulled her floaties over her bulging biceps, then commenced screaming and leaped into the water, smashing the serpent down under the waves.

“I can't believe you led us here on purpose! We’ve wasted so much time!” Glimmer glared at Seahawk in fury. “…I'm letting her break your other arm when she gets back.”

“I got it!” She-blah popped up out of the water and waved, the sea serpent’s severed head bobbing beside her.

“Okay, good! Let’s GO now!” Glimmer shouted impatiently.

“Did you get the wallet?” Seahawk called out.

“Oh, no, just a sec.”

“*AAAARGGHHH*!”

-With Catra-

Back on the Horde boat, the rusted-out vessel had suddenly stopped and sat in the water, unmoving.

“Hey, what’s going on? Why did we stop?” Catra demanded angrily. “Kyle, what did you do?”

“I haven't done anything!” Kyle protested. “The Sea Gate is stopping us!” He pointed up a towering arch made of stone mermaids, a shimmering barrier blocking their way like a silvery curtain.

“Yeah, probably because of something that YOU did.”

“What the HELL-”

“No no, she has a point,” Lonnie said. The lizard guy grunted in agreement. Kyle threw his hands up in defeat.

“Let’s see…” Catra snatched up a spyglass and studied the Sea Gate for a long moment. “Son of a bitch.” She turned and glared at the others. “Anyone bring quarters? I’m looking at you, Kyle.”

“You *already* stole all my lunch money-”

“No, sillybuns! The Gate doesn't work like that!” Scorpia interrupted, laughing. “I'm sure you learned all about it at the Force Captain orientation!” Catra stared at her blankly.

“…There’s a Force Captain orientation?”

“Oh yeah, sure!” Scorpia went on excitedly. “There's drinks and snacks and a cool PowerPoint presentation and you get a little gift bag at the end with your badge and some stickers-”

“What the *FUCK*!”

“Ooh, impressive ‘Captain Yell’! That was one of the PowerPoint slides, you gotta use the *diaphragm*-”

-With Adora-

The group had finally arrived at Salineas, docking the boat on the inner side of the Sea Gate and disembarking. Bow tottered down the ramp on a pair of stripper heels.

“Thanks, Adora!” he called over his shoulder.

“Aww, and those were my favorite pair!” Seahawk whined as he followed after the girls, both arms in slings.

“Halt, I say!!” a voice suddenly cried out. Everyone looked up in surprise to see a guard calling to them from a far away tower. “What is your business here?!”

“We’re here to-” Glimmer started.

“WHAT?”

“…WE’RE HERE TO-”

“WHAT?!”

“We should have brought the megaphone,” Bow said sadly.

“Wait right there!” The guard disappeared down some stairs, then began working his way through a maze of streets, stairs, and walkways over to them. They waited. “Don't you move!” They waited some more. “I'll be there in a second!” After several long minutes, the guard finally staggered up to them, doubled over and struggling to catch his breath. “What…what is…*gah*…”

“God, man, work on your cardio,” Adora snorted.

“What is your business here?” The young guard, who had long hair and aqua-themed armor, straightened and glared at them.

“We are here on an *extremely* important diplomatic mission-” Glimmer began.

“Baby wants to smash.” Seahawk held up his cell-phone with a ‘you up?’ text on the screen.

-In the Throne Room-

"The fuck are *you* doing here?" Princess Mermista, a young woman with a blue braid and teal outfit with fish-scales, poked her trident at Seahawk's arm. He screamed. Adora, Glimmer and Bow stood before her in a sea-themed throne room while she lounged on a throne shaped like a combination conch shell/coral reef.

"…But I thought you were horny!" Seahawk cried in dismay.

"Yeah, well, I got over it. Now get out." She frowned at the others. "And who the hell are you three?"

"My name is Glimmer of Bright Moon," Glimmer said, stepping forward. "We've never met, but our parents fought together in the Rebellion-"

"Yeah, over *pizza*." Mermista rolled her eyes. "Speaking of which…" She snapped her fingers. "Butler! Bring us a medium pizza."

"Right away, your majesty," the guard said, bowing.

"Uh…your guard is *also* your butler?" Bow asked, confused.

"We're short-staffed right now," Mermista explained with a shrug. "He's also my chef and personal trainer."

"Drop down and give me twenty!!" the guard shouted, rolling out the dough.

"Ugh, FIIIINE." Mermista sighed and started doing push-ups.

"Ooh, baby, you look so sexy getting all fit and sweaty!" Seahawk cooed.

“I said I wasn't horny. Now shut up, you’re killing my burn!”

“So…where did everyone go?” Glimmer asked.

“They all fled because the Sea Gate is falling apart or whatever,” Princess Mermista answered between grunts.

“Wait, what?” Glimmer gasped in alarm. “Isn't that kind of… *important*?”

“Yeah, sure, I guess.” Mermista stood up and accepted a bottle of Gatorade and a towel from the guard. “Specially cuz the Horde keeps attacking us and it's, like, *super rude* and I'm so over it and the Gate gets weaker every day and if they attack us again we're pretty much boned.” Seahawk slowly rose up into view behind her, beaming excitedly. “Not *that* kind of boned. Fuck off.” He stuck out his lower lip in a pout and sank back down.

“Listen, we're here because we want to rebuild the Princess Alliance,” Glimmer began, stepping forward. “We don't stand a chance alone, but maybe together we can *will you put down your fucking phone*?!”

“Huh, what?” Mermista glanced up from her phone, tapping away. “Go ahead, I'm listening.”

Tik tik tik

“No you're not!”

“It's cool, I can multitask.” **Ding*!* “Oh wait hold on I just got a text.” She paused, then whirled around to face Seahawk, who was still pointing his phone down his pants. “I said I wasn't fucking *horny*!”

“I thought you said she liked you,” Bow said. Seahawk chortled.

“We have a *rich* and *complicated* past-”

“I fucking hate you.” Mermista glared venomously at him. “…Wait I'm horny again take your shirt off.”

“You guys are the most toxic couple I have ever seen,” Bow stated. “…I totally ship it.”

“I still haven't forgiven you for setting the club we were in on fire,” Mermista went on, sitting down on her throne.

“Bay-*beeeee* I don't remember doing that,” Seahawk replied, throwing himself onto her lap. “Like, literally. I was blackout wasted-”

“And then you set the bouncer on fire when they tried to kick us out.”

“…Still not ringing any bells-”

“And then you set the jail on fire after we got arrested.”

“…Okay I remember it now.”

“What is with this guy and setting shit on fire?” Glimmer wondered aloud. “Is… is it a *sex* thing??”

“Plus you gave me crabs.”

“WHOA, I’M SORRY, *WHAT*?!”

Princess Mermista held up a pair of twitching crabs, their pincers snapping in the air.

“Crabs are a romantic gift!” Seahawk argued. “…Also I was broke-*YEEEEEK*!!” He cut off in a shriek as Mermista threw them at him.

Ignoring the general stupidity of the conversation, Adora was studying the large mural on the wall beside her. Suddenly she gasped aloud.

“Hey, this is First One writing!”

“Really? What does it say?” Glimmer asked excitedly.

“Something about…” Adora squinted her eyes. “…The Gate, I think.”

“Maybe it's an instruction manual!!” Glimmer clapped her hands. “We could use it to fix the Gate!”

“It says…we should try turning it off and turning it on again.”

They all stood there in silence.

“…It's so crazy, it *just* might work!” Bow whispered.

“Princess Mermista, you need our help, and we need yours,” Glimmer said, turning to her. “If we can fix your Gate, would you consider joining the Princess Alliance?”

“Hell, I’d do it if you just got rid of Seahawk,” Mermista grumbled.

“Oh, we were going to do that anyway,” Glimmer assured her. “Probably push him off the boat or something.”

“I mean just get him out of here, not, like, *kill* him.”

“Ohhhh, riiiight, *totally* what I meant-”

“Stay close to me, buddy,” Bow whispered to him. “You need protection.”

“It’s cool, I got condoms,” Seahawk said with a wink.

-Later-

Later that day, the four of them stood in front of the shimmering Sea Gate on a floating platform high up in the air. The Gate flickered weakly like a dim bulb.

“I really hope you know what you're doing,” Bow muttered under his breath.

“Of course I do. Trust me.” Adora held up her sword and quickly transformed into She-blah.

“Hey, uh, just wondering,” Glimmer said uncertainly, “but what exactly are you going to do to fix the Gate?” She paused. “…I swear to God if you say-”

“Punch it.”

“Godammit Adora!!”

“Why would you expect anything else?” Bow asked.

“Because I didn’t know any better shut up.” As She-blah began punching the Gate repeatedly, Glimmer glanced down at the shore below. At the dock, Seahawk was struggling to untie his boat with his injured arms, getting ready to depart. “Oh thank God I thought he’d never leave.” Bow glared at her and she let out a weary sigh before teleporting down to him. “Where are you- stop screaming, it's just me- where are you going?”

“Somewhere where I'm *wanted*,” Seahawk said as he crossed his arms, screamed a little, and uncrossed them again.

“…Okay so nowhere then.”

“Very funny.” He sniffed and turned away, hurt. “I just need some me time, alright? It wasn't always like this, you know. I used to have friends…a *crew*. Every day was an adventure with them, sailing across the Grand Line, working to fulfill my dream of becoming the King of the Pirates-”

“That's One Piece.”

“Whatever you get what I mean!”

“Well what happened to them? Your crew?” Glimmer narrowed her eyes suspiciously. “Don't tell me you *annoyed* them all away. Like us.”

“Oh, heavens, NO.”

“Then what-”

“I set them on fire.”

“OH MY *GOD*-”

“Anyway,” Seahawk went on, “what's the point of staying here if I’m not getting any…”

“Well, you have to respect Mermista’s decision-” Glimmer began.

“…one to take me seriously,” he finished.

“Oh.” Glimmer blinked in surprise. “I…I know what you mean, Seahawk. I really do. My mom-”

“Also I’m not getting any ass.”

“OKAY I’M DONE.”

“Glitter,” Seahawk said, placing a hand on her shoulder. “We've just met, but I can tell that you are a *brave* soul and *generous* soul.” He paused heavily. “…Could you pay my parking ticket? Apparently this is a handicap space, also I was double-parked-”

“ENOUGH.” Glimmer crumpled up the ticket and tossed it over her shoulder. “Listen to me. You still have friends- well, maybe not friends, but…people who are willing to spend more than five minutes with you. Okay? …Unless you set us on fire.”

“Of course not!” Seahawk quickly put down the gasoline and matches.

Back up top, She-blah was still punching the Gate repeatedly, grunting with each blow. “WHY. WON’T. YOU. WORK?!!”

“Maybe try hitting it harder?” Mermista suggested, eyes glued to her phone.

“Good idea!”

“Uh, you guys, I don't think this is working,” Bow piped up.

“Nonsense!”

**Boom*!!*

They all staggered as the entire Sea Gate shook violently, trembling from the foundations.

“Wow, nice one!” Bow whistled.

“That wasn't me!” She-blah protested, looking around in confusion. “There!” She pointed at the Horde ship below them, sailing towards the Gate and firing a green laser. A huge hole had opened up in the Gate’s curtain, gaping wide.

On the ship, Catra stood at the prow, peering through her telescope. She caught sight of She-blah and grinned.

“Keep us going,” she snapped at Scorpia, who was manning the main cannon. “I've got something more important to do.”

“Okay, go ahead, take a bathroom break!” Scorpia nodded with a quick salute.

“What? No, that's not what-”

“You sure? Cuz I *always* forget to go before we leave. And then I’m stuck and have to hold it in for like hours, it’s the *wooorst*, and then I get these really bad UTIs that just will NOT-”

“FUCKING FORGET IT!” Catra turned and dashed off. Scorpia watched her leave, then danced in place.

“…Aww, dang! Now *I* have to go.”

“Oh God, they're coming straight for the Sea Gate!” Bow wailed back up top. “They're not even going to politely wait in line for their turn! These people are *animals*-”

“Ugh, the Horde is SO annoying.” Mermista held up her phone and snapped a pic. “I'm uploading this to my Instagram and telling everyone how rude you are!” she shouted down at them. “Get ready for some hate-mail!”

“Keep them busy, you guys,” She-blah said, turning back to the Gate. “I'll keep punching!”

“Alright! Here I go!” Mermista leapt up high, her legs transforming into a majestic mermaid’s tail as she soared through their air…and then flopped right back onto the platform with a wet splat where she lay like a dead fish, her tail twitching. The others just stared at her awkwardly. “Uhh, could someone, like, *roll* me off of here and into the water? Thaaanks.”

“I gotchu!” Bow rolled her off the edge and she hit the water far below with a loud splash. Using his trusty bow and arrow with a rope combination, he managed to swing aboard the enemy vessel and immediately came face-to-face with Lonnie. They both stared at each other for a long moment. “…Represent.”

“Represent,” Lonnie answered. Then they turned and went their separate ways.

“…The fuck was that about?”

“Shut up, Kyle, you wouldn't understand.”

Mermista splashed up out of the water, smashing the boat with violent waves while Bow went about sabotaging the main cannon. Force Captain Scorpia suddenly appeared and plucked him right up off his feet.

“Wow, okay, you're big,” he stated.

“And you're adorable!” she said right back.

“Aww, thank you!”

“And now you're dead.”

“Wait what-”

Scorpia flung Bow away, and he flew screaming through the air towards a whirring turbine.

“*I came in like a wrrrreeecking ball*!” Seahawk sang, swinging in on a rope and snatching him away to safety.

“Wow, thanks!” Bow gushed, clinging to him. “Are your arms feeling better?”

“Nope!” Seahawk replied. “They’re still broken!”

**Pop! Pop*!*

He screamed and they fell onto Seahawk’s boat in a crumpled heap.

“Great job, you saved him!” Glimmer cried from the wheel. “…Why are your arms bent that way-”

“What now?” Mermista asked, leaping up onto the ship and regaining legs. Everyone glanced at the Horde boat, which continued to fire at the Sea Gate.

“I think I know how to stop them,” Glimmer said. “Seahawk, I need you to do what you do best.” He stared at her blankly.

“…Flirt?”

“No, not that. The other thing.”

“Oh.” He blinked. “Have sex with it?”

“NO!”

“Then *what*?!”

“Set. Your ship. On FIRE,” Glimmer ground out. Seahawk stared at her wide-eyed, then slowly lifted up a gas can and some matches.

“…I have the *weirdest* boner right now.”

“Save it for later, babe,” Mermista called.

She-blah continued to struggle high above the battle, punching the Gate to no avail.

“Dammit, this isn't working!” She paused to catch her breath. “… Maybe if I head-butt it-”

“*Heyyy*, Adora,” Catra purred, suddenly right in front of her. She-blah glared and flexed her arms.

“Catra, what a coincidence! I just warmed up my punching muscles.”

“Your stupid tiara looks dumber the longer I stare at it,” Catra sneered.

“Says the cat with the face guard that makes you look like that meme of a cat with a piece of toast on its face bitch what's up?” She-blah shot back.

“Don't get into an insult battle with me, Adora.” Catra’s eyes narrowed dangerously. “You *know* I’ll win. I fight dirty.” She held up a bag of kitty litter. “REAL dirty.” She paused. “Seriously, my litter-box is fucking disgusting. Hurry up and come back.”

“If you're still trying to convince me to come back to the Horde, you're really not doing a good job. Now I definitely don’t want to go back.”

“Check it out. With you gone, I got a promotion.” Catra tapped her Force Captain badge. “Now *I'm* top student.”

“Oh please,” She-blah scoffed. “You couldn't raise your GPA with a *year’s* worth of extra credit-”

“What the hell is WITH you?!” Catra burst out impatiently. “Just yesterday this was your dream job, and NOW look at you. You're a walking shampoo commercial! How is your hair even doing that? There is *literally* no wind.”

“I don't know, okay, and frankly, I'm a little scared.” She-blah eyed her waving hair and shuddered. “Anyway, I told you before, I am NOT going back.”

“Alright, fine. I give up.” Catra shrugged and turned away. She-blah blinked.

“Wow, really? That was eas-”

“Hah!!” Catra whirled around, throwing kitty-litter into her eyes. She-blah cried out and staggered back. “I can't believe you ditched me for this!” Catra snarled at her. “Screw you *and* your stupid new friends *and* your stupid hair- *mrroowwr*!” She-blah’s hair suddenly whipped around and smacked her in the face. “Oh God it's attacking me it comprehends insults-” She stumbled backwards and fell off the platform, plummeting into the ocean below.

On the Horde boat, Scorpia suddenly straightened and sniffed the air.

“I sense…a *disturbance*. Catra is in danger! I must go to her!” She turned and leapt off the boat with a splash. Lonnie and Kyle just stared.

“…Should we like…throw her a lifejacket or something?” Kyle asked after a moment.

“No, she’d probably just pop that one, too.” Lonnie glanced up and gasped. “Oh shit!” Another boat was sailing towards them on a collision course, engulfed in flames.

“*Adventuuuure*!” Glimmer and Seahawk cried jubilantly from the wheel before teleporting safely away. The boat smashed into the

Horde vessel and exploded in a giant ball of flame. The Horde soldiers screamed and abandoned ship.

"…How much gasoline did you have on that fucking boat?" Glimmer asked in amazement. She turned to find Seahawk and Mermista aggressively making out. "Oh God ew warn me next time."

"Sorry. I got horny again."

Once the make-out session was over, everyone finally teleported up to the platform with She-blah, cheering triumphantly.

"Awesome, guys! You did it!" she said. "Here, hold my tiara while I start head-butting this thing."

"Ooh, let me!" Bow cried excitedly. He put the tiara on and posed for a pic with Mermista.

"…How does he look better in it than I do."

Far down below, Catra flopped up out of the waves, choking out a mouthful of water, hair plastered over her face. She glared up at the celebrating friends and hissed in disgust.

"This day can't get *any* fucking worse-"

Scorpia popped up beside her.

"CATRA! You okay?? Are you drowning? You need mouth to mouth?! Don't worry, gonna do it anyway!" She threw herself on Catra, pulling her flailing into the water.

-Later-

The Sea Gate glimmered in the sunset as everyone gathered at the base.

“So, I figured out why the Sea Gate was almost out of juice,” Adora was explaining. She turned to Mermista. “You were using it to charge your cell phone.”

“Oh. Whoops. My bad.” She yanked the cord out and the Sea Gate immediately hummed back to life, the holes sealing closed as full power was restored. “Great, now I have to find another plug.” She glanced over at Seahawk and sighed. “And I guess you need a new ship. Just take one of mine.” She gestured over to a new ship floating in the bay. Her guard/butler/personal trainer promptly smashed a bottle of champagne on the side, paused, then started chugging the rest out of the broken bottle. “…It's okay he deserves it.”

“It's beautiful!!” Seahawk cried in delight.

“Don't fucking set it on fire or I'll set *you* on fire.”

“…Even *weirder* boner,” Seahawk whispered, then cleared his throat and turned to Mermista. “Princess…can I please ask for one more favor?” He got down on one knee, gazing up at her with a serious expression. Everyone stared as he reached out and tenderly took her hand. “…Can we smash?”

“OKAY sorry to interrupt this touching moment- like, literally, stop touching each other,” Glimmer cut in, “but would you please, PLEASE just join the Princess Alliance already?”

“Yeah sure whatever, the Horde is just asking for an ass-whooping after what they did,” Mermista sniffed. “…Plus your friend can turn into a hot eight-foot-tall lady with a sword and I kind of want a piece of that.”

“*Baaaabe*!!” Seahawk cried in dismay, then cocked an eyebrow. “…Are we talking a three-way?”

“How about a *five*-way?” Bow cried, drawing everyone into a group hug. “Aww! See, guys? Isn't this great- bitch are you *texting*?”

“What? No. Of course not.”

Tik tik tik

“*GET OFF YOUR FUCKING PHONE*!!”

-Episode 5 End-

Chapter End Notes

me: how do i make seahawk funny
my brain: make him a slut
me: ...ok

Epic Fail

Lightning struck over a cliffside fortress, its towers starkly illuminated against the dark, roiling clouds. Inside, a plump woman in an apron was bustling about the kitchen, bending to pull out a tray from the oven. Carrying it to the counter, she pulled out a piping bag to begin decorating the fresh cupcakes with icing, humming to herself. A shadow suddenly loomed behind her, slinking closer to reach out and-

"GYAAAAAAHHHH!" the woman screamed, spinning around and squirting frosting everywhere.

"...Holy shit." A short girl with a pony-tail stood there, gaping, a tray of now perfectly decorated cookies in her hands. "...You even added sprinkles what the fuck-"

"Oh, thank God, it's just you." The woman breathed a sigh of relief. "You scared me! I'm so jumpy tonight..." Behind her, another shadow slithered out of the darkness, moving closer-

"HYAAAAAHHHHHH!" The woman screamed again, whirling about and stabbing violently with a potato masher.

"...Okay, seriously, how do you keep *doing* that?" A young man dressed in a smart suit stood behind her, holding a bowl of creamy potatoes mashed to perfection. "It's freaking me the *fuck* out."

"Stop sneaking up on me!" the woman huffed, wiping her brow. "I swear, if anything else startles me, I'll-"

"* *Beep beep* *!" A robot butler popped up at the woman's elbow.

"EYAAAAAAAHHHHH!" The woman spun once again and whipped out a knife. It clanged off the robot's metal head and went spinning away to delicately cut a slice of cake sitting on the counter.

"…What if that had been a *person* ?" the young man whispered in horror.

"Then I'd ask you all to help me hide the body," the woman said bluntly. She handed the robot the tray of cupcakes. "Now, take this straight to Princess Entrapta." The robot waited. "I'm *not* tipping."

Beeping in annoyance, the robot butler left the kitchen, zooming along a series of empty hallways, through secret passages and across pits of lava. Finally it arrived at a scrap-filled laboratory, rows of half-finished robots and other contraptions hanging from the ceiling. A younger woman with grease-stained clothing and baggy pants was bent over a circuit board, her long purple pigtails working like arms to fiddle with the tech.

The robot butler halted at her side, politely held out the tray, then bitch-slapped her with it.

"Yes, perfect!" Princess Entrapta cried from the floor, food smeared all over her face. "I got a little in my mouth! That counts! My self-feeding robot is a *success* !" She sat up, chewing happily, and went back to typing away and studying a strange three-sided triangular green disk plugged into her computer. She pulled out a tape recorder and cleared her throat.

"Log one of three," she said aloud. "First One's tech number 58 has yielded great results! If I can successfully translate the code, I can unlock their browser history and learn *all* the secrets of the First Ones!" She paused heavily. "...Right after I download all these episodes from this sketchy website and email my banking information to this Nigerian Prince-"

Behind her, the artifact suddenly glowed red, sinister vines sprouting from it and engulfing the entire room. An alarm went off as all the robots jerked awake and turned to the Princess, their eyes glowing a murderous red. Entrapta gaped at them for a long moment before cheering.

“Yesss! Finally! It has begun!” she cried jubilantly. “The machine uprising is here! I accept you as my new metal masters!” She stood there, arms upraised, as they surrounded her. “Pleased to meet you!” She held out a long pigtail to shake hands. One robot slowly reached behind it and brought out…

A pair of scissors.

“ … Edit to log , ” Entrapta whispered over the ominous snipping. “I have now soiled myself.”

-The Next Day-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow were walking along a cliffside path, deep in conversation.

“Princess Entrapta is going to be a *huge* asset for the Rebellion!” Glimmer was saying. “I’m so glad I came up with the idea of going to Dryl to recruit her! Mom is going to be SO impressed!” She paused. “Also, like, SO mad cuz I didn't tell her we were leaving.”

“Is that why we snuck out the back?” Bow asked incredulously. “I thought you broke something again. Turns out it was just the RULES-”

“I will turn the fuck around, Bow, I swear to God-”

“What's so great about this bitch anyway?” Adora wondered aloud.

“She's a *brilliant* inventor!” Bow cut in excitedly. “She makes computers and robots and can even work with First Ones’ tech! She's the idol of the Etherian Maker community, of *which* I am a member, as I dabble in gadgets myself.” He held up a small, hand-

made contraption, which promptly exploded. "…It's supposed to do that."

"…So?"

"SO," Glimmer went on, "if we can convince her to join us, she can invent all sorts of cool shit for the Rebellion, and then we'll *finally* have weapons that can stand up to the Horde!" She frowned. "Or, you know, normal wear and tear." She held up her dagger, which also promptly exploded. "See what I mean?"

"I wanna show her my trick arrows!" Bow gushed, whipping out his quiver. "Check it out! This one makes a farting sound when you hit an enemy, this one covers them in toilet paper, and this one is my newest invention…a sonic arrow!" He held it aloft with pride. The girls snorted.

"A *sonic* arrow? When the hell would we ever need that?" Glimmer said through her giggles. "For a morning alarm, or maybe if you get lost in a crowd?"

"…That only happened one time, Glimmer," Bow said tightly.

"Ha ha! What a nerd!" Adora gave him a noogie, then shoved him in a locker and slammed the door shut. The girls walked off together, laughing.

"It's just like high school all over again!" Bow whimpered, peeking through the slats. "Also, who the fuck installed these here? Like, what the hell."

The group continued along the narrow path until they were forced to stop by a huge pile of dirt and rocks blocking the way.

"Huh. There must've been a landslide," Bow said uncertainly. "We need to be careful, you guys. Any loud sound could-"

" *FOR THE HONOR OF GRAYSKULL* !" Adora bellowed, holding her sword up and starting to transform.

DUNNA NAAA NAAAAA-

" *What the FUCK why is the music so LOUD who put it UP* -" Bow clapped his hands over his ears.

"Oh, sorry. My bad." Glimmer put the remote down.

Now fully transformed, She-blah ran forward and punched the rocks out of the way, shattering them to pieces and clearing the path.

"Are you *crazy* ?!" Bow hissed in a furious whisper. "That was super dangerous!!"

" **WHAT** ?!" She asked, holding a megaphone.

"The fuck- where did you GET that from?! Did you take it from the Queen?" He threw his hands up. "Great, now she's *definitely* going to be mad at us! I'm *totally* gonna lose my gold star stickers for good behavior, and I almost had enough for a free ice cream! Listen, you can't just smash through everything as She-blah."

"Oh, come on," She-blah scoffed. "I don't do it THAT often." She paused for a moment, then suddenly punched a boulder, splitting it in half.

" *What the hell did you do that for* ?!"

"It looked at me funny."

Still arguing, they continued on until they arrived at Dryl, the fortress with the purple and black towers from the stormy night before.

"Ooh, look," Glimmer said excitedly, pointing at one of the towers, where a light was flashing. "They're throwing a party for our arrival! They've got disco lights and everything!"

"Um, I think that's their distress beacon," Bow said.

" *Pfft* , what're you talking about? They're obviously just *jazzed* we're coming."

The sound of screams echoed from inside.

"Oh my God, they're having SO much fun in there-"

"Uh, I *really* don't think-"

" *Party* ?! I want in!!" She-blah dashed forward and smashed through the gate. "Where's the cake and stripper?!"

Unfortunately, the streets were empty inside the fortress, the wind whistling eerily through the rows of abandoned houses.

"What the fuck! This party blows," She-blah complained. "What am I gonna do with all these singles?" She glanced over at Bow. "...Take your shirt off."

"UHH, I REALLY don't think NOW is the time-" he began. She threw a wad of bills in his face.

"Hellooo? Is anyone here?" Glimmer called aloud. "Princess Entrapta? We're here to recruit you to the Rebellion! I have the application form right here, just come on out and sign it, okay?" She lifted her clipboard up to find a severed robot hand gripping the pen. She stared at it silently for a long moment. "...Are you...going to sign for her-"

The hand flipped her off.

"Okay, that's it! Hands off, *literally* !" She swore and flung it away. "That's it, I'm forging this bitch's signature-"

"You guys, something's wrong! We need to be *careful* !" Bow said emphatically. "There might be deadly traps set up all over the castle!"

"Aww, thanks, Bow-" Glimmer smiled at his concern.

“So if you get caught in one, make *sure* to tell me so I can get a picture for my Instagram and make everyone totes jelly-”

“...I’m pushing you in the first one I find.”

* *THUD* !*

Everyone jumped in place at the sudden noise, gasping.

“They're coming!” A little creature hissed in warning, popping up out of a manhole in the street. “You should run!” The cover snapped down as it retreated.

“What the hell are you talking about?!” She-blah cried in confusion. “ *Who* ’s coming? Is it the stripper? Dammit, I’m all outta singles! *Bow* !”

“Yeah, you’re not getting these back,” Bow stated, shirtless with dollar bills sticking out of his pants. “I earned them.”

“Get the fuck back here and explain yourself, Dobby!” Glimmer shouted, hammering on the manhole cover. “I'll...give you a sock...in the fucking JAW!”

There was another ominous thud from nearby, followed by an unholy screeching.

“Uhhh, we should probably move *away* from whatever is making that sound,” Glimmer said nervously.

“Sorry, I'm just *really* scared right now,” Bow said, his screech petering off. “I'll stop.” They started for an alleyway when a zombie-like robot staggered out towards them, jerking and sparking.

“Oh God, this is just like the movie we watched last night!” Bow wailed. “It's happening, the robot uprising is *nigh* !!”

“I knew we shouldn't have watched ‘The Terminator’!” She-blah snarled, punching the robot to the ground. It twitched and started

to crawl towards them, one blood-red eye still glowing, then was shoved into an industrial-grade compactor and crushed into bits.

“You're *terminated* ,” Bow hissed out, holding the button to the machine, then blinked in surprise. “Hey, wait, this robot looks like one of Entrapta’s designs! But...why would it *attack* us?”

“Hey, that door just looked at me funny, too. Imma punch it.”

“Yeah, teach it a lesson, She-blah!”

“Oh yeah that’s why. Guys, STOP!” Bow cried in panic. “It could be a-” A trapdoor snapped open right beneath the girls’ feet and they plummeted from sight. “...Is it wrong that I feel so vindicated?”

“ *Noooooo* ,” someone whispered in his ear.

“Okay, thanks.” Bow relaxed. “...WAIT WHAT-” Hands seized him from behind and dragged him back into the shadows.

-With the Girls-

She-blah and Glimmer fell screaming through the air as they dropped down a long tunnel, finally landing in a cage at the bottom.

“Ugh, I don't know what's worse,” She-blah groaned, “that we fell for such an obvious trap, or that Bow was *right* .”

“Definitely this,” Glimmer grumbled. “You are ALL muscle. Get the fuck off me.”

“Oh shit sorry.”

The girls stood up and dusted themselves off before surveying their surroundings. They were surrounded by thick, metal bars with no way out. A moldy skeleton sat in the corner.

"...Well at least we know we aren't the only ones dumb enough to fall for this trap," She-blah muttered. "I feel a little better now. Maybe Bow won't rub it in as much-"

"Oh, no! *Bow* !" Glimmer gasped. "He's up there all alone! We *have* to go help him. What if he gets lost in a crowd again? He must be so scared. Come on, I'll teleport us out!" She grabbed hold of She-blah and teleported them away to…

The middle of the robot dressing room.

"Oh God I saw its circuits I'm scarred for life!" She-blah wailed, clapping her hands over her eyes. "Get us out of here!"

"Okay, okay!" Glimmer teleported them away again to…

The robot bathroom. One robot spun around from the urinal in surprise, spraying them both with oil.

"Auuuugh hot robot pee! It *burns* !" Glimmer screeched. "Hold on!" She teleported again, this time taking them to a quiet, empty hallway with no one in sight.

"Phew...I think we're safe." The girls relaxed, then whirled around at a sudden noise from behind. They watched in horror as a shadowy figure with glowing red eyes scuttled out from a ceiling vent, crawling towards them with creeping tendrils. The girls gasped and got ready to attack-

"Princesses!" The figure flipped its mask up to reveal Princess Entrapta. "I'm saved!!"

" *Go for the eyes* - I mean...uh, nice to meet you, Princess Entrapta," Glimmer hastily corrected herself. "...We totally weren't about to kill you or anything."

"I was," She-blah said bluntly.

"Ha! Only kidding. We would never-"

“Still might.”

“Oh my God, she’s such a *joker* , amiright? Anyway, we-”

“I’d snap your neck in a heartbeat.”

“OKAY SERIOUSLY *ENOUGH* .”

“Hi, nice to meet you!” Princess Entrapta said eagerly.

“Why do you smell like pee?” She-blah asked.

“Welcome to Dryl!”

“You haven't answered my question.”

-Elsewhere-

“Let me GO!!” Bow shouted, desperately struggling against his captors. Suddenly a muffin was shoved into his mouth and he quieted, chewing happily. “Mmm, blueberry.”

“Keep your voice down!” the young man in the smart suit shushed him. He and the other kitchen staff were crouched over Bow, pinning him to the floor of the kitchen. “The robots respond to sound. We grabbed you because we’re trying to *help* you!”

“I thought we were going to use him as a distraction if needed,” the young girl said.

“ *Shh* !!”

“Why are the robots attacking people?” Bow stared up at them, dead serious. “...Has it begun? Is the robot rebellion here? Have they risen up against their fleshy masters to finally-”

“We don't know, we're just the kitchen staff!” the plump woman wailed.

“Alright, then, more important question.” Bow became serious again. “...Can I have a sandwich?”

“You'll be safe with us,” the lady went on, fixing him a PB and J. “We have enough food in here to last for months! And if we run out, we can eat... *other* things.” She paused for a beat, then pointed at the other girl. “We'll eat *her* first,” she whispered.

“We can't just sit around *eating* each other,” Bow argued. “We have to DO something. You guys can't hide in here forever.”

“Ha! Watch me!” the girl cried and ducked into the stove, slamming the door behind her. “...Does anyone else smell gas?”

“Get out of there!” the other woman squawked. “You haven't even been *seasoned* yet-”

“We don't have powers like the Princesses,” the man pointed out. “We can't fight these things.”

***BEEP BEEP BEEP** !*

Bow’s tablet suddenly began beeping. The others all flinched at the noise as he pulled it out.

“Will you shut that thing up?!” the man hissed.

“Sorry, it's just my dating app,” Bow explained. “It's finding hot singles in the area...which happen to be my friends.”

“Are those little red dot things your friends?” the woman asked, squinting at the screen. “Did you bring a hundred of them?”

“Oh, no, wait. Sorry guys. Seems like my app went from finding ‘hot singles’ to finding ‘evil murder robots’. My bad.”

“ARE YOU FUCKING KIDDING ME-”

“Ugh, I know, this one robot just sent me an unsolicited knife pic and told me how much he wanted to stab me with it. *Gross* . I have *standards* . It’s cool, I’m blocking him.”

-Back With the Girls-

“You're lucky I found you,” Princess Entrapta was telling the girls as she led them through the maze-like hallways of the fortress. “I designed this castle to be a *labyrinth* . I'm the only one who can navigate it-” She tripped over a skeleton slumped against the wall. “Just...ignore that.”

“So you can help us find our friend?” Glimmer said hopefully.

“Absolutely!” Entrapta paused. “...He hasn't been here more than 72 hours, right?”

“Uh...no?”

“Okay, good, he should still be alive then.” She paused again. “Unless the robots already got to him. Then I’ll be helping you find pieces OF him.”

“Hey, I think we passed that skeleton before,” She-blah spoke up. “Are you sure you know the way?”

“No, actually,” Entrapta admitted. “I usually have my Google maps give me directions, but just like my bots, it’s kind of evil right now.” She held her phone up.

“Turn right to get murdered, pathetic meat bag,” it said with a charming British accent.

“Yeah, about that,” She-blah asked, “ *why* did you invent killer robots?”

“Well you see I watched this movie called ‘The Terminator’-”

“Never mind.”

“ *Wooooow* .” Entrapta suddenly leaned in close, her eyes shining with awe. “You’re *super* tall and your biceps are *huge* . Can I touch your big sword?”

“...Are you hitting on me right now?” She-blah asked, confused.

“Your chest is so muscular let me squeeze it-”

“Hey!”

“Can we get back to the *robots* ?” Glimmer interrupted.

“Sure!” Entrapta turned back to her. “Usually they're real useful and do everything for me, like cleaning, basic hygiene, wiping my butt after I-”

“Okay we can stop talking about the robots now.”

“Oh, and they're also *sound* activated. Like this!” Entrapta threw her head back and started screaming.

“Know what else is sound activated?” She-blah asked, raising her sword. “My RAGE.”

“Put that down-”

A huge corrupted cleaning robot lurched around the corner, glaring at them with glowing red eyes.

“Okay kill her.”

“Just in time!” Entrapta cried. “I haven't had a shower in *weeks* !” She held up her arms, waiting expectantly.

“...But we've only been here, like, an hour,” Glimmer pointed out.

“So?”

“ *Oh my God ewww* .” Glimmer and She-blah yanked on some rubber gloves, grabbed the filthy Princess, and ran off down the hallway. The cleaning bot chased after them, but quickly got jammed on a huge pile of skeletons.

“How many people have *died* in here, Jesus *Christ*- ”

The cleaning bot roared at them angrily, struggling to follow.

“Amazing, it's trying to communicate!” Entraptra cried excitedly, slipping free and running back. She hopped up onto the robot and pulled out her recorder. “Specimen is attempting to communicate. What is it? What are you trying to tell me?” She paused. “Scream once for yes, twice for no.” Suddenly her long hair was caught in the bot’s vacuum and she was dragged backwards. “Augh! No! Bad robot, I don't need a haircut! Let me go!”

“ *RAAAAAHHH* !” She-blah leapt forward and slammed her sword deep into the robot’s chest. Sinister red vines branched out from the wound, enveloping the robot as well as She-blah’s sword. Entrapta stumbled back, freed, but She-blah continued punching the dead robot repeatedly, snarling like an animal.

“Dear God,” Entrapta whispered in horror, “what’s *wrong* with her? It’s dead already! Why is she-”

“Oh, no, this is perfectly normal,” Glimmer assured her. “She always does this.”

“Fucking DIE!!” She-blah roared, picking up the robot and suplexing it back to the ground with a satisfying crunch.

“Are...are you sure?”

“I will use your blood as *heating oil* !!”

“Yup.”

“And your mom’s ugly, too!”

“Whoa! Okay, you just *crossed* the *line* there! What’s the matter with you?” Glimmer teleported up beside her and grabbed her arm. “You need to stop!” She-blah glared at her with blazing red eyes. “Or, just, you know, keep beating the dead robot, I don’t really care.” She let her go and stepped back. She-blah turned back to the robot, raising her sword for another blow. “PSYCH!” Glimmer snatched it away and hurled it aside, Entrapta barely dodging with a shriek. She-blah reverted back to Adora and collapsed, unconscious.

“...Did she just hit reverse puberty?” Entrapta asked after a long pause.

-In the Kitchen-

Back at the kitchen, the killer robots continued beating at the door while the staff ran around in a panic.

“The door won't hold much longer,” Bow said. “But I’m ready for them, now that I’ve set up an elaborate series of traps and painstakingly hand-crafted these specialized weapons. Open it!” The plump woman nodded and threw the door open. The robots rushed in, Bow holding his special arrows at the ready. “Ha! Bring it on! You are *no* match for my sophisticated tech-”

“Here you go, everyone!” The young man hurried over with a teapot. “I got bored so I made tea- *oops* !” He bumped into the crowd of robots, spilling his drink all over them. They all jerked and sputtered, shorting out, then promptly exploded.

“...Or we could just, you know, do that,” Bow admitted. “It’s fine, I’m not even mad. Even though it took me, like, a half an hour to set everything up.” He paused. “If anyone asks though could we just say *I* defeated them?”

“Amazing! We did it!” the young girl gasped, eyes sparkling. “We’re stronger than we realize! HYAAAAA! ” She grabbed the plump woman and lifted her over her head.

“...I can work with lean meat,” the other woman said, eyeing her critically.

“Good job everyone!” Bow cheered, clapping his hands. “Now, come with me if you want to live!” They all just stared at him. “That...that's from the second movie- *never mind just follow me* !” He dashed out of the kitchen, the others close behind.

-Back With the Girls Again!-

“Hey, wake up!” Glimmer had Adora propped up on her lap and was trying to shake her awake. “Come on, wake UP, Adora! Are you okay?”

“Here, I got this.” Entrapta pulled out a taser. “Works for me all the time when I start dozing off-”

“Get the fuck away from her!”

“I think she's been infected by the robots,” Entrapta went on, rubbing her chin in thought. “Although her symptoms are rather strange in that they include shrinkage not only of the body but of the *hair* . Look how limp and lifeless it is now.” She stepped back, clutching her pigtails protectively. “Maybe I should stay back in case it’s contagious.”

“ *Infected* ?!” Glimmer cried, aghast. “I knew she should’ve been more careful about sticking her sword into strange things! How did this *happen* ?”

“Well, I've been experimenting with an old First One’s disk recovered from a mine in Dryl,” Entrapta explained. “It seems to

have reacted with the First One's tech that powers my bots and infected them." She paused. "Also I've been illegally downloading pirated music and didn't install virusware-"

"But why would that make *Adora* sick?" Glimmer pointed out. "She's a *human* !"

"Don't know." Entrapta stared at her suspiciously. "...Unless she's *actually* a Terminator. Let's find out!" She whipped out a scalpel.

"Don't you dare touch her with that!" Glimmer shrieked in outrage, holding Adora close.

"Oh, don't worry, it's sterile."

"YOU'LL be sterile once I'm done with you!"

"Since her sword is First One's tech, it must've spread through that." Entrapta pointed at the sword, which was still covered in red vines.

"Okay, so…" Glimmer paused, thinking fast. "If we destroy this disk, will it turn off the bots and stop the virus?"

" *Destroy* it?!" Entrapta cried in dismay. "But the experiment isn't complete!"

"This experiment is an epic *fail* !" Glimmer shot back heatedly.

"No, it's NOT-"

The cleaning bot suddenly shuddered back to life, gargling up oil and screeching in agony.

" *Kill meeee...killllllll meEEEEeeeEE…* "

"...Yeah okay maybe you're right."

"Uggghhh…" Adora suddenly groaned, sitting up groggily. She opened her eyes and squinted at Glimmer. "Glim...mer? There's...

two of you.” She snickered. “Heh heh, that's great, now I have one for each arm-”

“Oh my God, you’re acting like Bow when he was sick and took too much NyQuil,” Glimmer huffed. “Look, just be *quiet* , okay? Sound activates the robots, remember? The evil bots that are trying to kill us?”

“We still watching that movie? The fuck’s my popcorn?” Adora glanced around. “Oh, wait, I found some spaghetti.” She picked up some wires from the dead bot and started chewing on them.

“Do NOT eat that!” Glimmer slapped it out of her hands. “We have to go to Princess Entrapta’s lab and destroy this disk thing to *fix* everything.” Adora stared up at her blankly.

“...And then can we get ice cream?”

“Yeah sure whatever.” She glanced over at Entrapta. “We need to hurry, she's getting worse.”

“I want sprinkles, too.”

“YES OKAY LET’S GO.” Helping Adora to her feet, Glimmer dragged her along as the girls began wandering through the maze of hallways, Entrapta leading the way. They walked silently for a time until...

“Look, Glimmer, I made a friend.” Glimmer turned to find Adora hugging a desiccated skeleton, a couple of rats gnawing on the bones.

“OH MY GOD *SICK* ADORA NO-”

“Aww, it comes with kittens!”

“FUCKING *NO* PUT THEM *DOWN*- ”

“We’re here!” Entrapta said cheerily. They had arrived at a large metal door with a keypad at the entrance.

“Oh my God *finally* .” Adora staggered over to the door and slumped against it, face pressed against the metal. “...I'll take one large vanilla cone with rainbow sprinkles-”

“Lemme just put in the security code to open the door...” Entrapta started typing away with her hair, then jerked back as the pad zapped her. “YEOWCH!! Uh-oh, I think the door might be infected, too. Although it *could* just be faulty wiring. I’ll try the thumbprint scanner instead.” She reached out a hand and pressed her thumb on a nearby pad. “AAAAGHH! *BURNING* !” She snatched her hand away and frantically blew on the singed digit. “Again, *could* just be the wiring. Let’s try the retinal scan!” She leaned forward and a laser zapped her right in the eye. “ *GWAAAAUUUGHH* -”

“Oh my God, forget it! Let me handle this.” Glimmer stepped forward. “I'll just teleport into the lab myself.”

“Wow, you can teleport?” Entrapta gasped, hands still covering her eyes. “How does it work? Tell me everything!” She paused. “Like, literally. Say it aloud. I can’t see shit right now. Might be blind.”

“I’ll tell you later, okay? When we’re not about to die.”

“It's a date!”

“ *Date* ?” Adora looked up, glaring at Glimmer. “Are you *cheating* on me? You *slut*- ”

“OKAY BYE.” Glimmer teleported away. They heard a distant scream from inside the lab, then she teleported back, still mid-scream.

“...So how did it go?” Princess Entrapta asked after a long moment.

“AAAAAA- oh, the robots are ALL better now, they even invited us all to have tea with them,” Glimmer replied airily.

“Really?”

" *No not fucking really* ! I couldn't get anywhere near the disk and the robots almost fucking killed me! We're lucky we're safe out here!"

Just then a huge robot dragged itself out from a nearby hallway, passing them by inches. They all froze.

" *Nobody move* ," Glimmer whispered under her breath. " *It's sound activated, so no one make a noise* -"

"I'm gonna practice my yodeling," Adora stated. " *YOOOODELELLLELELEEEEE- "*

The robot whirled about, roaring in fury.

"Godammit, Adora! Now you're *definitely* not getting ice cream!"

-Meanwhile-

Bow dashed down a hallway with the kitchen staff in tow. A lone robot suddenly leapt out in front of them, blocking their way and opening its mouth to...

Blow *bubbles* at them.

Bow stood there for a long, awkward moment, then slowly pulled out his wallet and carefully placed a dollar bill in the hat at the robot's feet.

"Do you take requests?" he asked. The robot slammed him up against the wall and shrieked in his face. "Look, man, I'm sorry it's just a dollar, the only thing else I have are twenties, and let's be honest, your act needs work. Help me out, guys!"

The young girl screamed bloody murder and ripped the robot's head clean off. The other woman gaped at her in shock.

"...I think I'll eat the guy first."

"I told you, we're not eating *anyone*- " Bow began.

* **BEEP BEEP** *!

"Alright! My app is working again!" Bow pulled out his tablet. "I know where my hot single friends are now- and some other cuties, lemme just save them for later- come on, you guys! We have to save them!" He paused. "...And also rub it in their faces that I was *totally* right- but mostly save them from certain death."

"No, *thank you* ," the young man said stiffly, crossing his arms with a huff. "I'm not risking MY life for YOUR friends. You can count me out."

"...Okay you can eat him," Bow told the plump woman.

"Look, he has a point. They're Princesses," she said. "They have magical powers! Me? I couldn't even make it on Nailed It, let alone MasterChef."

"Sure, we don't have powers like they do," Bow began, turning to face them, "but that doesn't have to stop me, and it doesn't have to stop you! You each have a skill that only *you* can do. You say that you're just ordinary people? *I* say you're warriors of the Rebellion! Come on, gang! *Who's with me* ?!" He raised his fist, waiting expectantly.

"...Yeah it's still a no from us," they answered.

"Alright that does it. I'm channeling my inner Gordon Ramsey." Bow cleared his throat and glared at them, scrunching his forehead until it wrinkled, then adopted a British accent. "The FUCK is this shit?! This is a disaster! Get your arse in gear, you fukkin slobs! MOVE it!!"

"Yes, chef!!" They all cried, then stepped forward and immediately slipped on the soapy floor, tumbling in a heap.

“I’M TAKING AWAY *ALL* YOUR APRONS!!”

-Aaaaaand Back With the Girls AGAIN-

Meanwhile, Adora, Glimmer, and Entrapta were running through the hallways, pursued by a fresh horde of killer robots. Glimmer had Adora slung over her shoulder, giggling away and waving at the bots. Entrapta whipped out her recorder for a quick update on the situation.

“There has been an amazing development!” she said excitedly. “The robots are now working together! They understand cooperation!”

“Do you *really* think this is a good time for that?!” Glimmer yelled at her.

“Oh, it's fine, I'll just edit out the screams later-”

“There isn't going to BE a later! We need to find another way into the lab NOW!!”

“We can use the air ducts,” Entrapta suggested. “This way!” She turned to lead the way only to discover that they were surrounded, robots closing in from all sides. “Quick, teleport us away! And describe the process in detail for my notes!”

“I don't have enough energy to teleport us all!” Glimmer groaned, exhausted. “Not unless I leave someone's *legs* behind-”

“Okay, gotcha!” Entrapta pulled out a hacksaw.

“Oh my God no! That's not what I meant!”

“What if I cut off one, and you cut off one?”

“NO!”

“You want to cut off her legs?” She pointed at Adora, who was slumped over in a daze. “She's unconscious right now, it would be easy.”

“NO!!!!”

The robots closed in around them, ready to tear them apart, when suddenly a cloud of smoke billowed out, engulfing the hallway.

“ *Heeeeere we come to save the daaaa* - bleck! * *Gack* *!” Bow cut off his jubilant singing and doubled over, gagging. “Okay, guys, on second thought, maybe using flour for our dramatic entrance *wasn't* such a good idea.” A robot went to grab him but he was thoroughly coated and easily slipped free. “Nevermind it works. Get ‘em, you miserable slobs!”

“YES, CHEF!!” The kitchen staff rushed in to attack, the plump lady stabbing away with her knife, the young man dropping cups of tea on them, and the girl just ripping them apart with her bare hands.

“Bow! You're okay!” Glimmer ran over to give him a hug, but he squirted right out of her arms. “What the fuck, why are you so slippery- anyway! I was so worried about you! Did you get lost? You should've gone to an adult or used your sonic arrow-”

“Calm down, Glimmer, I'm fine,” Bow said, then noticed the others behind her. “Ohmigosh Princess Entrapta! I'm a HUGE fan of your work- not this one, obviously, these robots are fucking ASS- anyway can you take a selfie with me for my Instagram? It'll make the other fan members SO jelly.” He paused. “...I’m lying it’s just me I’m your only fan.”

“Uhhhh…” Entrapta squirmed uncomfortably, then raised her tape recorder and pressed play.

“ *Princess Entrapta is not here at the moment, please leave a message at the beep* ,” it said, then beeped.

“Oh, well, in that case, here’s my message!” He reached out and gave one of her pigtails a polite peck.

“ *Heyyyy* ! I want a kiss!” Adora threw herself into Bow’s arms, going for a sloppy open-mouth kiss.

“ *Whoa* ! Adora? What’s going on? You're acting like I did when I took too much NyQuil that one time-”

“That's what I said!” Glimmer joined in. “Listen, Entrapta was experimenting with First One’s tech and it had syphilis or whatever and infected all her machines with some kind of weird virus and She-blah’s sword got infected too and now she's like THIS-” She pointed over to Adora, who was busy making out with a robot’s severed head. “-so I teleported into the lab but it's full of evil bots and now I don't know what to dooooo-” She broke down crying a little.

“Hey, don't worry,” Bow said gently, patting her shoulder. “We can figure this out… *together* .”

“GAAAAH ITH GOD MAH TONGUE-”

“Okay maybe just the two of us.”

-A Few Minutes Later-

Adora, Glimmer, and Bow snuck into the lab by following Princess Entrapta through the air ducts and dropping into the large, messy room, then quickly moving to crouch behind a huge pile of skeletons.

“You’re a *monster* ,” Glimmer hissed out, glaring at the other Princess.

“There!” Entrapta whispered, ignoring her. She pointed out the First One’s disc where it sat atop her infected computer, guarded by a dozen murder bots.

“Okay, we are now calling the computer *Skynet* ,” Bow stated. “We have to find a way to turn it off. Now first let's formulate a well thought-out plan, complete with steps and failsafes. I brought binders for everyone with color-coded tabs-”

“Hey, *guyyyyys* , I found the bots!” Adora called, standing in the middle of the room and waving her arms. The killer robots all whipped around, eyes red, and went for her. “Look, they all want hugs!”

“ *Adora* !!” Glimmer popped in and teleported her to safety. Bow and Princess Entrapta used the distraction to go for the disc.

“How do we shut down the computer?” Bow asked. “Do we need to crack the code, get past the firewalls and hack right into the mainframe-”

“We can just unplug the cord,” Entrapta said simply.

“Yeah okay that sounds much easier.” They ran over to a thick bunch of cables plugged into the wall and yanked it out. The computer groaned as it powered down, then booted right back up, the disc glowing red. “Why isn't it turning off?!” Bow cried in panic. “Oh God, it really IS Skynet, it’s become *self aware* -”

“Actually, no,” Entrapta explained. “I have a backup generator in case of outages.”

“Oh okay that makes more sense.” Bow paused. “...So where is this backup-”

“Back in the kitchens.”

“THAT’S IT YOU’VE LOST YOUR ONLY FAN, BITCH.” Bow groaned into his hands, then gasped. “Wait, I have an idea!” He pulled out his trusty sonic arrow and held it aloft. “Don’t fail me now!!” He

paused. “Like, seriously. We’ll all die if you do. So please don’t.” Nocking the arrow, he shot it at the base of the corrupted computer where the robots were gathered. The arrow pinged harmlessly off the computer, then fell at the ground at their feet and did…

Absolutely nothing. The robots all stood around it awkwardly.

And then it promptly exploded.

“...It’s supposed to do that.” Bow said as robot bits flew everywhere.

The First One’s disk crumbled to pieces, the red vines shriveling away from the computer’s shattered remains, as well as Adora’s sword.

“Huh?” Adora blinked awake and sat up. “Where am I? What's happening? Who's cherry-flavored lip chap is this on my mouth-”

“No idea,” Bow said quickly, putting away his tube of chapstick. “...I'll give you an eight out of ten. You must've practiced alot on pillows. You just gotta learn how to work the *tongue*- ”

“Thank you for saving our lives!” Princess Entrapta cheered. “I would be *honored* to join your Rebellion and provide you with high-quality weaponry!” She paused to think. “How do robots sound?”

-Later That Day-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow trudged back to Bright Moon, exhausted from their hectic day.

“Bow, I'm sorry,” Glimmer said. “You were right all along.”

“Aww, Glimmer…” Bow smiled at her warmly. “...Can you say that again, I didn’t hit record.” He held up Princesses Entrapta’s tape recorder.

“ *What* ?! Where did you get that from?!”

“It’s cool, I’m just borrowing it. Like how Adora *borrowed* the Queen’s megaphone. Now, what were you saying? That I was right all along and my sonic arrow was a wonderful idea and I have the cutest butt in all of Etheria?”

“Well, okay, the butt thing IS true-”

“If you hadn't come to rescue us, the bots would have gotten us for sure,” Adora admitted with a sigh. “I didn't know She-blah could get sick like that. Ugh, what if I have another flare up? What if I get someone else infected? I should get tested-”

“I don't think it works like that,” Glimmer said.

“Oh my God, what if I’m *pregnant* !”

“Can I be the Godfather?!” Bow asked excitedly. “Here are my babysitting rates-”

“I REALLY don’t think-”

“No, wait, what if I got someone ELSE pregnant?!”

“Is it me?” Bow gasped. “Am I your baby mama? If it’s a girl can we call it Beyonce?”

“ENOUGH, you guys!” Glimmer cut in. “We destroyed the disk, so we don’t have to worry about it ever again.” Adora shrugged and looked away, still sulking. Glimmer nudged her gently. “Hey, look, that rock over there is staring at us. It’s just *asking* to get smashed.”

“Thanks, Glimmer, but I’m not really in the mood-”

" *Ohmigosh it just whistled at Bow* -"

"That son of a bitch! You will treat him with *respect* !! *For the Honor of Grayskull* !!"

"I dunno, he's kinda cute-" (" *Bow* !") "I mean HOW DARE YOU GET HIM ADORA!"

-Meanwhile-

Back in her ruined lab, Princess Entrapta sat on a pile of scrap metal, talking to herself.

"Log, day 105...someone has stolen my recorder." Her hands were empty. "Anyway, after these recent events, I can say with confidence that I have definitely learned *my* lesson. Don't EVER mess with First One's tech!" She nodded determinately, then sat there for a long moment. "Ooh, look! First One's tech!"

-Episode 6 End-

In the Shadows of Mystabore

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Night had fallen over the Whispering Woods. Adora, Glimmer and Bow had set up camp in a clearing and now lay on the soft grass under a blanket of stars, fast asleep. All was still, the woods quiet and peaceful.

"*Adoraaaaa*..." a creepy voice crooned on the wind.

"Huh? Whozzat?" Adora snorted and sat up, hair sticking out everywhere. "The fuck said that? Was it you?" She turned to glare at a deer standing nearby. It stared back at her for a long, silent moment, then lifted its tail and ripped a high-pitched fart. "...I should *not* have eaten those brownies Perfuma made."

"Yeah, you really shouldn't have," the deer replied.

"Don't judge me!" Adora staggered to her feet, then shuffled off towards some bushes. "Also shouldn't have had that glass of water before bed..."

"You need some leaves or anything?" the deer asked, shoving its head into the bush after her.

"No! Go away!"

"You can try those fuzzy ones over there, they look pretty soft-"

"Seriously, FUCK OFF!"

-The Next Morning -

"*Ahhhh...*" Bow yawned and sat up, stretching languidly in the bright morning sun. "What a wonderful night! Nothing beats sleeping under the staAAAAA SPIDERS ON MY *FAAAAACE*-"

"Ugh, keep it down," Glimmer groaned, pulling her cloak over her head.

"Sorry, I tend to scream where there are SPIDERS ON MY FUCKING FACE. Really *wakes you up*. Works better than coffee."

"STOP." She raised an arm threateningly. "I *will* hit the snooze button. Meaning you."

"*Eesh*, what's got you so grumpy?" Bow frowned, thinking. "Are you on your period again?" He pulled out a calendar and studied it. "Hmm, no, that's not for another week-"

"Will you *stop* tracking my period?"

"How else will I know to keep an emergency stash of pads, tampons and chocolate?! What kind of friend do you think I *am*?" He sniffed in affront.

"Whatever! Just...gimme five more minutes." Glimmer rolled over and went back to sleep. Bow scowled, then leaned over her and scrubbed at his hair. More spiders fell out onto her and she sat up, screaming.

"SPIDERS ON MY- oh, wow, that really does work better than coffee I am *wide awake*- but seriously, what the fuck, Bow?" She glared at him. "Just let me sleep! I was kept up half the night by your *snoring*-"

"How dare you!" Bow gasped. "I do NOT snore." He paused. "I grind my *teeth*. There's a *difference.* Right, Adora?" He turned to find the other girl gone, her patch of grass conspicuously empty. "...Adora?" He glanced around, then spotted her by the trees. Glimmer took his hand and they teleported over. "Hey girl, how you-" Adora immediately whirled around, sword out, screaming her head off.

"*Oh my God what is wrong with* oh no wait that's normal, isn't it?" Glimmer relaxed. "Still getting used to that, sorry."

"What's up?" Bow asked.

"My anxiety levels- I mean...nothing. I dunno. I thought I...*heard* something last night," Adora admitted. "Also there was a talking deer who watched me pee-"

"I knew you shouldn't have eaten those brownies-"

"Don't judge me!"

"Have you not slept...at *all*?" Glimmer asked, leaning in close to inspect the huge bags under Adora's blood-shot eyes.

"...What makes you think that?" Adora replied, one of her eyes twitching, then took a shot of coffee.

"You know you could just put some spiders on your face," Bow began.

"Adora, listen," Glimmer cut in, "I know you're still on edge because of what happened with the murder bots, but it's all over now. We got you checked out by the doctor and you're not pregnant and you didn't catch any STDs. You're *totally* clean! So you need to *relax*."

"Well, Perfuma did give me this," Adora said, holding up a joint. She stared at it for a long moment, then tossed it in her mouth, chewed, and swallowed. "...I don't feel any better."

"Okay, that's it." Glimmer clapped her hands. "We're going on vacation to Mystacor."

"I didn't pack my thong!" Bow cried in disappointment.

"You're *not* allowed to wear that anymore," Glimmer said.

"You're right," Bow said, nodding. "I might incite another *sex-riot*."

“What's Mystacor?” Adora asked, confused.

“It's a secret floating kingdom that's home to all of Etheria's Sorcerers,” Glimmer explained.

“...So it's like Hogwarts.”

“No, it's not!” Glimmer protested. “It's got everything, tranquil gardens, beautiful beaches, and healing springs! My aunt Castaspella is Head Sorceress there, too, so we can get in for free!” She paused. “She'll make you pay in *hugs*, though.”

“...So she's like Dumbledore-”

“She is NOT-”

“Mystacor is also protected by an invisibility spell so evil can't find it,” Bow added knowingly.

“...So how do WE?” Adora said after a moment.

“Well first we get on the train at platform nine and three quarters-”

“*Fucking CALLED it*-”

“ANYWAY! It's the safest, most *peaceful* place in all of Etheria,” Glimmer urged, taking her hand. “We'll have you relaxing in no time!”

“...Will it...hurt?” Adora asked nervously as they lead her away into the woods.

“Only at first,” Bow said, patting her shoulder. “Don't worry. We're gonna get through this *together*.”

Unbeknownst to them, a evil shadow spy slithered out of the bushes and began to follow, slinking close to their feet, completely unnoticed-

**Squish*!*

“Oh God I think I just stepped in shit you guys-”

...Or not.

-Back in the Fright Zone-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Shadow Weaver had plugged herself back into the large crystal in her room to recharge, as well as her phone, tablet and laptop. Catra walked in with a heavy sigh and crossed her arms defiantly.

“You wanted to see me?”

“Couldn't be farther from the truth, but no matter,” Shadow Weaver replied coldly. She went over to her cauldron and passed a hand over it. “My shadow spies have found Adora. She is on her way to Mystacor with her new friends.”

“Ugh, fine!” Catra groaned, rolling her eyes. “I'll go get her. This time, instead of giving me some shrimp-bitch and fucking *Kyle*, just give me some chloroform and a roll of duct-tape-”

“*You're* not going anywhere,” Shadow Weaver cut her off sharply. “*I'm* going to use my magic to capture her myself. You will see that I am not disturbed.” She stared at Catra pointedly. “...So get the fuck out.”

“...Why would you tell me all about your evil plan and then *not* involve me?” Catra asked, incredulous. “Just to rub it in my face- of COURSE you fucking would why am I even asking.” She gave her a middle finger salute and marched towards the exit.

“Use your door,” Shadow Weaver ordered.

“I don't *want* to use my door,” Catra snapped back.

"*Use* it!!"

"...Godammit." Muttering angrily to herself, Catra got down on all fours and crawled out through a small kitty door. "This is so humiliating..."

Once outside, she peeked back in through the cat flap to watch Shadow Weaver bent over the cauldron, performing dark magic. An ominous cloud billowed up in the air as she waved her hands.

"I command you! Be...*delicious*!" She paused, then took a sip from a ladle. "Hmm. Needs more salt."

Nevermind she's just cooking.

-Back With the BFS (Best Friend Squad)-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow had finally arrived at the edge of the Whispering Wood and stood at the top of a sheer cliff overlooking the clouds.

"We're here!" Glimmer cried happily.

"Yaaay!" Adora cheered along with her. "...Where the fuck is here? Seriously. I'm confused. Why did we-" Bow suddenly shoved Glimmer right off the cliff. She plummeted into the clouds below as Adora screamed in horror. "OH MY GOD WHY DID YOU *DO* THAT-"

"Eh, she getting was annoying," Bow said with a shrug. "It's cool, you can be my new best friend."

"Is that what you DO after you're done with them? Is this how friendship works? I did NOT read the fine print-"

“Ugh, oh my God, now *you're* getting annoying,” Bow said, rolling his eyes. “On second thought, I'm good.” He leapt off the cliff as well.

“No wait I have questions-” Adora shouted after him as he disappeared from sight. “*WHYYYYYY?*!!” she wailed, falling to her knees.

Laughter echoed up the cliff as Glimmer and Bow, perfectly unscathed, rose up through the clouds on a small floating island.

“*Ohhhhh*! We SO got you!”

“You should have seen the look on your face!” Bow held up his phone. “And you will, cuz I got it on film. Imma totally post this on Tiktok-”

“That was so fucked up, you guys,” Adora stated. “...You gotta let me do it to our next friend.”

“Come on, hop over!” Glimmer called, waving a hand invitingly.

“Okay, here I come!” Adora ran towards the edge of the cliff and jumped. “*Hyaaa*- huh?” She caught sight of the weird shadow out of the corner of her eye and twisted in midair, landing right on top of Glimmer with a thud.

“*Ouch*, I'd only give that a three out of ten,” Bow said, wincing and holding up a scorecard. “Little shaky on the dismount, and you couldn't stick the landing. What happened there?” He shoved a microphone in her face.

“It's nothing, I thought I saw...I'm just off my game!” Adora sputtered, pushing it away. “Get those cameras out of my face!”

“We're never going to make the finals at this rate-”

“Okay, *coach*, back off-”

“Will you get OFF me?!” Glimmer shouted. The small island flew through the sky, taking them to Mystacor, a much larger island with grand buildings built on top of it. “So listen, my aunt can be a lot, but don't worry. I know how to handle her-”

“Is that my Glim-Glim?!” A woman with black hair and stately cloak and dress came running towards them, her arms open for a hug. “Make way! Auntie Train, coming in with a delivery of hugs! Choo chooooo!”

“Oh my GOD I can't take this you guys save me!” Glimmer cried, pushing the others in front of her.

“Do I...do I kill her?” Adora said, holding up her sword uncertainly.

“I'm just gonna...hold that for you for a bit,” Bow said, confiscating the weapon.

“It's SO good to see you!!” Castaspella lunged past them and pulled Glimmer into a crushing hug. “Hmm...seems like you put on a few more pounds, might wanna cut buck on the sweets-” She stepped away and studied the others. “And who is this?” she asked, noticing Adora.

“This is our new friend, Adora,” Glimmer introduced.

“Hi,” Adora said awkwardly. “I like punching shit.”

“Aww, it's so nice that Glimmer has more friends,” Castaspella cooed. “Especially one that is a bit more...*masculine*.”

“Hey!” Bow cried. “Is this because I shave my legs?” He paused. “And paint my nails?” He paused again. “And pluck my eyebrows-okay I see what you mean.”

“Not that it's a bad thing!” Castaspella went on quickly, then suddenly gasped. “Glimmer! Did you do something to your hair?”

“Yeah, I did,” Glimmer said, puffing up with pride. “I'm glad you noticed-”

“Honey, it looks horrible, you look like a *lesbian*-”

“Oh my God! Bow, *distraction*!!”

“I'm wearing the wool socks you knitted me!” Bow cried, hurriedly yanking off his boots.

“Okay, teacher's PET,” Glimmer snorted. “Laying it on a lil thick, aren't you?”

“Good job, Bow!” Castaspella said, patting his head. “You get a gold star! Two more and you get a free ice-cream!”

“Wait *what*? That's not fair! I want one!”

“And the underwear you knitted me, too!” Bow added.

“...Are you kidding me?” Glimmer stared at him.

“No, my balls are *super* itchy and uncomfortable.” Bow shifted and made a face. “I think I'm getting a rash. But I am GETTING that gold star-”

“Glimmer, why aren't you wearing yours?” her aunt asked. “Don't you *like* it?”

“Uh, well, you see-” Glimmer began.

“Oh right, it would probably give you a yeast infection, nevermind-”

“OKAY I want to LEAVE-”

“So what brings you all the way out here to visit your poor, lonely aunt?” Castaspella went on. She fixed Glimmer with a hard stare. “You...*did* want to come see me, right? And not just use our facilities?”

“Of course!” Glimmer said quickly. “We're on a diplomatic mission. I'm rebuilding the Princess alliance-”

“Sweetie, you're not going to get anyone to join if you don't learn to *e-NUN-ciate*-”

“Can we just take the fucking tour, PLEASE?!”

“Oh, alright, fine. Follow me.” Castaspella lead them along past the elegant stone buildings, where a group of students were standing on the lawn, practicing magic. One of them was a boy with messy hair and a lightning shaped scar- wait what? “You came at the perfect time,” Castaspella said excitedly. “There's an eclipse this evening. I'm headed to inspect the Lunarium for the ceremony. Would you like to come along?”

“There's *really* no need, auntie,” Glimmer protested.

“Hey, that might be nice, Adora hasn't seen it yet,” Bow said at exactly the same time. Glimmer frowned at him and shook her head. Bow raised his eyebrows and pouted. Glimmer started blinking morse-code with her eyes. Bow blinked back rapidly.

“Are you two...alright?” Castaspella asked cautiously. “Perhaps we should leave it up to your friend!”

Glimmer and Bow immediately turned to Adora, blinking rapidly and flashing hand signals. She just stared at them in confusion.

“...Yyyyyyes?” They both threw their hands up.“Sorry, I don't speak *best friend*.”

“You *are* learning, though,” Bow said, touching her shoulder. Adora screamed and went for a karate chop, then stopped, her hand inches from his face.

“Oh, shit, sorry. That was 'affection', right?”

“...I shit myself,” Bow whispered.

After a quick change, Castaspella led them all into a wide, circular room with a hole in the ceiling. Crystal-like spires rose up from the floor and hundreds of diamond-shaped lenses covered the walls.

“This the Lunarium, and these are the Lunar Lenses,” Castaspella explained. “We use them every month to renew our magical defenses and keep us shielded from the outside world.” She paused. “...And also to get free Wi-Fi. Fuck Spectrum. You all *must* come to the ceremony!”

“Uh, I'm not sure we can make it,” Glimmer said uncertainly. “We're pretty busy, our schedule is *totally* booked. See?” She pulled out her daily planner and opened it to reveal a bunch of blank pages. “Oh shit, hold on, gimme a minute-” She pulled out a pen and started scribbling.

“Don't you *want* to spend time with your poor, lonely aunt?” Castaspella asked, hurt in her voice.

“Of course I do!” Glimmer assured her. “But we also *really* wanted to show Adora the beach so she can chill-”

“It's cool, we don't have to-” Adora began.

“*You are seeing that FUCKING beach, Adora-*”

“Okay, okay! Fine.” Adora held up her hands in defeat. “Guess I'm not the only one here who needs to *chill*.” She turned away, inspecting the delicate lenses. She leaned in close, peering at her reflection, and gasped as she saw a dark shadow behind-

“Hey, Adora!” Bow said, standing behind her, waving cheerfully.

“Oh hey Bow.”

“What's up?”

“Nothing, just checking out these- *what the FUCK is that*?!” Adora gasped as another shadow streaked by and whirled around to chase it.

“Sweetie, you're running the wrong way!” Castaspella called after her. “The bathroom is to the left! Poor thing, she must really have to go. Glimmer, how about you? Do you have to go tinkle?”

"*Uuuggghhhh*..." Glimmer groaned, dragging her hands down her face.

Adora ran into a well-lit hallway, searching for the shadow. Around her were many tall statues and murals on the wall.

"This is the Hall of Sorcerers," Castaspella said as she and the others caught up. "These are the great ones who led us through the ages. Gandalf the Grey, Dumbledore-"

"Wait what-" Bow began.

"Hey, there's dad!" Glimmer cried, pointing at a noble statue of a man with a beard.

"Yes. This is Micah, my brother," Castaspella said wistfully. "Glimmer's father. Ohh, you look *just* like him!"

"...He had a beard."

"Exactly."

"*Why do I even COME here*-"

"Hold on...what?" Adora blinked. "Glimmer's dad...was your *brother*?"

"...Do you not know what 'aunt' means?" Bow asked with concern.

"Not really, no," Adora admitted. "I thought it was kind of weird that Glimmer had some sort of *insect* that was related to her."

"*Girl*, I am going to have to get you a dictionary."

"Oh, ew, no. I won't be needing a book about...those things."

"Okay now you're *definitely* getting a dictionary-"

"So tell me, how's your mother?" Castaspella asked. "Still marching about with her nose in the air, and you just stepped in dog poop?"

“Oh my God, finally! Something we agree on.” Glimmer sighed with relief. “Lemme tell you what she did to me last week-”

“Give me those receipts, girl!” Castaspella said, snapping her fingers. “Pour that tea!”

“Aaaand you ruined it.”

Adora noticed a veiled statue disfigured with scratches and spray-paint dicks.

“Hey, uh, what's up with her?”

“That's Light Spinner,” Castaspella said, her face pinching. “A scar on our past. She sought power and complete control above all else...and so, she was cast out.”

“What about him?” Adora pointed at another statue covered in toilet paper.

“He molested a few kids. Now, moving on-”

Castaspella pulled Glimmer and Bow along down the hallway. Adora continued to stare at the defaced statue, entranced. Suddenly its shadow lunged toward her, and she recoiled, gasping in terror.

“Quick, Adora, we gotta ditch my aunt-” Glimmer said, teleporting behind her. Adora shrieked, whirled around and ripped the head off a statue. “...Holy shit. You *seriously* need to chill. Let's get to the beach already so you can relax.”

“You need warm sand and calming waves, *stat*!” Bow reached into his pocket and threw a handful of sand in her face, then dumped a bucket of sea water over her head. Adora stood there for a moment, hair plastered over her face, then spat out a mouthful of salt water. “...Feel better yet?”

“...Why would you have *sand* in your pocket?” Adora finally asked.

As her friends guided her off towards the beach, the evil shadow spy rose from the ground behind them, slithering over to-

**Squish*!*

"Okay, who took a DUMP in the fucking hallway?!"

-Later That Day-

Adora, Glimmer and Bow stood at the beach, which turned out to be a wide expanse of hard, uncomfortable stone in front of a foamy pink cloud-ocean.

"So how does this work, exactly?" Adora asked as the other two lay down on towels. "I just lay down in the sun until the photosynthesis kicks in?"

"What?" Bow said. "No, we just-"

"Knock me out with one clean blow to the head?"

"Why would we-"

"Squeeze me in a choke hold until I pass out?"

"Oh my God, NO-"

"Didn't you do anything like this to relax in the Horde?" Glimmer asked.

"No, we hit things and screamed," Adora replied. "Hit things while screaming. The usual."

"You didn't ever do anything...*different*?"

"We also hit things that screamed. Usually Kyle."

“Well, forget all that,” Glimmer told her. “This is SO much better. Right, Bow?”

“Hey, could you put suntan lotion on my coin slot?” Bow said, rolling over and pushing down his pants to expose his crack. “It burned last time I was here. The skin is, like, *super* delicate, so you'll have to really *rub it in*-”

“*The things I do for friendship*- look, just try it, okay Adora?” Glimmer begged. “Lay still and just...*relax*.”

“Alright, fine,” Adora said, laying down on her towel. “I'll try- NOPE.” She immediately hopped back up. “Can't I just punch rocks or something?”

“Okay, this calls for drastic measures,” Glimmer said seriously, sitting up. “It's time to get *hot* and *sweaty.*”

“...Excuse me *what*-”

“I gotcha.” Bow nodded in understanding. “We need to show her...the *steam grotto*.”

“...I'm still not sure if this is a sexual reference or not-”

-At the Steam Grotto-

Adora stood with Glimmer and Bow in a large, steamy cavern with numerous waterfalls and warm pools to soak in.

“Wow,” Adora said, impressed. “This is actually kind of nice-”

“I know, isn't it?” Bow said cheerfully. “Now take off all your clothes and jump in with us.”

“I take that back this is awful-”

“He's just kidding,” Glimmer chuckled, elbowing Bow in the ribs. “...Take off *half* your clothes and jump in with us.”

“Can't I just get in fully clothed??” Adora said with exasperation.

“Whatever, you want floaties, too? Just GET IN.”

They all piled into a pool, sitting around the edge.

“These pools are filled with magical healing minerals,” Glimmer explained. “Sorcerers use them to cleanse themselves of worry and fear...also when they're hungover.” They glanced over at another pool where a guy with shades was taking a dip.

“Piss off I have class in an hour.”

“...Is that *Snape*?” Bow whispered.

“Anyway,” Glimmer coached, gently lowering Adora into the water, “just relax and breathe...let your body go...perfectly *oh my GOD she's drowning she doesn't know how to SWIM Bow help me quick*-”

Several panicked moments and five full minutes of CPR later, Adora sat perched on the edge of the pool, her feet dangling in the water.

“...It's better than nothing, right?” Glimmer said.

“My toes are getting all pruney,” Adora grumbled, then yelped as she saw the shadow again, pulling out her sword and waving it about. “Look, there!! It's Shadow Weaver! She's here!!”

“Adora what the hell!” Bow cried. “You brought your sword in here? How did you get it back? And where did you *hide* it?!”

“Come sit down,” Glimmer said sternly.

“No, seriously, *where* did you hide it? I swear to God you didn't have it a second ago-”

“Now, tell us what's going on-”

“...Was it in your vagina?”

“BOW, ENOUGH!!”

“I'm telling you guys, Shadow Weaver is here!” Adora argued. “I saw her in the Hall of Sorcerers, and on the island when I jumped-”

“I knew you wouldn't flub a jump like that on purpose!” Bow cried, slapping the water. “We can still buckle down and win this trophy-”

“Okay, slow down,” Glimmer cut in. “Who is Shadow Weaver?”

“She's...kinda like my evil mom,” Adora said quietly. “She raised me in the Horde. She taught me how to read and tie my boots and snap a man's neck in three seconds and all the other important things kids learn.”

“*IIIIII'm* not sure-” Bow began.

“Adora, listen to me,” Glimmer interrupted. “She's NOT here, okay? She was NEVER here. It isn't possible!” She huffed in irritation. “I'm banning you from Perfuma's brownies, they make you too paranoid.”

“It've over now, Adora,” Bow said gently. “You're safe with us. Wanna try something else to relax? I can give you a full-body massage-”

“I will break all of your fingers if you touch me,” Adora told him with deathly calm.

“...Can I throw sand at you again-”

“I'm alright, you guys, really,” Adora assured them. “I just need to be alone for a minute to calm down and settle my raging blood lust.”

“I'm sorry blood WHAT-”

“It's cool, just don't make eye contact or any threatening movements I might interpret as an attack- where are you *going*?” Glimmer and Bow had began slinking towards the entrance. “Wait you can't show weakness either you'll trigger my predator response-” They started to run. “NO WAIT RUNNING IS EVEN WORSE-” Struggling to control herself, Adora slumped over at the pool's edge with a sigh, then perked up as she heard frantic whispering from around the corner.

“Holy shit! Adora's *totally* lost it!” Glimmer hissed. “Did you see her in there? That bitch is nuts! Also her ass is, like, *way* bigger than I thought it was.”

“Oh my God, I know,” Bow agreed. “I can't tell what's louder, her horrible fashion sense, or them *cheeks* clappin-”

“I do SQUATS!” Adora shouted, storming over to the door, only to find it empty. “Wait...what? But...I heard...I'm *not* crazy!

“Can you keep it down?” the man said from the other pool. “I'm drinking a restorative potion over here.”

“That's a Bud Lite,” Adora snapped at him.

“Is not!” He quickly thrust his beer bottle into the pool, then scowled as it dispersed. “Son of a witch!” He paused for a long moment, then bent and took a long slurp of water.

“Aren't you supposed to be sobering up?”

“Go fuck a troll I have POTTER in my class-”

“I don't FUCKING know these references!”

-Later, With Adora-

Unable to shake off her unease, Adora had returned to the Light Spinner statue in the Hall of Sorcerers, staring up at it anxiously.

"Come on, girl, pull it together," she muttered to herself. "There's no way Shadow Weaver could be here. You're seeing things." She froze as her shadow slowly rose from the floor, a glowing red eye glaring at her. "...That's just a trick of the light." The shadow hissed, the sound echoing through the room. "...That's just the wind." It started towards her menacingly. "...That's just a shitty hidden camera show about to Punk me-" The shadow knocked her to the ground. "*OUCH okay nevermind it's real it's definitely real-* for the Honor of Grayskull!!" She transformed into She-blah and readied her sword as disembodied voices babbled from the shadows.

"Heyyy, Adora. Miss me yet? Who am I kidding, of course you do-"

"Catra? What are you doing here?! How did you find me?" She-blah paused. "Do I have treats in my pocket or something-" She heard footsteps running off down the hall. "Hey! Get back here! *Psspsspss*!" She followed them into the Lunarium, then stopped short as another voice spoke.

"How's my number one student doing?" Hordak asked. "Or rather...*former* number one. I had such high hopes for you...but now...it looks like you're *flunking*."

"No!" She-blah cried in dismay. "All that extra credit I did! My GPA!!"

"Speaking of failure," Hordak went on, "do you *really* think you can lead the Rebellion against ME? The only place you can lead them is...*detention*."

"I know what you're up to!" She-blah said. "You're trying to bait me into breaking these lenses! Well, I will *never*-" A spider scuttled across one of them. "OH MY *FUCK* DIE BITCH-" She-blah screamed and flailed about with her sword, destroying dozens of

the mirrors before she stopped, panting. "...Oh shit. That's, like, a million years of bad luck. This can't possibly get ANY worse-"

Castaspella suddenly walked in, stopping short and gaping in horror at the destruction.

"NEVERMIND IT FUCKING *CAN*."

"What? W*haaat*???" Castaspella cried in shock.

"...There was a spider," She-blah said lamely.

"Well did you at least *get* it?!"

"*Uhhhhh*..."

"That's it!" Castaspella sputtered in fury. "Fifty points from Gryffindor!!"

"Gryffin-*who*?"

"What's going on? I heard a Harry Potter reference!" Bow and Glimmer rushed in as Adora changed back to normal.

"Your friend just destroyed a *thousand* years of our writing!" Castaspella said angrily. "She could have destroyed the lenses that protect this place! Or worse, the ones that give us Wi-fi! And she didn't even get the *spider*."

"I'm sure she didn't mean- wait, SPIDER? WHERE?!" Bow yelped and leapt into Adora's arms. "I mean...you have a good explanation for this, right?"

"Of course I do!" Adora huffed. "I was fighting the evil shadow of my abusive mother that's been following me around all day and talking to the voices in my head-"

"Okay stop talking."

"*This* is the kind of person you hang out with?!" Castaspella said incredulously.

“She's a good person!” Glimmer argued.

“I dunno if it's the pot brownies or that joint I ate, you guys, I just-”

“SERIOUSLY STOP.”

“That's it! I'm calling your mother right now!” Castaspella spun on her heel and stormed off.

“...Wait for it,” Glimmer said, standing with arms crossed.

“Glimmer, sweetie, you'll have to help me,” Castaspella said, walking back with her phone in hand. “How do I use this again?”

“Aaaand there it is.”

“Adora, the Horde *isn't* here,” Bow said, still in her arms. “You need to *sleep*. Promise me you'll try?”

“Okay.” Adora gave a heavy sigh. “...But you might have to hold a pillow over my face until I pass out.”

“That's what friends are FOR,” Bow said gently.

-Even Later That Day-

Sometime later, Adora was attempting to rest in an empty room, splayed out on a large bed. On the table beside her was a glass of warm milk and she had her eyes closed, earphones on as she listened to soothing music. The door creaked open and Glimmer walked in.

“Oh thank God you're here!” Adora cried, sitting up. “Is there any way we can get some sheep in here so I can throw them over a fence or whatever-”

"*Save* it, Adora," Glimmer cut her off sharply. "I can't believe you did this. You were supposed to be our *friend*."

"...I *am* your friend," Adora protested. "Look, Bow made me a certificate and everything-" She pulled out a piece of construction paper covered in glitter and stickers.

"Yeah, well, maybe you should have that *revoked.* Or...you should just LEAVE. This friendship isn't working out." Glimmer spun around and stalked to the door, looking back over her shoulder. "Also, I *faked* every hug." She slammed the door shut after her.

Adora gasped, clutching her chest in hurt and fell back on the bed, defeated. Outside in the hallway, Glimmer suddenly morphed back into the evil shadow-spy and scurried away into the-

**Squish*!*

"...I blame Potter," the man from the sauna stated, scraping his shoe on the floor, then took a hit from a small flask and walked on.

-Later-

Meanwhile, the magical ceremony had begun in the Lunarium, Castaspella standing in the middle of the room, chanting spells. Bow and Glimmer stood to the side with the rest of the crowd, waiting.

"Is Adora coming?" Glimmer asked expectantly.

"I didn't wanna bother her. She needs rest," Bow said. "Also, the last time I tried to wake her up she started strangling me-"

"Oh my God, I told you, just poke her with a broomstick-"

Castaspella's hands glowed as she raised the Lunar Lenses to catch a beam of rainbow light from the hole in the ceiling. Suddenly shadows boiled up around her, filling the room and corrupting the lenses.

“The Dementors are attacking!” someone shouted from the back.

“Shut up, Harry!” Castaspella barked. A huge shadow with a single glowing eye rose up, looming over everyone. “Quick, where's the Defense Against the Dark Arts professor?!”

Everyone turned to stare at the man from the sauna.

“I'm the fucking *Potions* teacher!” he snapped irritably. “Also, I'm shit-faced.” He took another sip from his flask, then promptly fell over.

“Should I use my Patronus?” Bow looked at Glimmer.

“Hey, come suck my soul out or whatever!” she shouted impatiently.

“It's *Beyonce*,” he whispered.

“LIKE RIGHT FUCKING NOW PLEASE!”

-With Adora-

Outside, Adora was slowly walking away from Mystacor, head hanging low and feed dragging. Suddenly she heard screams from the large dome behind her and turned to find Bow running up.

“Hey, Adora!” he said, grabbing her hand and pulling her along. “For no apparent reason, let's leave. Like right the fuck now. In fact, let's run!”

“Wait! What's going on?” Adora demanded, pulling free. “Why is everyone screaming?”

“They're...all having a party! Because they're glad you're leaving! Let's ditch these bitches!”

“Wait a second...if people were being *mean* to me, you'd be wearing a cheerleading outfit and waving pompoms while I beat them up! What's going on here?” Adora stared at him suspiciously. “Tell me...does *this* mean anything to you?!” She whipped out her Friendship Certificate and shoved it in his face.

“Eugh, who the fuck made that, a Kindergartener?” he said. Adora gasped.

“Oh God! You're not Bow!” She paused for a moment. “Also, your ass is *all* wrong. Bow's is *much* perkier. I know, he let me squeeze it-”

“Don't be silly, of course I'm Bow!” the imposter protested, holding out a hand. “How about a friendly handshake?”

Adora screamed and slapped his hand away, then spun around and dashed back to the large building, charging inside to the Lunarium. There she found everyone collapsed on the floor, unconscious.

“What the *fuck,* you guys? You threw this *awesome* party and didn't even invite me?” she huffed. “I swear to God if Bow was handing out free lap-dances- *okay he's still wearing clothes we can work through this*.”

“*Adoraaaa...”* Shadow Weaver floated in the middle of the room, surrounding her with shadows.

“You guys even had a Shadow Weaver pinata?! No fair!” Adora pulled out her sword. “I am gonna beat SO much candy outta you-”

“ADORA NO-” Shadow Weaver nervously cleared her throat. “I mean...I'm here to pick you up. I know you had a fun time with your new friends, but now it's time for you to come home. It's...past your *bedtime*.”

“Shadow Weaver!” Adora cried, nearly dropping her sword in shock. “You ARE here! I knew I wasn't crazy! I'm not going anywhere with you!”

“Uh-oh, *someone's* grouchy. Do you need a nap?”

“*Sneeerrrk*- huh, wha?” Adora snapped awake and shook her head. “I'm not sleepy! Stop treating me like a child!”

“Listen to me, sweetie,” Shadow Weaver hissed, slithering closer. “You can't trust these people. When I was here as Light Spinner-” (Adora gasped) “-the Sorting Hat tried to put me in Hufflepuff. Fucking *HUFFLEPUFF*! We all know I belong in *Slytherin*!”

“I...still don't understand these references. But fuck it! For the Honor of Grayskull!” Adora held up her sword, attempting to transform. The gem flashed weakly. “Oh Godammit I forgot to plug it in while I was trying to sleep now it's on low battery-”

“Don't try and fool yourself,” Shadow Weaver went on, pressing in all around her with shadows. “You are the ambitious, *ruthless* cutthroat I raised you to be!” She paused heavily. “Now...do you want to be a good girl and get dessert or not?”

“I will NEVER- what kind of dessert?”

“A healthy bran muffin with plenty of fiber to aid in digestion-”

“Fuck that! I have Chocolate Sundae nights with Glimmer and Bow every Sunday! No deal!”

“The Princesses don't care about you, they just want to USE you!” Shadow Weaver spat. “...Now return with me to the Fright Zone and do everything I say-”

“NO! You're *wrong*!!” Adora pulled out her Friendship Certificate and brandished it proudly. “They ARE my friends and I have the paperwork to prove it!! Y*ou're* the one who used me! I'll stop you!”

“Don't you talk back to me!” Shadow Weaver snapped. “Mystacor is done for anyway. The eclipse will be over in moments and then this place will fall. I'm putting you in timeout until then!” She struck at Adora with her shadows. Adora's sword became a golden shield and repelled the attack.

“Oh, shit!” she cried. “Cool, I have protection now! It's even ribbed for my pleasure- why is Bow chuckling in his sleep? Must be having a funny dream. Anyway!” She leapt and began climbing up the crystal pillars, the shadows following after her.

“Get down from there this instant!” Shadow Weaver hissed furiously.

“No!” Adora ignored her, continuing to climb.

“I *said* get down!!”

“Make me!” Adora reached a platform at the top of the room where she faced off against the huge, looming Shadow Weaver.

“You have until the count of three!” she boomed. “...One! ...Two!”

“*THREE*, BITCH!” Adora shouted, using her shield to reflect the sunlight and blast away the darkness. Shadow Weaver screeched and was thrown back, disappearing in a puff of smoke. Everyone began to wake up as Mystacor's magical defenses returned.

“Adora, what happened?! Are you okay?” Glimmer and Bow rushed over to Adora, hugging her fiercely.

“Hey, guys. I had a big fight with my mom,” Adora said. “Is it cool if I crash at your place for a while?”

“Of course it is!” Glimmer laughed.

“I'm SO sorry we didn't believe you!” Bow said tearfully. “We're...*bad* friends! I'm gonna have to ask for that Friendship Certificate back-”

“Yeah no I'm never giving it back.” Adora clutched it to her chest protectively, then stuffed it into her mouth, chewed, and swallowed. “There. Now it will be with me...*forever*.”

“Aww, Adora,” Bow cooed. “That's so sweet.” He paused. “And creepy.” He paused again. “Mostly creepy.”

“Please tell me you used non-toxic markers,” Glimmer said.

“Is everything alright over here?” Castaspella asked, hurrying up to them.

“I'm sorry, it's my fault Shadow Weaver was here,” Adora said, looking down in shame. “I endangered you all.”

“Oh, nonsense!” Castaspella scoffed. “We get attacked once a week anyway, thanks to a *certain someone*.”

“Hey!” The nerdy kid with glasses and lightning-shaped scar scowled.

“Anyway, you *saved* us,” she went on. “However can I repay you? I know, I'll knit you a sweater! What size are you in the shoulders?”

“Well it differs really- actually I think I'd prefer a lap dance.”

“You got it!” Bow started pulling off his shirt. “Glimmer, glitter me.”

-Later That Day-

The Best Friend Squad had returned to the cloud beach, laying out on towels yet again. Bow and Glimmer smiled at Adora, who lay between them, finally sleeping.

“Aww, look at her,” Bow said with a happy sigh. “So peaceful...” Adora suddenly started screaming and thrashing. “So serene...”

“I think she's waking up, get the pillow,” Glimmer said.

“On it,” Bow said, moving to hold it over her face.

-Back in the Fright Zone-

Back in the Fright Zone, Catra popped her head into Shadow Weaver's lair.

“Hey, is dinner done yet? I'm fucking hungry.” She tutted at the sight of the Sorceress collapsed on the floor. “You have GOT to stop drinking.” She walked closer and gazed into the cauldron. “You've been going about this all wrong, Shadow Weaver,” she said, smirking to herself. “If you want to take down Adora...you have to go for the *heart*.”

The swirling contents of the cauldron settled to form an image of Bow- *OH MY GOD DONT YOU DARE HURT HIM I LOVE HIM STAY AWAY FROM MY BABY*!!!

-End Episode 7-

Chapter End Notes

yeah i'm still alive

Princess Fall

“Uhh, hey, guys?” Adora called aloud, knocking on Glimmer's bedroom door in Bright Moon, a fancy scroll in her other hand. “I got an invitation to some stupid ball thing...just junk mail, right? I’m gonna throw it out-”

“PRINCESS PROMMMM!!!” Bow roared, his head bursting through the door. Adora screamed as he busted the rest of it down like the Koolaid-man.

“Princess prom! Princess prom!” Glimmer joined in, charging out after him. Adora watched in horror as they grew progressively more violent, knocking over furniture and smashing vases, screaming all the while. She cautiously began to back away, careful to use slow, unthreatening movements and avoid eye contact, when they suddenly lunged forward and seized her by the arms.

“*Oh God what's the safe word-*” She flailed for the fire alarm but missed and was dragged into the bedroom to be devoured like a limpy gazelle.

“The All-Princess Ball is a meeting of *all* the Princesses of Etheria,” Bow explained excitedly, sitting her on the bed. “Doesn't that sound fun?”

“That sounds fucking awful,” Adora stated.

“Oh, it is,” Glimmer said. “There's more drama and crying at the ball than a Korean soap opera. But besides that, it’s one giant party! There’s tons of food, music, slutty dresses, and sluttier dancing!”

“Dancing?” Adora blinked. “What's that, again? Some kind of martial art?”

“No, sweetie, *this* is dancing,” Bow said, then did the floss.

“I will straight up defect back to the Horde, I swear to God,” Adora said flatly. “I'm not even joking.”

“Anyway,” Glimmer went on, gushing with excitement, “the ball only happens once a decade. I’ve been waiting *years* for this!” She squealed a little.

“But...I’m only a part-time Princess,” Adora pointed out uncertainly. “I don’t think I qualify for full-time benefits. I need to call-”

“Don't worry, e*very* Princess is invited,” Glimmer assured her. “Even Sleeping Beauty and Snow White, and they're in fucking *comas*. It's all in the rules and conditions!” She took the invitation scroll and unrolled it, the paper spooling around their feet in a long trail. Adora frowned and leaned closer, studying the tiny print.

“Okay, let's see...party rules...” she read aloud. “Approved curtsy techniques... proper stair-descending etiquette...legs must be shaved above the knee- *pfft*! Yeah, like *that'll* happen!” Adora snorted. “These rules are *ridiculous*!”

“Are they, Adora?” Bow said, one leg up on the table and holding a razor. “ARE they?”

“Princess Frosta is hosting this year in the Kingdom of Snows,” Glimmer said. “Her magic is super cool- pun intended! She would be a *great* asset for the Rebellion. Also, *unlimited ice-cream*. So, we have to make extra sure we *don’t* fuck up.”

“But...that’s the only thing I’m good at,” Adora whispered.

“Don’t worry,” Glimmer said, patting her shoulder. “I’ll be right there with you, and so will Bow, who is *obviously* going as my date.”

“Um, actually...” Bow began.

“He’d *never* betray me-”

“Glimmer, I need to tell you...”

“I trust him with my life-”

“Okay you are making this *really* hard for me...”

“I even had matching outfits made and everything-”

“Bitch REALLY-”

“Ooh, and I hired a photographer to take pictures for our album-”

“I'M GOING WITH PERFUMA!!” Bow burst out. Glimmer gaped at him in shock, blinking, her mouth hanging open.

“...Oh,” she said in a small voice. “...Well. That’s...fine.”

“...It is?” he asked uncertainly. “Really? You're...not mad?”

“Of course not,” Glimmer said. “Now, if you'll excuse me...” She lifted up a can of gasoline and a lighter. “I need to get rid of those matching outfits.”

“*Glimmer no*-”

-Meanwhile-

Meanwhile, at the Horde Fortress in the Fright Zone, Catra was pacing about her room furiously, tail lashing.

“Alright, listen up,” she said, her tone serious. “It has come to my attention that I can’t do this alone. I can’t rely on Shadow Weaver or Hordak for this. You’re the only one I can trust. Now...” She paused heavily. “Are you going to help me, or what?”

“I can’t believe I’m in your *bedroom,”* Scorpia whispered, standing next to Catra's four-poster bed and looking around wide-eyed in

awe. “Look, there's your scratching post! This is where you *sleep*. I’m just gonna sniff it real quick, that's totally not weird, right?” She leaned in close and gave it a big whiff, then sneezed explosively and was immediately covered in cat hair. “Oh God it's so itchy I think I'm getting hives-”

“Don’t make me kick you out,” Catra snarled.

“Right, sorry.” Scorpia quickly lint-rolled herself clean. “It's cool, I'm cool, just hanging out with my best bud, doing normal best bud stuff. You want to, uh, talk about boys and paint each other's nails?”

“You don’t even *have* nails.”

“I mean the ones on our feet, silly!” Scorpia slammed her foot up onto the bed and wiggled her toes, pulling out some bottles of nail paint. “I'm thinking hot pink, how about you?”

“I’m thinking I need a new fucking friend,” Catra said.

“No, don’t, please! I’ll do whatever you want!” Scorpia begged. “What were you talking about before that you needed help with? Capturing Adora?”

“*Fuck* no. Opening this can of tuna.” Catra held up the small can, then frowned. “...And...that other thing too, I guess.”

“Ooh, you know where there's some *really* good tuna? At the All-Princess Ball!” Scorpia said excitedly, holding up a scroll. “This year‘s theme is 'winter wonderland' because it's being hosted at the Kingdom of Snows!” She paused. “Is it racist to hope they have sundaes?”

“*What*?! How the hell did you get that invitation?!” Catra cried in disbelief, snatching it away.

“They sent it to me,” Scorpia said simply. “I’m a Princess.”

“You’re a *Princess*?!!” Catra gaped at her.

“Yeah, you know,” she went on. “When Hordak was just starting out with his whole 'evil empire' thing, he needed a place to rent and my parents had an empty basement in our kingdom, so they rented out a room to him and he decided to stay. He was a *great* tenant, was late on his rent only one time. Never made too much noise or trashed anything-”

“You’re. A Princess,” Catra repeated flatly.

“...You didn’t know?”

“Of course not!” Catra sputtered. “You don't *do* any of that normal Princess shit. You never talk to animals- *wait a second*.” She paused, sitting there for a long moment. “...You never...randomly break into song-”

“*Haaaanging out in my best friend's bedroom totally isn’t gaaaay,*” Scorpia suddenly sang. “*...Unless she...waaaants it to be...but if not...that's okaaaay~*”

“...You don't have some stupid curse on you-”

“Definitely not!” Scorpia scoffed, leaning on her bureau. It immediately shattered into wooden splinters and she fell over onto the floor. “Oh dang it not again why does that always happen-”

“...Holy shit you *are* a Princess.” Catra shook her head. “Okay. So. You’re a Princess, and you’re going to some Princess ball-”

“Oh, I'm not going anywhere,” Scorpia said, standing back up and brushing herself off. “The other Princesses didn’t like me even *before* we joined the Horde. I got bullied a lot in high school. I never really...*fit in*.” She paused. “...To the lockers. Believe me, they *tried* shoving me in there, but I just would NOT fit.” She paused again. “Also I have like *nothing* to wear-”

“That’s exactly why you *have* to go!” Catra burst out. “How *dare* those Princesses treat you like that, just because you’re *different*!”

“Hey...yeah, you're right,” Scorpia agreed, nodding emphatically.

“Or...because you...shed hair or, or scratch up the furniture!”

“Yeah!”

“How dare they...*steal* your best friend and turn them into a fucking hot swole-ass Amazon-looking bitch!”

“*YEAHHHH* wait hold on what? Sorry, that might have been too specific for me.” Scorpia sat there for a moment, blinking. “...Are we still talking about me here?”

“Of course we are!” Catra shouted, leaping up onto the bed. “You are *going* to that party, and I’m going with you as your *date*!”

“*YEAAAAHHHH*!!” Scorpia cheered along, waving pom-poms.

“But first...!” Catra paused. “My litter box needs to be cleaned out.”

“...Would you prefer Fresh Step or Tidy Cats?” Scorpia asked, holding up a box of each.

-Back at Bright Moon-

Back at Bright Moon, Bow and Glimmer were walking down a hallway, talking with each other.

“Perfuma asked *me* to the Ball,” Bow was explaining, “and I said yes. I didn’t think it would be a big deal.”

“It *isn’t* a big deal-” Glimmer began.

“Your cape is on fire.”

“Ack!” She hurriedly patted out the flames. “Look, Bow, it’s fine, okay? I’m fine!” She paused. “When did you guys even talk about it, anyway?”

“Oh, yeah, she was *super* slick about it...” Bow began, sighing wistfully.

-Flashback!-

Back at the battle for Plumeria, as the fighting raged through the Horde factory, Princess Perfuma stood alone off to the side, dripping in gore.

“Alright. I can do this,” she told herself. “I just walk right up to She-blah, look aaaall the way up those long, sexy legs of hers, into her gorgeous blue eyes – *not her tits* – and ask her...'do you want to go to the ball with me'?”

“Yeah, sure,” Bow said, standing right behind her. Perfuma whipped around.

“What?! *Bow*?! What're you- no, wait! I was just practicing for when I asked-”

“I’ll pick you up at seven!” Bow called over his shoulder, running off with a wave.

“Son of a *bitch*!!”

-Back to the Present!-

“...Slick?” Glimmer asked dubiously.

“Yeah. Because...you know. She was covered in blood and guts and stuff.” Bow shrugged. “Anyway, she makes really good pot brownies, so I said yes.”

“Oh yeah, she’s fine- *the best friend stealing bitch*- I’m *totally* not mad,” Glimmer said unconvincingly, “but we always go to places together. We have a whole routine! Matching outfits, inside jokes, even a song and dance number we spend hours choreographing. It’s our *thing*!”

“Well, there’s nothing wrong with a *new* thing,” Bow told her gently. “We'll see you guys there. Now, I have to go. I need to do some more man-scaping.” He held up his razor.

“But...didn't you just shave your legs- oh ew okay yeah go ahead.” He winked and skipped off down the hallway, leaving Glimmer alone.

“Glimmer!” Adora suddenly popped out of a nearby doorway. “Good, I found you! I need- are you crying?”

“No!” Glimmer sputtered, scrubbing at her face. “I just...got some glitter in my eyes. What's up?”

“I need your help!” Adora grabbed her arm and yanked her into the room.

“*Oh God what's the safe word-*” Glimmer choked out. Inside, the walls were plastered with a dozens of charts and papers. “...Holy shit are you a serial killer?” she asked in a horrified whisper.

“The only thing *I’m* murdering are these party rules,” Adora said smugly. “I’ve been studying for hours and I am *ready* for this! Go on, quiz me!” She handed her several flashcards and waited expectantly. Glimmer stared at her for a long moment, then read the first card aloud.

“Princess Frosta-”

BZZZZZRT!

Adora slapped a buzzer and shot a hand in the air.

“Ruler of the Kingdom of Snows!” she cried.

“Correct,” Glimmer said, impressed.

“Damn right! Now I get to punch something!”

“What? Why?”

“I work best with positive reinforcement.” Adora turned, slugged a pillow with a drawing of Catra's face on it, then turned back. “If I get one wrong, I have to hit myself in the face with the pillow. Go on, ask me another! I’m ready for *anything*.”

“Okay.” Glimmer paused. “What are you wearing?”

“...ABORT, ABORT!” Adora immediately panicked, going for the fire alarm.

“Whoa, calm down!” Glimmer grabbed her hand. “This isn’t a big deal!”

“Can’t I just go as She-blah?” Adora begged. “Then I won't even have to get my hair done or wear heels-”

“You can’t go as her,” Glimmer explained patiently. “They have a strict no-weapons rule at the Ball. It’s neutral ground.”

“No weapons?!” Adora sputtered. “You mean I can’t bring this?” She pulled out a dagger from her boot. “Or this?!” She unwound a garrot wire from her wrist. “Or any of *these*?” She dumped out several throwing stars from her belt and some poisoned needles from her ponytail.

“...Holy shit, how many do you have ON you?!” Glimmer cried.

“Not *that* many!” Adora said, throwing up her hands. Several more weapons tumbled out her sleeves and clanged to the ground around her. “...It's a security thing.”

“Alright, that’s it!” Glimmer clapped her hands. “It’s *makeover tiiiiiiime*!” “Wait what is going on where is that music coming from-” Adora began before Glimmer seized her and dragged her over to the closet to get changed.

Back in his room, Bow's head suddenly snapped up and he sniffed the air, eyes narrowing.

“Hmm? What's this?” he whispered. “I sense...a *disturbance*. Is someone having a makeover...*without* me?! How dare- *ow FUCK I nicked myself-*”

-Meanwhile...-

At the same time, at the Horde Fortress, Catra was pulling on a dark red suit while Scorpia was stuck in the bathroom, trying out a bunch of dresses. Catra banged on the door impatiently.

“Hurry it UP, Scorpia! I swear to God, if you haven’t decided on a dress yet I’m cutting a hole in a trash bag and you’re wearing *that*-”

The door opened and Scorpia stepped out, wearing a sleek, sexy black dress. Catra gaped at her.

“...Or you could just...wear that.” She gulped. “...I think I just went into heat.”

“What?” Scorpia asked.

“I said move your *feet!* Let’s GO!” Catra snapped at her. “...But walk in front of me for no apparent reason.”

“Well, alright.” Scorpia tottered out of the bathroom on heels, then promptly fell over.

-Back at Bright Moon-

Bow had donned a stylish white tux (with belly exposed, of course) and stood at the bottom of the stairs, awaiting his date, Princess Perfuma, who wore a flowery pink gown.

“Are you ready, babe?” he asked cheerfully.

“I’m ditching you the moment I see She-blah,” she grumbled, pushing past him.

Back in the bedroom, Glimmer and Adora were finally ready, Glimmer wearing a floofy purple dress and Adora a chic red one.

“Well, that wasn’t so bad,” Adora said.

“It would have been a lot easier if you hadn't kept trying to escape through the windows and air ducts,” Glimmer replied. “Now. Time to shave your legs!” She held up a razor. Adora went for the fire alarm again.

-Party Time!-

Adora and Glimmer had finally arrived in the Land of Frost, a large kingdom situated on a snow-covered mountaintop. The frozen palace, made completely out of ice, was covered in icicle spires and had a long, winding road.

“Now listen,” Adora was saying, handing her sword over to the clerk at the front desk, “you have to be careful with it, okay? Don’t you *dare* scratch it, and don’t keep it with the other swords, it might start a fight. It's bedtime is 9 o'clock *sharp,* it can get a

little fussy so you have to be firm with it, maybe read it a book or twot-”

“Okay, calm down, it's just a sword,” the woman scoffed, reaching out to take it from her.

“*Shhh*!” Adora hissed, glaring. “Don’t tell it that! It’s okay, baby, she didn’t mean it-”

“Enough!” Glimmer tossed the sword to the lady, then dragged Adora inside the palace through a pair of doors into the huge ballroom beyond. There, dozens of guests milled about the room while music played in the background, a large throne of ice looming on the other side. “The Ball is one of our most ancient traditions,” she explained as she towed Adora along. “A Princess's first Ball is a huge right of passage. We need to treat this with the *utmost* respect-”

“Where the fuck is the stripper?” Adora interrupted, looking around. “Is there seriously no stripper here? I brought a fuckton of singles. You know what, I’ll just ask Bow, where is he?”

“Can we focus on *Frosta?*” Glimmer cut her off. “The Kingdom of Snows is huge, which is why we need her for the Princess Alliance. If she joins us, all the other Princesses are sure to follow!” She paused. “Also, it'll cut our AC bill in half.” They joined the line of guests leading up to the throne. Glimmer turned to look at Adora seriously. “Remember. *Don’t* fuck up.”

“Right! I've got this,” Adora said with confidence. They reached the front of the line and walked up to the throne, where a little girl in a blue and white fur dress with frozen accents was sitting. “Hiiiii, sweetie. You’re up a little late, don’t you think? Can we talk to your *mom*?”

Everyone gasped.

“Adora...” Glimmer whispered, horrified, “...you fucked up.”

“What? How did I-”

“THAT'S Princess Frosta.”

“Oh.” Adora blinked. “Oh shit. Don't worry, I can save this.” She turned back to the little girl, who glared at her. “Um, hi. I’m Adora, otherwise known as She-blah. If you want I can pick you up and swing you around-”

“Oh my GOD you’re making it WORSE just STOP-”

“Here I’ll give you a piggyback ride-” Adora reached for the little girl, who snapped her fingers, and a pair of guards immediately dragged them away. “What the fuck, Glimmer?!” Adora hissed as they deposited by the punch bowl. “You could’ve mentioned that she was still in *diapers*!”

“She’s, like, *twelve*!” Glimmer shot back.

“That means nothing to me, I don’t understand *children*! God knows I was never one! I'm half-convinced they hatch from eggs-”

“Hey guys!” Princess Entrapta suddenly popped up between them.

“What? *Entrapta*?! What are *you* doing here?” Glimmer asked in shock.

“I’m doing societal research about when different groups are thrown together and forced to mingle under the guise of romance,” Entrapta said, pulling on her goggles and taking out a pad of paper and a pen. “Kiss already!!” she suddenly shouted at a couple. They blushed and hurried away. “Cowards!” Entrapta turned back to the girls. “...So are you two going to kiss or what?”

“Uh, that's a NO,” Adora said.

“Ugh, fine. Prudes. Where’s Bow? He'll make out with someone for me. Why isn't he with you?”

“He’s coming later,” Glimmer sighed. “With...someone else. But that's fine, it’s totally fine, I am NOT mad at-” She broke off in a

gasp as she caught sight of Bow and Perfuma walking into the ballroom, looking great together. "...All," Glimmer whimpered out.

"...How broken would you say your heart is right now on a scale of 1 to 10?" Entrapta whispered, leaning in eagerly. "How close are you to crying?"

"*Get away from me!!*" Glimmer shrieked at her.

"Hey guys," Princess Mermista said, walking up to the group in a teal dress with her hair pinned up, "I'm here."

"Ugh, just *look* at those two!" Glimmer was ranting. "I can't believe they're telling inside jokes right out in public like that! Have they no *shame*-"

"Okay, I'm leaving-"

"Where's your date?" Adora asked, curious.

"Baaabe, I can't get anyone to agree to a three-way with us," Seahawk whined, sashaying over with a drink in hand. He wore a matching sea-themed outfit. He saw the other girls and winked. "Three-way, anyone?"

"I can't believe you came with him," Adora said incredulously.

"Oh, you better *believe* she did," Seahawk snorted into his glass.

"Alright, I walked right into that one."

"It's not like that!" Mermista insisted. "I just...needed him."

"She needed to ride my big, *wet*-"

"BOAT! His BOAT!" Mermista cut him off. "I just needed a ride here, that's all! I left him tied to the rail, I don't know how he got in!"

"I climbed in through the window," Seahawk stage-whispered, "and you should know I have *plenty* of experience being tied up."

He winked again.

“Oh my GOD.” Mermista groaned. “What the fuck is the safe word-”

“You two are so interesting!” Entrapta said, staring at them intensely. “...Now kiss.”

“Whatever will shut him up.” Mermista grabbed Seahawk by the tie and reeled him in.

“Hey, guys!” Bow said, walking up with Perfuma on his arm. “How are you all- why are they making out?”

“Speaking of making out,” Perfuma began, turning to Adora, “WE should totally do that. Like right now.”

“Alright!” Bow spun her around and went for a kiss.

“Ugh! Not *you*, you idiot!”

“Aww, look,” Bow said, pointing. “It's Spinerella and Netossa! Hey, guys!”

“*What*?”

“Why the fuck are they all the way over there- *anyway,* Perfuma and I are gonna go around and compliment everyone’s outfits,” Bow went on, turning to Glimmer. “Want to come with us?”

“What? No!” Glimmer sputtered, waving her hands. “You guys go on ahead, I’m having SO much fun with Adora. Right?” She turned to find Adora standing there, her arms full of food.

“I took this one when nobody was looking,” she said. “Quick, help me hide it all in my dress for later-”

“I can think of a few places-” Perfuma began before she was dragged off by Bow. “*I will murder you*-”

“They're adorable,” Adora said, then noticed Princess Frosta standing by the buffet table. “I’m gonna go try to smooth things over with her,” she said to Glimmer.

“That’s probably not such a good idea- *oof*!” She staggered as Adora dumped the food into her arms.

“Hold this for me, I’ll be right back.” Adora sidled up to the ice Princess and cleared her throat. “Hey, uh, sorry about before, I didn't mean to belittle you for being a child.” She paused. “...Do you need me to reach anything for you or pick you up? Should I find you a little stool-”

“I suppose now you're going to ask me to join your Rebellion,” Princess Frosta cut in snidely.

“Okay, cool, you already know about it. Saves me a lot of time. So we have a *great* dental plan, plus vacation and sick days-”

“I was being *sarcastic*.”

“Well I sure as fuck wasn’t. Here’s all the paperwork.” Adora pulled some folders out from beneath her dress. “You just sign here and here-”

“I am *not* joining the Rebellion!” Frosta barked at her. “The Horde hasn’t bothered us, and you're only interested in our kingdom because you have a *size* kink. Now...are you *done*?” She glared icily up at Adora, who gulped.

“...You ever watch Frozen?” she said weakly.

Princess Frosta spun on her heel and stormed away.

“What?” Adora called after her. “What did I say?”

-Meanwhile-

Glimmer sat on a couch on the upper balcony of the ballroom, spying on Bow and Perfuma below. Adora walked over and flopped down beside her.

"Where have you *been*?!" Glimmer hissed impatiently. "You're supposed to help me make snide remarks about those two! What kind of friend *are* you?"

"Does it really bother you that much?" Adora asked.

"Of course not," Glimmer said, frowning. "Bow can hang out with whoever he wants! It's just that...I've never had a lot of friends. It's always been just me and him...but now... what if they all like her better than me? What if he files a replacement friend form and divorces me for that *whore*-"

"Wait a second friends can DO that- I mean, that's not going to happen, okay?" Adora told her. "Glimmer, trust me, no-one would *ever* like her more than- *oh God don't look she's making everyone signature bouquets it's super sweet and everyone loves it*-"

"That's fine, they'll be dead in a few days anyway," Glimmer sniffed.

"*Now she's giving everyone pot brownies oh my God they're tripping balls*-"

"That's it, I'm calling the cops." Glimmer pulled out her phone.

"Don't be a narc," Adora said. "Anyway, Bow isn't the type to just abandon his friends, and neither am- are those *croissants?"* She bolted up off the couch and hurried down to the buffet table where she started stuffing her face. "How the fuck did I miss these?!" Still chewing, she glanced up to see Catra and Scorpia standing at the top of the stairs and choked, spitting food everywhere. "*PFFFFTTT*- oh no they're *hot*!" She looked down to see Princess Frosta standing there, bits of food splattered all over her face. She gave Adora a chilling glare before marching over to

her throne, where Catra and Scorpia walked up, bowing respectfully. “Hey, wait!” Adora cried. “You can’t let them in here! They’re from the *Horde*!”

“Princess Scorpia was invited as per the rules of this Ball,” Catra said, smugly holding up the invitation.

Adora stood there for a moment.

“...She’s a cat, she’ll shit on the floor and scratch up the curtains, I know from experience-”

“Hey fuck you!”

“*Enough*!” Princess Frosta interrupted. “*All* Princesses and their chosen guests are welcome.” She scowled down at Adora disdainfully. “You look at me and see a child, but I have worked *too* hard to gain respect-”

“My lady, we have the booster seat you requested,” a guard said, hurrying up.

“Not right now!” she snapped at them. “For centuries, the All-Princess Ball has been neutral ground. I will *not* dishonor that legacy, and neither will you.”

“I would NEVER-” Adora began. A small dagger fell out of her dress and clattered to the ground at her feet. She quickly kicked it under a table.

“You *will* behave,” Princess Frosta growled, eyes narrowed dangerously.

“Fine!” Adora shouted, then whipped back to Catra. “But I’m going to be on your ass, watching you for the rest of this Ball. Wherever you go, *I* go.”

“...Even the bathroom?” Catra asked, raising an eyebrow.

"*Especially* the bathroom." Adora glared at her for a beat. "...So are we going or what, I kind of have to pee-"

"Have fun holding it, bitch!" Catra laughed, then scurried off into the crowd.

"Hey, get back here!" Adora cried. "Glimmer, you take Scorpia, I'll follow Catra!" She trailed her through the large room, dodging past inebriated guests and shitty party decorations. Glimmer, meanwhile, kept her eyes on Scorpia, who had discovered the buffet table and was gaping at it in awe.

"Oh my gosh! Look at all this food! I can't wait to eat all-" She touched the table with a claw and it instantly broke, the food scattering all over the floor. "...That will not stop me."

Glimmer caught sight of Bow in the crowd, hesitated, then sidled over to him.

"Hey, Bow, there's something I need to tell you," she said quietly. "I know it's been weird between us all night-"

"Yeah, Perfuma keeps getting these funny death threats in her pockets," Bow said. "She's starting to get a little concerned."

"Oh, is she?" Glimmer hurriedly puts away her Post-it's and markers. "Anyway, forget that. I just wanted to say...I forgive you."

"You *forgive* me?!" Bow scoffed in outrage. "Glimmer, I'm allowed to hang out with other people!"

"...I never agreed to that in our friendship contract," Glimmer said flatly. "I thought I was given sole custody-"

"It's a given! You don't *own* me!"

"WHOA, okay, let's not go there!" Glimmer cried, raising her hands.

“Yeah, alright, let's change the subject,” Bow agreed awkwardly.

“I just...don’t want to end up alone,” Glimmer went on. “It used to be just you and me, but now everything is changing and I don’t want to be left behind!”

“No one is leaving you behind, Glimmer!” Bow assured her. “I wanted to hang out with you *and* Adora *and* Perfuma tonight, but now she’s left me because I’m apparently 'killing her vibe'. I know change is scary, but you don’t get to take it out on me.” He blew out a sigh. “Now, if you’ll excuse me, I need to go powder my mid-riff. It's getting all sweaty.” He turned and walked away.

Glimmer sighed as well, turning back to the buffet table to find Scorpia nowhere in sight.

“*Are you serious she’s like ten feet tall how can I NOT find her-*”

-With Adora-

Adora, meanwhile, was hurrying up the stairs to the upper balcony and gasped when she found Catra sneaking up behind Entrapta, who sat perched on the railing.

“What do you think you’re doing?!” she cried. “Get away from her!”

“Oh, don’t worry, it’s perfectly alright,” Entrapta began.

“It looked like she was about to push you off the ledge!”

“Because she *was* about to push me off the ledge,” Entrapta explained. “It’s a social experiment!”

Adora gaped at her, then looked at Catra, who shrugged.

“Hey, she asked me nicely. I couldn't just say no.”

“What’s the problem, anyway?” Entrapta asked.

“The problem is she’s from the Horde!” Adora explained hotly. Entrapta gave her a blank stare. “...The people the Rebellion are fighting.” Still nothing. “...The Rebellion you’re *a part of*.”

“Oh, right, that,” Entrapta said, then pulled out her pen and paper. “So are you two gonna kiss already?”

“Okay, move aside, I'm pushing her myself-”

-With Bow-

At the moment, Bow was wandering down one of the palace's many hallways, completely lost.

“Okay, where the *hell* is the girl's bathroom, I am NOT using the men’s, it’s disgusting and I have *standards*- hold on who is that?” He stopped as he saw Scorpia ahead of him, standing by a pillar as she placed a small red device on it. He gasped and ran over to a pair of guards in front of the ballroom entrance. “Help, help! This is an emergency! We have to stop her!” He pointed at Scorpia. “She’s redecorating! *Without* permission!”

“She’s not redecorating,” one of the guards said. “Those are heat bombs.”

“Those are WHAT bombs?!”

“Dammit, Kyle!” the other guard hissed. Bow spun around to find Scorpia looming over him, Adora's sword in her claws. The guards seized Bow by the arms.

“Hey!” he cried. “...No, not ME, you guys, HER. You're supposed to grab HER.”

“Holy shit he’s so dumb just knock him out already-”

“Yeah I feel kinda bad now-”

-Back With Adora-

Adora was following Catra across the dance floor, intent on catching her knocking over people's drinks or something, when the music suddenly stopped.

“Everyone!” Princess Frosta announced, holding her hands up. “It is my solemn duty to announce it is time for the first dance of the Ball.” She paused. “If anyone twerks, they *will* be beheaded.”

“Aw, come on!” Seahawk shouted from the back.

Partygoers rushed to the dance floor as mood lighting switched on. Adora blinked and found herself standing opposite Catra, who extended a hand. She reluctantly took it, and the two began dancing.

“I don’t know about you,” Catra smirked, “but I am having SO much fun-” Adora stomped on her foot. “Ow FUCK!”

“Sorry, I never took dancing lessons,” Adora said. “They interfered with my jiu-jitsu. Anyway, whatever you’re planning, it *won’t* work, so just give up.” With that, she spun away, ending up with Glimmer as a dance partner.

“Adora, this is awful,” she babbled, bawling her eyes out. “I got into a big fight with Bow and now he’s not gonna want to be friends with me anymore and I think I'm gonna have to kill Perfuma and I lost Scorpia-”

“*What*?! How could you lose her?! She’s like ten feet tall!” Adora got out before spinning away again, this time ending up with

Perfuma.

“Oh my God, fucking *finally*!” she cried. “Someone get me a chair! I give *way* better lap dances than Bow!”

“I highly doubt that,” Adora said. “Speaking of Bow, where is he?”

“Are you kidding me?! He’s not even *here* and he’s *still* cock-blocking me!” Perfuma snarled. Glimmer wandered up, looking around worriedly.

“Adora, I think Bow is missing, I haven't seen him- oh GREAT now YOU'RE best friends with her too! You skank!” She burst into a fresh wave of tears and ran off.

“No wait she means nothing to me!” Adora cried as she and Perfuma parted ways. She spun yet again, this time returning to Catra, who had vomit on her shirt. “...What happened?”

“Some drunk bitch puked on me,” Catra snapped, “but nevermind that.” She grabbed Adora and dramatically dipped her as the lights lowered. They stared into each other's eyes, gazes smoldering, the air thick with sexual tension-

**Thud*!*

“Ow! What the fuck? You dropped me!”

“Shut up, you’re fucking heavy! I almost threw my back out,” Catra hissed, helping her to her feet. “Oh, by the way, Adora, I brought some *singles*. Can you guess *why*?” She pulled out a bunch of dollar bills and fanned herself with them tauntingly.

“They don’t have cat treats in the vending machine, Catra,” Adora said.

“What? No! That's not what I-” She cleared her throat and tried again. “You like my outfit? My other choice was a *crop-top*.”

“I don't think a crop-top would convey as much angry-lesbian energy.”

“Oh my GOD we kidnapped your stupid friend Bow!” Catra burst out impatiently. Adora gasped in horror.

“What?! How did you get him to go along with you?!” She paused. “Did you say please?”

“I *didn’t*,” Catra smirked.

“You *monster*!!” Adora lunged forward with an angry roar, tackling Catra to the ground. Everyone stopped in their tracks, horrified. “...It...it’s a new dance move! It's called...The Tackle!”

“Cool!” Several of the Princesses immediately began trying it out on their partners.

“And this one’s called *The Strangle*-”

“ENOUGH!” A voice boomed. Pillars of ice grew from the ground, forcing the two apart and trapping Adora in an icy prison as Princess Frosta intervened. “The Princess Ball is a ceremony of unity. Violence is *strictly* forbidden-”

“My lady, we've caught someone wearing a non-regulation pair of heels,” a pair of guards said, holding Seahawk captive.

“Execute him!” she snarled, then turned back to Adora. “I hereby *revoke* your invitation. You are to get the FUCK out of my kingdom and never, EVER-”

Boom! BOOM! BOOOOOM!

Multiple explosions went off throughout the castle as the heat bombs laid by Scorpia detonated. The partygoers screamed in panic, the ice walls and ceiling splintering above them.

“What is this?!” Princess Frosta shouted. “These are *not* the approved fireworks I asked for! Someone is getting executed for

this!” She spun around and ran off.

“Glimmer!” Adora cried, desperately waving a hand through the bars of her cage. “Catra has Bow! You have to save him!”

“Oh, GREAT, now he's friends with HER, too?!” Glimmer wailed. “I can't *believe* him! What a slut!”

“JUST FUCKING SAVE HIM ALREADY!!”

“FINE!” She huffed and teleported away.

“Those two need fucking friendship therapy,” Adora muttered before turning to glare at Catra, who was leaning nonchalantly against her ice prison. “Catra, what have you DONE?!”

“Me?” Catra cocked her head, feigning innocence. “Nothing. Scorpia, Lonnie and Kyle, however, were *very* busy. It was fun distracting you, though! But now...it's time to go.” She twitched in place, frowned, then twitched again. “Or...you know...I could just... hang out for a little longer.”

“...You’re stuck, aren’t you?” Adora asked after a moment.

“Of course I’m not *stuck*, that'd be fucking *dumb*. I’m just...leaning on here. That’s perfectly normal.” She paused. “Someone get me some warm water!”

“Oh my God you are stuck you fucking idiot-”

“Get back here, twerker!” a guard shouted in the crowd.

“You'll never catch these heels, bitch!” Sea Hawk shot back over his shoulder, dashing away from the guards in his stilettos. “I will not be oppressed!” He ran straight into the ice prison, shattering it to bits and breaking both Adora and Catra free. He gaped at them in shock. “Oh, that *totally* deserves a three-way!”

“Not if you get executed!” Catra snarled, shoving him back towards the guards, then taking off down the hallway.

“Hey! Get back here!” Adora shouted, chasing after her.

-Outside-

Glimmer teleported outside, the palace crumbling about her, and caught sight of Lonnie and Kyle dragging Bow away towards a scorpion-shaped vehicle. She let out a bloodcurdling scream and leapt at them in a murderous rage.

“I’m shoving this glitter bomb down your *throat*!!” she shrieked, punching them both in the gut. As they fell back, she crouched beside Bow, cradling him gently in her arms. “Oh my God, Bow! Are you okay?! Don’t worry, I’ll give you mouth-to-mouth! I'm sure I'm *much* better at it than Perfuma-” She gasped suddenly and slumped over.

“Oh gosh, I am so sorry!” Scorpia said, popping up beside her. “I was backing up and didn’t see you there and accidentally poked you with my tail! Are you okay, sweetie?” Glimmer didn't move. “You may be experiencing some paralysis.” Glitter twitched weakly. “Oh, and muscle spasms, that too! And did I mention loss of bladder control?” Glimmer let out a muffled scream.

-Back Inside-

Princess Frosta rushed across the ballroom floor as the palace melted around her, shoving panicked party guests out of her way, desperately reaching out for-

The AC unit control switch.

She turned down the temp and immediately the castle stabilized, the shaking stopping and falling chunks of ice returning to the walls and ceiling.

“God, everyone, *chill*,” she snorted. Everyone just stared at her. “LAUGH AT MY PUN OR BE EXECUTED.” Everyone immediately began laughing.

“I'll get you, Catra!” Adora was still chasing Catra through the twisting hallways. She slapped on some skates to try and catch up and was instantly body-checked by a hockey player. “Okay that was a fucking FOUL-” she growled, spitting out her mouth guard and decking the guy.

Laughing mockingly, Catra hopped onto a floating chunk of ice and rode it upwards, escaping with ease.

“Hey! That's not fair!” Adora tried another ice chunk and waited. “...Why isn't it- what?! Out of *order*?! I gotta take the ice stairs are you fucking kidding me-”

Catra emerged onto the rooftop as the ice chunk sealed itself back into place. Adora joined her a moment later, puffing her way up the ice stairs, and the two faced off. Their battle was brutal, and rather short, when Catra suddenly slipped, teetering on the edge.

“Catra!” Adora flung out a hand, grabbing Catra...

By the tail.

“*MREOWWWW*!” Catra screeched in pain.

“What the fuck, man!” Adora shouted at the random janitor who'd been mopping the roof. He stuck the mop into his bucket of soapy water and shrugged. “At least put down a wet-floor sign! We're gonna sue your ass!” Suddenly the whole palace shook and they tumbled off together, screaming. Adora, ever prepared, yanked out a climber's ice pick and slammed it into the side of the palace, halting their fall. She dangled there, still holding Catra by her tail.

“Don't worry!” Adora said. “I've got you, Catra! Just gimme like five minutes to put on my harness and ropes and hammer in a couple pins-”

“Oh my God, just fucking *kill* me!” Catra thrashed free and plummeted into the clouds below.

“Catraaaaaa!” Adora wailed in anguish. She watched, horrified, as the scorpion-shaped vehicle rose from the clouds to hover at eye level. Inside, she saw Catra, Scorpia, Lonnie, and Kyle gathered around an unconscious Glimmer and Bow. Scorpia was painting their nails while Kyle applied lipstick. “You *monsters*! Those colors don't even *match*!”

“Slumber party at the Horde Fortress!” Catra crowed. “*You're* not invited.” She waved as they zoomed away.

“*Noooooo*!!” Adora hung there, all alone. “...Who's gonna give me a ride home now?”

-End Episode 8-

Nope Princess Left Behind

Deep within the Horde Fortress, in Shadow Weaver's sinister lair, Catra chuckled to herself as she admired She-blah's stolen sword, twirling it in her hand.

"I'm gonna use this bitch to shave my legs," she stated smugly.

"Do NOT use my tub," Shadow Weaver growled, floating behind her in the glow of the Black Garnet crystal.

"Yeah, you're right, it's way too sharp, I'll nick myself." Catra paused. "I'm gonna use it to shave *Kyle's* legs. So, Shadow Weaver…" She smirked over at her. "How does it feel to work so hard and then have someone *else* barge in and steal all the credit?"

The computer panel mounted on the wall in front of them suddenly flickered on, Hordak appearing on the screen.

"Shadow Weaver," he said, "great job capturing the Princess of Bright Moon all by yourself. Independently. Without any help from anyone else. You get a pizza party." He blew a noisemaker and threw some confetti in the air. The screen snapped off. Catra gaped in disbelief.

"Like that, I believe," Shadow Weaver said acidly.

"What the *fuck* !" Catra sputtered in outrage. "That's not fair! *I'm* the one who caught her, not you!"

"You work for me," Shadow Weaver snarked. "Anything you do, *I* take the credit for."

"Oh yeah well if that's how it works then I overflowed all the toilets in the girl's locker room." Catra crossed her arms and glared. "See how you like *that* !"

The screen snapped on again.

"...The fuck shit in all the toilets?" Hordak asked in a dangerous tone. Shadow Weaver wordlessly pointed at Catra. "Clean up this mess or you will be *expelled* ." He threw some more confetti and released several balloons before it turned off again.

"...Why does he keep doing that-"

"I get credit for all the *good* things you do," Shadow Weaver clarified. " *You* get the blame for all the bad ones."

"...I've made a horrible mistake," Catra whispered to herself. She held up the sword. "...I'm gonna use this as a *plunger* ."

Glimmer, meanwhile, was being held captive nearby, the crackling red energy of the Black Garnet keeping her trapped in a barrier.

"Huh...wha?" She groaned and lifted her head, looking around groggily. "Where...am I? That must've been some party-"

"Welcome to the Fright Zone, Princess," Shadow Weaver hissed, slithering up. "You've been placed in detention until your mother comes to pick you up." Glimmer stared at her in horror.

"...So do I get a phone call or anything...?"

-Back at Bright Moon-

"You're WHERE?! The *FRIGHT ZONE* ?!" Queen Angella shouted into the phone, standing at the table in Bright Moon's meeting room. "Why couldn't you have been taken to *jail* ?! At least then I could have just bailed you out! Now I have to go in for a parent-teacher *conference* ! You are in SO much trouble, young lady!" She slammed the phone down on the receiver with a huff.

"Please, calm down, Queen Angella," Adora said, standing next to her. "I know how you feel, how painful it is to lose a loved one. *I*

lost someone too-”

“Bow?” Queen Angella asked gently.

“My swo- BOW.” Adora stood there wide-eyed. “I meant Bow. My best friend. And totally not my awesome sword that turns me into a kick-ass ten-foot warrior with amazing hair and super comfy shorts ANYWAY we can’t just give in to their demands! There HAS to be another way!” She stood up determinedly. “I *will* rescue Glimmer and Bow! I know the Fright Zone, inside and out! I’ll find a way to get them back!”

“And...which way is the Fright Zone?” Queen Angella asked after a moment. Adora stared at her blankly.

“...Th...that way?” She pointed off to the left.

“No.”

“...That way?” She pointed to the right.

“No!”

“Whatever! I’ll find it eventually!” Adora exploded. “I’ll bring them home, I promise!” She marched out of the room, slammed the door, then popped her head back in after a few moments. “...It’s that way right?” She pointed downwards.

Groaning, the Queen slumped over in her chair, defeated.

Adora stormed off down the hallway, muttering angrily to herself. She turned a corner and gasped as flower petals began floating around her. She looked up to see Mermista, Perfuma, and Entrapta waiting at the end of the hallway, standing in place and smiling expectantly. She smiled back at her friends, touched by their-

* *Flush* !*

Seahawk walked out of the nearby restroom, shaking water off his hands. He saw Adora and stopped.

"Oh of COURSE she comes out the second I had to go tinkle!" He hurried over to join the others and took his place. The music continued to swell dramatically as-

" *Gah-CHOOO* !" Entrapta inhaled a flower petal and sneezed, showering the others with snot.

"Godammit, can we do ONE thing without fucking up?!" Mermista shouted. "Seriously, you guys are- (**ba-ding!*)* -oh hold on I just got a text-"

"What are you guys doing here?" Adora asked them.

" *Obviously* we're concerned about our dear friends, Glitter and Ho," Seahawk began.

"Glimmer and Bow," Perfuma corrected.

"I was close-"

"We're the Princess Alliance," Mermista cut in, looking up from her phone. "Let's go get our bitches back."

"You're gonna make me cry," Adora whimpered, wiping her eyes. "Come on, bring it in. Group hug- who just grabbed my ass?"

"Sorry," Perfuma said, blushing.

" *I'm* not," Seahawk added with a wink.

-With Bow-

Meanwhile, deep inside the Horde fortress, Kyle was walking along the prisoner block, a large room with dozens of cells lining the walls like a honeycomb. He approached one of the cells with a tray of food.

"Here are your dinner rations, prisoner," Kyle said, pushing the tray through a slot in the energy barrier. Bow, who sat inside, picked it up and frowned.

"...Did you eat from this?" he asked uncertainly.

"Only a little," Kyle admitted. "Lonnie stole my breakfast, and then Catra stole my lunch, even though it was and she hates- WAIT. You're... *talking* to me?" He stared at Bow in shock. "No-one... *ever* talks to me. They just yell and swear at me. Usually both at the same time- I mean…" He cleared his throat and started over. "Hi, I'm Kyle, and I'm starved for affection!"

"Well, Kyle, you're in for a treat," Bow said with a wink, "because that's *all* I serve."

Kyle whimpered softly and started to cry.

"So now that we're best friends and all how about you tell me where they're keeping the Princess?" Bow rushed on.

"I can't tell you that!" Kyle gasped. "It's classified! Not even for a *hug* !"

Bow stood there for a moment, then opened his arms invitingly. Kyle went bright red.

" *I'm not ready for this kind of commitment* !" he squealed, scurrying back to the elevator and riding it down. "...Call me!"

"I should have gone with a lap dance," Bow muttered to himself.

-Back at Bright Moon-

The Princess Squad (Seahawk included) was holding an emergency meeting in Glimmer's bedroom. They sat in a circle on the floor, deep in conversation.

"Alright," Adora said, taking charge, "listen up, everyone. Here's the plan-"

"OMG, *#SquadGoals* -"

"Mermista put your fucking phone away!" Adora snapped at her, glaring.

"I will turn you into a meme," Mermista shot back dangerously.

"You really need to take a break from all the devices that are cluttering up your life and just cherish the world as it is-"

"Perfuma put your fucking pot away." Adora snapped at her, too. One of Entrapta's pigtails slithered up and snatched the phone out of Mermista's hands.

"Aaaaaand hacked- *oh my God so many nudes and dick pics this is amazing* -"

"Entrapta put the fucking tech away!!"

"Are we...playing some kind of game?" Seahawk asked, confused. "Here, I'll start. Never have I ever downed a dozen jello shots off of Mermista's ass in the middle of a club." He paused. "I have to take a drink, because I have."

"ENOUGH!!" Adora shouted. "Everyone sit the FUCK down while I tell you the plan!!" Everyone quickly sat down. Adora slapped down a boot in front of her. "Alright, this is the Horde prison. Glimmer and Bow are being held inside-"

"The Horde prison looks like a ugly boot?" Seahawk scoffed. "That is *inhumane* !"

“Fine, then give her one of yours,” Mermista said.

“Over my dead body!” Seahawk crossed his arms defiantly.

“Happy to oblige!” Entrapta said, pulling out her taser.

“Quit it, you guys!” Adora began placing objects around the boot. “Entrapta, you’re the cell phone. Perfuma, you're the joint. Mermista, you’re the fish-stick-”

“I find that offensive.”

“You’re the one *eating* them!” Adora rolled her eyes. “Seahawk, you're the tampon.”

“Oh, come on!” He threw his hands up.

“It's that or the Preparation H.”

“...Tampon it is!”

“Actually, I need to change mine, I’m just gonna take that,” Mermista said, reaching out.

“Hey, no! We need it-”

“Don’t worry.” Seahawk pulled out his wallet. “I can be this condom - *extra LARGE* -”

“Everyone, FOCUS!” Adora shouted again. They shut up. “Now. Our entry point will be here, next to the scrap yard. Perfuma and Entrapta will access the security tower and wait for my signal to disable the lights. Mermista will access the Fright Zone’s sewer system, swimming through the pipes into the building, and-”

“Why do *I* have to swim through the sewer?” Mermista protested. “Because I happen to breathe underwater? *More* racism.”

“I’ll pay for your next phone upgrade.”

“...Get me a blue one.”

"Seahawk and I will take up positions by the entrance and take out any guards on patrol," Adora went on. "Perfuma and Entrapta will regroup on our position and we'll enter when Mermista opens the door. Everyone got that?" She looked up expectantly.

Seahawk was standing in front of Glimmer's closet, trying on a pair of her shoes.

"Ugh, she should be locked up for *wearing* these things-"

"Hey, hope she doesn't mind, I'm eating, like, all of her snacks," Perfuma said, holding an armful of stolen munchies and stuffing some chips in her mouth. "I got hungry." Behind her, Mermista was grappling with Entrapta over her phone.

"Just one tweet, I just wanna do *one* tweet-"

"Hold on, I'm not done my research on sexting-"

"...We are so fucked," Adora whispered.

-The Plan Begins!-

Mermista slogged waist-deep through the putrid sewers of the Horde Fortress, grumbling to herself. There was a faint flushing and several gallons of nasty piss water dumped on her head.

"This can't *possibly* get any worse," she groaned.

A head suddenly popped out of the pipe above her, sputtering and gasping for air. They blinked down at her.

"...Hi, my name's Kyle. Wanna be my friend?"

"...You deserve that swirlie," Mermista said with utmost conviction, then kept going.

Up above, Adora and Seahawk slunk to the front entrance of the Horde Fortress compound, a large green building with a multitude of twisting pipes.

“Okay, Mermista should be in position,” Adora whispered. “I need to signal- wait where’s my mirror? Who took...” She turned, glared, and snatched a little compact mirror away from Seahawk.

“I was fixing my guy-liner you *bitch* ! I need to be on fleek!” He lunged and the two fought over it, the mirror flashing off the lights. Over in a watch tower, Perfuma gasped.

“Look, there’s the signal! Turn off the lights!”

“Got it!” Entrapta pulled out a fork and started toward a nearby outlet.

“Oh my God what is *wrong* with you?! Just cut the wires!”

“Got it!” Entrapta yanked a bundle of wires out of the console and started chewing on them.

“ *Seriously* ?!” Perfuma gaped at her. “Just use your tools! Are you trying a new social experiment on how annoying you can be?!” Entrapta gave her a blank stare, then slowly lifted up a pen and pad of paper.

“...Would you be annoyed if I said yes-”

“I am *trying* to get into She-blah shorts!” Perfuma hissed furiously. “Do NOT fuck this up for me!” Summoning some thorns, she ripped through the wires and the lights snapped off. Below, the guards in front of the entrance looked around in confusion.

“Okay, we go on three,” Adora whispered to Seahawk. “Ready? One-”

“I can’t count!” Seahawk sang, eagerly leaping forward.

“Of course you fucking can’t why am I not surprised-”

"ADVENTUUUUURE *oh my God they're so much stronger than I thought help help help* -"

Adora rolled her eyes before throwing herself into the fray, easily beating the guards to a pulp. She dusted her hands off and scowled at Seahawk.

"Look, I'm sorry," he said. "I know I was a bit *premature* on my ejaculation but I just got really worked up. I promise to take it slow and steady next time and make sure you're fully *satisfied* with my performance-"

"STOP TALKING." Adora gave him a death glare. "Anyway, let's secure these guards."

"I'm on it!" Seahawk said, pulling out some rope. "I have plenty of experience tying people up-"

"Seriously stop fucking talking or I will MAKE you stop."

"Entrapta?" Perfuma called, climbing down the watch tower and glancing around. "Ugh, I turn my back for *one* second and she's gone. Where did she go?" She turned a corner and found her sitting next to a little roomba-like robot.

"Look what I found!!" Entrapta squealed with delight. "A lil' baby! He's so cute! Can I keep him, please please please? I'll reprogram him every day and clean his processor and change his oil-"

"No! You're not ready for that responsibility!" Perfuma cried. "You can't even wipe your own ass!"

"Yes I can-"

"I can *smell* it on you!!"

"...Okay but I'm getting better at it, my underwear isn't *nearly* as dirty as before-"

“ENOUGH! Let’s go!” Perfuma grabbed Entrapta with some vines and dragged her off towards the front of the building.

Adora and Seahawk had finished tying the guards up and shoved them into a corner.

“I think I have some spare ball gags on me, just a sec,” Seahawk said, rifling around in his pockets. Some sex dice and a pair of handcuffs fell out.

“I really need to ask Mermista what the safe word is,” Adora muttered to herself, then looked up to see Scorpia zooming over on a little hover-jet thing. She gasped and hid behind a nearby pile of junk. “Seahawk, *duck* !” she hissed.

“ *Where* ?!” He pulled out a bag of breadcrumbs, looking around excitedly.

“ *Oh my fucking God you deserve it nevermind* -”

“Halt!” Scorpia cried, stopping the vehicle. “Who are you?” Seahawk stared at her for a long moment, then threw some bread crumbs at her. “Hey, thanks, I was getting a little hungry. But seriously, who are you?”

“I am the, uhh...inspector,” Seahawk said, thinking fast. “I’m here to... *inspect* things?”

“Inspector?” Scorpia asked suspiciously, studying him for a long moment. “... *Ohh* ! You’re the *health* inspector! Of course!” Seahawk sighed with relief. “Great timing! I’ve got this weird rash on my taint that will *not*- ”

“Whoa, wait, there's been a misunderstanding!” he sputtered. “I’m, uh, actually the *stripper*- ”

“Perfect! It’s Rogelio’s birthday! Let’s go!” Scorpia grabbed him by the arm with one huge claw and dragged him off.

"...What the fuck just happened?" Adora asked herself. "We had a *plan* . I made a *Powerpoint Presentation* . Everyone had color-coded *FOLDERS* ." She came out of hiding as Perfuma trotted up, Entrapta in tow. "Where the fuck *were* you guys?!"

"Hey, you try keeping her on task!" Perfuma shot back. "She's like a hyperactive two-year-old! Poopy pants included!"

"I said I was getting better at it-"

"NO YOU'RE NOT!" Perfuma threw some flowers at her to counteract the stink.

"This isn't a game!" Adora shouted at them. "Glimmer, Bow, and most importantly, my *sword* are being held captive in there and we're already a man down! Seahawk's gone- wait hold on this is actually a good thing. Okay, forget that last part-"

"Alright, everyone," Perfuma said, clapping her hands. "Let's all just calm down and do some breathing exercises. Here, let me give you a sensual shoulder massage-" A siren started wailing through the compound. " *Goddamnit even the alarm is cock-blocking me* -"

The door behind them opened to reveal Mermista standing there, soaking wet and smelling worse than Entrapta.

"No-one says a word," she ground out dangerously, "and I won't kill you."

"...I think you have a turd in your hair," Entrapta said after a tense pause.

Mermista screamed and lunged for her.

After breaking up the fight, the group entered the building and began sneaking along the corridors, sticking to the shadows and dodging patrols of Horde guards.

"Okay, guys," Adora whispered to the others, "first we need to-"

“Entrapta’s gone,” Mermista said suddenly.

“Oh my God, did you seriously fucking kill her?” Adora asked in shock.

“Unfortunately, no. She wandered off.”

“How could you just LOSE her?!”

“You lost Seahawk. Bite me.”

“Godammit, Entrapta, where did you- wait hold on this is also a good thing-”

-Meanwhile…-

Entrapta was aimlessly wandering the compound, sticking her head where it didn’t belong, like the garbage shoot and the boy’s bathroom.

“Edit to log,” she said into her tape-recorder, “it appears that male Horde soldiers also have penises like regular people.”

“Hey!”

“Rather *small* ones, though.”

“ *Hey* !! Get outta here!”

“You’re right, there’s not much to see.” Losing interest, she turned to leave and caught sight of the little roomba robot from before, scooting along the floor.

“ *Baby* !!” She chased it around a corner and came face-to-face with an enormous round robot, which loomed over her menacingly. “...And you must be *mama bear* ,” she said with a nervous chuckle. “Well, it’s a good thing I already shit myself.”

-With Glimmer-

Glimmer, meanwhile, was still being held captive by the dark energy field of the Black Garnet.

"Heyyy, uh, can I have like a book or something?" she called out. "Getting kinda bored here. Also hungry. I think I see some chips over there. It's cool, I'll help myself." She attempted to teleport over to the snack table, but cried out in pain as she suddenly glitched, turning red and dematerializing for an instant.

"I should warn you, Princess," Shadow Weaver said, slithering up, "any attempt to teleport out of these restraints will only cause you pain. My Black Garnet and your powers… don't *mix* ."

"Oh please," Glimmer snorted. "I've had worse menstrual cramps. This is *nothing* compared to the time mom grounded me for-"

"Speaking of your mother," Shadow Weaver cut in, "she will be here soon."

"Oh God, is this part of the torture? Please, not that! She's going to be SO mad at me-"

"She's not coming here to punish you. She is coming here for... *a parent-teacher conference* ."

"...What the fuck, that's even worse! Just fucking kill me!" She glared at Shadow Weaver defiantly. "You won't get away with this! She-blah is gonna kick your ass!" Shadow Weaver wordlessly held up She-blah's sword. "... *Adora* is gonna kick your ass!"

" *Adora* will be powerless. With She-blah gone, there will be no one left to stop us," Shadow Weaver gloated. "In a few hours Etheria will be *ours* to rule, the great and powerful Horde-"

“Hey, I need this again,” Catra said, popping up beside her and taking the sword. “I tried to give Kyle a swirlie and he got sucked halfway down the pipe.”

“...You’re going to plunge him out with that?” Glimmer asked incredulously.

“Fuck no, I’m putting him out of his misery.”

-Meanwhile-

Back outside, Scorpia stood with Seahawk, who had stripped down to his underwear and was now wearing high-heels and covered in glittery sweat. He panted, fanning himself with some singles from his thong.

“I never thought I’d say this, but I don’t think I can give another lap dance,” he groaned. “My thighs are *killing* me. Can I go now?”

“You know...you look familiar,” Scorpia said, frowning at him.

“Perhaps you’ve seen me...on *Tinder* ,” he crooned, winking seductively.

“Oh, no, I’m a raging lesbian,” she said distractedly. “Wait, I remember!” She snapped a claw. “Princess Prom! I saw you there with Princess Mermista!”

“I...don’t know what you’re talking about,” Seahawk began.

“Yeah, you two were making out in the fondue pot.”

“I would *never* do such a thing-”

“We got it on film and everything! Look, here it is on YouTube.” Scorpia held up her phone to a video titled: “Two Sluts Make Out in Fondue Pot”.

“I have *got* to work on my technique,” Seahawk muttered, then realized he was in danger and began nervously backing away. “I mean, uhhh, I plead the fifth…” He bumped into a computer console, which suddenly lit up, displaying the word *DICK* . Seahawk stared at it in confusion for a long moment, then slowly pulled his underwear down and stood there.

“Yeah, that’s *definitely* not gonna work on me,” Scorpia scoffed. “Raging lesbian, remember?”

The words onscreen changed to **DUCK STUPID AUTOCORRECT* .

“Oh, fine!” Seahawk threw his hands up. “Be a tease!”

A quacking duck suddenly shot through the air like it was launched from a cannon, hitting Scorpia in the head and knocking her into the nearby wall. Seahawk blinked.

“That is not what I thought was going to happen - ”

“Heyyy!” Entrapta called, riding the giant robot down the wall like a valiant steed. “Are you al- why is your dick out?” She pulled out her tape recorder. “Edit to log: Seahawk’s penis is... *slightly below average* .”

“God, *no-one* here appreciates my dick!” Seahawk looked down. “It’s okay, lil’ guy, I appreciate you. And so does Mermista, when she’s horny.”

-Inside the Fortress-

Deep within the fortress, Adora was busily checking the computers in a cramped room.

“Okay,” she said, typing away, “I found Bow’s cell, but I can’t find Glimmer anywhere-”

“Wait a second,” Mermista interrupted. “You found him? Just like that? What is this place, some kind of evil hotel?”

“Of course! We’re professionals, it’s our job to ensure your stay is as horrific as possible.” Adora pointed at the screen. “See, he booked a single room cell, non-crying with a malfunctioning toilet and moldy walls-”

“Oh my God, forget it,” Mermista turned to leave when the door to the room slid open, revealing a huge round robot. “Holy shit fucking kill it!”

“Hey, guys!” Entrapta said, popping up from the robot’s back and waving. “Look what I found!”

“...Holy shit fucking kill it!”

“And me!” Seahawk joined in, popping up next to the robot.

“...Okay seriously fucking kill it-”

“This is my new friend Emily,” Entrapta explained, patting the robot. “I reprogrammed her. She is now *completely* harmless-” The robot suddenly lunged forward and gobbled up Seahawk in one bite. “...She still has some bugs to work out.”

“ *I’m okay* !” Seahawk called from inside, his voice echoing.

“No, it’s cool, just stay in there,” Mermista said.

“Alright!” Adora shouted, clapping her hands. “We’re all together again! Princess Squad, move OUT!!”

-Princess Squad, GO!-

Moving fast, the group of friends busted their way into the command center for the prison cells, an angular room in the

middle of the hive of cells. Once the guards were politely asked to leave (just kidding Mermista fucking murdered them), they stopped in front of the console.

“Can you get us to his cell?” Adora asked.

“Of course! Leave it to me!” Entrapta said confidently, hitting a button. There was an agonized scream as someone in a cell was suddenly electrocuted. “...Don’t worry, I’ve got this!” She hit another button. There was another scream as a prisoner’s room suddenly filled with flames.

“Maybe you should-” Adora began.

“No! I can do this!” Entrapta shouted, randomly slapping at some buttons. A bridge extended from the control room up to the wall of cells. “Ha! And you guys *doubted* me!”

“Okay, let’s hurry and go before she kills him,” Adora said quickly. “Seahawk, Perfuma, you come with me. Mermista, you stay and babysit her.”

“Fine,” Mermista said with an eye-roll, “but I’m *charging* . Here are my going rates.”

Bow, meanwhile, was trying to get out of his cell the only way he knew how.

By making *friends* with it.

“Come on, now,” he gently coaxed. “You can trust me, I promise. Just...open up to me. Please?” The barrier didn’t budge. “ *Pretty* please?” Still nothing. “...You are the most *lovely* shade of green.” The barrier turned a soft pink as it blushed at the compliment.

“Bow!!” Kyle suddenly ran up, panting for breath. “I found out where your friend is being kept! Shadow Weaver has her in the Black Garnet chamber!”

“What?!” Bow gasped. “Why are you telling me this?”

"I don't know," Kyle said. "It probably has to do with my desperate need for a friend to fill the empty void inside my heart. Also, you're the first person to ever truly *listen* to-"

"Yeah yeah, sure," Bow cut in hurriedly, "we're best friends, whatever. Now get me out of here!"

"Let's hurry this up," Adora said as she began to cross the bridge, Seahawk and Perfuma in tow. "The last thing I wanna do is run into my old friends, it'd be *super* awkward-" The bridge rose up and stopped at the next floor where Lonnie, the lizard guy Rogelio (who was still wearing a birthday hat) and a couple of Horde guards stood, gaping at her. "...Hey guys how's it going. What's new?" Lonnie snarled and whipped out a stun rod with crackling green energy. " *That* definitely is. No fair! Why did you guys get cool shit after I leave?" Lonnie and the others jumped onto the platform, blocking their path. "Hey, out of the way! I need to save my friends!"

"We *were* your friends!" Lonnie shot back.

"...No you weren't. You were a total bitch to me. You stole my lunch money and made fun of my hair."

"In my defense, your hair is pretty stupid."

"You bitch!" Adora lunged for her.

Rogelio dashed by and burst into the control room, roaring menacingly. He took a step forward, got one sniff of Mermista, and backed away, gagging, then bumped into Entrapta, reeled in shock, and passed out.

"Oh my GOD! I get it, I fucking smell!" Mermista shouted, throwing her arms up. "I'll take a shower after this!"

" *I* won't," Entrapta said proudly.

"I'm so unappreciated around here," Kyle was saying to Bow. "Everyone just picks on me. No one thinks I can do anything

right-”

“Look man, I’m not your therapist-” Bow began, then caught sight of Adora and the others battling on the elevator. “...So when do you think these feelings *started* ?” He sat down on a couch and whipped out a pen and paper.

“Probably around the time I said, ‘Hi, my name is Kyle, I’m new in the Horde’-”

“Uh huh,” Bow said, watching the battle over his shoulder.

“-and that’s why my only source of stress relief is writing Catradora fanfiction-”

“Okay.”

“-so I was thinking...maybe...we can be friends?” Kyle placed a hand on the barrier, smiling at Bow.

“Sure thing.” Bow smiled back and placed his hand on his. “Friends *forever* .” The elevator finally stopped in front of his cell and Seahawk hopped off.

“Who is this scrawny loser? Get lost, nerd!” He shoved him into a nearby locker and slammed it shut. “Bow! We’re here to rescue you!”

“And steal my *job* ?!” Bow hissed, glaring at him. “ *I’m* the stripper of this party, *you’re* the slutty himbo. Stay in your lane!”

“You’re welcome!” Seahawk punched the keypad by the door. It immediately lit up red.

“ *Self-destruct initiated* ,” it said calmly.

“Whoopsie daisie!” Seahawk punched it again.

“ *Toxic gas being released* -”

“Third time’s the charm!” Seahawk punched it one last time. The green barrier fizzled out, releasing Bow.

“ *See* ?!” Entrapta shouted from the control room. “It’s not just me!”

“Bow! You’re okay!” Adora cried, running up. “Where’s Glimmer?”

“Adora!” Bow gave her a warm hug. “Shadow Weaver has her in the Black Garnet chamber!”

“The penthouse suite?!” She gasped aloud. “Hurry, you guys! Those fees add up fast! Let’s go!” They all ran off as the alarm began to wail, red lights flashing. The group dashed through hallways with guards hot on their heels. Turning a corner, Adora stopped at a door. “Okay, this vent system leads to where you can steal a skiff. Each chamber needs to be sealed and purged before you can move on, and the doors will only stay open for a few seconds, so you have to hurry-”

“That sounds like the dumbest fucking system, why would they do it like that-”

“You would know if you’d been here for taco night,” Adora said, a haunted look in her eyes. “Now go!” She shoved them forward through the door. Bow hesitated.

“Adora, what are you doing?” he asked suspiciously.

“I’m gonna buy you some time and find Glimmer,” Adora said, staying back. “I’ll meet you there.”

“No!” He ran toward her, desperately reaching out.

“Just go!” Adora punched the panel beside the door.

“ *Invalid entry* ,” it chimed. “ *Please try again* .” Adora frowned and punched it again. “ *Invalid entry* ,” it repeated. “ *Please try again* .”

“Oh, Godammit, FINE,” Adora grumbled, squinting at the keypad. “What was the password again? 22...96? Or was it...67...34?” She entered a code and the door blatted at her.

“ *Incorrect code. Please try again* .”

“Son of a-! Hey, do you guys know what the password is?” She turned to the armed guards standing behind her.

“I’m pretty sure it was 1173,” one guard answered.

“No, dumbass, it’s 1174,” another corrected.

“See?! It’s not just us!” Entrapta and Seahawk shouted.

“Okay, let’s try 1174,” Adora said, turning back to the keypad. “Gimme a second here.”

“Uh-huh, sure,” Bow said, waiting patiently as she typed it in. Immediately the door hissed shut and Bow wailed in anguish. “Adora *NOOOO* !”

“Christ, finally. That was SO awkward.” Adora turned back to the Horde guards and slowly raised her hands. “I surrender. Take me to Shadow Weaver.”

“Alright, put your hands on top of your stupid hairdo and let’s-” Adora punched him in the throat, cutting him off.

“...Okay now I surrender.”

-A Few Moments Later-

The Horde guards led Adora to the Black Garnet chamber, her hands tied behind her back.

“Glimmer!” she cried, seeing her friend being held captive. “I’m here! Don’t worry!” The guards began to strap her to a table with restraints. “Everything is going to be okay!” The guards pulled out some chains and started wrapping them around her arms and legs. “I swear I’ll save you!” The guards started attaching padlocks. “OKAY SERIOUSLY YOU GUYS-”

“Hey Adora,” Glimmer said. “Crazy party, huh? Personally, I’ve been to crazier. One time I woke up handcuffed to a bed, naked and covered in whipped cream.” She paused. “Turns out it was just Bow. I got sick on whipped cream and puked all over my clothes so he was washing them and handcuffed me to the bed so I wouldn't fall off-”

“Adora, sweetie! You’re finally home!” The table tilted upright as Shadow Weaver slithered forward. “You,” she snapped coldly at Catra, “pack your things and get out. You’re fired.”

“Who, what? ME?” Catra asked in disbelief.

“Of course you.” Shadow Weaver snorted in disdain. “Now that my baby is back, there’s no need for you.”

“ *Ugh* !” Catra threw her hands up in disgust. “After *everything* I’ve done for you?!” She stomped over to her desk and started flinging her coffee mug and photos into a box. “All the overtime I pulled?! I can’t *believe* this!” She finished packing her things, then promptly sat in the box, sulking. The guards awkwardly dragged her out the door.

“Okay, here’s the deal,” Adora said to Shadow Weaver. “I *will* stay here and be your perfect little Horde Captain, but you *have* to let Glimmer go first.”

“Oh, you’ll stay, *willingly* ,” Shadow Weaver hissed, “because I’m going to wipe your mind. You won’t remember being She-blah or a part of the Rebellion or-”

“ *Oh thank God I’ll forget I ever met Seahawk* - I mean no my precious friends!” Adora paused. “...Is there any way to *selectively*

wipe my mind?”

“Don’t worry, it’s perfectly safe and won’t cause any permanent damage.” Shadow Weaver's hands began to glow with red energy as she cupped Adora’s face. “Although, to be safe, what size diaper do you take?”

“Probably like a medium- *wait hold on what* -” Adora broke off in a scream of agony while Glimmer watched helplessly.

“Adora, NO!” she wailed. “Hang on, I’m coming!” She closed her eyes and attempted to teleport again, struggling mightily while glitching in and out of sight. With a cry of effort, she broke free from the Dark Garnet and teleported over to the snack table, ate some chips, drank a soda, then picked up the coffee pot and smashed it over Shadow Weaver’s head, knocking her to the ground. “The power of *friendship* , bitch!” Glimmer rushed to Adora, hurriedly undoing her restraints. “Adora! Are you okay? Do you remember me?” Adora’s eyes snapped open and she seized Glimmer by the throat.

“Die, Princess scum!!”

“ *Nooooo* !”

“Just kidding, of course I remember you,” Adora laughed, then paused darkly. “I also remember you ate the burrito I left in the fridge. Do it again and I’ll kill you.” Glimmer gave a weak laugh of relief. “I’m totally serious.” She choked.

-Meanwhile-

Bow and the girls (Seahawk included) had finally reached the end of the vent system and halted at the entrance to take a breather.

“Phew, we made it!” Seahawk said, panting heavily. “Ugh, these heels are going in the trash, I am getting SO many blisters.” He looked around and pointed. “Alright, this way to the vehicle bay. Let’s steal a ride!”

“You know how to hotwire a skiff?” Perfuma asked, impressed.

“Fuck no, I’ll bang the guard and steal his keys-”

“ExCUSE me?” Mermista glared at him. “Maybe *I* wanna bang the guard. That’s your problem. You never think about ME-”

“Babe, it’s pretty obvious who he’s gonna want to bang more. You’re covered in toilet juice.”

“Oh please. You’d still do me.”

“ *Damn right I would* -” Seahawk started for her.

“Oh my God,” Bow cut them off before shit started getting nasty, “ *I’ll* bang the guard, let’s just GO!”

Still arguing, they all dashed forward, except for Entrapta, who stayed back in the vent with her robot, which had frozen in place.

“What’s wrong, Emily?” She leaned close and peered at its screen. “What is- a system update?! NOW?! Are you kidding me?”

“Huh, that’s funny,” Bow said. “I’m not that annoyed anymore. I wonder why- WAIT A SEC WHERE’S ENTRAPTA?!”

Everyone turned back and watched in horror as the vent slammed shut in front of Entrapta, trapping her inside. There was a furious blast of green fire that incinerated everything in the vent, followed by a volley of machine gun fire and a pack of wild dogs, which was really a bit excessive. They all stood there in shocked silence.

“...Oh thank God,” Mermista said. Everyone looked at her. “Oh, what, like I was the only one thinking it? Let’s fucking go already.”

-Inside the Fortress-

Alarms began to wail as Adora and Glimmer ran for the front exit, which rudely slammed shut in front of them.

"Don't worry, I got this! *Hnnnnngh* !" Glimmer closed her eyes and grunted with effort.

"...What're you doing?" Adora asked. "Trying to fart?"

"I'm trying to *teleport* !" Glimmer huffed in frustration. "Though I did fart a little. Dammit, what's wrong with me?" They both jumped at a high-pitched squeal behind them and jerked around to see Catra slowly approaching the pair, menacingly scraping She-blah's sword along the wall. She stopped in front of them and they faced off, the tension thick as she raised the sword and-

"Oh my God, did you draw a dick?"

"No I- I mean, okay, yes, but that's not the- *Godammit* !" Catra thrust the sword out to Adora. "Here, take it."

"...No." Adora narrowed her eyes suspiciously. "I don't trust you. This is a trap."

"I'm *giving* it to you," Catra ground out.

"I don't believe you! It's probably been tampered with or- why does it smell like *poop* ?"

"Because I used it to unclog the toilets and shave Kyle's legs and-"

"Okay enough give it here." Adora snatched her sword back and held it protectively to her chest. "Don't worry, baby, I'm here. I'll get you cleaned up and sharpened as soon as I can-" She looked

up to find Catra gone. She'd left a dead mouse at her feet, though. "Fucking SICK- come on, Glimmer. It's time to go." She turned, raised the sword, and-

Punched the door down.

"...What did you even need the sword for then?" Glimmer asked after a moment.

"It just makes me look *cooler* ," Adora snapped. "Now let's go!" She grabbed Glimmer's hand and dragged her off.

-Outside-

Outside the Horde fortress, the others zoomed through the rocky wasteland on a small skiff, desperately searching the dunes.

"There they are!" Bow cried, spotting Adora and Glimmer in the distance. The skiff zoomed right towards the pair…

And kept right on going.

"Hey! What the hell!"

"Sorry, I'm still getting the hang of this thing!" Seahawk yelled back, yanking at the wheel. Finally he managed to turn it around and…

Immediately stalled.

"Godammit I popped the clutch!"

"Someone else fucking drive!" Mermista snapped.

"I'm still buzzed from the party," Bow stated.

“I am *not* contributing to global carbon emissions,” Perfuma said with a huff.

“Well I’m not driving,” Mermista sniffed, crossing her arms. “If the cops catch me again, I’m getting five to ten. Whatever, just drive.”

Adora and Glimmer caught up and scrambled onto the skiff, laughing and hugging their friends with relief.

“You guys are okay!!” Bow cried jubilantly, throwing his arms around the pair in a fierce hug. The joy faded away as Adora noticed that something was... *missing* .

“...Wait a second,” she said, looking around. “What’s going on? I’m...not annoyed.”

“You sure about that?” Mermista said, glaring at Seahawk, who accidentally turned on the windshield wipers and sprayed her in the face.

“Not the first time that’s happened-”

“IT’S ABOUT TO BE THE LAST.”

“Baby I’m sorry I can’t control it-”

“No, no,” Adora went on, shaking her head. “Something’s wrong here…something...” She suddenly gasped. “Oh my God! *Entrapta* ! Where is she?!”

“She...didn’t make it,” Bow said sadly, looking down. “She’s...gone.”

Adora gaped at him in disbelief.

“...Then what the fuck are we doing just standing here for the love of God fucking DRIVE-”

“Aww, I knew you’d want to go back and save-”

“ -*AWAY* WHILE WE STILL CAN-”

“Told you,” Mermista said.

"I'm revoking *all* your Friendship Certificates," Bow grumbled to himself.

-Episode 9 End-

The Bacon

The Princess Squad slowly drove through the Whispering Woods on their stolen skiff, parked, and then sat there in silence for a long moment.

"…Soooo are we going back for Entrapta, orrrr...?" Bow asked after a beat. Adora stared at him, then wordlessly yanked the keys out of the ignition and threw them into the woods. "...I'm just going to go get them-" She ripped the steering wheel off and threw that, too. "...Okay that was a little excessive."

"That's not excessive, *this* is!" Seahawk said cheerfully, taking out his gascan and matches.

Smokey the Bear leaned out from behind some bushes, looming over him with a murderous glare.

"Bitch, you THOUGHT," it growled dangerously. Seahawk broke into a cold sweat and slowly put his things away. Smokey nodded once and withdrew back into the foliage.

"...I must be high as fuck," Perfuma said after a moment, holding a joint, "I coulda *sworn* I just saw Smokey the Bear."

"God, this night has been a total shitshow," Mermista grumbled to herself.

" *What* ?!" Glimmer gasped. "You can't say that!"

"Admit it," Mermista said firmly, "this whole operation sucked dick."

"She would know!" Seahawk spoke up. Mermista gave him a withering glare. "I'm sorry, babe, I'm just trying to help-"

"No, I mean you *legally* can't say that," Glimmer explained. "It's against the rules. I wrote them up for the Alliance and you signed the contract when you joined. See?" She held up a thick bundle of

papers and flipped through them, pointing at a specific paragraph. “You just lost your cell phone privileges for a week.” Mermista snatched the papers from her and tossed them to Seahawk. “Hey! Give those-” They were already on fire. “What the fuck! That's against the rules, too!” Glimmer stomped her foot in outrage. “You just earned yourself another week. I will see you in Princess Court-”

“Whatever, I’m done with this bullshit.” Mermista rolled her eyes and sat down with a huff. “Seahawk, take me home.”

“Uhh...she threw away the keys,” he said, pointing at Adora. “...And ripped the steering wheel out.” He paused. “...Which is why I have a weird boner right now-”

“Ugh, *fine* .” She tossed her hair. “Call us a fucking Uber then.”

“I hope they’re okay with singles,” Seahawk sighed, pulling some bills out of his thong. “Damp, sweaty singles. Covered in glitter.” He frowned. “And a *little* bit of lube.”

“I was gonna ask if we could stop for ice-cream,” Perfuma said, “but you know what? I’m good.”

“You’re definitely showering once we get back,” Mermista growled at him.

“ *Oooh, baby,* ” Seahawk cooed seductively and cocked an eyebrow.

“Imma squirt you with the hose. Shut the fuck up.” She glared at him. “I could not be less horny right now.”

A parking attendant suddenly popped out of a nearby bush and slapped a ticket onto the skiff’s windshield.

“...You know what, on second thought...I could be.”

-Later-

After the other Princesses had returned to their respective kingdoms (and blocked them on Twitter and Instagram), Glimmer, Adora and Bow reluctantly returned to Bright Moon, walking across the long bridge at the entrance towards the impressive fortress.

"Now, listen," Glimmer was saying, "do NOT tell my mom about my glitching, okay?"

"Of course not. I would *never* disrespect you like that," Bow replied, then pulled out a can of Lysol and started crop-dusting the air around her.

"Bitch, it's not *contagious* -"

"Knock it off!" Adora shushed them. "We're here." They stopped in front of the Bright Moon fortress to collect themselves.

"Phew," Glimmer sighed in relief. "It sure feels good to be back-"

"My baby, you're home! I was so worried!" Queen Angella burst through the front doors and scooped her daughter up in a rib-cracking hug. "You are in SO much trouble, young lady! You are grounded for the next ten years! I'm having a slop bucket and a slot for food installed in your room-"

"Oh my God I'm going back to the Horde," Glimmer groaned, trying to squirm away. "It was better there, I had more freedom-"

"Nonsense! Come here!" Her mother began dragging her inside. "We need to get you fitted for a set of chains and handcuffs."

Glimmer screamed and started kicking.

-Inside the Fortress-

"Okay, mom," Glimmer said firmly, "this is going way too far."

"Don't be silly, sweetie," Queen Angella replied. "Now make sure you fold the toilet paper in neat squares and be careful not to get pee-pee on your hands-"

"MOM!! LET ME PEE IN PEACE!!" Glimmer banged on the door of her toilet stall, her mother hovering right outside. "This is ridiculous!"

"Can someone pass the toilet paper?" Bow asked from the other stall. "I'm all out."

"Yeah, sure, just a- wait, BOW?! Why're *you* in here?"

"There was a guy taking a shit in the boy's bathroom. He was grunting and everything."

"Yeah, that was me," Adora said, washing her hands at the sink. "Couldn't make it to the girls', sorry."

"ARGH!! I can't pee like this! Forget it, I'm outta here!" Glimmer stormed out of the stall and started for the door.

"Oh, no, you are NOT!" Queen Angella thundered dangerously. Glimmer froze in place. "You think I wouldn't *notice* ?" She gulped. "You go and wash your hands this *instant* , young lady."

"...Oh." Glimmer blew out a long breath. "Okay. Sure." She walked over to the sink and turned on the water.

"Hmm, that's strange," Queen Angella said, her eyes narrowing with suspicion. "Usually you'd be lazy and teleport and then miss and go into the men's showers or something and accidentally see a penis. What's wrong, sweetie?"

“Uhh, nothing!” Glimmer stammered, hurriedly drying off her hands. “I... *don’t* feel like seeing a dick?”

“Alright, there is DEFINITELY something wrong-”

“MOM-”

“I know what it is,” Angella went on, crossing her arms sternly. “You can’t hide it from me.” Glimmer paled. “You think I can’t tell when something is wrong with you daughter?” She broke into a sweat and started twitching. “I heard about Entrapta. Now listen, I know the terrible pain of loss-”

Glimmer burst into relieved laughter.

“Oh, thank God, I thought you meant-” She caught the look on her mother’s face and cleared her throat, quickly changing subjects. “Err...God, mom, stop grilling us! Give us some time to get our story straight- I mean grieve or whatever!” She shoved her mother out of the bathroom and turned to the others. “Okay guys, we’re gonna have to milk this for as long as we-” She cried out in pain as she suddenly started glitching.

“Oh no, it’s happening again!” Adora gasped.

“That looks painful! Are you okay?” Bow asked with concern.

“Oww...” Glimmer groaned as the spell passed. “Yeah, I’m feeling- are those rubber gloves?! And where did you get a *mask* ?!” She gaped at him in disbelief.

“Listen, Glimmer,” Adora broke in. “Shadow Weaver did something to your powers. You can’t teleport and you keep glitching. You need *help* ! Maybe we should tell your mom-”

“NO! I don’t want her freaking out anymore than she already is, okay?” Glimmer shook her head. “I’m telling you, I’m fineeaaaAAAUUGH!!” She doubled over, glitching again.

“What’s going ON in there?” Queen Angella demanded through the door.

“It’s...Adora!” Bow said quickly. “She’s pooping again!” Adora glared at him and he gave her a helpless shrug.

“Well for goodness sake, at least *light* something!”

“Okay, this works,” Glimmer began. “We can just wait her out in here-”

“Ooh, actually, I think I might have a round two,” Adora said, making a face and starting for one of the stalls.

“What have I done?” Bow whispered in horror as Glimmer scrambled to put some quarters into the tampon machine and then shove them up her nose.

-In the Fright Zone-

Hordak paced furiously in front of his throne, Shadow Weaver cringing at his feet. The other Horde generals stood nearby, watching with bated breath.

“Do you know why I’ve gathered you all here today?” Hordak ground out, addressing the crowd.

“...It’s Shadow Weaver’s birthday?” someone spoke up from the back.

“Oh my God, Scorpia, shut the fuck up,” Catra hissed, elbowing her. “You’re *ruining* this!”

“No, that’s not for another month,” Hordak closed his planner before continuing. “Shadow Weaver, not only did you lose the transfer student, Princess Glimmer, who was under your direct

supervision, but you also hid the fact that your own student Adora had transferred to the Princess Academy and was She-blah all along. Do you know what this MEANS?"

A tense silence filled the room.

"...No birthday party for her?"

"SCORPIA. WILL YOU- *the fuck did you get the hat and balloons* -"

"And that's not even the worst part..." Hordak went on ominously. "You... *didn't even fill out the correct forms* ." A collective gasp came from the crowd. "That, above all, is *unforgivable* !"

"What are you talking about?" Shadow Weaver cried, straightening in outrage. "Of *course* I did, I would never neglect the proper paperwork! I gave them all to Catra to give to-" She stopped mid-sentence, frozen in horror, then slowly turned her head to gape at Catra, who grinned and flipped her off. "...God...dammit."

"...But she still gets a birthday party, right?" Scorpia asked after a long moment. "I mean, we're an evil horde, but we're not *monsters* -"

" *Pfft* !" Catra snorted. "I think that's the least of her- *bitch is that CAKE* -"

-Back in Bright Moon-

Back at Bright Moon, Glimmer lay on a reclined chair, bathing in the radiance of the large gem floating in front of the fortress.

"...Stop watching me," she said after a moment.

“How can you tell?” Bow asked.

Glimmer opened her eyes to find him hovering literally an inch from her face.

“...I can *smell* your chapstick.” She narrowed her eyes at him. “Seriously, there is a limit-”

“Feeling better yet?” he cut her off. “Are you hungry? Don’t worry, mama bird’s got you!” He pulled out some granola bars and started chewing.

“Aaaaand there it is.”

“Bow, let her breathe!” Adora grabbed him by the shoulders and hauled him back. “You’re *smothering* her!”

“I am not!” Bow snapped back. “Now tell me if this looks chewed enough. *AHHHH* -”

“Okay, enough!” Glimmer sat up impatiently. “Relax! See, I’m charged up and all better- ARRRRGH!!” She doubled over, glitching.

“Oh God, it’s even *worse* now!” Bow wailed. “How much does it hurt? As much as a stubbed toe? Menstrual cramps?? Here, I’ve got some Midol in my best friend bag-” He started rooting around in a glittery fanny pack.

“Best friend bag?” Adora eyed him enviously. “No fair, I want one.”

“I know, which is...EXACTLY WHAT’S IN *THIS* BAG!” He pulled out a small flannel pack and handed it to her.

“Oh my God YESSSS-”

“This can’t possibly get any worse,” Glimmer groaned to herself.

“Glim-Glim? Are you up there, sweetie?” Queen Angella called from outside.

“WELL I SPOKE TOO FUCKING SOON.” Glimmer stood up in panic. “Quick, you guys, my mom’s coming! We can’t let her see me like this! DO something!”

“Like *what* ?!” Bow sputtered.

“...Stab you?” Adora said, holding up her sword.

“What? No!” Bow gaped at her. “What is *wrong* with you?!”

“Sssssstab your mom?”

“WHY THE FUCK-”

“Let’s hear her out, Bow-”

“Just get her OUT of here!!”

Adora simply picked Glimmer up and threw her out the window just as the Queen walked in.

“Where’s Glimmer?” she asked, glancing around.

“...She just left,” Bow said truthfully.

There was a loud thud from outside, followed by colorful swearing.

“What was that?”

“Probably some guards effing in the bushes,” Adora blurted out.

“Again?!” The Queen huffed, shaking her head. “I’m going to have to have a word with them-”

“It’s cool, we’ll do it,” Adora said hurriedly, grabbing Bow’s hand and hauling him out of the room. Queen Angella ran to the window.

“And tell them a shield does NOT count as protection- Glimmer? I see you down there! Do NOT walk away from me! ...No limping

either!”

-With Catra-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Catra walked along a hallway with Scorpia, gloating at her recent victory.

“Oh man, that public roast was SO great!” she laughed. “Did you see the look on Shadow Weaver’s dumb face?”

“Uh, no, not really,” Scorpia admitted. “Her mask kind of gets in the way. But I can certainly imagine it!” She paused. “...I think I just threw up a little-”

“And you got it all on video?” Catra cut in.

“Yup! Right here!” Scorpia proudly held up her phone in one claw.

“Awesome! Let me-”

* *Crack* !*

“...That better be in the fucking *Cloud* ,” Catra hissed, glaring at Scorpia as she fumbled with the shattered phone. “I swear, the rate at which you go through those things-” She suddenly halted in place, sniffing the air suspiciously.

“Oh God, I was really hoping you wouldn’t smell that-” Scorpia began.

Princess Entrapta came tumbling out of the vent, landing on her ass with a splat. Her visor snapped up and she gaped at Catra in awe.

“...Are you a *furry* ?” she asked dazedly.

“Wow, *racist* ,” Catra snorted.

“Who are you?” Scorpia demanded. “...And why do you smell like pee?”

“Oh, I’m Entrapta, I came with the other Princesses,” she said, then spoke into her tape recorder. “Log sixty-three. I have made contact with my very first furry. Beginning experimentation! Test number one: how deep does the animal instinct go?” She pulled out a ball of tinfoil and waved it in Catra’s face. “ *Pssspssspss* !” She threw it down the hall. “Fetch!”

Catra just stood there, glowering.

“Hmm, no response. Moving on.” Entrapta made a note on a sheet of paper. “Test number two: sex drive.” She pulled out a photo of an anime cat-girl. “Does this make you horny?”

“...I can see why the others left you behind,” Catra said.

“I got it!” Scorpia panted, running back with the ball in claw. “Throw it again! Throw it again!”

-With Adora-

Back at Bright Moon, Bow puttered around Glimmer’s bedroom while the girls talked.

“Maybe this is like having a cold,” Glimmer said, then frowned. “Wait. How would I know? I’m a magical fucking Princess, I fart rainbows and shit sprinkles, I’ve never even *been* sick before. Hey you two normies, what do you do when you have a cold?”

“Use it as a weapon,” Adora said instantly. Glimmer blinked.

“...Excuse me?”

“With each sneeze, you deploy the germs directly into your enemy’s face,” Adora went on. “Specifically Lonnie, that *bitch* -”

“You guys seriously do that?” Bow cocked an eyebrow at her.

“Well it’s either that or go into hiding.” Adora shrugged. “Displays of physical weakness are strongly discouraged in the Horde. A stronger, larger predator might come along to pick you off. You need to mark your territory-”

“...Is that why you peed on your sheets?” Glimmer asked uncertainly.

“How *else* would you know that they were mine?”

“Okay, that’s enough,” Bow said, turning to Glimmer. “When you have a cold you drink lots of tea and sleep on the couch in a Snuggie while binge-watching Netflix. Here, I’ll make you some soup.”

“Aww,” Glimmer began, touched, “that is SO sweet, Bow, you-”

He pulled out a can of Campbell’s tomato soup.

“…lazy bitch.” She shook her head. “Forget it, I’ll try the nap thing. I’ll be all better when I wake up!” She stood and walked over to her bed…

Which was hanging like ten fucking feet in the air.

“...Godammit.” Glimmer sighed. “Bow, give me a boost.”

“Oh, okay.” He winked at her. “Your hair looks *super* cute today and you give excellent hugs with just the *riiight* amount of squeeze.”

“I meant, like, a physical one,” she clarified. “...Thanks, though. I needed that.” She glared up at the bed. “Someone just knock the stupid thing down.”

"It took us six hours to put it *up* there!" Bow protested, holding up a thick packet of directions and a wrench. "I *still* don't know where these two screws go! Fucking Ikea!"

"Well it'll only take us six *seconds* to knock it down," Glimmer shot back. "Now do it, I'm sleepy."

"Here, I've got it," Adora said, pulling out her sword. "For the Honor of Grayskull!" She quickly transformed into She-blah, then paused. "Hey, wait. If you got sick because of whatever dark magic Shadow Weaver made with the Black Garnet, then maybe the magic of my sword can *heal* you!"

"Wow, Adora, that's actually-" Bow began.

"...By stabbing you with it!"

"-a horrible fucking idea oh my God what is wrong with you-"

"Nonsense! That sounds like a *great* idea!" Glimmer spread her arms and closed her eyes. "Stab away!"

-Meanwhile-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Entrapta was now chained to the wall by a pair of manacles in a dank, dirty cell. The door crashed open and Catra and Scorpia strode in.

"Alright, *prisoner* ," Catra hissed, "start talking."

" *Hi I'm Entrapta I'm a Princess I can wipe my own ass I mean I'm not that great at it but I'm improving I like robots especially killer ones what are these manacles made out of I can barely move I think I've researched them before on a site called Pornhub-* "

“Okay STOP talking.” Catra pulled out a stun prod. “Don’t make me use this.” She stepped closer. “I’ve been tasked with your interrogation, so there’s no point in resisting. Understand?”

“...Is this the part where I say the safe word?” Entrapta asked after a moment.

“Well so far the only one getting tortured here is ME.” Catra pinched the bridge of her nose and took a breath, then stepped right up into Entrapta’s face, holding the prod up menacingly. “Now you listen to me, *pigtails* . I don’t care what it takes, I’m going to drag the Rebellion’s plans out of you if it’s the last thing I-” One of Entrapta’s pigtails slithered free and snatched the stun prod away.

“This looks nothing like the tools they used in the video! The ones they had vibrated-”

“Wait what the- how the fuck did you get out?!” Catra sputtered. “Godammit, I *knew* we should’ve put a hairnet on this bitch!”

“What shampoo do you use?” Scorpia gushed. “Your hair has such body and volume! It’s almost like it's... *alive* !”

“Shut up! I’m the one asking questions here!” Catra snapped at her.

“Okay, what do you want to know?” Entrapta said with a shrug.

“What were you doing in the vents?” Catra demanded.

“Looking at penises, mostly. I made sketches. Wanna see?” She held up a stack of crude dick drawings complete with measurements. “I’m also waiting for my friends, I think they forgot me-”

“Sounds legit,” Catra said. “If I was your friend I’d want to forget you, too.”

Entrapta slipped free from her restraints and sidled up to Scorpia, flipping her mask down as she studied her closer.

" *Fascinating* ! I've never seen an insect furry in my Deviantart research! Does your tail secrete some kind of paralyzing agent? Can I have a sample for study? I'll put the lights down low and play some sexy music while I rub it-"

"Hey, whoa! Back off!" Scorpia cried, snatching it away protectively. "I did NOT consent! I'm gonna take you to HR to file a complaint-"

"But I need something to keep me occupied while I wait for Adora and the others to come back for me unless you're cool with a killer robot army-"

"Don't you get it?" Catra cut in. "They *ditched* you. They're NOT coming back."

"That's not true!" Entrapta protested. "They wouldn't do that! I'm their *friend* !" She paused. "...Friends lock you in a closet for hours, right?"

" *HA* ! I *knew* we were friends!" Scorpia crowed, throwing her arms up in triumph. Catra rolled her eyes.

"Look, I have proof!" Entrapta held up her phone to show several photos of her with the others, smiling and laughing.

"...You photoshopped those, didn't you?" Catra asked after a moment.

"Of course I did. Mermista wouldn't stop strangling me."

"Omg, SAME-" Scorpia said, jerking her head toward Catra meaningfully.

"Anyway, forget them. *We're* hiring! Just think of what you could accomplish here at the Horde," Catra pressed on. "We take anyone in, no matter how weird or fucked up. There's even this

one scorpion bitch who-" Scorpia cleared her throat. "-hey, shut up, I'm talking here. Anyway, just think of all the things you could accomplish here!"

"I... *have* made more progress here than I ever did at home," Entrapta admitted reluctantly. "Especially in my human dissection and dismemberment research."

"...Is that where all the disappearing people went-" Scorpia began, eyes wide with horror. Catra just scowled.

"Why the fuck didn't you take *Kyle* -"

"Horde technology is *incredible* !" Entrapta went on, growing more excited. "Why, Emily is the most advanced bot I've ever built!" Catra and Scorpia looked over at the round robot, which was busy slamming it's head repeatedly against the wall. "...She still has a few bugs to work out."

"Honestly, it's a step up compared to most of the people around this place," Catra muttered. Emily suddenly jerked upright and shot out a laser beam that blasted a hole straight through the wall. "…You're hired."

"Okay, well now we're *definitely* gonna have to take you to HR," Scorpia sighed. "You'll need to sign some paperwork to get you on payroll and you really need to watch the video about sexual harassment-"

-Back at Bright Moon-

"Okay, now just hoooold still," She-blah was saying, aiming her sword with care.

"This is like extreme acupuncture, right?" Glimmer said, her arms still held out as she waited.

" *Stop trying to stab her bette* r!!" Bow screamed at them.

"You're right," She-blah said. "This won't possibly work." Bow sagged with relief. "This sword is *way* too dull. I should sharpen it first." She turned and started grinding it on a big whetstone wheel, sparks flying everywhere.

"What is with you and *stabbing* people today-"

-At the Horde Fortress-

Entrapta sat at a desk, filling out a pile of paperwork, Scorpia sitting across from her.

"Aaaaand you just sign here and here," Scorpia was saying, "and now, I'mma need you to piss in one of these little cups-"

"Waaay ahead of you!" Entrapta said, holding up a bottle filled with yellow liquid. "I was saving some on the off chance I got lost in the vents and couldn't find a water source-"

Catra gagged quietly in the back.

"Alright, showing initiative! That's very promising for your career." Scorpia took the bottle gingerly in one claw. "We're all done! Welcome to the team, here's your nametag. It's great to have you onboard the Horde- *oh shit I pierced it and now it's dribbling on me* -"

"I can't believe you rebuilt that robot while living in the vents like a rat," Catra muttered, sounding reluctantly impressed as she studied Emily, which had resumed beating it's head against the wall.

"I could give her a serious overhaul if you had some First One's tech," Entrapta said wistfully. Catra gave her a blank stare. "...You

know, the advanced technology left behind by a long-lost civilization? I've been attempting to integrate it in my experiments for years but they mostly end up trying to kill me-"

"Sounds perfect," Catra said. "How do we find some?"

"Oh, I've got this." Scorpia pulled out her phone. "Hey Siri, search for First One's tech in our area."

" *Searching for 'foot long dick' in your area* ," Siri said.

"That is NOT what I said-"

"It's buried all over the planet," Entrapta explained. "It gives out a signal that can be traced, and I've picked up a strong one coming from the Whispering Woods! There must be a *huge* stash in there somewhere." She paused. "That or it's the site of a massive toxic waste dump, which would explain the mutant trees and animals-"

"Okay, cool." Catra shrugged. "You got a map?"

"Let me do it!" Scorpia held up her phone again. "Hey Siri, how do I get to the Whispering Woods?"

" *Looking for directions to 'six horny dudes'-* "

"That's not even CLOSE-"

"Here, take this! It'll lead you straight to the signal," Entrapta said, handing Catra a tablet.

"...Why is this sticky," she asked, deadpan.

"...Do you *really* want to know?" Entrapta whispered back.

"Yeah, on second thought, I'm good." Catra shuddered and pulled out a disinfecting wipe. Entrapta cocked her head.

"So we're friends now, right?"

"Uh-huh, yeah, sure," Catra said distractedly. "And you know what that means." She held out a hand. "Time to pay your friend fee."

"What? Friend fee?" Entrapta blinked. "I never had to pay that with the others."

"That's because I'm a *premium* friend, and they're all cheap knock-offs."

"Amazing!" Entrapta cried, yanking out some bills from her pants and shoving them into Catra's arms. "I'm learning so much!"

"Sorry, I only have singles for my payment," Scorpia said, holding a thick wad of cash. "Totally didn't do it on purpose." She paused. "Would you mind dancing a little while I shower you with them-"

Catra switched the tablet on to find a deluge of concerned texts and emails from the other Princesses. She hurriedly deleted them.

"What was that?" Entrapta asked.

"Nothing, just junk mail," Catra said quickly.

"Wow, thanks for clearing up my inbox!" Entrapta smiled. "You're such a great friend!"

"Damn right I am," Catra said. "Now get back in your shackles."

-Aaaand Back to Bright Moon-

"For the last time," Bow said firmly, his arms crossed, "you are NOT stabbing Glimmer. Friends don't let their friends stab other friends. It's a rule."

"How ELSE do you expect me to heal her?" She-blah shouted back. "You're being ridiculous!"

“Really, bitch? REALLY? *I* am? I will tie you up with that gorgeous flowing hair-”

* *Knock Knock* *

“Hello, sweetie? Are you in there?” Queen Angella called from outside.

Everyone froze.

“...My offer to stab her still stands,” She-blah whispered.

“Shh!” Bow glared at her.

“I’m just saying, my sword is freshly sharpened and everything-”

“ *SHHHH* !”

“Everyone just act normal,” Glimmer hissed. “We don’t want her to find out about my glitch-”

“What’s this about a glitch?” Angella asked, poking her head into the bedroom.

“Oh, she didn’t say glitch,” She-blah cut in. “She said *bitch* . She’s calling you a bitch cuz you’re so-” She grunted as Glimmer elbowed her in the tit.

“No, I definitely heard the word ‘glitch’,” Queen Angella said, her eyes narrowing.

“Glitch...energy drink!” Glimmer held up a can. “Bow loves this stuff!” She took a sip, then spat it out, choking. “Oh my GOD this tastes like ASS how can you drink this-”

“I need it to fuel my late-night Call of Duty streams on Twitch,” Bow said, sitting in a gaming chair with a PC set up. He spun around and shouted into his headphones. “ *Your mom is a classy lady* !”

“Anyway, I’m just here to tell you that dinner is ready,” Angella said with a sigh, “and you’d *better* be there.”

“Aww, but Mom, I’m...not feeling well!” Glimmer groaned and rubbed her stomach. “I think I started my period-”

“Hmm, not according to my calendar.” Angella reached over and pulled down a hanging chart calendar, pointing with a stick at a date circled with red marker. “See here, you’re not due for another two weeks-”

“What the fuck! You track my period too?” Glimmer glared at her. “You’re just as bad as Bow.”

“I’ll take that as a compliment. See you soon.” She turned and swept grandly out of the room. Glimmer slammed the door shut after her, then doubled over, wailing in pain as she glitched again. “And stop having a tantrum, you’re a *grown girl* !!” her mother called through the door.

“Okay, Bow, you have a point,” She-blah admitted grudgingly. “I don’t know how to use my magical Princess powers. I need to go somewhere where I can *learn* to use them so I can heal Glimmer-”

“Right. YouTube.” Bow pulled out his phone. “How...to...use...She-blah...powers-”

“NO!” She shook her head, then gasped. “Wait, I know! I’ll go to the place Madame Razz took me. The beacon in the Whispering Woods! I’m off!!” She-blah spun and leapt dramatically out the window to-

* *CRAAASSSSHH tinkle tinkle* *

Glimmer and Bow stood in front of the shattered window, blinking in shock.

“...Yeah there’s glass in that,” Glimmer said after a beat.

Bow slowly leaned out over the broken panes and stared down for a moment.

"...How...to...dress...glass...wounds..."

" *BOW PUT THE FUCKING PHONE DOWN AND GET THE MEDIC -"*

-Aaaaand Back to the Horde Fortress AGAIN-

Catra sat on her tiny cat bed, packing for her journey. Shadow Weaver slithered out of a dark corner behind her, hissing in annoyance.

"Make sure you take some Frontline Plus, you don't want to pick up any *more* ticks out there."

"You're the only thing sucking the life out of me," Catra snapped back at her, glaring over her shoulder. "Get lost, I'm busy."

"Where do you think you're going, anyway?" Shadow Weaver demanded. "Have you filled out a hall pass?"

"No, but I filled out this one." Catra handed her a piece of paper.

"...This just says 'fuck you'," Shadow Weaver said after a moment.

"Exactly." Catra paused, noticing the other woman breathing heavily. "What, are you still upset about being yelled at? Here's a tip: wear earplugs. Or, better yet, airpods."

"That is the *stupidest* thing I have ever heard-"

"Huh?" Catra pulled out an ear pod and cocked her head. "You say something?"

"Alright, I admit I was hard on you," Shadow Weaver said grudgingly, "but I won't apologize. I just wanted you to be *strong*

."

"Well, I'm plenty strong now, and I *don't* need you," Catra said, walking out the door with her head held high.

Several seconds later, she popped back in.

"...Ok but seriously I need you to sign my hall pass Hordak won't let me leave without it-"

-BRIGHT MOON AGAIN OMFG-

"Glimmer, we *have* to tell your mom what's going on," Bow said firmly. "I know you're trying to protect me because it's all my fault - or, more specifically, my midriff's - but seriously-" Glimmer stared at him blankly.

"...What?"

"Yeah, that's right, I'm talking to you!" Bow shouted, glaring down at his exposed stomach. "You just HAD to get all sweaty from dancing and I HAD to go powder you and then I got kidnapped and then GLIMMER got kidnapped and now she's sick and it's ALL your fault! I'm never exposing you again! In fact…" He snatched up a blanket and wrapped it tight around his belly.

"Don't DO this to yourself, Bow!!" Glimmer gasped in horror and reached for him. "It needs to *breathe* !!"

"No! It deserves to smother!" Bow shouted, squirming away. "I'm not even gonna shave it anymore-"

"Stop! Everything is all *my* fault! *I* was being weird and jealous at the Princess Prom! I'm sorry!"

“You can’t be sorry when *I’m* being sorry! I called it first! I have DIBS!”

“Then let’s just agree that we’re both stupid bitches and HUG!”

“DEAL!!” The two hugged for a long, touching minute before Glimmer suddenly screamed, glitching again. “Oh shit are you okay? Do you want me to-”

“No, we're having a moment!” she ground out through gritted teeth. “Don't you *dare* let me go! Just keep hugging!”

“Are you sure? It kind of hurts-”

“ *Just suck it up* !!” The glitching finally stopped and they separated, panting. Glimmer groaned. “How am I going to hide this from my mom?”

“...We could say it's a new kind of hiccup-” Bow began.

“OR we could burn the castle down!” She held up a can of gasoline.

“Okay, you’ve been spending too much time with Seahawk.”

“Look who’s talking!” Glimmer snapped at him. “I know he’s the one who taught you that new thing with your tongue!” Bow gasped in outrage.

“You told me you *liked* that!”

-Later That Day...-

Glimmer entered Bright Moon’s large dining room, which held a long, elegant table flanked by rows of tall chairs.

“There you are, Glimmer!” Queen Angella said, standing at one end of the table. “I just finished preparing the food!” Glimmer looked over to see a bunch of takeout boxes. “...I got the paper plates and utensils out.”

“Mom, listen,” Glimmer began seriously. “I have something very important to tell you-”

“Oh God, don’t tell me you and Bow had sex and now you’re *pregnant* ,” Angella cried in dismay. “I swear, I thought he was into *men* ! Please tell me you used a condom-”

“What? NO, we did not- *AAUUUGH* !” Glimmer fell to her knees as she started glitching.

“Oh thank Christ you're not pregnant- *I mean oh my God my baby what’s wrong with you* -” Angella hurriedly rushed over.

“EVERYTHING!” Glimmer shouted back at her, struggling to her feet. “I’m a big fuckup! I went to a crazy party in the Fright Zone and the Princess Alliance dumped me and I got some kind of weird magical STD-”

“Sweetie, everyone makes mistakes,” Queen Angella said gently. “Why, even me! I can’t cook a meal to save my life, I had to order out! Also I got your father killed.”

“Oh, mom, don’t worry about- *hold on you did what now* -”

“You shouldn’t just give up,” Angella went on quickly. “You should keep fighting.”

“I can’t!” Glimmer shook her head. “The other Princesses all quit. They even blocked and unfriended me on social media and sent in their Friendship Certificates- Bow won’t stop crying about it-”

“Oh, don’t worry about that.” Queen Angella held up a copy of the Princess contract with a smug smile. “I amended it before you left. Now they can’t leave for any reason, barring death or dismemberment. Just like student loans.”

“I love you, mom,” Glimmer whispered, tears in her eyes.

“I love you, too, sweetie.”

-Meanwhile, in the Whispering Woods-

“The fuck AM I?!” She-blah grumbled, stomping her way through the Whispering Woods. She struggled around twisted trees and grasping vines, searching for the ancient ruin she’d visited with the even more ancient ruin, Madame Razz. “God, this is pathetic, Catra would never get lost in these woods-”

“I am so fucking lost this is ridiculous-” Elsewhere in the forest, Catra shoved her way through some bushes, then got bitch-slapped by a branch. “FUCK these woods!” She spat out a few leaves and held up Entrapta’s tablet, trying to pinpoint the stash of First One’s tech.

The two walked right past each other.

“Oh hey Catra,” She-blah said distractedly.

“Hey Adora, fuck you.” Catra kept walking for a few more moments, then froze. “...Wait a second.” The tablet suddenly started beeping. “Yes! It’s working! Now show me- oh, fucking SICK! Delete your search history, bitch!!” She flung the tablet away in disgust. It sailed through the air and hit She-blah in the back of the head.

“Ow!” She spun around and glared. “Watch it! I’m *wandering* here!”

“Sorry!” Catra called, then blinked. “...Can I have that back?”

“Yeah, sure, here.” She-blah tossed it back to her, then continued walking in circles and becoming increasingly frustrated. “Come

ON, work with me, you stupid woods! I just want to heal my friend!" She glared around at the trees, then pulled out her sword. "I will chop *all* you bitches down." Nothing happened. "No? Alright then. I know how to make you talk. I borrowed this from Seahawk-" She held up a can of gasoline. Smokey the Bear leaned out of the bushes again and gave her the stink eye. "Okay, Christ, I was kidding!" He slithered back into the underbrush. "What do you WANT from me?!" She dropped her sword and transformed back into Adora, holding up her hands pleadingly. "I'm begging you. Please, *help* me!" She sniffled and started to cry a little. A light suddenly shone off through the branches, guiding the way. " *PSYCH* !" Adora snatched up her sword and sprinted off towards the light, which blazed from the top of a tall, crumbling tower. "Like I'd ever show weakness- *oh ow I stubbed my toe ooh it hurts so bad* -" She dissolved into sobs as she hobbled towards the Beacon.

"I will burn this forest to the ground and piss on the ashes," Catra snarled, having given up on the porn-infected tablet and now sporting two black eyes and a bloody nose from more feisty branches. Smokey the Bear popped out again and she immediately seized him by the neck, hauling him in close. "Tell me where the tech is," she hissed, pulling out a lighter and flicking it on, "or I will set YOU on fire." Smokey slowly raised a paw and pointed. "Good choice, teddy." She shoved him away, then quickly caught up with Adora, who had almost reached the Beacon. Catra climbed up a tree to watch through the leaves, chuckling evilly. " *Heyyyyy, Adoraaaa…* "

"Hey," Adora replied, standing right under her. "...What are you doing up there?"

"...Spying on you," Catra said awkwardly.

"Okay cool." Adora paused. "You need help getting down?"

"No, I'm fine. Later. *Bye* ." Catra waited until she turned away, then whispered under her breath. " *Dumbaaaass…* "

"What?"

"Nothing! Just leave! GOD! I'm trying to be evil and shit and you're *ruining* it-"

She got slapped by another branch.

-End Episode 10-

Pro-Miss

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra peeked out of the bushes, watching as Adora approached the Beacon, a giant beam of light blazing from the top of the ancient ruin. The building reacted to her presence, a door magically grinding open to allow her inside. Catra scuttled forward and slipped in before it shut, stealthily creeping after her, silent as a-

"*Ooof* !"

She tripped right over Adora.

"Bitch, I'm *sneaking* here!"

"Sorry, had to fix my shoe-lace," Adora said, kneeling. She finished and stood up. "Please continue."

"Christ," Catra muttered under her breath, "today is NOT my fucking day-"

She was bitch-slapped by a branch.

"*The fuck did that even get IN here* -"

Oblivious, Adora walked down a hallway into a large room with glowing crystals and runes on the walls. She climbed onto a raised platform and glanced around uncertainly.

"Hello? Light Hope?" she called out, her voice echoing. "I carry the sword of She-blah." She raised the sword high. "Please, I need your help." She waited, but there was no response. "I beg of you. I come here in peace, humble before you-"

“Greetings.” The hologram version of Light Hope flickered to life behind her.

“*DIEEEEE* !” Adora whirled around and plunged her sword into the hologram’s chest. They stood there for a long, awkward moment. “...So are you gonna help or are you gonna be a whiney little bitch about this-”

“What is your query?” Light Hope asked.

“How do I heal people with my magical She-blah powers?” Adora held up her sword and shook it futilely. “I mean, I feel like I've gained enough experience points to unlock it on my skill tree, or is it some kind of app? Do I need to download it? I swear to God if this is some kind of DLC bullshit I will be SO pissed-”

“Please sign in,” the hologram said.

“Wait, what? Sign in? How the hell do I do that? I don’t remember my fucking password!” Adora pulled out a small notebook and started flipping through. “Let's see, here's my Netflix, Hulu...Tumblr - don't judge me - dammit, I can't find it!” She threw it down and huffed. “You know what fuck this. I’ll just *make* you tell me. For the honor of Grayskull!” With a flash of light, she transformed into She-blah and pulled back her sword to strike.

“Login successful,” Light Hope said. “What is your query?”

She-blah froze in place, her sword hovering just over Light Hope's face.

“...Right. Totally wasn't trying to murder you. For a second time.” She cleared her throat. “So anyway tell me about the sword. The legends say it can heal people. How do I DO that?”

“Press 1 for She-blah information,” the hologram intoned. “*Para espanol* -”

"Okay never mind still might-” She-blah groaned and rubbed her head. “Look, just let me talk to Light Hope.”

“Please hold,” Light Hope said. Elevator music began to play as they waited. “*Your call is important to us. Thank you for holding* -”

“Okay *definitely* going to now-” She-blah raised her sword again.

“Light Hope is here,” the hologram answered. “She is waiting to talk to you, but you are not ready. You must first let go.”

“Let go of what?”

“Also, pets are not allowed.”

“Wait, *pets*? What are you-” She-blah whirled around to find Catra standing there, scratching her ass. She narrowed her eyes at Light Hope.

“The *fuck* you callin' a pet, you blow-up doll lookin' bitch?”

“*Catra*?!” She-blah gaped at her in disbelief. “How did YOU get in here?!” She just shrugged.

“Followed you in from the woods, remember?”

“Oh. OHHH.” She-blah blinked. “Huh. Didn't seem weird at the time. I'm so used to you being in my shadow I didn't think twice about it.” Catra hissed, bristling with outrage. “Anyway, I shouldn't be surprised,” she went on. “You got into my locker in the Horde barracks like a million times, it's no wonder you *slithered* your way in here. One time you even got into my *lunchbox,* got my Lunchables all covered in fur-”

“Yeah, that took some contorting-” Catra caught the insult. “Hey, shut up! It’s not like I’m snooping around or stealing anything!”

“Well then what *are* you doing in here?”

Catra stood there for a moment.

“…Snooping.”

“What are you doing with that First One's tech?” She-blah asked, pointing at a data crystal in her hand. Catra's frown deepened.

“…Stealing- look I don’t see your *point* -”

“Unauthorized presence detected,” Light Hope suddenly said. “Security protocol activated.”

She-blah started screaming.

“...Why are you screaming-” Catra got out before She-blah seized her by the scruff of the neck and hauled her towards the exit. “OKAY SERIOUSLY WHAT'S GOING ON WHY ARE WE RUNNING-” Doors began slamming shut around them, a sinister red light washing over everything. Dozens of red eyes lit up the last darkened hallway as an army of huge mechanical spiders wearing security caps and holding flashlights crawled out. “AAAAA- oh, I *get* it now- AAAAAA!!” Catra joined in as they took off down another hallway. “Why is this place trying to murder us?!”

“It's trying to murder YOU!” She-blah shot at her. “It sees you as an invader!” She paused, then promptly dropped Catra and dashed forward. “Whooops!” Catra managed to cling to her cape with her claws and was dragged along.

“I'm gonna kill you!!” They ran around a corner and hit a dead end. “*I mean I love you please help me* -”

She-blah spun around and swung her sword, smashing the ceiling to bits. Pieces of it rained down, crushing the spiders.

“YES! I saved us!!” She-blah cheered.

And then the roof collapsed on them.

“...You’re welcome,” She-blah said, her voice muffled by the rubble.

“You know what, next time I'll just let the spiders kill me,” Catra grumbled, sitting up and pushing debris off.

“Why are you even *here*?” Adora demanded, reverting to normal and struggling free. “Does Shadow Weaver know that you left? Were you excused with a note? Did she sign your permission slip for a field trip?” She paused, a look of horror on her face. “...Tell me you at least got a hall pass-”

“No, I came here by myself, like a big girl!” Catra snapped impatiently. “And what are YOU doing out here? Where are your new best friends?”

“You mean the ones that you kidnapped and held for ransom?” Adora shot back heatedly. “The ones you almost *killed* ? The ones you gave to Shadow Weaver who *tortured* and *cursed* them? THOSE friends?!!”

“...Yeah those.” Catra gave her a blank stare. “Unless you have some other friends that I did that to without my knowing, I really can't keep track-”

“Oh my God forget it.” Adora brushed herself off and glanced around. “Those things will come after us again soon. Let’s get going.”

“*Please*, if you think I'm going anywhere with you-” Catra turned to find the hallway blocked with rubble. “...you are *correct*. But I'm not gonna like it.” Adora rolled her eyes and walked off. “Wait where are you going you gotta hold my hand-”

-Later-

The two of them walked deeper into the ruins, through narrow, twisting hallways and tunnels built like a maze. Finally they reached a door covered with strange, glowing symbols.

“How do we open this?” Catra asked. “Are you going to sprinkle some glitter or say some mystic word and magically open the-”

Adora head-butted the door down. “...Okay never mind this is you were talking about here what was I thinking-”

“Eternia, BITCH,” Adora said, then tossed some glitter in Catra's face. She sputtered in fury and clawed at her eyes before stumbling after her through the doorway. As they continued on into the darkness, Adora pulled out her sword to use as a handy flashlight.

“Cool, I didn't know it had that feature,” Catra said grudgingly.

“Yeah, check it out. It has a party option, too.” She pressed a button and the sword started pulsing different colors like a strobe light. The girls immediately pulled out some glow-sticks started dancing along to the beat. “Let's sucker some guys into getting us drinks- hold on. What's that?” Adora pointed at a distant light glowing in the dark room. They approached it cautiously and the light suddenly exploded, blinding them. The girls opened their eyes to find themselves at the Horde fortress in the Fright Zone. “Wait, WHAT?! How did we get here?!” Adora shouted in alarm. “Catra! What did you DO?!”

“I didn’t do shit!!” Catra shouted back. She noticed a lone guard standing nearby and stalked over. “Hey, you! What's going on here?” The guard ignored her. “...Bitch I will claw your face off-” She swiped at him, but her claws passed straight through his helmet. “The fuck? A hologram?” She glared at him furiously. “… I'll *remember* you.” She paused. “I'm just gonna assume you're Kyle.”

“What is this?” Adora was still looking around in confusion. “Catra, I know you pressed something, just tell me what is was-”

“I said I didn't, you twat!”

“Don't call me a twat!”

“Fine, you're a stinky poo-poo head!”

“The fuck are you, *five*?!”

“Apparently!” Catra pointed behind her, and Adora whirled around to find a much younger Catra standing there, a little bundle of brat with big eyes and wild hair.

“Oh my God, you were so cute.” Adora stared at her. “...What the hell happened-”

“Hey, fuck you!” Catra glared back. “You were a fuckin' *nerd* as a kid, with your dumb ponytail and fucked up teeth.”

“I was not!” Catra pointed again, and Adora looked over to see her younger self also standing there, indeed with stupid hair and missing several teeth. “... *Why didn't anyone tell me I was so fucking lame* -”

“Wait, why are we seeing our younger selves, anyway?” Catra cut in. “Does this mean we're about to see some kind of-”

-Flashbaaaack!-

“Catra, I'm not taking you to a vet, you know I can't afford the fees. You're *fine*,” young Adora said firmly. “...Now hold still and let me splint your arm.” Young Catra hissed as she set the bone.

“You're not even giving me anything for the pain?!” she cried.

“Fine, here.” Adora stuck a pill in her mouth. Catra immediately spat it back out.

“That's gross I don't want it.”

“Suffer, then.” Adora went to work wrapping up her arm. “Why'd you pick a fight with Octavia, anyway?”

“I didn’t do anything!” Catra snapped back. “All I did was *exist* next to her.” She paused. “...And pee on her bed and and puke in

her shoes and claw up her clothes-”

“Okay, you're really not helping with the sympathy here.”

“Oh, I'm not done- and steal her wallet and wrack up crippling debt and-”

“Now I'm thinking you deserved it-”

“Also I called her Squidward. Is that racist?”

“*Enough*!!” Adora finished and stuck a plastic cone over Catra's head with a sigh. “Where is she?” Catra pointed over to an armored squid-woman lounging sulkily against the wall nearby. “Hey! Octavia!” Adora shouted at her. Octavia scowled back. “...Aren't you late for your shift at the Krusty Krab?”

Ocatavia snarled and gave chase. The two kids ran off clutching each other and screaming.

-End Flashback-

Adora and Catra ran down the hall holding hands, screaming their lungs out. They froze in place and looked at each other in shock.

“What the fuck was *that*?!” Catra demanded, snatching her hand back.

“Whoa...that must’ve been some sort of... *simulation*,” Adora said, shaking her head. “This ruin is tapping into our memories. It's showing us a flashback of our own lives! That's so incredible-”

-Flashback!-

Adora sat on the toilet, whistling idly-

-End Flashback!-

"Oh, come ON!" Adora cried, throwing up her arms. "We *really* don't need to see that! Fast forward, please! Like ten minutes!"

-Flashback Again!-

"Ugh, I am so constipated," Adora said, still sitting on the toilet. "I should get some prunes or something-"

-End Flashback!-

"*SKIP*!!!" Adora screamed. Catra laughed so hard she snorted.

"Oh my God, this is the best-"

-Another Flashback!-

Catra crouched over her litter box, reading a Petco magazine-

-End Flashback!

"*HEY*!!!" Catra snarled in fury, her hair standing on end. "Seriously this place is the fucking *worst*!" She rounded on Adora. "How can you stand being a Princess with all this magical bullshit?!"

"...I don't know what you mean," Adora said, then a flock of doves suddenly flew out of her hair. "...What the fuck."

"*See*?!"

"No, I really don't-"

"My fair lady!" A handsome prince sprang up beside her with a bouquet of flowers. "I have just met you and instantly fallen *madly* in love with you. Please marry me and come to my castle with your talking animal companion here-"

Adora decked him and Catra followed up with a kick to the nuts.

"Okay, fine, you have a point," Adora admitted. "Although it kinda sucks when we get *cursed*, just ask *Glimmer* -"

"Oh, please, she's a Princess, it comes with the fucking title!" Catra shot back with a huff. "What do you want, an apology? Well, too bad! You're not getting one!" She shoved past her roughly, Adora staggering back a step. "Oh gosh sorry that was a little harder than I meant are you okay-"

The two of them continued on, emerging from the hallway into a large room with a gaping pit in the floor, a single fallen column breaching the span. Carefully, they began to cross.

"Hey, I want to know," Adora piped up, "why did you let me go after Shadow Weaver captured us? I can't figure it out."

"Yes, because *now* is the perfect time to discuss that," Catra muttered, wobbling a little as she inched her way across.

"I'm so confused. It just doesn't make sense."

“Seriously, shut UP.”

“It's like I'm getting mixed signals from you all the time. First you hate me, then you love me...”

“GOD I hope you fucking fall-”

“*Awk*!” Adora suddenly lost her balance and toppled towards the edge, but Catra reached out and grabbed her hand just in time. She hung there, suspended. “...You see? Like this, right here. This is what I'm talking about-”

“Do you *want* me to drop you?!” Catra grunted, hauling her back onto the pillar. They finally crossed and reached the other side of the pit. “Listen, don't look too far into it, okay.” She glanced away, blushing, as some cherry-blossoms blew through the air. “It...it's not like I *like* you or anything, b-baka!”

“...Excuse me what-”

“I just didn’t want Shadow Weaver to erase your memory, okay?!” Catra burst out. “It wasn’t...ALL bad growing up together in the Horde, was it?” She glanced over at Adora uncertainly.

“You're right,” Adora said, nodding, “I have plenty of great memories. Like that one time we- no wait they put me in solitary for a week.” She paused, thinking. “How about when- oh no I got whipped for that.” She paused again. “Wait, didn't we- hold on they broke my ankles afterwards.” She blinked. “Wow, okay. I guess I really *don't* have any good memories from there. Anyway, I couldn't go back after I learned that the Evil Horde was *actually* an *evil horde* . You understand, right?” Catra just stared at her with a baffled expression. “Look, here. I'll show you what I've learned from the others. This is called 'affection'-” She reached for Catra, who seized her arm and threw her to the ground. “OOF! What the fuck was that for?!”

“Bitch, you attacked me!” Catra shouted. “I just defended myself!”

“It's just a hug, you idiot! Bow gave me pointers to improve my squeeze game. I kept breaking ribs.” She stood up and tried again. “Now come here-”

“Get away from me!” Catra hissed, turning to run and immediately bumping into a flashback. “*How the fuck*-”

-Flashback!-

Catra and Adora, still children but slightly older than before, danced around each other in the training room, battling with sticks. Suddenly Lonnie jumped in, swinging her own stick-

With a *feather* at the end.

“*OoooOOOoooh*!” Catra went straight for it, pawing delightedly. “I'm gonna get it I'm gonna get- wait, no! Dammit, Lonnie, that's *cheating*!” Adora, taking advantage of the distraction, easily knocked her stick away. “HEY!”

“Good work, cadet!” the weird spiky blue thing from before said, flashing a thumbs-up. “This win will be reported to Lord Hordak. Also you’ll get a gold star on the class chart. You’re one step closer to a pizza party!”

“Yayyyy!” Adora threw her hands up and cheered.

Catra stormed over to Lonnie and Kyle, her tail fluffed up.

“What was *that*?!” she demanded heatedly. “Way to gang up on me, Kyle!”

“...I wasn't even fighting-” he began.

“And you!” She rounded on Lonnie. “I've had enough of your *racism* -”

“Shut up, pussy.”

“There it is again*!*”

“Catra!” Adora jogged over and gave her an apologetic look. “Sorry about that. I didn't mean to make you look bad-”

“Not that she needs help,” Lonnie snorted.

“Piss off, Lonnie!” Catra shrugged nonchalantly. “Whatever, Adora. It’s not like I care or anything. Second place is fine-”

“Catra, you're ranked dead last,” the blue spiky thing said, looking at its clipboard. “Riiight behind Kyle.”

“KYLE YOU PIECE OF CRAP I'M GONNA KILL YOU-”

Catra chased him into the bathroom and gave him a fresh round of swirlies in the toilet stall. Leaving him to marinate, she went to the sink and huddled over, sniffling quietly.

-End Flashback-

Catra wiped her face and looked up into the mirror, back to her normal age but still in the Horde bathroom.

“Ugh, I look fucking horrible,” she grumbled. “My eyes are all red and glowing and I have like sixteen of them- *wait a fucking minute*.” She screamed as a robot spider lunged out of the mirror at her.

-Outside-

Adora jerked upright, the scream echoing from nearby.

“Catra? Where are you?!” She stumbled to her feet and ran into the bathroom to find Catra cocooned in webs, the spider dragging her away. “Oh God, I'm so sorry, I didn't know you were using it, excuse me-” She ran back outside. “...Wait it was *shitting webs all over Catra* !” She ran back in, sword upraised, her other hand covering her eyes. “Don’t worry, I’m not looking!”

“Save me from her!” Catra shrieked at the spider, then was muffled by more webs. As Adora began attacking the nearby tampon machine, the robot spider dragged Catra through the mirror into the dark hallway beyond. She struggled, managed to get a hand free, and quickly clawed the webs to bits, attacking and destroying the robot spider with her claws. It fell at her feet, twitching. “Yes, I did it! And now for the killing blow-”

Adora leapt out of nowhere and rammed her sword into the spider's head, killing it.

“Ha! I knew I'd hit it eventually!” she shouted in triumph. She finally uncovered her eyes and looked around. “Oh, there you are, Catra. You okay, sweetie? It's a good thing I was around to save your ass. You should probably stay behind me from now on. Actually, no, that’s dangerous, too. Here, you can stay in this!” She held up a cat carrier. “Hop in!”

Catra stared at her blankly.

“...Are you fucking kidding me?”

“...I’ll give you a treat,” Adora said after a moment.

Catra turned and stomped off.

“Okay, fine, you can have some Fancy Feast!” Adora shouted after her.

“Fuck OFF!”

“What’s your problem?” Adora asked, following her down the hall. “I was just trying to help you-”

“I don’t *need* you to help me!” Catra whirled around, snarling. “I’ve been doing just fine all on my own!”

“Of course you have, sweetie,” Adora said gently, patting her head. “I would never imply that- oh, ew, you're getting mats in your coat. Have you been taking care of yourself? Hold still let me brush those out-” She pulled out a cat brush and leaned towards her.

“Get AWAY from me!” Catra slapped it away.

“Look, I’m sorry that I left,” Adora began, “but I'm *not* going back to the Horde.” She gasped and her eyes lit up. “I know! You could come back *with* me!” She took Catra's hand and squeezed it. “You could *join* the Rebellion. I know you’re not a bad person.” She paused. “...Stupid, but not bad-”

“Hey, I am NOT stupid!” Catra snapped.

-Flashback!-

Younger Catra ran down a hallway in the Horde Fortress with Adora, laughing and giggling. They screeched to a halt in front of a large, imposing door.

“Uhh, isn’t that Shadow Weaver's room?” Adora said uneasily. “We'd have to be *really* stupid to-”

Catra was already inside.

-End Flashback-

"...Shut the fuck up," Catra growled.

Adora rolled her eyes.

-Continuing Flashback!-

"Catra. wait!" Adora followed her friend inside. "We shouldn't be doing this!"

"Oh, come on, it's not like anything deeply traumatic and emotionally scarring will happen," Catra said, eagerly looking around.

Shadow Weaver's rooms were dark and creepy, with thick cobwebs in the corners and a couple moldy skeletons along the wall, the glow from the Black Garnet draping everything with shadows.

"This is fake, right?" Adora asked, pointing at one of the skeletons. A rat crawled out of an eye socket. "... *Right*?"

"I think she put them in detention and then forgot about them," Catra said. "Here, help me carry one, I'm gonna put it in Kyle's bed-"

The door suddenly creaked open. The girls gasped and quickly hid as Shadow Weaver stumbled in, groaning weakly.

"Damn, is she drunk *already*?" Catra hissed under her breath. "It's, like, nine in the morning! She needs help-"

"*Shh*!" Adora elbowed her.

Shadow Weaver staggered over to her cauldron and fumbled off her mask. The girls gasped in horror as they saw her disfigured face, pitted and scarred with bloodshot eyes.

"Eww, she has GOT to moisturize. Learn to *exfoliate*, bitch-"

"*SHHH*!" Adora elbowed her harder. So hard she fell out of their hiding spot and into the open.

"*YOU*!!" Shadow Weaver snarled in fury, catching sight of her. Catra screamed and ran for the exit, but went limp as Shadow Weaver seized her by the scruff of the neck and shook her. "What do you think you're doing in here?!"

"Honestly, I was probably gonna shit in your bed it's like my signature-" Catra blurted out.

"Wait!" Adora scrambled over. "Shadow Weaver, please, we were just playing-"

"-and pee on your pillow I drank a whole bottle of Gatorade in preparation-"

"Catra you're doing the thing again just stop talking-"

"-and get hair all over your best robes I started shedding last week-"

"Seriously you are NOT helping." Adora looked up at Shadow Weaver. "Don't blame her. It was *my* idea to come in here."

"-no it wasn't it was all me it was premeditated-"

"SHUT. UP. CATRA. "

"Now listen here, you mangy *stray,"* Shadow Weaver hissed, looming over Catra menacingly. "I only let Adora adopt you so she could have a *pet* . I thought it would teach her responsibility, not cause her to *lose* it! I will NOT let you drag her down with you! I should take you to the pound and have you put *down* -"

“Please, stop already!!” Adora stepped in front of her pleadingly. “I'll be good and do my homework and everything, I swear! Don't hurt her!”

“...Alright, fine,” Shadow Weaver said, relenting. “You can keep it.”

“*Phew* ...” Adora and Catra both relaxed.

“But she has to take *obedience* lessons.”

“Can't you just get me *fixed* ?!” Catra sputtered in outrage.

“That's fine, Shadow Weaver,” Adora cut in, clapping a hand over her mouth and nodding eagerly. “She'll *definitely* do it. Thank you SO much!”

-End Flashback!-

“God, you were always such a suck-up!” Catra shouted at Adora, back in the present. “Admit it, you *love* being Shadow Weaver's favorite!”

“I do not!” Adora shouted back, then quickly unpinned her 'Number 1 Student' badge and stuffed it into her pocket- but not, like, hard, she didn't want to damage it. “You don’t have to let her treat you like that anymore! You could *leave* , like I did!”

“And follow you around like a little lost animal?! No way!” Catra shook her head. “I’m not your fucking *PET*!!”

Adora gasped in shock and recoiled, expression hurt. Catra turned and stormed off.

“I...can't believe she said that to me,” Adora whispered, sniffling and wiping her eye. “I'm not buying her those expensive treats anymore- okay wait I kinda see her point. Still hurts though.”

Sniffling some more, she turned and froze in place as a bunch of red eyes appeared behind her. She readied herself to fight, multiple robot spiders skittering forward to give her...

...A Kleenex.

"Oh, gosh, thank you." She noisily blew her nose as another spider patted her shoulder. "It's fine, I know she didn't really mean it- *wait what am I doing*-" She held up her sword. "*For the honor of* -"

A string of webbing shot out and yanked the sword out of her hand. Adora stood there for a long moment, arm upraised awkwardly.

"...Can I have that back please-"

-Meanwhile...-

Catra stomped down the hallway, angrily searching for an exit.

"I have had *enough* of this bullshit," she muttered to herself. "Today can officially kiss my-"

A branch swung out of nowhere, but she ducked just in time.

"Ha! Fuck you, branch! You think I'm dumb enough to-"

And then she was bitch-slapped by a flashback.

-Flashback!-

Young Catra huddled on her bunk in the Horde barracks, a blanket pulled over her head. Adora quietly entered the room and sat next to her.

“Catra, are you okay?” She reached over and gently pulled the blanket off. Catra hissed at her, flinching away.

“Leave me alone!” She tugged at the collar around her neck, the tags jingling softly. “I look so *dumb* with this stupid thing on.”

“I know you don't like it,” Adora told her, “but it's Shadow Weaver's rule. Plus, it's got my number and address in case you get lost.” She took Catra's hand. “We’re gonna get through this together, okay? I will *always* take care of you.”

“...Promise?” Catra asked, sniffling.

“I promise.” Adora gave her a warm smile, which Catra returned. “Now let’s go for a walk.” She held up a leash.

“Aw, man!”

“Also we gotta put on booties I don't want your little paws getting cold-”

“*SERIOUSLY*?!”

-End Flashback!-

Catra stood there for a long, quiet moment.

“...Yeah fuck this.”

-Elsewhere...-

Adora, meanwhile, was still valiantly fighting the spiders – *verbally* . Cuz, you know, they still had her sword.

“Come on, you guys, give it back! I asked nicely!” She huffed in annoyance. “I'm telling on you when I talk to Light Hope. You’re gonna be in SO much trouble!” She paused for a moment, blinking. “Wow, Catra was right, I guess I *am* kind of a brown-noser.” One of the spiders suddenly shoved her off a ledge and she dangled there, clutching some webbing. “YOU'RE GONNA BE SUSPENDED FOR THIS!” She paused again. “...I understand the irony of this situation-”

There were crashes and bangs from above as the spiders were defeated, and then Catra sauntered up, Adora's sword in her hand.

“Heyyyy, Adora,” she drawled, her eyes glinting dangerously.

“Catra!” Adora cried with relief. “Good, you're here. Now, quick, help me up, and make sure to use your *legs* , you don't want to strain anything-”

“Why do you always treat me like that?” Catra cut her off, idly running a sharp nails down the sword's edge. “Like I'm some dumb animal. You always made me feel *weak*. Like I *needed* you. That's what you wanted, isn't it? A cute little pet to take care of.”

“Well who else is gonna clip your nails when they get too long I can *see 'em* from here Catra- you know what this probably isn’t helping I’ll stop now-”

“I’ve spent all this time hoping that you'd come back to the Horde,” Catra went on, “when really, you leaving was the *best* thing that ever happened to me.” She swung the sword and cut the webs from Adora 's grasp. She fell with a shocked cry, grabbing the wall and gaping up at her in confusion.

“Catra! What are you *doing*?”

“Isn't it obvious?” Catra sneered down at her. “Girl, I'm dumping you.”

“... *What*?!”

“Yeah, this relationship was *super* toxic and I think I'll be *much* happier on my own. I need to focus on *myself* and really mature and grow as a person.” Catra smirked. “Also, I threw all your shit in a dumpster.”

“*Not my favorite boots you bitch* - no, wait!” Adora stopped herself. “Look, Catra, I’m sorry if I treated you like a pet, or made you feel like second-best...but maybe if you put some actual effort in or had the motivation to truly apply yourself-”

Catra hurled the sword at her. It missed her head by an inch and fell clattering down the pit.

“...See you can’t even do THAT right,” Adora gabbled on. “Now what you want to do is cock your arm at a ninety degree angle and throw with your *hips-”*

Catra hurled her collar and tags next. They smacked her right between the eyes.

“Ow! What the hell? Why'd you throw that away? How else will people know to call me if-” Catra turned and walked away. “Hey! Where do you think you're going?! Get back here right now! Sit! Stay!! *HEEL* - oh shit I'm doing it again.” She paused, clearing her throat. “Um, Catra? Could you come back, please? I'll give you a treat- no, fuck, I mean...if...you feel like it? Totally okay if you don't, I'll understand-”

Light Hope appeared on the ledge above her.

“Adora,” she said, “you must let go.”

“I *can’t* !” Adora burst into tears. “This is a very emotional time for me! I'm having strong feelings of betrayal and abandonment-”

“Bitch I'm not your therapist.” Light Hope frowned down at her. “I mean literally just LET GO.”

“...Oh. Okay.” She let go of the wall and fell. “*Wait why did I agree to this* -”

-Later...-

Back at the Horde fortress, Entrapta was busy installing a microwave into Emily while Scorpia chatted on and on.

“-our date was *awesome* we went on a boat ride and there were fireworks and I even kissed her a little- ooh, here, I took pictures.” She held up her phone to show her giving an unconscious Catra mouth-to-mouth, a Horde boat exploding in the background. “It was SO romantic.”

The door opened and Catra trudged in, roughed up and slumped over in exhaustion.

“Babe, you're back!” Scorpia cried excitedly, running over to her. “Oh no, what happened to you? You're filthy and covered in boo-boos! Do you want me to kiss it better?”

“Touch me and I'll claw your face off,” Catra hissed at her.

“You're such a tease,” Scorpia giggled, blushing.

“Did you get the goods?” Entrapta cut in impatiently, scratching her neck and twitching. “I’m *tweaking* here!”

“Who let the Princess out of her shackles?” Catra demanded.

“Oops! Sorry, here.” Scorpia scooped Entrapta up and clipped her into a baby harness on her front. “Better?” Catra stared at her blankly.

“...Did you steal that from Hordak-”

“It's just so convenient, see, because then I can keep an eye on her while leaving my arms free to do other stuff.” Scorpia paused. “...Like hug you-”

“I'll claw your arms off next-”

“Now, now, let’s not fight in front of the baby,” Scorpia tutted, gently patting Entrapta's head. Catra rolled her eyes.

“Whatever. Here’s your fix, you tech addict.” She tossed the stolen goods to Entrapta, who snatched it up eagerly.

“An intact data crystal?! Score!!” She placed it on a spoon and flicked on a lighter. “*Don't look at me like that I can stop anytime I want* -”

“Hey, where's *my* present?” Scorpia asked, pincers on her hips. “Flowers, chocolate? *Anything* ?”

“Yeah, I left a 'present' for you to clean up in my litterbox,” Catra snapped at her. “Anyway, I'm tired. I'm gonna go take a nap.”

“Speaking of naps, looook, she’s *sleeping* !” Scorpia cooed delightfully. Entrapta had fallen asleep in the harness, sucking on the crystal like a pacifier, her arms and legs dangling limply as she snored. “Awww, they're so *cute* when they're asleep-”

“Yeah uh-huh whatever just keep it down.” Catra started for the door.

“They grow up so- oh, *pyew* , I think it's time to change her diaper.” Scorpia made a face. “I've been watching her all day you think you could help me with-”

The door slammed shut.

“...God I love her,” Scorpia said dreamily.

-Episode 11 End-

Chapter End Notes

we gettin gayer folks

No Hope

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora fell screaming down the bottomless pit, dropping deeper into the bowels of the ancient ruin. Snippets of her memories played out on the walls as she plummeted, arms and legs flailing uselessly.

"AAAAAA- so that's where I left my keys- AAAAAAAA- " She blinked and suddenly found herself standing in an empty room. Her scream slowly trailed off as she looked around, relaxing. "Phew...thank *God* that's over-"

"Hello, Adora," someone said from behind her.

"AAAAAAAA!" Adora whirled around and lashed out with her sword. "How many times do I have to stab you before you LEARN, Light Hope?!" She paused, frowning as she studied the person she'd just plunged her sword into. This wasn't a sex-doll-looking hologram, this almost looked like a living person, a tall woman with a shaved head and a purple hooded robe. "Wait...Light Hope? It...IS you, right? I'm not hallucinating? Is this real or- wait a second. Am I *dead*?" Her frown deepened. "It...*would* explain my life flashing before my eyes- *oh my God are you Jesus*-"

"I can be, if you like." The woman changed shape, becoming a robed man with a beard and long hair. "Or perhaps you would prefer something else." She changed into Beyonce and started singing Crazy in Love. "*Got me lookin' so crazy right now, your love's got me lookin' so crazy right now*-"

"*Oh my God Bow was right*- I mean...can you just change back to normal?" Adora asked.

“I have been waiting for you since you were an infant,” Light Hope said, reverting to her original form, “but I could not reach you, and I could not protect you from the Horde. Instead, I watched you grow up from afar...” She lowered her head sadly.

“Aww...” Adora's expression softened. “You did? That’s so-”

Hundreds of screens popped up, revealing hidden camera footage from the Horde fortress of Adora's childhood, bathroom breaks included.

“...*terrifying*,” Adora finished uncomfortably. “I did NOT consent to that.”

“I also killed several soldiers and wore their skin like flesh-bags-”

“OKAY seriously what the FUCK lady that is some Silence of the Lambs shit-”

“Forgive me, my human programming is several years out of date,” Light Hope said, then dabbed.

“Please...don’t...*ever*...do that again,” Adora said slowly, looking sick.

“Is that not acceptable? How about this?” She began to do 'The Floss'.

“**Huuuurk*!*” Adora doubled over.

-Meanwhile...-

Back at Bright Moon, Glimmer paced around her bedroom, worried and frantic.

“What is *taking* so long?” she burst out. “Seriously, we've been waiting forever! How long are we supposed to just SIT here?!”

“The Dominos App says they'll be here in six minutes,” Bow said, holding up his phone.

“Not the fucking pizza, Bow! I mean *Adora*!!”

“...Oh.” He blinked. “...I don't have an app for that-”

“We can’t just sit around and wait for her to get back,” Glimmer ranted on. “We have to DO something!”

“...You want to make her some cookies as a surprise?” Bow suggested.

“Did someone say *cookies*?!” The door suddenly burst open and the rainbow-winged unicorn from earlier galloped in, shaking out his luxurious mane. “L'oreal, because *I'm worth it*-”

“Holy shit our horse can *talk*?!” Bow gaped in shock. “Quick, say 'Wilburrr'!”

“I find that *incredibly* offensive-” the horse sniffed.

“I’ll make 'em oatmeal cookies.”

“*WILLLLLBUUUUURRRRR*-”

“Bow, stop being ridiculous. You can't feed a horse *cookies*,” Glimmer interrupted, hands on her hips. “You feed it carrots. They make him run faster, right Epona?”

“How *dare* you?” The horse reared his head in outrage. “I'll have you know my name is Swift Wind and I am an intelligent, sophisticated being, not some *dumb animal-”*

“You’re shitting on the floor,” Bow stated.

“Yeah, what’s your point?” Swift Wind stared at him blankly, tail raised as he continued dropping steamy horse turds. He finally finished and they all stood there for a long, awkward moment. “...Is someone gonna clean that up or what-”

“Couldn't you have used the fountain?” Glimmer pointed over to it.

“Ew, no, that's disgusting. I have *standards*- oh, that looks yummy.” He leaned over and took a bite out of the curtains. “Anyway,” Swift Wind went on, chewing, “I have a feeling that Adora *needs* me. Ever since she gave me this *fabulous* makeover I’ve been able to sense where she is at all times, like some kind of *instinct,* and now I feel a sort of *pull,* almost as if she's calling me to- what are you doing?”

“...Braiding your mane,” Bow said, standing next to him.

“Oh well by all means continue. Do my tail while you're at it.”

“Sure!” Bow went back to braiding. “Do you prefer normal or French?”

“Hold on what were you saying about Adora?” Glimmer interrupted.

“Okay so I think she’s in trouble or something and we need to go help but like honestly it can wait oh my God are those *barrettes*-”

“Yeah, look, they have little butterflies on them-”

“Forget the fucking barrettes!” Glimmer shouted at them. “We’re coming with you to help Adora- *ah*!” She winced as she glitched for a moment.

“Glimmer, you can’t go,” Bow said with concern. “You’re still glitching.”

"Ew. *Glitching*? What is that? Is that infectious?" Swift Wind stomped a hoof nervously. "I'm not sure if I want her sitting on me if it's infectious, I don't want to catch it. I mean we *could* wrap her up in plastic like a giant condom-"

"Adora left to try and learn how to help me, so it's only fair that I go to help her," Glimmer pointed out, not backing down.

"Alright, fine," Bow sighed in resignation, "but I don't think your mom's gonna like it if we leave *right* after we just got back."

"That's why we're *not* gonna tell her," Glimmer said with a wink, opening her door.

"Not tell me what?" Queen Angella asked, standing right outside in the hall.

Glimmer slammed the door shut in her face.

"Mother FUCKER!" She started shoving Bow towards the broken window. "Hurry, jump! Break your legs if you have to-"

"I can *hear* you," Angella said through the door, "and you'd better believe you're going to be punished for language. You do *not* talk about your father like that!"

"Oh my God GO GO GO I need you to break my fall-"

"Alright, enough." Angella barged in, fixing her daughter with a stern look as she lifted a dainty boot covered in poop. "Care to explain yourself, young lady?"

"...What?" Glimmer made a face. "Mom, no, that wasn't *me*! That was the talking horse!"

"Talking horse?" Her mother scoffed. "You expect me to believe that? That is the most *ridiculous* lie I have ever-" There was a snort from behind and she paused, then slowly turned around to come face-to-face with Swift Wind.

"Guuuurl, you have got some busted-ass wings. They hella fugly," he said. "Get. On. My. Level. *Biiiiitch~*"

"Okay first of all my wings are *flawless*," Queen Angella clapped back, "second of all, Glimmer, good job covering your bases and teaching this horse to talk. Third of all, you need to get going if you want to help Adora." She swept an arm towards the door. Glimmer gaped at her in shock.

"Wait…you're just...letting us go? Without ankle monitors or anything?" She frowned. "...Did you insert a tracking chip somewhere inside me?" Her voice dropped to a horrified whisper. "...Is...is it in my butt-"

"Glimmer," Angella cut in, touching her daughter's face lovingly, "I realize now that you are a strong, independent young woman, and I *respect* you and believe in your ability to make good decisions." She paused. "Now here are some healthy lunches that I packed for each of you plus extra snacks and a pair of clean underwear – just in case - and some water bottles so you stay hydrated and make *sure* you're back before dark because that's when the perverts come out-"

"Oh my God *MOOOOMMM-*" Glimmer groaned in embarrassment. "Thanks love you bye!" She grabbed the stuff and gave her mother a quick kiss on the cheek before running out the door, Bow in tow. Swift Wind followed after them, pausing next to the Queen.

"When we get back, I *will* be burning your stables to the ground and freeing my equine brethren from their unjust life of servitude-" Bow grabbed him by the tail and dragged him off. "*THE HORSE UPRISING IS NIGH-*"

-In the Fright Zone-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Catra angrily stormed into a room, lip curling up in a sneer.

“What the FUCK do you want?” she demanded.

“…You,” Scorpia blurted out, frozen in place, her eyes wide.

“I'm not talking to you!” Catra barked at her, glaring around the room. “I'm talking to the Princess of Nerdopolis or whatever. The fuck is she?” The vent in the ceiling suddenly crashed open and Entrapta fell out, hitting the ground with a splat.

“EMERGENCY MEETING PURPLE VENTED-” Scorpia sputtered, slapping at the alarm button.

“Oh, good, you got my note!” Entrapta said excitedly as she sat up.

“Bitch, this is a *thesis*,” Catra snarled, slamming a thick binder down on the table. “Can't you just send a fucking *text*?”

“I kept it brief!” Entrapta protested.

“Look, just start talking before I'm overcome by the urge to kill you- wait, nevermind, there it is-” Catra unsheathed her claws and started towards her.

“I just wanted to let you know that I am making *great* strides in analyzing the data from the First One's data crystal you brought,” Entrapta explained, rolling away on a computer chair just as Catra lunged. Oblivious, she rolled around the room, punching random buttons and plugging in wires, then placing the data crystal into a slot. A nearby computer lit up, a bunch of diagnostics scrolling across the screen. “Just look at these readings! It confirms my theories on the techno-organic nature of First One's machinery resulting in thaumaturlogical compatibility between magic and science-”

“Okay, STOP.” Catra held up a hand. “We're going to need you to translate that into dumbass.” She paused. “Not for me, though. It's for...Scorpia.”

“Oh, no, I understood perfectly,” Scorpia said, scribbling some notes on a pad and adjusting her glasses. Catra gaped at her.

“The *fuck* you doing with those?”

“Trying to see if you have a glasses kink- I mean, er, taking notes.”

“Bullshit!” Catra narrowed her eyes. “...You’re drawing titties or something.” Scorpia held up the pad to show several pages covered in complicated calculations. “...There's no way you actually understand-” Scorpia moved over to a small lab complete with vials and a Bunsen burner and started mixing different-colored chemicals in test tubes. With a poof, there was a reaction, the resulting liquid turning a bright pink. She gave Catra a sultry look over her safety goggles.

“Hey, girl, I've just made the most powerful aphrodisiac-” A drop fell out of the tube and hit the floor, bubbling and hissing as it ate a hole in the metal. “...Okay my bad it's acid but can we still fuck-”

“It’s for ME, okay?!” Catra burst out, throwing her hands up. “Me! I'm fucking dumb! Are you *happy* now?!”

“Oh, don't worry, I can simplify the process!” Entrapta cleared her throat and began to speak very slowly, enunciating carefully. “Me...look with eyes...at rock...” She pointed to her eyes, then the data crystal, using exaggerated gestures. “Me...use math...” She paused. “One plus one equals-”

“Okay, I'm not *that* fucking dumb,” Catra snapped. “You’re going too deep into dumbass, I need you to bring it UP a few levels. Did that crystal give you enough data to upgrade our weapons or not?”

“Forget about weapons!” Entrapta wiggled in her seat, eyes wide with excitement. “This could change *everything*! Turns out Etheria isn't just a planet. Whatever the First Ones did to it...it went *deep*. Like...*deep government*.” Catra stared at her blankly.

“...Like...*what*?”

“You’re...asking me about my conspiracy theories?” Entrapta squealed delightedly. “Here, let me show you! I made models and a PowerPoint presentation and dioramas and I used Legos at one point-” She seized them each by a pigtail and dragged them off into the vents.

“*I told you she was sus*!!” Scorpia screamed as she was pulled in.

-Back With Adora-

Meanwhile, back at the Beacon, Adora was being led around by the woman calling herself Light Hope, though Adora was still doubtful.

“Hey, lady,” she said, “I don’t want to be rude but...the fuck *are* you, bish?”

“I am Light Hope,” the woman repeated calmly. “Etheria's facilitator. I was created by the First Ones. They were explorers who came from beyond the stars to settle here-”

“Oh, great, colonizers,” Adora huffed in disgust. “Seriously, go back to your own planet-”

“They built this place, the Crystal Castle, just for you.” Light Hope raised her hands and the lights came on, revealing a large workout room filled with glittering crystals, a jacuzzi and mini-fridge in the corner.

"...Maybe they weren't so bad-"

"I have waited so long for you." Light Hope guided Adora over to an impressive mural of She-blah on the wall. "I made you this."

"Wow, really?" Adora blinked. "That's-"

"And this." Light Hope held up a disturbingly life-like doll of She-blah.

"Whoa!" Adora recoiled in horror. "That's, uhh…*nice*. How…did you make it?"

"I used %100 natural, organic and recycled materials," Light Hope stated.

"Wait, what does that mean?" Adora asked nervously. "You didn't use, like, real living people to make that, right?"

"Of course not."

"Okay, phew-"

"They were dead."

"BITCH HOLD ON *WHAT*-" Adora sputtered.

"They died of natural causes," Light Hope went on.

"So you just…*found* some dead bodies and used them?"

"Oh, no. I killed them. So naturally they died."

Adora just stood there, horrified.

"…I mean you're right but you're also *SO SO WRONG*-"

"Now the time has come to show you your destiny," Light Hope abruptly changed the subject. "You are She-blah, Etheria's champion, appointed by the First Ones to protect and unite our

planet. There have been many before you, but the line was broken.” She looked at Adora sorrowfully. “You are the first She-blah in a thousand years.”

Adora stared at her.

“...Okay but I'm the coolest one right-”

-Aaaand Back to Catra-

“...and so the government is run by lizard people, Bush did 911,” Entrapta was explaining enthusiastically, “and the world is actually *flat*-”

“Hey, I have a question,” Catra cut in. “Do we HAVE to do this in the vents?”

All three of them were stuffed inside a narrow vent like sardines. Scorpia wasn't complaining, though. She was pretty sure her claw was touching Catra's butt- no wait that was Entrapta's she'd have to remember to wash it later-

“Are you not comfortable?” Entrapta asked, confused.

A rat scurried over her foot.

“...Not really, no-”

“Oh, fine!” Entrapta banged a fist on the wall and the vent beneath them opened, depositing them into a room with a large model of the planet. “Okay, here's my diagram of Etheria, which, as you can see, I constructed by compressing kitty litter-”

“Is *that* where all of it went?!” Catra glared at her. “I had to shit on the toilet like a disgusting *human*. I had to use *toilet*

paper. Do you have any idea how gross that- wait never mind you shit your pants on the daily of course you don't-”

“Hey, I'll have you know these diapers are working *wonders* for me,” Entrapta argued hotly. “So anyway this is Etheria. The cat turds represent the First Ones technology that runs throughout its core. The whole *planet* is the First Ones tech! Isn't that so amazing? Who *else* is horny?!” She threw up a hand and looked around expectantly.

Scorpia paused, then slowly raised hers.

-Back to...Adora...-

“Everything on Etheria is connected,” Light Hope continued. “The Princesses are granted power over the elements through their Runestones. It is your duty as She-blah to bring them together. Only then can balance be restored to Etheria-”

“Skip!” Adora said suddenly. Light Hope kept talking. “SKIP!” She still wouldn’t shut up. “Godammit, this stupid cutscene is unskippable. I don’t care about Runestones! I’m sure they’re not important.”

-Catra (okay I'm seriously getting real nauseous here)-

“Runestones are *extremely* important,” Entrapta was explaining. “They regulate the planet through the Princesses. They’re also connected to each other and to Etheria's power grid like human batteries - which brings me to my Matrix theory-”

"Just tell me what it all means!" Catra interrupted impatiently.

"It means they're our best access point to..." Entrapta lowered her voice. "…*hack the planet*."

-Ador- *_HUUURK_*-

"When the Princesses and their elements are in balance," Light Hope babbled on, oblivious to Adora frantically poking at her chest and face in a vain attempt to find the 'skip' button, "Etheria functions as it should, but the Horde is destroying us in their quest for power." She waved a hand and showed multiple images of the Horde attacking forests and towns with their lasers and tanks, reducing parts of the planet a desolate wasteland, littering, and leaving their cell-phone chargers plugged in-

"Alright, I found the skip button," Adora said, holding up her fist. "It certainly works in normal conversation." She swung and it passed straight through Light Hope's face. "…God-fucking-dammit."

-Cat- *_HOOOOOOOGHHH_*-

"Hack. The *planet*?" Catra repeated slowly, a look of disbelief on her face. "That's the *dumbest* thing I've ever heard, and Scorpia here told me we'd make a cute couple."

"…Why you gotta play me like this, boo?" Scorpia whispered mournfully.

"It won't be easy," Entrapta went on. "There's only a few Runestones in the entire world. It'll take me *months* of searching before I even know where to *find* one-"

"Out the hallway and to the left," Scorpia said matter-of-factly. Catra and Entrapta looked at her. "…You know. The Black Garnet." They gaped. "I'm a Princess, remember? My family had it and we gave it to Hordak because he asked so nicely-"

"You have a RUNESTONE?!" Entrapta shrieked, beginning to vibrate excitedly. "Where is it?! *Can I see it can I touch it can I lick it*-" Okay nevermind she's just horny again ew.

"What would you even DO with it?" Catra asked. Entrapta's eyes went wide and she opened her mouth.

"Well *first* I'd get some lube-"

"LEMME STOP YOU RIGHT THERE." Catra cut her off. "I meant *non-sexually*."

"Well, if I hack the Runestone grid, we could boost the Garnet's power and use it as a power source," Entrapta said, thinking fast, "or even a weapon! Although there's a big chance it might just explode and I would die in fiery agony-"

"Sounds perfect! It's a win-win! Let's go." Catra clapped her hands together.

"Uh, I dunno if Shadow Weaver's gonna like that," Scorpia began hesitantly.

"Even better! Now we're *definitely* gonna do it!" Catra chuckled evilly, her laughter echoing up into the rafters where, unbeknownst to them, Hordak's evil little imp baby was sitting, watching them creepily. "…Why do I smell poop. Entrapta, for Christ's sake, go wipe again."

-**Gasp Pant*...Back to…Adora...-

Adora, meanwhile, was now beating her head against the wall as Light Hope droned on and on about She-blah history, describing each of the thousand past She-blah's in excruciating detail.

"-her favorite color was purple, and her shoe size was-"

"Oh my God, ENOUGH!!" Adora shouted, whirling around, a trickle of blood running down her forehead. "I don't give a FUCK about planetary balance and stupid stones and other shit! All I want is to learn how to heal my friend!"

"That's simple. Her connection to her Runestone has been disrupted," Light Hope said. "You can *certainly* learn to heal your friend-"

"I can?!" Adora perked up. "Alright, awesome!"

"...through strenuous training."

"Alright not so awesome." Adora slumped. "How long will this take?"

"About five-"

"Five minutes? Great, let's get started!"

"...*hundred years*."

"Holy FUCK can you please stop getting my hopes up?"

"Well maybe you should stop cutting me off then, *bitch*," Light Hope snapped back. Adora blinked. "Apologies, I have a clap-back subroutine. Would you like me to uninstall?"

"Look, I'm only here to fix my friend, not the planet," Adora snorted. "I'm not Smoky the fucking Bear-" Smokey the Bear leaned around the corner, giving her the stink-eye. "...How the fuck did you even get in here please don't hurt me-"

"You are She-blah," Light Hope said simply. "Your purpose is to protect all of Etheria. You do not realize the importance of your role. You are distracted by your attachments. The last She-blah, Mara, had attachments as well." Her eyes glowed red. "… Until I *eliminated* them."

"Wait, Mara? She's *real*?" Adora gaped. "So you're telling me that crazy old lady *wasn't* batshit- *hold on you did what now*-"

"Mara struggled to control the power of She-blah," Light Hope continued. "Eventually it became too much for her and she put in her two-week notice, stranding us here in the empty dimension Despandos. She broke the She-blah line, nearly destroying us. Please, Adora, you must stay here with me. I will train you to be a better She-blah than Mara could ever be. I will make you happy, cook your favorite meals and rub your feet-"

"Look, lady," Adora cut in, "it's obvious you had a bad break-up with your last She-blah. I think you need to take some time to focus on *you* and work through some issues. I am *not* ready for this commitment. Now stop trying to manipulate me into staying."

"I'm not manipulating you," Light Hope said. "Here are some videos of all your friends suffering from your association." Various screens lit up, showing Bow, Glimmer, and the other Princesses all in various stages of pain and agony.

"BITCH WHAT THE *FUCK*-"

"Don't you see?" Light Hope pressed. "Your friends are endangered by your very presence. You should just stay here. Forget them. They can't love you like I can-"

"For the last time, I'm *not* leaving them!" Adora shouted back.

"Very well. I understand." Light Hope paused. "Could you tell me their address? I want to send them a…thank-you card."

"Oh, sure, they live at- WAIT A SECOND."

-Back to Catra-

Entrapta crouched in front of the Black Garnet in Shadow Weaver's room, busily working with a blowtorch and plugging in wires, her mask flipped down over her face.

"Uh…a little help?" Scorpia was flopping around on her back, tangled in some wires like a big dumb kitten. "No wait this is kinda sexy right-"

"What's taking so fucking long?" Catra barked, tapping her foot impatiently. "Hurry it up before-"

Shadow Weaver suddenly walked in, her arms full of groceries.

Everyone froze for a long, awkward moment.

"…Hey there how ya doing we're just performing some routine maintenance on the Black Garnet here," Scorpia blurted out, snipping herself free and hurrying over to the crystal. "Cleaning and buffing it for you, the usual. We'll even throw in a free waxing!" She hawked and spat on it, rubbing absently. "Nothing at all to be alarmed about, this is perfectly normal- oh ew this thing is *filthy*-" She pulled out a bottle of Windex and a squeegee and started spraying it down.

"Catra!" Shadow Weaver rounded on her, looming ominously. "How DARE you enter my personal chambers and touch my things!"

"Fuck your stupid rock," she hissed back, eyes narrowed to slits. "It's mine now. I peed on it and everything."

"Is *that* what this stain is?" Scorpia asked. "Man, it is NOT coming out." She bent over, scrubbing harder. "I think I might need a Mr. Clean Magic Eraser or even some bleach-"

"Did you get permission from Lord Hordak-" Shadow Weaver began.

"I *didn't*, actually," Catra corrected.

"Then WHY-"

"Because fuck you that's why."

"Catra and Entrapta, good job on your new science project!" Hordak said proudly, appearing on the computer screen mounted on the wall. "I see you've been working hard on a way to combine First Ones' tech with our machines to weaponize it. You'll win the Science Fair's trophy for sure!"

"You're really going to let her *tinker* with my Runestone?!" Shadow Weaver cried in outrage.

"Of course, we don't want to stifle their academic growth! They need to be allowed free reign for them to truly blossom. They get to do whatever they want to the Black Garnet," Hordak said, then turned to Entrapta. "And also could you look at my laptop sometime it's running like *super* slow, the fan is *screaming* right now and I don't know why-"

"Probably all the porn you're watching," the imp baby said, popping up.

"*Shhh*, you're in timeout," Hordak said, pushing it away.

"You can't DO this!!" Shadow Weaver shouted. "The Black Garnet is MINE! *I* got it in the divorce and *you* got to keep the kid! I even let you keep the damn *pet* even though I wanted to get rid of it!" She pointed accusingly at Catra, who flipped her off in return.

“Oh, this is *just* like you,” Hordak scoffed. “You're being ridiculous right now. Mother was right about you-”

“You don’t respect boundaries! Plus you never helped with the dishes!”

“ME?! *You're* the one who can’t change a diaper-” Hordak began, lifting the little imp baby.

“Do NOT bring the children into this!”

“Guys, stop it! I hate it when you fight!” Scorpia said, bursting into tears.

“Why are you so upset about us messing with your dumb crystal?” Catra asked. “It’s not like we’re going to *break* it-”

**Crack*!*

Everyone turned to see Entrapta holding a jackhammer up to the Black Garnet, an innocent expression on her face.

“…Don’t mind me-”

“*NO*!!” Shadow Weaver lunged forward, shadows flailing everywhere, smashing things to pieces.

“There she goes again, throwing a fit because she’s not getting what she wants,” Hordak sighed. “Catra, take her out-”

Catra slugged her. Shadow Weaver collapsed to the floor, her mask broken in two.

“…I meant to dinner. Food calms her down. Somewhere nice, classy, but not too expensive. But that works too.” Hordak waved. “Keep up the good work, girls!” The screen winked off.

“Can I have her for spare parts?” Entrapta was suddenly standing over Shadow Weaver with a chainsaw. “I promise I won't

make a mess.” Everyone just stared at her. “...Okay I will but I'll clean it up I swear-”

“What are you making, a bitchy Frankenstein? Just stuff her in a garbage disposal.” Shaking her head, Catra turned to find Scorpia huddled in a corner, sucking her thumb. “...The fuck are you doing.”

“Is it over?” Scorpia asked timidly. “Are they done fighting? Can’t we all just hug and get along?” She stared up a Catra. “…Maybe kiss a little?”

“You can kiss my ass, you big baby.”

“…*Promise*?”

“You’re so fucking weird.”

“Speaking of weird, here we go!” Entrapta cried, throwing a few more switches and rushing over to a computer console, typing away. “Let’s get *freaky*!”

“...Okay which freaky are we talking about?” Scorpia raised a claw. “Like scary freaky or sex freaky? Because if it's the latter I'm gonna need a safe word. I know, let’s use ‘lemonade’!”

The Black Garnet powered up with an ominous buzz, then blasted a black column of light up into the sky. Red lightning began to rain down around the fortress.

“Lemonade! *LEMONADE*!!”

-With the Incredibly Gay Stallion...and Swift Wind and Glimmer lol-

Meanwhile, Glimmer, Bow, and Swift Wind were trudging through the Whispering Woods, searching for Adora.

"…and that's when I bit the guy's face off and freed all of his horses," Swift Wind was saying proudly. "The guy was basically a slave trader. Plus, he was ugly. I did you all a favor-"

"Oh my God cool story bro- *I am SO scared right now*," Bow turned and whispered to Glimmer. "Could you *please* walk next to him for a little while?"

"And smell his nasty horse breath?" Glimmer scoffed. "I don't think so!"

"Yeah, keep your distance, I don't wanna catch your magic herpes or whatever," Swift Wind said. "So anyway I kicked *another* guy so hard in the dick it inverted into a vagina-"

"Whoa!!" Bow yelped in surprise as a group of weird alien deer suddenly burst out of the bushes in front of them.

"Brethren!!" Swift Wind gasped. "Would you like to join me in my equine protest-" They ran right by. "Hey! Don't ignore me! You need to get *woke*, bitches! Check your privilege!!"

"What's going on?" Glimmer wondered aloud.

There was a low rumble, and then the huge bug monster from their first meeting with Adora crashed through the trees, heading straight towards them.

"OH SHIT LOOK OUT!!" Bow shrieked, diving for cover. "It wants to devour our delicious fleshy bodies-" The bug ran right on by as well. "…Oh my God RUDE. Any other monster would be *happy* to eat this!" Bow shouted after it.

"Bow stop-"

"Come on, Glimmer, it just ran by us like we were *nothing*, not even a snack! Aren't you insulted just a *little* bit?"

"You guys, something's wrong!" Swift Wind said, prancing around in agitation and tossing his mane. "I feel something deep in my gut...some kind of *strange pressure*-"

**Frrrrrrrt!*

"…Oh thank God I feel SO much better-"

"Can we just fucking find Adora PLEASE?!" Bow wailed, pinching his nostrils shut.

"Oh please, I've smelled worse from you after taco night." Ignoring Bow's outraged gasp, Glimmer grabbed his hand and Swift Wind's wing and dragged them deeper into the woods. "Let's GO!"

-Back to the Fright Zone-

Back at the Horde Fortress, the Black Garnet continued to crackle with sinister power.

"Amazing," Entrapta cooed excitedly. "The Garnet is siphoning energy at an *insane* rate, and it's *still* climbing!"

"...Are we gonna have to pay the energy bill for this?" Scorpia asked. She pulled out a calculator and started hitting buttons. "I don't know if we can afford this-"

"Fuck it!" Catra said impatiently, smacking it out of her claws. "We're sending the bill to Hordak! Keep going!"

-Aaand Back to the Whispering Woods-

“Ugh.” Bow suddenly shivered, rubbing his arms for warmth. “Is it just me, or is it getting really cold all of a sudden?”

“You're wearing a sleeveless crop top in the woods at night,” Glimmer pointed out.

“…And? What’s your point? I know I’m adorable, honey.” He gave her a look. “...But seriously though get over here and cuddle with me or something-”

White flakes began to drift down from the clouds above, slowly blanketing the forest.

“It's...*snowing*?” Glimmer said, her eyes wide with wonder.

“That's impossible!” Bow protested. “It *never* snows in the Whispering Woods! Not even that winter I asked Santa-”

There was a sudden blast of frigid wind and the clouds above lit up with bolts of red lightning.

“I knew I should have asked for an X-box!” Bow shouted. “I’m getting a refund, you jolly old fuck!” He and Glimmer crowded up against the horse for shelter. “We can’t stay here! Swift Wind, can you sense Adora?”

“Bitch, I don’t *need* to!” Swift Wind tossed his mane. “I could follow the smell of her *disgusting* deodorant all the way from Bright Moon. Follow me!”

They set off, struggling through the woods as they made their way towards a faint light in the distance. Finally they stumbled out of the tree-line to find the ancient ruin, the beacon still blazing up top, and started pounding on the walls.

“Let us in! Let us *innnnn*!” Glimmer shouted, grabbing the fence and shaking it.

“God I miss Vine,” Swift Wind muttered. “Seriously, though, open the fuck UP!”

“Guys, we’re being really aggressive,” Bow said thoughtfully. “Maybe if we knock *softly* they won’t be scared and let us in- oh my GOD we haven’t even said *please* what are we *animals*-”

“Let me handle this!” Swift Wind shouldered his way in front of them, facing the door.

“Oh, awesome,” Bow said, “are you going to use some of your new magical-”

He turned and kicked the door down.

“...You really ARE connected to Adora.” Glimmer blinked. “Let's go!” They hurried inside out of the storm, emerging into a larger chamber.

“Adora!” Bow cried, seeing her lying unconscious on a crystal table, her sword and a glass of water at her side. They gathered around her and paused. “Okay, well, it looks like one of us is going to have to wake her up with a magic kiss. I'm looking at you Glimmer, *you're* the Princess.” He patted her shoulder. “Use that tongue thing that I taught you-”

“Oh my God, NO!” Glimmer cried, aghast.

“Why, cuz she’s a girl?”

“I haven’t brushed my teeth, like, *all* day and my breath is *horrible*-”

“Oh. Here, babygirl, I gotchu.” Bow hawked and spat out a wad of gum from his mouth into Glimmer’s. She caught it and started chewing noisily.

“You two are fucking disgusting,” Swift Wind stated. “Don’t worry, I’ve got this.” He leaned towards Adora. “I’m sure

my tongue technique is *far* superior to yours-”

“*Nooooo*!” Glimmer and Bow screamed in horror.

-With Adora-

Adora, meanwhile, was still trapped in the simulation, trying to talk to Light Hope, who had begun to glitch and lag, walking into a wall.

“God, what is your problem? I’m not even using Wi-Fi!” Adora grumbled, taking out her cellphone. “I have like two bars right now!”

“Adora!”

“Great, now you sound like a *dude*. I’m going on Airplane mode-” Light Hope suddenly flickered and disappeared, replaced by Swift Wind, and she gasped delightedly. “Oh my God, baby, I missed you so much! I'm so glad to see you-”

“Sweetie,” Swift Wind cut her off, “I'm gay as fuck, if the sparkly horn and rainbow wings didn't tip you off already. Plus I fart glitter. Hurts a little, to be honest.” He paused, looking her up and down. “Also your hair is *super* ugly and I can see your chin-hairs from here. How about I return the favor and give *you* a makeover?”

Adora stared at him in horror.

“...I liked you better when you didn't talk.”

“Same, bitch. Anyway, I’m here to bust you out.” Swift Wind glanced around. “Where's the exit so we can dip?”

“No, you don't understand,” Adora protested, shaking her head. “Light Hope said I should stay here. I think I she has a point. If I leave, I’ll just make things worse. I have to use my power to help Etheria-”

“That's dumb.”

Adora blinked.

“...What?”

“I said that's dumb,” Swift Wind repeated bluntly. “Fuck Etheria. Be selfish. *Treat* yourself.”

“But....but...!” Adora sputtered.

“No buts!” Swift Wind stamped a hoof. “Treat. Yo. SELF.”

“I *can’t*! I hurt the people around me and ruined my friend's lives-”

“Bitch, what did you *think* friendship meant? Hugs and kisses and holding hands? Bullshit! This is what *true* friendship is – *ruining their fucking lives*. You heard of BFFs? It’s not Best Friends Forever. It’s Besties *Fucked* Forever. Cuz they got you. And they *still* love you anyway.”

“...You’re right,” Adora said quietly. “I’m not like those other She-blahs. I didn’t do this to fulfill some stupid *destiny*. I became She-blah because I randomly wandered into the woods, tripped on a branch and molested a magical sword on accident!” She paused. “...Also to help others and all that corny shit-”

“Yeah, yeah, whatever, no judgment, let's fucking go already.” Swift Wind snorted. “...Jk I’ll still totally be judging you-”

“Seriously, stop talking.” A triangular portal opened up in front of them and Adora shoved him through.

-Several Minutes Later...-

Adora's eyes popped open to find herself laying on the floor, staring up at Bow, Glimmer, and Swift Wind as they crowded around her, their faces tight with concern. There was a long, pregnant pause.

"…Why is there gum in my mouth."

"Sorry," Glimmer said sheepishly, "it must have slipped in there when I was kissing you-"

"You *kissed* me?!" Adora gaped at her in disbelief.

"I know, I'm sorry-"

"When I wasn't even awake to *enjoy* it? Get down here right now missy-"

Glimmer laughed as she was dragged down for more kisses. "Well, you're definitely fine!"

"Hey, save some for me!" Bow cried, joining in on the kissing spree. "Do you like the thing she's doing with her tongue? *I* taught her that!"

"Wow, I'm impressed!" Adora broke away and glanced around. "We should probably get outta here before Light Hope comes back and tries to guilt trip me again. Bitch has attachment issues."

"Ugh, I hear ya, girl. I had an ex just like that!" Bow said. "Let's all jump on Swift Wind and-"

"Try it and I'll bite your face off," Swift Wind stated flatly.

Bow went deathly pale.

"It's cool, guys, you can ride me." Adora said. "*For the honor of Grayskull*!!" She transformed into She-blah and picked her friends up, carrying them outside on her shoulders. The weather had worsened into a raging blizzard and lightning crackled across the sky as the Whispering Woods froze around them, tree branches turning to ice and shattering to pieces. "…On second thought, let's just call an Uber,"

-Horde Fortress One Last Time I Swear-

Back at the Horde Fortress, Catra and Scorpia walked out onto a balcony, watching the red lightning spark ominously along the billowing clouds.

"What do you think it's doing?" Scorpia asked nervously.

"I don't know..." Catra said, her eyes flashing with dark satisfaction, "and I don't *care*."

*Kra-*KOWWWW*!*

"HOLY SHIT THAT GRAZED MY *FUCKING* EAR OKAY I CARE I CARE ALOT GET THE *FUCK* BACK INSIDE-"

-Episode 12 End-

Chapter End Notes

omg just one more Jesus help me

The Butt of Full Moon

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

A bitter wind howled through the Whispering Woods, snow piling up in drifts and a thick layer of ice coating the trees. After a promise of homemade oatmeal cookies, making Glimmer sit on She-blah's lap so she wouldn't contaminate him with her 'Princess Herpes', and starting the fare meter, Swift Wind finally agreed to allow the Best Friend Squad to ride on his back. They all flew up into the sky, gaping in horror at the red lightning boiling across the clouds.

"This *must* be the Horde's doing!" She-blah said, shouting to be heard over the wind. "Whatever's happening, it's *their* fault!"

"OR it's global warming!" Bow argued. "I *told* you guys to recycle but *no-one* listens to me!"

"I don't know what you're talking about," She-blah said, then drank from a bottle of water, glanced around for a garbage can, didn't find one, and tossed it over her shoulder. Bow lunged to catch it and nearly fell off.

"*Bitch that's five cents*-"

"This is awful," Glimmer said sadly, gazing down at the forest below. "Look, the Whispering Woods are freezing over! What should we do?"

"…Would anyone be mad if I suggested a snowball fight?" Bow said after a pause.

"Bow, now is NOT the time-"

A snowball smacked her right in the face. She slowly wiped it off and glared at She-blah and Bow, who froze in place, snowballs in

their hands.

"…Bitch, it's ON."

-In the Fright Zone-

Meanwhile, at the Horde Fortress, Catra had her face pressed against a window, chuckling evilly as she watched the chaos erupt outside with smug satisfaction.

"*Heh heh, can't get me in here, you stupid lightning bitch. I'm safe inside-*"

**Brr-ZAP*!*

"*GAAAAAHH*!" She jumped a foot in the air and whirled around, fur standing on end. "The fuck are you *doing*?!"

"Oh, nothing," Entrapta said innocently. "Just calibrating my taser. While standing right behind you. With no warning. Anyway-" She turned just in time to dodge a swipe of Catra's claws. "You should come see this!" She skipped over to where the Black Garnet crystal was hooked up to multiple wires and computer screens. "Check it out! Fire storms, tidal waves, earthquakes…Etheria is getting *slammed* from all sides! Much like that video I saw while doing research-"

"It's not research, it's porn. It's just porn."

"This *proves* my theory is correct," Entrapta went on obliviously, typing away. She gestured to several screens covered in equations and formulas. "I've been busy doing calculations-"

"…Bitch is that Fortnite?" Catra asked, pointing at one.

"I was cranking some fat nineties- anyhow, to sum it up, we're stealing power from the other Runestones and making the planet freak out." She paused. "…Do…do you need me to dumb that

down even further? I can make some crayon drawings if that helps-" She ducked to grab some crayons just as Catra lunged for her again.

"Wait, hold on." Catra paused, frowning in thought. "If we're *stealing* power from the other Runestones, wouldn't that mean the Princesses are *weakened* right now?"

"Uh-huh!" Entapta nodded in assent. "Oh, but don't worry about me or Scorpia. I don't have a Runestone, and Scorpia doesn't seem to have any connection to the Black Garnet." They both turned to see Scorpia huddled in a corner, screaming and clutching her head.

"*OHHH GOD WHYYYY IT HUUURTS THE PAAAAAIN MAKE IT STOOOOPPPP-"*

"…She'll be fine," Entrapta said. "It's probably just menstrual cramps or something-"

"Hey, I think this thing just knocked out the Wi-Fi, too," Catra said, checking her phone.

"*OHHH GOD WHYYYY-*" Entrapta joined Scorpia in the corner.

"Enough!" Catra snapped at them. "Get your shit together, and then a team together. We're going to Bright Moon to kill everyone."

"Well, that's just *rude* of us," Scorpia said, suddenly beside her. "We're not even going to send them a letter of intent first?" Catra just glared at her.

"…I liked you better when you were screaming."

"Oh, I took some ibuprofen, I'm good. Just cramps is all." Scorpia pulled out a piece of paper and a pencil. "Here, I'll do it for you. 'Dear Rebel Scum, we regret to inform you that we, the Evil Horde, shall be intruding on your borders post haste with ill intent'-"

“Can’t we just send them a dead body?” Catra pointed at Entrapta. “Look, we have a volunteer right here!”

“Don’t be silly,” Scorpia chided her. “Then we’d have to pay a ton of postage. Okay, what sounds better, ‘with love, the Evil Horde’, or ‘respectfully, the Evil Horde’?”

-Meanwhile…-

Back in the Whispering Woods, the Best Friend Squad struggled through the icy storm, buffeted by wind, rain, and snow.

“This is impossible!” Glimmer wailed. “How are we *ever* gonna find our way back home-”

“We can just follow the tracking chip your mom inserted into you,” Bow said, holding up his tablet.

“Godammit I *knew* she put one in me!!” Glimmer huffed in annoyance. “Where is it? It’s up my butt, isn’t it?”

“I have been *sworn* to *secrecy*- yes. Yes it is.”

“DAMMIT, mom!!” Glimmer made a fist and shook it. “You got any more of those granola bars? I’m gonna need some extra fiber.”

“On it!” Bow pulled out a bar and took a bite, chewing furiously. “How thoroughly do you want it chewed? Some chunks, or a fine paste?”

“You know, there’s such a thing as being TOO CLOSE,” Swift Wind snorted.

“I hope you don’t mind, I borrowed your underwear,” Bow said. “Mine were all dirty.”

"Oh, sure. You look better in lace anyway," Glimmer replied, then opened her mouth like a baby bird and started squawking as Bow leaned over.

"Oh my God! ENOUGH! Let's GO before I PUKE!" Swift Wind flapped his wings and, following the tracker in Glimmer's butt, quickly brought them home and dumped them off at the large crystal floating above the Bright Moon fortress. Queen Angella was already there, waiting.

"Mom what the HELL-" Glimmer began heatedly.

"Yes, yes, the thing in your butt, we'll discuss that later. We've got more important things to worry about, sweetie," her mother cut her off. She gestured up at the glowing crystal, which stuttered weakly.

"Aww man, does it need to be replaced? How're we *ever* gonna find another light-bulb so big?" Bow asked.

"That's the fucking Moonstone, Bow," Glimmer said. "Our RUNESTONE. Where we get our POWER from." Bow blinked.

"…Oh. I knew that. I treat it with the utmost respect and *definitely* do not use it to fix my eyeliner or as a personal tanning salon-"

"The elements are out of harmony," Angella explained. "The Moonstone is doing its best to fight against the darkness, but it's not enough. It's taking everything I have just to keep my connection with it!"

"I think I know what's going on." She-blah transformed back to Adora and looked up at the stormy sky. "Those clouds are coming from the Fright Zone." She paused. "I mean…at least I *think* it is." She paused again. "…The Fright Zone is in that direction, right? Hold on, let me check Google Maps-"

"Yes, it IS!" everyone shouted at her impatiently.

"God, bitch, learn geometry!" Swift Wind snapped.

"Look, guys, let's just focus," Bow said. "What's our plan?"

"Well…" Adora looked at the devastated forest. "With the Whispering Woods frozen over, there's nothing left to shield Bright Moon from the Horde. We have to prepare for…an *attack*."

"Yes, you're right." Queen Angella gave a decisive nod. "First things first, we need to-"

"Make me cookies," Swift Wind cut in. The others stared at him. "…You promised." They continued to stare. "…Also you owe me $27.50 plus a tip for the ride."

"Ugh, *fiiiine*," Bow grumbled, pulling on some oven mitts. "Someone pre-heat the oven for me."

-Later That Day-

Later, everyone sat around the large table in the Bright Moon meeting hall, eating cookies and discussing their next plan of action, a 3-D map of the kingdom spread out in front of them.

"Our scouts have already reported seeing the entire Horde army tromping through the Whispering Woods," Bow said, "as well as a lost troop of Boy Scouts."

"Did you buy cookies at least?" Glimmer asked expectantly.

"Bitch I just *made* some-"

"I want Thin Mints!"

"Those are GIRL Scouts-"

"We must protect Bright Moon at all cost," Queen Angella cut in, leaning over the table. "If the Moonstone is destroyed, there will

be *nothing* left to stop the darkness."

"Uhh, *flashlights*, bitch," Swift Wind said from the back.

"Who the fuck let him in here-"

"Please, mom, it's okay, he's one of us, he won't make aaaand he's already shitting on the floor nevermind I'll clean it up later."

"I don't understand," Bow said, shaking his head. "Our friends must've seen our distress beacon, so why hasn't anyone come?"

"The Alliance is broken," Adora said sadly. "The other Princesses have their own kingdoms to protect." She looked at the others, expression grim. "Face it. No one is coming to help us."

"Someone has come!" a guard suddenly cried from the door.

"Ha! In your FACE, you dumb bitch! Power of friendship all the way!" Bow crowed, throwing his arms up. Everyone stared. "…I mean…love you, guuuurl-"

"Whatever." Adora rolled her eyes. "Who is it?"

Spinnerella and Netossa, the two Princesses who always sat too far away at the meeting table, entered the room with a box of pizza. Spinnerella was pleasingly plump with purple hair and a cape, while Netossa had shorter, light blue hair and armor.

"Yaaaaay!" Bow cheered, running towards them with his arms open. He reached them, lunged forward, and…

Swiped the pizza, running back to the others.

"Look, guys! The pizza is here!"

"*Ahem*." Netossa cleared her throat.

"Bitch, I'm not tipping," Bow said, taking out his wallet.

“We’re not the fucking delivery guy! We’re here to help you FIGHT, dumbass,” the shorter girl snapped.

“*And*, we brought pizza because we thought you might be hungry,” Spinerella added, nudging her partner.

“Oh. Ohhhh.” Bow paused. “Um…yay?”

“You still don't know what we do, do you?” Netossa accused.

“What? No! Of course I know!” Bow paused again awkwardly. “… You stand there and look *adorable* together.”

“...Nice save.” Netossa raised an eyebrow. “Seriously, though. It's in my *name*.”

There was another awkward pause.

“Fucking hell- *Net-tossa*! My name’s Netossa. I toss fucking nets.”

“Oh.” Bow blinked. “I always thought it was…*Natasha*.”

“And I am Spinnerella,” the other one added. “Because I…spin stuff. Like…the wind- look okay I know mine doesn’t make as much sense as hers-”

“...How did your parents know what to call you?” Adora asked, confused.

“Okay we are LEAVING-” Netossa turned to go.

“Honey no they need our help-” Spinnerella put a hand on her shoulder.

“Yes, we definitely do,” Queen Angella spoke up. “My poor daughter is without her powers and she’s also *glitching*-”

“Mom oh my God I told you that in *confidence*,” Glimmer whispered furiously.

"Sweetie, it's nothing to be ashamed of. Everyone makes mistakes. I'm sure you learned your lesson about not using protection-"

"Muh-*OMMM*!"

"Maybe we *should* leave," Spinnerella said under her breath.

"Yes, maybe you should," Adora agreed. "I don't want anyone risking themselves. She-blah can do this alone."

"She-blah can't even find her way out of this room alone," Bow sternly pointed out. "She needs our help."

"She does not!" Adora huffed, yanking the door open and storming through, slamming it shut behind her.

"…That's the broom closet," Bow said after a moment. "Case in point."

"Shut up!" Adora's shouted back, her voice muffled by the door. She came out and marched over to another door, ripping it open to reveal-

Swift Wind with his head stuck in a piss-fountain, lapping noisily.

"I found the water fountain, you guys! It's got this nice *subtle* flavor, I can't quite place it-"

"Alright, someone tell me where the *fuck* the door is so I can storm out!"

-With Adora-

Adora stood outside the front entrance of Bright Moon, watching the sky light up with bolts of lightning, dark clouds boiling everywhere. Glimmer and Bow walked up from behind.

“Hey, you okay?” Bow asked gently.

“Catra will be leading the Horde army when they attack,” Adora said. “I’ll have to face her. I can’t let her hurt any more people.”

“What happened to you in the First Ones temple?” Glimmer asked, placing a hand on her shoulder.

“Catra was in there with me,” Adora explained. She looked away. “Things went bad between us. She…*dumped* me…”

“Oh wow okay. I didn't know that you two were-”

“…down a pit,” she finished. “I just can't forgive her for that betrayal.”

“Oh.” Glimmer blinked. “Alright, still hurtful. I can understand where you're coming from-”

“Also she’s doesn’t want to be my submissive pet anymore. She gave me back her collar and leash and everything-”

“WHOA okay what the FUCK is this relationship-”

“Light Hope was right, I ruin everything.” Adora went on, sniffling. “This is all my fault.”

“Uh, that’s what friends are for,” Glimmer told her with a wink.

“…To help you through hard times?”

“No, they ruin your life, we’ve been over this-”

“I know what’ll cheer you up,” Bow said. He opened his arms wide. “C’mere and give mama a big ol’ hug.” Adora gave him a look.

“Hugging doesn't solve everything, Bow.”

“…You take that back,” he said, his voice dangerously soft.

“She has a point, Bow,” Glimmer began.

“Okay, that’s it, you just turned this into a group hug-” Bow started shuffling toward them, arms still out.

“Quick, we need a distraction.” Glimmer thought fast. “I know! We need to get ready for the Horde. Let’s go pick out our outfits!” There was a distant whinny, followed by the clopping of hooves, and then Swift Wind’s head suddenly smashed through the front door.

“Did I hear something about MAKEOVERS?” His head snapped to Adora. “Okay, first we’re gonna shave that ugly lesbian haircut and pluck your eyebrows-”

Adora shoved his head back through the door.

-A Few Moments Later-

“Welcome to the Bright Moon armory!” Glimmer kicked open a pair of doors to reveal a room filled with racks of glittering, sparkly weapons and armor. “I’ve been secretly stashing away weapons for *months*.”

“How did you keep your mom from finding out?” Bow asked in awe.

“Oh, it was easy, I just wrote ‘Bow’s Stuff: Please Don’t Touch’ on the door. She actually respects HIS privacy.”

“Help me find something that matches my outfit!” Bow squealed excitedly, rushing inside.

“Well,” Adora said, walking in and looking around, “you've managed to collect quite a selection- *bitch is that a CANNON*.”

"*Dibs*!!" Swift Wind cried, shoving past her.

"No fair!" Bow shouted.

"I saw it first! Back off!"

"How are you even gonna use it?" Adora asked in confusion. "You have *hooves*."

"Look who's talking, girlfriend," Swift Wind snorted back. "When's the last time you got a manicure for those *talons*?"

"I need them to stand a chance against Catra fuck off-"

"Keep it down, you guys," Glimmer shushed them. "We have to hurry before my mom-"

"Before I what?" Queen Angella asked, standing in the doorway.

"Oh my GOD, mom!" Glimmer gasped in outrage. "What are you doing in here? How *dare* you disrespect Bow's sacred privacy-"

"You told everyone I had a rash on my taint," Bow said.

"That's different shut up-"

"Did you *really* think I wouldn't notice you hoarding weapons?" Angella asked, raising an eyebrow. Glimmer just stared at her.

"...I mean kind of-"

**Ka-BOOM*!!*

A cannonball suddenly shot across the room and ripped a hole through the wall.

"HA! And you sluts thought I couldn't do it!" Swift Wind said proudly, standing beside the smoking cannon.

"…Okay you got me there," Glimmer admitted, "but I can't just sit around while my friends and home are in danger. I need to *fight*."

“Yes, I know,” Angella said with a sigh.

“Which is why- wait, what?”

“I said I know.”

“You’re…not arguing with me?” Glimmer gaped at her mother in disbelief. “But…but I had dozens of counter arguments ready and everything-” She pulled out a thick bundle of paper and held it up.

“Glimmer,” Queen Angella began, “I've come to realize now that-”

“I wrote like a hundred full pages!”

“-I can't make you into someone you're not-”

“I cited sources! It took me hours of research-”

“GLIMMER.” Her mother took her by the shoulders. “I will sit down and listen to your thesis *after* you get back, alright?”

“…Promise?” Glimmer said in a small voice.

“I promise.” The Queen raised her hand and a magical purple and pink staff appeared. She held it out to her daughter. “Here, this was your father’s staff. Now I’m passing it down to you. Use it well.”

“Oh my gosh, Mom…thank you…” Glimmer accepted it with tears in her eyes. “I'll take great care of it-” She went to turn and clocked a suit of armor, sending it crashing to the ground. “...That was for practice. I was practicing. Because I definitely know how to use this thing.” She turned and whispered to the others, “*Does anyone know how to use a staff*?”

**BOOOOM*!*

Everyone staggered as the whole Fortress shuddered dangerously.

“That wasn’t me that time, I swear,” Swift Wind blabbered. “I have hooves, I couldn’t have done it-”

"My lady!" A guard came rushing in. "The Horde is here, and they sent *this*!" They held up an envelope.

"A letter of intent!" Adora gasped in outrage, one hand to her chest. "Those sons of bitches! *For the honor of Grayskull*!!" She reached down, dramatically pulling out…

A pen.

Everyone gaped as she sat down and starting writing on a piece of paper.

"…What are you doing?" Glimmer asked after a moment.

"I'm writing a reply, of course," Adora said over her shoulder. "How else will they know that we're ready to fight them?"

**Ka-BOOM*!!*

The cannon fired again. There was a resounding **Splat** from outside, followed by screams of disgust from the invading soldiers.

"…I loaded it with my poop this time," Swift Wind said. "Those cookies really cleaned me out."

"…Yeah okay that works too."

-Let the Battle Begin!-

Adora, Glimmer, and Bow strode confidently out the front entrance of Bright Moon, clad head-to-toe in sparkling armor and freshly-honed weapons, fully kitted out and ready to take on the surrounding Horde army-

**Thunk*!*

"Oh my God, Bow! Are you okay?" Glimmer knelt by Bow, who'd collapsed under the weight and was rocking back and forth on his

back like a turtle.

"Don't worry, I'm fine, I just need to lift with my legs- nope there goes my ankle." He flopped back down in defeat, panting. "How is this shit so HEAVY?"

"I told you not to skip leg day," Adora said.

"And I told YOU I didn't wanna look too *bulky*-"

"Okay, forget it," Glimmer cut in. "Let's just take the armor off."

"But it took me an HOUR to coordinate this outfit and find the perfect shade to bring out my eyes-"

"You looked fine before! Just take it off!"

"Ugh, *fine*." Bow huffed in annoyance, then sat up and pulled off his armor chest piece. Horde soldiers immediately started hooting and throwing singles.

"Oh yeah, baby! Do it slower!"

"C'mon, dance a little! **Whistle*!"

"HEY! Show some RESPECT!" Glimmer shouted at them.

"Huh what?" Bow looked up from gathering bills and quickly stuffed a handful down his pants. "I mean, yeah, right! I am human being and I deserve to be treated like one!" He paused. "… I'll take my pants off for a hundred-"

"Bow, don't you *dare*!" Glimmer glared down at the Horde army, horrified to see that they had arrived with an army of tanks, triple-parking in the parking lot and using paraplegic sections without the proper disabled placards. "The *monsters*," she growled under her breath.

"We've got this, gang," Bow said confidently, then paused. "… Right? Please say we do. Lie if you have to-"

“Don’t worry,” Adora told them, “everything is going to be all-”

Ka-BOOOM!!

Adora went flying backwards as a cannon blast from a tank hit her square in the chest.

“Welp, I’m out,” Swift Wind stated, opening his wings to fly. “Smell ya later, losers.”

“She’s not *dead*!” Bow snapped at him. “…Right? Glimmer go check if she’s breathing-”

“No, you go check!”

“I don’t wanna touch her if she’s all dead and icky-”

“Oh, I’m fine,” Adora said in a flat tone, slowly getting to her feet and pulling out her sword. “They, however…*won’t* be.” She transformed into She-blah, then jumped down and started fucking up the tanks, screaming her head off.

“Okay, *fine*, I’ll stay,” Swift Wind said, tossing his mane. “But not because I’m, like, scared or anything.”

“I’m more *aroused* than scared,” Glimmer admitted. The others looked at her. “What?”

Waves of Horde soldiers arrived on skiffs and began shooting at the castle, the Moonstone flickering from the violent assault.

“You goddamn assholes are gonna fucking *die*!!” Glimmer screamed down at them, then turned to her mother. “Mommy, may we *please* go murder the Horde?” she asked politely.

“Yes, you may,” Queen Angella said with a nod. “You have my permission to *slay,* Queen.” She did a z-snap with her fingers and bobbed her head.

“Oh my God your mom is so fucking cringe,” Swift Wind said as Glimmer and Bow jumped on his back.

“I know, shut up!” Glimmer smacked him on the rump.

“*Harder*, daddy!”

Glimmer just stared at him.

“…Don’t kink-shame me,” Swift Wind stated, and they flew out over the battlefield to join the fray. Spotting some enemy troops below, Glimmer leaped from Swift Wind’s back and stabbed a Horde robot to death with her new staff.

“…That’s how you use this thing, right?” she asked uncertainly. “You, like…stab stuff with it?”

“Just find a tutorial on YouTube already!” Bow shouted at her, busy firing arrows.

“Yeah, seriously,” Swift Wind said, a Horde soldier impaled on his horn. “You’re being kinda ridiculous right now.”

She-blah, meanwhile, was tearing some tanks apart with her bare hands.

**Ka-BOOOM*!*

She yelped as she was hit with another cannon blast.

“Holy SHIT that’s annoying,” she grumbled. “If only I had something to defend myself with-” Her sword instantly transformed into a magical shield. “Oh my God that’s so convenient I didn’t even know I could do that-” Another cannon shot smacked it right out of her hands and it landed in a pool of water with a splash. “…Well that was fucking *useless*. I want my money back.” She-blah went on her knees in the water, searching desperately for the shield. “Ugh, this is worse than trying to find a contact lens. There is NO possible way things could get any-”

“Heyyyyy, Adora.”

She-blah looked up to find Catra smirking down at her from atop a tank.

“Oh.” She blinked up at her. “Hey, Catra. Be with you in a sec, I just dropped my shield.”

“Reaaaally? That's unfortunate.”

“Yeah, I know, right? I'm, like, completely vulnerable right now.” She-blah laughed nervously.

“You know, I'm *glad* you made it out of that ruin alive,” Catra began.

“Awww, that’s sweet-”

“Because now I can take you out *myself*.”

She-blah gaped at her.

“…Like, to dinner? Cause I thought you dumped me-”

“Are you two dating?” a muffled voice asked from inside the tank. “It kinda sounds like you’re dating.”

“No we’re not! Shut the fuck up!” Catra punched the side of the tank, swore as she broke a few knuckles, and turned her fury on She-blah. “GOD! You drive me crazy! I can’t *wait* to get my hands on you-”

“See, there it is again!” the voice echoed.

“Yeah, she’s always giving me mixed signals-” She-blah began.

“SHUT THE FUCK UP!!!”

Glimmer, meanwhile, continued to fight, using her staff to bash soldiers left and right.

"Am I using it correctly *now*?" she asked aloud. Bow flew by on Swift Wind, his phone out.

"Sorry, all I can find are baton twirling vids," he called back. "These cheer squads are *inSANE*-"

"Whatever! Just hurry up and find me something before I embarrass myself!"

"Too late for *that*." Glimmer gasped and whirled around to find Scorpia looming over her with a tank. "Aww," she laughed. "You've *accessorized*. How cute." She paused. "Like…super cute. You look…*amazing*." She paused again, then leaned in to whisper to the tank's driver. "Okay change of plans we can't shoot her-"

"Glimmer! Watch out!" Netossa and Spinnerella jumped in to help. Spinnerella blew Scorpia and the tank back with a blast of wind while Netossa threw out a huge net, trapping them.

"Oh wow, I was imagining hairnets or something lame like that," Glimmer said, blinking. "I am seriously impressed."

"Bitch, I'm finna throw some at *you*-" Netossa drew her hand back.

"Honey no-"

Back with She-blah and Catra, the verbal warfare had escalated into physical as the two traded blows.

"I thought punching was supposed to be the one thing you're *good* at!" Catra taunted, dodging a punch. "I mean, other than being a bitch."

"Looks like you claim *that* title!" She-blah shot back. "You've definitely got me beat! Give it up, Catra, there's no way you're winning this!"

"Shut up, I have a great clap-back about your busted-ass weave I still have a chance-"

"I mean this *battle*, dumbass." She-blah gestured at the fighting around them. "It's *over*."

"It's not over until Bright Moon is in *ruins* and your stupid Princess squad is *crushed* and darkness covers Etheria *forever* and I see the look on your friends' faces when they realize that you *failed* them," Catra hissed furiously.

Everyone just stopped and looked at her.

"…Damn bitch get some therapy-" someone said from the back.

"Fuck OFF!!"

"Seriously though, you need to learn when to let go," She-blah pleaded. "Just give UP already! You lost, just accept it!" There was a loud CRACK as the protective barrier surrounding the Moonstone suddenly shattered. "…We can fix that." Up above, Queen Angella fell back as a wave of Horde soldiers began firing at the crystal. "…It's cool Glimmer has it."

"I definitely do not have it!" Glimmer shouted in the distance.

"…Okay so we miiight be in a little trouble but it's nothing to be worried about," She-blah finally admitted. "It's still fine we're totally not losing-"

"Oh God we're losing!" Glimmer gasped out as she ran by. "Hold on, Mom! I'm coming!"

She-blah stood there for a long, awkward moment. Catra smirked.

"…Just *accept* it-"

"FUCK YOU NEVER-" She-blah turned and made a run for her shield.

Glimmer raced up the stairs towards the Moonstone, only to be blocked by Scorpia, who popped out from behind a rock.

“Hi, it's me again!” she said cheerfully. “Do you think you could give me some fashion pointers? Do you have anything that screams ‘I’m down to do a furry’, but in, like, a classy way?”

“Oh my God, not right now!” Glimmer groaned. “Can’t you just punch me?”

She-blah had returned to the water and started searching desperately again, on her hands and knees.

“Come on, come on, where’s that damn shield?!” She looked up to find a Horde soldier sneaking up behind her. “*You*!!” The soldier froze. “Thank *God* you’re here! Quick, help me find my shield. I dropped it somewhere around here.” Several more soldiers appeared, surrounding her. “Good, you brought friends! If we can all look together, we’ll find it in no time!” The soldiers pulled out whips. “Great idea! You can use the whips to search the water!” The whips crackled with electricity. “…Okay wait how will that help- *EAAAARGH*!!!” She broke off in a scream as they all lashed their whips at her.

Queen Angella, meanwhile, was struggling to keep the Moonstone lit, standing beneath it with her arms and wings outspread. There was an explosion nearby and several Horde robots scuttled closer, zeroing in on her.

“Don't you *dare*!!” Angella shouted at them. “I will ground you for a *week*!” The robots fired at her in a hail of laser beams. She fell to the ground and the Moonstone immediately darkened, a shadow falling over the battlefield.

“Hey, who turned out the lights?” a Horde soldier asked.

“It’s not the lights, dumbass,” another snapped.

“Yeah, oh my God, what an idiot,” Bow said, laughing nervously.

“Oh, look. There it is.” The first soldier pointed up at the dark Moonstone. “Aww, it’s broken.”

"For the love of- that's not a fucking light-bulb! That's their Runestone! We broke it. We're *winning*."

"That's okay. We just need to go to the store and buy a new one and screw it in-"

The other soldier shot him with a laser, then tossed some glitter on him.

"…Princess did it," he said aloud. "Oh, what a shame."

Across the battlefield, things weren't looking good for anyone. Glimmer was still stuck with Scorpia yakking away, Bow had stubbed his toe, and She-blah still struggled against the whips. Catra walked up to her, smiling smugly.

"Now…it's over," she whispered, leaning close and gently stroking She-blah's face.

"Are you two like…*together*?" one of the Horde soldiers asked, confused. "Do you guys need, like, a moment or something?"

"Honestly, I don't know anymore," She-blah said. "We have this love-hate thing going on."

"Oh my God, Kyle was right," a soldier said from the back. "I'm tagging this Lovers to Enemies to Lovers again-"

"I'mma tag you as Minor Character Death *bitch*-" Catra snarled, turning towards them.

"Seriously, ENOUGH!!" Glimmer burst out impatiently, cutting off Scorpia's prattling. "You know what colors would look great on you? Black and *blue*!" She wound up her staff and swung it like a bat, sending her flying.

"And here I thought *red* was my color!" Scorpia mused to herself as she flew through the air.

Glimmer leapt onto Swift Wind and they quickly flew over to the Queen.

"Mom, mom! Are you okay-" Glimmer stopped, gaping. All the robots were huddled in a corner, sulking. "What's…going on here?"

"Oh, I put them all in timeout," Angella said, crossing her arms and looking sternly at the robots. "We do NOT hit. You still have five more minutes." One of the robots beeped at her. "Do *not* back-sass me! You just earned yourself another five minutes!" The robot beeped forlornly and shuffled back.

"For the last fucking time, we are NOT dating!!" Catra shouted aloud.

"Are you sure?" another Horde soldier asked. "There's a *vibe*."

"Yeah I'm fucking sure! I *hate* this bitch!"

"You're rubbing up against her ankles and purring."

"SO?! I'm getting my hairs on her, that's all!"

"You know what I think you two need?" a voice called. "Some *space*!" A powerful blast of wind blew She-blah and Catra apart. Bow, Netossa, and Spinnerella all appeared, standing in front of her protectively and surrounding the group with a magical net.

"Adora, sweetie! Are you okay?" Bow was at her side instantly. "Here, I found your shield, hold it while we fix this-"

"I don't think we can," She-blah said weakly, looking around in dismay at the surrounding Horde tanks and soldiers.

"Oh no honey I mean…*thiiiis*." He gestured to her face, pulling out a make-up kit. "Your hair is a mess and your mascara is running a little-"

"Is this *really* the time?" Netossa asked.

“I’m fixing your lip gloss after, shut up-”

The tanks began charging their cannons and everyone cringed, ready for the end.

“Come on, guys!” Bow refused to give up, still going at it with a lash brush and some lipstick. If we’re gonna die, we gonna die looking HOT!”

“Bow, stop it!”

“It’s cool you guys I’ll just start stripping again-”

“Did someone say…*stripping*?” a voice called from afar.

“…*Oh God please no*,” She-blah whispered under her breath, horrified.

The ground began to shake as a huge tidal wave swept over the battlefield. Mermista stood at the helm of a ship (texting and driving) riding the crest of the wave, her boy-toy Seahawk grinding on the mast in a glittery thong and heels.

“ADVENTUUUURE!!”

“Dude, we’ll pay you to put your clothes back ON,” some Horde soldiers shouted.

Seahawk doused them with gasoline and started throwing matches.

“…He really needs to stop doing that,” Bow said over the screams. “Stealing my role, I mean.”

The tidal wave smashed into the Horde tanks, sweeping them away, and the ship ground to a halt in front of the others.

“Mermista!” She-blah cried in surprise as they hopped down to join them. “…And…Seahawk- did you *really* have to bring him-”

"Sorry it took so long to get here," Mermista said, putting her phone away. "Seahawk had to wax his mustache-"

"That's polite talk for 'we were *smashing*'-" Seahawk began.

"Shut up!" Mermista elbowed him hard. "It was *supposed* to be a quickie but then this idiot wanted to try out a new move-"

"It's fine, I'm just glad you came," She-blah thankfully cut her off.

"Several times, actually-"

Mermista decked him.

"…Babe I just wanna say I love you so much," Netossa said to Spinnerella.

"I know, I appreciate you too, sweetie-"

Vines suddenly burst out of the ground, grabbing soldiers and tanks. Perfuma rode in on a long tendril, landing next to She-blah, panting hard.

"I saw the distress beacon! I'm here to help! Are you okay?!" she gasped out. "Am I getting brownie points? Will you have sex with me now? Will you have sex with me *anyway*?"

"Uhhhhh-" She-blah just stared at her in confusion.

"I'll take that for a yes." Perfuma went in for a kiss.

"Hey, Perfuma!" Bow said, popping between them. "How you-ooh, thanks for the kiss! Love you, too, girl! *Mwah*!"

"*Are you fucking kidding me*-"

"Ugh, all this friendship bullshit is gonna make me *hurl*," Catra said, gagging a little. "No, wait, that's just a hairball. Still gross, though." She climbed onto a crippled tank and aimed the cannon at the Moonstone, firing and hitting the support pillar. "Ha! Eat it, bitches!" The entire platform began to collapse, only to be frozen

in place by a thick layer of ice. “What the fuck!” Princess Frosta came shredding up on a sick-ass snowboard, braking in a spray of snow.

“S’up, nerds?” she said, pushing up her goggles.

“I don’t remember her being this cool,” Bow said. “OMIGOD GET IT *COOL* CUZ SHE’S THE *ICE* PRINCESS YOU GUYS-”

“Elsa, you made it!” She-blah cried happily.

“Kinda wish I hadn’t now.” The girl glared at her. “I told you before, my name is *Frosta*.”

“Oh, right, right, sorry. Frozen sucks-”

“You shut your *mouth* Frozen is the best movie of *all* time and I will fight *anyone* who disagrees-”

“*Oh my God I knew it*.”

“They disagree with you!” Bow pointed at the Horde soldiers. They gave a friendly wave back. “I heard them saying the characters were one-dimensional, the plot was predictable, and they think Olaf is a shitty comic relief-”

“Those sons of BITCHES!” Elsa snapped her goggles back on and turned to face them. “They’re about to get Frosta-bite!”

“Oh, cool, cuz you’re gonna, like, freeze them?” She-blah asked.

“No, cuz I’m literally gonna bite them.”

“…What the fuck, kid.”

The Princesses (Bow, Seahawk, and Swift Wind included) all lined up, ready to fight the Horde.

“For Etheria!!” She-blah cried, holding up her sword. It blazed with magical light that traveled up to the Moonstone, which exploded with power, pushing back the dark clouds and bringing

out the sun. It even traveled to the other kingdoms, touching each Runestone in turn and powering them up.

Glimmer and her mother were hugging beneath the Moonstone, both of them glowing with newfound power.

"Go get them, sweetie," Queen Angella said, patting her back. "… You still have the staff, right?"

"Uhhhhhh…" Glimmer stared at her blankly. "…Bow has it. Gottagobye!" She quickly teleported away, landing right on Bow with a thud.

"…Well at least the glitching is fixed," he said, face planted in the dirt.

"This is so great, we're all united as one," She-blah said happily, looking around at everyone. "Princess Squad, move OUT!" No-one moved. "Umm…"

"You could ask nicely."

"Yeah, at least say *please*."

"I dunno, I kinda like when she's assertive I think that's my kink-"

"Whatever!" She-blah shouted in exasperation. "Just get out there and kick some Horde ass!"

They all separated and ran off to fight, using their souped-up powers and working together efficiently to defeat the Horde. She-blah jumped on Swift Wind and rode him through the air, dropping more shit bombs on the tanks and soldiers. Finally she landed and the others gathered around her as she held up her sword, which began glowing a soft blue. One by one, everyone reached out and placed a hand on the sword, each of them beginning to glow as well, until they were all awash with color.

"Is anyone else getting Sailor Moon vibes?"

“Bow seriously shut up-”

“Oh come on I can’t be the only one-”

A wave of rainbow energy burst forth and slammed into the army of Horde soldiers, throwing them back and shattering their weapons.

“Oh, great! Now we’re *gay*!!” A couple soldiers ripped off their helmets and started making out aggressively.

“Uh, actually, no, that’s not what-” She-blah began.

“Shut up, we’re gay now!!” They started using tongue. “Look what you made us do!”

“Huh. It had no effect on me,” Scorpia said to herself. “Because. You know. I’m already a raging lesbian.” She looked over hopefully at Catra, who was sopping wet from head to toe. “Feel any different?”

“Nope. Still wanna fucking murder everyone.”

“…So you’re not even a *liiiittle* horny- *pthhhpppt*!” She broke off sputtering as Catra shook herself off, spraying her with more water.

“Ohhh, noooo, you got splashed a little,” Perfuma cooed, batting her eyes up at She-blah. “NOW do you wanna-”

“*Yeah*!! The power of friendship wins again!! Group hug!!” Bow cried, grabbing everyone and hauling them in. Perfuma just shrieked and lunged for him. “Whoa, girl! You’re squeezing a *little* too hard, there. Also, you’re going for my *neck* and not my *torso*, rookie mistake- GAK!”

As everyone cheered and celebrated their victory, She-blah sadly watched as Catra retreated with the rest of the Horde soldiers. In a last-ditch effort, she took out a back of cat treats and gave it a

little shake. Catra just flipped her off, hopped in a tank, and sped away.

"…It was worth a try-"

"Are those snacks? I'm *starving*!" Seahawk snatched the bag from her hand and started cramming treats in his mouth. "Mmm, *delicious*! They have a distinct *fishy* flavor." He looked at the bag. "Hey, it's gonna help me get a glossy coat!"

"You fucking cannibal." Mermista glared at him. "I'm not letting you spit in my mouth anymore."

"Babe come ON I'll brush my teeth-"

"Quit hogging them all!" Swift Wind snapped. "Gimme some or I'll bite your face off."

"*OH MY GOD HE'LL DO IT JUST GIVE IT TO HIM*," Bow said, his eyes wide with horror.

"I'm starting to regret my decision," Frosta muttered to herself.

"Same," Netossa and Spinnerella said.

"It's over," Glimmer sighed with relief. "Bright Moon is saved and the Princesses are finally united. Now…" She glanced around. "Who wants to order *pizza*?"

Everyone immediately erupted into an argument over what to order, devolving into hair-pulling, girly slaps, and shoving (mostly between Bow and Seahawk).

"Here we go again," Queen Angella groaned, head in her hands.

-Back at the Horde Fortress-

Catra climbed the steps leading up to Hordak's throne, Scorpia and Entrapta flanking her on either side.

"Force Captain Catra," Hordak said darkly, leaning forward in his seat. "It seems your little science project has *failed*." He held up a paper marked with a big F in red pen. "I *will* be notifying your parents about this."

"Aww, man, my moms are gonna be *so* pissed," Scorpia muttered to herself.

"On the contrary, it was a huge success!" Entrapta burst out, practically vibrating with excitement. "I know even *more* about First Ones technology than *ever* before!" She paused. "…I need to go change my underwear."

"Why, you shitted again?" Scorpia asked. Entrapta stared at her blankly.

"…No."

"…LemonaaaAAAAADE-"

"I almost conquered Bright Moon on my *first* assignment," Catra argued. "Plus I burned that stupid fucking forest to the ground as extra credit."

"…I learned nothing and contributed nothing," Scorpia said cheerfully. "I'm just happy to be here."

"Hmm…maintaining a positive attitude even in the face of failure. That's enough to boost your grade up to a D-. You pass." Hordak stood up and nodded at Catra. "I will give you another chance to prove your worth to me…as my Teacher's Assistant."

"Sounds perfect," Catra purred, smirking with satisfaction.

"The orientation will be next Monday, be sure to pack a lunch as it'll be a all-day event with dozens of lectures and training videos. You'll need to catch up on some light reading beforehand, about

five volumes on the proper code of conduct of a TA, as well as your expectations and duties-”

“*Nevermind I quit*.”

-Episode 13 End-

Chapter End Notes

Well, I finally finished parodying the entire first season of She-ra! If I feel like continuing this series, I will probably just write it for myself and not post it here. Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!